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# Speaking the map

## Komnzo texts

Christian Döhler

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I dedicate this book to my *ngom* Kurai Tawéth who grew up speaking the neighboring variety Wära and wishes for his children to speak Komnzo. *gatha mithnzo nrä. nzone brigsi tfotfo rä. karfo kwa ŋabrigwro bonemanzo!*

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I thank the Farem people for welcoming me into their community, for safeguarding me and for teaching me their beautiful language. In the context of this book, I thank them especially for sharing their stories with me. I was only able to include a few of these wonderful narratives in this book.

I pay tribute to the nine storytellers here, who are the rightful authors and owners of the texts prepared for this collection: Ruth Abia, Lucy Abia, Daure Kaumb, Maembu Kwozi, Kurai Tawéth, Maraga Kwozi, Abia Bai, Kaumb Bai, the late Marua Bai.

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# Abbreviations

The category labels for abbreviations follow the Leipzig Glossing Rules.[1] Additional category labels are listed below.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| ABSC | absconditive (attention getter, 'look here') | LPL | large plural |
| ADJZR | adjectivaliser | MED | medial deictic |
| AND | andative ('away') | ND | non-dual |
| ANIM | animate | NPL | non-plural |
| APPR | apprehensive | NPST | non-past |
| ASSOC | associative case | NSG | non-singular |
| CHAR | characteristic case | ONLY | exclusive marker ('only', 'just') |
| DEM | (anaphoric) demonstrative | PH | placeholder ('thingamajig') |
| DIA | diathetic prefix | PN | proper name |
| EMPH | emphatic | PLN | place name |
| ETC | et cetera ('and all') | POT | potential |
| IAM | iamitive ('already') | PRIV | privative case |
| IC | inclusory case | PROP | proprietive case |
| IMN | imminent particle ('about to') | REDUP | reduplication |
| IO | indirect object | RPST | recent past |
| IPST | immediate past | SIMIL | similative case |
| ITER | iterative | TEMP | temporal case |
| | | VENT | venitive ('towards') |

[1] http://www.eva.mpg.de/lingua/resources/glossing-rules.php

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# 1 Preliminaries

## 1.1 Introduction

This collection of Komnzo texts has the thematic focus of landscape, place names and locality. One does not need to dig very deep into Komnzo oral literature in order to investigate this topic. Judging just by the occurrence of place names in speech of any genre, one has to conclude that the anchoring of events in space is of great importance to Komnzo speakers. An early visitor to the region was the Government Anthropologist for the Territory of Papua, Francis Edgar Williams, who observed that "if you ask your guide where you stand at any moment, he will be able to give a name to the land" (1936: 207). In the late 1970s, the anthropologist Mary Ayres was based in the Komnzo speaking village Rouku. Ayres chose locality as the topic of her doctoral thesis — entitled *This side, that side: locality and exogamous group definition in Morehead area, Southwestern Papua* (Ayres 1983). She points out that the system of place names "is staggering in its elaboration" (1983: 38). In the following, I will include some analysis of the way Komnzo speakers use their language to talk about space, landscape and locality.

This book is structured as follows. As most of the cultural, demographic, anthropological and historical background information is given in the grammar of Komnzo (Döhler 2018: §1.3ff.), I include here only a summary thereof (§1.2). After a brief typological overview of the linguistic structure (§1.3) and a description of the glossing and orthography conventions (§1.4), I describe the provenance of the texts and the editing process (§1.5). Next, I address topics and text genres (§1.6), introduce the speakers (§1.7) and the texts (§1.8). The conceptualization of landscape, place and locality is topic of the second chapter (§2). The main body of the book, consists of the 14 texts (§3-§16). For each text, I provide the metadata in the introduction, a short summary of the content and some background information, a free translation into English in prose and finally the interlinearised text.

## 1.2 The setting

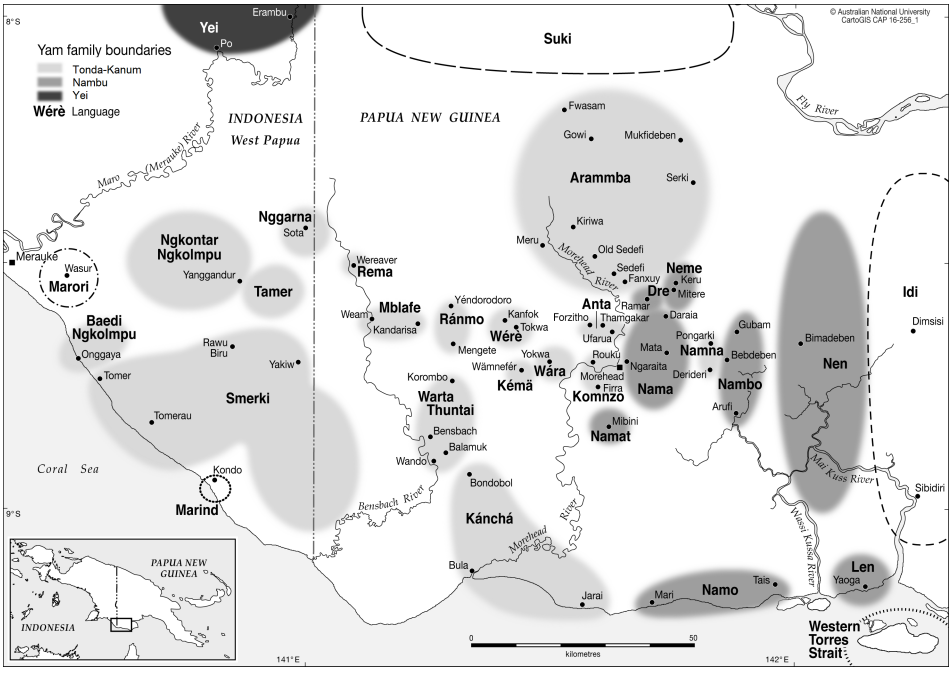
Komnzo speakers refer to themselves as the "Farem tribe". *Farem kar* is the name for the place of origin; the place where the apical ancestors of all Komnzo speak-

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ing clans met before they settled their respective places. Thus, in the oral history of Farem people, the concept of a shared place of origin overlaps with speech variety. Henceforth, I use the terms "Komnzo speakers" and "Farem people" interchangeably.

Komnzo is spoken in the village of *Rouku*, which is located about seven kilometers west of Morehead and about one kilometer north of the Morehead River. See Figure (1.1) for an overview of the area. It is situated on the road that connects *Morehead* with *Weam* in the west. Traditional lands expand about 20km east-west and 25km north-south. Other settlements are *Morehead Station*, 7 km east of Rouku, and *Gunana*, 2 km west of Rouku. While the people in one of these settlements have permanent houses, their lives are quite flexible, as they spend a lot of time in their gardens or in camps along the river, where they have storage houses and temporary shelters for sleeping.


Yam family boundaries
Tonda-Kanum
Nambu
Yei
Wérè Language
INDONESIA
West Papua
PAPUA NEW GUINEA
Coral Sea
Yei
Erambu
Po
Suki
Fwasam
Gowi
Mukfideben
Arammba
Serki
Kiriwa
Meru
Old Sedefi
Sedefi
Fanxuy
Neme
Keru
Dre
Mitere
Anta
Ramar
Thamgakar
Forzitho
Daraia
Ufarua
Pongarki
Gubam
Bimadeben
Mata
Namha
Bebdeben
Rouku
Ngaraita
Deriderí
Nen
Nambo
Arufi
Nama
Komnzo
Firra
Morehead
Wämnefér
Wára
Kémä
Mengete
Yokwa
Rámno
Kanfok
Tokwa
Mblafe
Yéndorodoro
Weam
Kandarisa
Wereaver
Rema
Nggarna
Sota
Ngkontar
Ngkolmpu
Merauke
Wasur
Marori
Yanggandur
Tamer
Baedi
Ngkolmpu
Onggaya
Tomer
Rawu
Biru
Yakiw
Smerki
Tomerau
Kondo
Marind
Warta
Thuntai
Korombo
Bensbach
Balamuk
Wando
Bondobol
Kánchá
Bula
Jarai
Mari
Namo
Tais
Len
Yaoga
Western
Torres
Strait
Idi
Dimsisi
Sibidiri
Namat
Mibini
Mari Kuss River
West Kussa River
Fly River
Merauke River
Morehead River
Bensbach River
Mato
Kikori River
Aramia River
Strickland River
Purari River
Gulf
Western
Central
Milne Bay
Oro
Morobe
Madang
Sandaun
Eastern Highlands
Enga
Hela
Southern Highlands
Western Highlands
Jiwaka
Simbu
Gulf
Central
Milne Bay
Oro
Morobe
Madang
Sandaun
Eastern Highlands
Enga
Hela
Southern Highlands
Western Highlands
Jiwaka
Simbu
Western

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widespread multilingualism. The local marriage pattern dictates that the women move their place of residence to the place of their respective husbands. They almost always come from a different village with a different language. The system can be described as symmetrical sister-exchange. Even though exogamous groups are based on clan and place, Mary Ayres states that it was explained to her sometimes as "a rule of dialect exogamy: *"We should not intermarry because we talk the same language"* is a phrase sometimes stated by informants" (1983: 186). As a consequence of this quasi-linguistic exogamy, children acquire not just the languages of both parents, but often the languages of their aunts and grandmothers, who might come from yet another language community. A repertoire of 4-5 local languages is quite common before entering the school system which is taught in English. The high levels of multilingualism — individual as well as societal — are contrasted by a conversational practice in which interactants converse in their respective languages: A Komnzo speaker meeting a Nama speaker on the road converses in Komnzo, while his interlocutor replies in Nama. This pattern is sometimes called "dual-lingualism" (Lincoln 1979) or "receptive multilingualism" (Rehbein et al. 2011, Singer 2023). Essentially, Komnzo speakers remain loyal to the language of their fathers — their patrilect — mainly for reasons of language ideology, emblematicity and linguistic purism. Over the recent years, a body of descriptive literature has emerged that focuses on this pattern in the Morehead District (Evans 2012, Evans et al. 2017, Döhler 2018: 34-36, Kashima 2020, Döhler 2021, Schokkin 2021, Schokkin 2024, Döhler forthcoming(b)).

Superimposed on the indigenous pattern of multilingualism is English as a lingua franca. English is the language of religion, education, media, and administration. The church services are held in English, with important phrases being translated for rhetorical purposes in Komnzo. The language of instruction in the primary school in Rouku and in the high school in Morehead is English. The national and provincial political sphere is conducted in English, as are the few available media channels such as the newspaper Post Courier and Radio Fly. With a few exceptions, everyone is proficient in English. Speakers over 65–70 also know Motu, as this was the language of the church and the school system until the 1970s. Younger men who have travelled and sometimes worked outside the region speak Tok Pisin and Bahasa Indonesia.

The languages of the Morehead District are not under immediate threat from English or from Tok Pisin, whose influence is growing only slowly. Nevertheless, they should be considered endangered languages due to their small size and limited distribution. Most are spoken in a single village. The traditional multilingualism is certainly at risk, as English is becoming more important in communication between different communities. This process can already be observed

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in the town of Morehead, where people with different linguistic backgrounds meet regularly. Changes of this kind have been the harbingers of language loss in other parts of New Guinea (Aikhenvald 2002).

Social segmentation of people in the Morehead district is organized in a multi-layered grouping system (cf. Williams 1936, Ayres 1983). The most basic level of organization is the clan. Clan membership is passed through the father's line, and clans are localized in the sense that they exist in and are associated with a particular tract of land. At the second level, all clans belong to one out of three groups: *Bangu*, *Sangara*, *Mayawa*. I use the term "section" for this level. If there were not three (but two) groups at this level, the more established term "moieties" would be appropriate here. Sections are non-local in that one finds them in almost all villages in the Morehead district. For example, there are two Mayawa clans in the Komnzo speaking territory (*Mrzar Mayawa* and *Banibani Mayawa*), their lands are adjacent, they belong to the same exogamous group, they share the same totemic animals and most mythological stories. At the same time, different Mayawa clans are found at other villages in the Morehead district. At the third level, all clans of all sections in a specific area claim prior unity at a particular place. This often involves the travelling myths of the respective apical ancestor. One such myth is given in the text in §3. For *Rouku*, this place is called *Farem kar*. The third level aligns with language variety, thus, members of all clans (of all three sections; and all clans within these sections) who claim their mythical origin at *Farem kar* are also speakers of Komnzo. An overview of the clans and sections of the Farem people is given in Table (1.1).

Table 1.1: Clans of the Farem people

| SECTION | CLAN NAME ('translation') | # OF PATRILINES |
|---|---|---|
| Bangu | *Nümgar* ('crocodile') | 1 |
| Sangara | *Farem* (place name) | 2 |
| Sangara | *Wazu* (place name) | 2 |
| Sangara | *Mutherata* (place name) | 1 |
| Mayawa | *Banibani* ('Brahminy Kite') | 2 |
| Mayawa | *Mrzar* (proper name) | 1 |

In addition to self-attribution, there is a web of more or less visible markers that distinguish a member of one group from that of another group regardless at which level. Such markers include certain designs printed on grass skirts, particular patterns carved on arrows or drums, special songs and dance styles. Further-

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more, there are totemic animals which one may not hunt or eat. Some of these markers overlap, for example the Swamp Eel (*dobakwr*) is a totem for all Mayawa and all Sangara clans. The most important fact about sections and clans lies in land ownership and exogamy. Moreover, clan affiliation is not only a theme in many stories, but some stories are also the property of a particular clan (cf. §2.7). For more information on the topic of social segmentation see Döhler (2018: 26ff.).

## 1.3 Grammar sketch

### 1.3.1 Introduction

Komnzo is a Papuan language of the Yam language family. The term "Papuan" was introduced by Ray (1895: 16), who defined these languages ex negativo as the languages of the region near New Guinea that are neither Austronesian nor Australian. The number of distinct Papuan language families that have been proposed ranges from ten (Wurm 1975) to 23 (Ross 2005) up to 60 (Foley 1986). Although authors acknowledge the incredible diversity within New Guinea, there have been some attempts at defining grammatical properties which are characteristic for Papuan languages (Foley 1986 and Foley 2000). Komnzo, the languages of the Yam family, and possibly the whole Southern New Guinea area deviate from this Papuan type in a number of ways. Other authors have shown that the languages of New Guinea do not share a set of typological features of Papuan type that set them apart from the languages of the world (Comrie & Cysouw 2012). In the following sections, I briefly introduce the typologically most striking features of the language. For an in-depth description, I refer the reader to the grammar (Döhler 2018).

### 1.3.2 Phonology

The Komnzo phoneme inventory consists of eight vowels and 18 consonants. The vowels are the five cardinal vowels [i], [e], [a], [ɔ], [u] plus a low front unrounded vowel [æ] and, two front rounded vowels [y] and [œ], which are unusual for Papuan languages.[1] The most frequent vowel is the epenthetic vowel, schwa [ə], which not analysed as a phoneme. Figure 1.2 shows the vowel inventory.

There are 18 consonantal phonemes (cf. Table 1.2). These follow a set of pairs of voiceless and prenasalised plosives at the alveolar and velar points of articulation: [t], [ⁿd], [k], [ᵑg]. There are labialised velars: [kʷ], [ᵑgʷ]. At the bilabial point of

[1]Outside of the Yam family front rounded vowels are also found in Awyu-Dumut languages (van Enk & de Vries 1997: 60).

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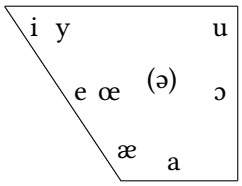



Figure 1.2: Vowels

articulation there is only a prenasalised plosive [ᵐb], while its oral counterpart [b] only occurs in loanwords. There are three nasals [m], [n], [ŋ], one trill/tap [r], two semivowels [j], [w] and, again unusual for Papuan languages, three fricatives [ɸ], [ð], [s] and two affricates [ts], [ⁿdz]. It follows that we can identify three main points of articulation: bilabial, alveolar and velar. Further points of articulation include dental [ð], palato-alveolar [ts] and [ⁿdz] as well as palatal [j].

Table 1.2: Consonants

| | bilabial | dental | alveolar | palato-alveolar | palatal | velar | labio-velar |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| stop & affricate | | | t | ts | | k | kʷ |
| pren. stop & affricate | ᵐb | | ⁿd | ⁿdz | | ᵑg | ᵑgʷ |
| fricative | ɸ | ð | s | | | | |
| nasal | m | | n | | | ŋ | |
| lateral | | | r | | | | |
| semivowel | | | | | j | | w |

As in other Papuan languages such as Kalam (Blevins & Pawley 2010) many syllables lack phonemically specified vowels. In this case, an epenthetic vowel may be inserted, usually a short central vowel [ə]. Many words lack phonemically specified vowels altogether, for example the inflected verb *ymgthkwrmth* [jəməᵑgəθkʷərəməθ] 'they were feeding him'.

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The syllable structure allows for complex onsets of the type CRV, as in *gru* 'shooting star' or *srak* 'boy'. Otherwise onsets are simply CV. Even though vowel-initial words exist, they are always produced with a glottal stop, as in *ane* [ʔane] 'that' or *ebar* [ʔe$^{m}$bar] 'head'. Syllable codas are optional, but they consist of one consonant maximally.

### 1.3.3 Morphology

Komnzo morphology can be used to easily distinguish nominals from verbs. As in other Yam languages such as Nama (Siegel 2017, Siegel 2023) and Nen (Evans 2015), Komnzo verb morphology exhibits a high degree of complexity. Verbal morphology is highly synthetic, while nominal morphology is agglutinative and almost entirely suffixing.

Komnzo nouns are inflected for number if their referent is animate. Otherwise number marking only takes place in the verb. Furthermore, nouns are marked for case by enclitics, which attach to the last element of the noun phrase. Table 1.3 shows the case markers for the inanimate noun *efoth* 'sun, day' and the animate noun *kabe* 'man, people'. For more information on the range of meanings of case marked noun phrases, I refer the reader to the grammar (Döhler 2018: 135ff.).

Nominal morphology in Komnzo is comparatively simple. Case marking is shown by enclitics that attach to the rightmost element of a noun phrase, which is usually a head noun as in (1a), but may sometimes be a modifier as in (1b).

(1) a. *kafar kabefnzo*
kafar kabe=f=nzo
big man=ERG.SG=ONLY
'only the big man (did sth.)'

b. *kabe kafarfnzo*
kabe kafar=f=nzo
man big=ERG.SG=ONLY
'only the big man (did sth.)'

In contrast to nominals, verb morphology is highly synthetic. Verbs may index up to two arguments showing agreement in person, number and gender. Verbs encode 18 TAM categories, valency, directionality and deictic status. Complexity lies not only in the number of categories verbs express, but also in the categories are encoded.

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Table 1.3: Cases

| | INANIMATE | ANIMATE (SG) | ANIMATE (NSG) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Absolutive | *efoth* | *kabe* | *kabe=é* |
| Ergative | *efoth=f* | *kabe=f* | *kabe=é* |
| Dative | *efoth=n* | *kabe=n* | *kabe=nm* |
| Possessive | *efoth=ane* | *kabe=ane* | *kabe=aneme* |
| Locative | *efoth=en* | *kabe=dben* | *kabe=medben* |
| Allative | *efoth=fo* | *kabe=dbo* | *kabe=medbo* |
| Ablative | *efoth=fa* | *kabe=dba* | *kabe=medba* |
| Temp. locative | *efoth=thamen* | n/a | n/a |
| Temp. purposive | *efoth=thamar* | n/a | n/a |
| Temp. possessive | *efoth=thamane* | n/a | n/a |
| Instrumental | *efoth=me* | n/a | n/a |
| Purposive | *efoth=r* | n/a | n/a |
| Characteristic | *efoth=ma* | *kabe=anema* | *kabe=anemema* |
| Proprietive | *efoth=karä* | *kabe=karä* | n/a |
| Privative | *efoth=mär* | *kabe=mär* | n/a |
| Associative | *efoth=ä* | n/a | n/a |
| Inclusory | n/a | *kabe=r* | *kabe=ä* |
| Similative | *efoth=thatha* | *kabe=thatha* | n/a |

### 1.3.4 Distributed exponence

Komnzo verbs exhibit what may be called "distributed exponence" (Carroll 2016); an exponence type that is characterised by morphemic underspecification. For many grammatical categories different slots have to be taken into account in order to arrive at the value of a grammatical category. This phenomenon is different from multiple exponence (e.g. circumfixes) in that each morphological slot can be manipulated independently. The basic principle is shown in Table 1.4 in the expression of a few selected tense-aspect-mood (TAM) categories for the verb *thoraksi* 'arrive, appear'; all in 3SG.M.

Distributed exponence means that we cannot gloss the prefix *y-* for a tense value, because it is used for the inflections of non-past, recent past and past. Furthermore, glossing the suffix *-m* as a durative is only half of its function as it backshifts tense as well from non-past to recent past and again from recent past to past tense. In fact, the only TAM morpheme in the table that serves only one function is the past suffix *-a*. Moreover, the table shows that the verb stem itself

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Table 1.4: Distributed exponence - TAM

| | |
|---|---|
| Non-past imperfective | *y-thorak-wr* |
| Recent-past imperfective | *su-thorak-wr* |
| Recent-past durative | *y-thorak-wr-m* |
| Recent-past perfective | *sa-thor* |
| Past imperfective | *y-thorak-wr-a* |
| Past durative | *su-thorak-wr-m* |
| Past perfective | *sa-thor-a* |
| Iterative | *su-thor* |

is also an exponent of TAM: (*thorak* versus *thor*). Indeed, most Komnzo verbs possess two stems which are sensitive to aspect. Again, the stem alone is not sufficient to express the aspectual values (imperfective, perfective, iterative, durative), but it is the combination of stem type, prefix and suffix.

Distributed exponence is best explained with the way Komnzo marks number on verbs. The four possible values are singular, dual, plural, and large plural.[2] The exponents of number are distributed over two morphological slots. There is a binary distinction in the prefix (*y-* vs. *e-*) and the suffix (*-thgr* vs. *-thgn*). The four possible combinations of these exponents encode the four number values. This is shown with the intransitive verb *migsi* 'hang' in a third person frame in Table 1.5.

Table 1.5: Distributed exponence - number

| | |
|---|---|
| 3SG | *y-mi-thgr* |
| 3DU | *e-mi-thgn* |
| 3PL | *e-mi-thgr* |
| 3LPL | *y-mi-thgn* |

### 1.3.5 Syntax

Komnzo is a double-marking language. The case marking is organised in an ergative-absolutive system. In addition to three core cases (absolutive, ergative

[2]Large plurals are available only for a small subset of verbs.

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and dative), there are 14 semantic cases (cf. Table 1.3). Verbs index up to two arguments. The undergoer argument is indexed by a prefix and the actor argument is indexed by a suffix, as in (4) and (5) below. One-place predicates split along the lines of stative versus dynamic event types. The latter employ the suffix for indexing, as in (3), while the former make use of the prefix, as in (2). However, in many cases the assignment of a verb lexeme to those inflectional patterns is rather idiosyncratic. Valency changing morphology, glossed as DIA (for diathetic) in (5), enables the indexing of a goal, beneficiary or possessor in the prefix. This is shown below with the verbs 'sleep' (2), 'return' (3), 'see' (4) and 'give' (5). I use the term "template" to describe the different inflectional patterns in which verb stems are found. Templates are fixed for some lexemes, but on the whole the system is remarkably fluid (Döhler 2022; 2023a; 2023b).

(2) *fi yrugr.*
fi y-rugr
3.ABS 3SG.M-sleep
'He sleeps.'

(3) *fi ŋabrigwrth.*
fi ŋabrigwr-th
3.ABS return-3PL
'They return.'

(4) *nafa fi ymarth.*
nafa fi y-mar-th
3PL.ERG 3.ABS 3SG.M-see-3PL
'They see him.'

(5) *nafa yare kaben yarithrth.*
nafa yare kabe=n y-a-rithr-th
3PL.ERG bag(ABS) man=DAT.SG 3SG.M-DIA-give-3PL
'They give the man the bag.'

The most frequent word order in Komnzo is SOV, more accurately AUV[3], since there is only weak evidence for a subject category. At the same time, the flagging of noun phrases with case allows for considerable freedom in the word order patterns. Nominal compounds and noun phrases are typically head-final, although

[3]AUV: actor undergoer verb.

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modifying elements in the noun phrase, for example adjectives or quantifiers, may occur after the head. Relative clauses follow their head.

Subordinate clauses in Komnzo are usually non-finite employing nominalised verbs with appropriate case markers. Verb chaining and the distinction between medial and final verb forms, which are typical for Papuan languages, are not found in Komnzo. The following examples show a phase complement (6) and a complement of desire (7).

(6) *nafa with rkusi thethkäfath.*
nafa with rku-si the-thkäfa-th
3NSG.ERG banana(ABS) knock_down-NMLZ 2|3PL-start-2|3PL
'They started knocking down the bananas.'

(7) *fi miyo yé nge fathasir.*
fi miyo yé nge fatha-si=r
3.ABS desire 3SG.M.be child hold-NMLZ=PURP
'He wants to hold the child.'

In addition to nominalised verbs, clauses can be connected with conjunctions (8), relative pronouns (9) or a placeholder pronominal inflected for case (10).

(8) *fi z zebnaf o komnzo yrugr?*
fi z zebnaf-ø o komnzo y-rugr
3ABS already wake_up-3SG or still 3SG.M-sleep
'Did he wake up already or is he still sleeping?'

(9) *kabe sathor kayé mane sfmarwrme.*
kabe sa-thor kayé mane sf-marwrm-e
man(ABS) 3SG.M-arrive yesterday which 3SG.M-see-1PL
'The man who we saw yesterday arrived.'

(10) *ŋare z zefar bänema nafane kkauna zwarithrth.*
ŋare z zefar-ø bäne=ma nafane kkauna
woman(ABS) already set_off-3SG PH=CHAR 3SG.POSS things
zu-a-rithr-th
3SG.F-DIA-give-3PL
'The woman has left already, because they gave back her belongings to her.'

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## 1.4 Conventions

### 1.4.1 Glossing conventions

The interlinearization follows the Leipzig Glossing Rules. Additional abbreviations that appear in the gloss line are listed in the preamble to this book.

With the exception of verbs, I apply the standard item-and-arrangement model for interlinearization, i.e., words are segmented on one line, which are then glossed on the line below. The phenomenon of distributed exponence (§1.3.4) prompts us to take a different approach for verbs, namely the word-in-paradigm model (Matthews 1974), which takes the word, rather than the morpheme, as the level of analysis. Hence, I do not provide a morpheme segmentation, but instead the verb stem is separated from all affixal material by \slanted lines/ on the morpheme tier. On the gloss tier, the inflected verb form is placed in its paradigm by listing information in the following order: argument structure, TAM, directionality, and (following a backslash) lexeme translation, as in (11). The values of grammatical categories are separated with a colon (:), e.g. NPST:IPFV:AND for non-past, imperfective, andative. Grammatical values that belong to the same domain are not separated or separated with a fullstop (.), e.g. 3SG.F for third singular feminine. The glossing of argument structure does not employ labels such as SBJ and OBJ, instead an arrow symbol indicates an actor > undergoer relationship, e.g. 1SG>3SG.M for 'I (did sth. to) him'. The only exception are ditransitivized verbs, which include the label IO for indirect object, usually a goal, beneficiary or possessor.

Note that for the overview section in this publication, especially in §1.3.5, I have used a simplified gloss for explanatory purposes. A fully glossed version of example (10) above would look like (11).

(11) *ŋare z zefar bänema nafane kkauna zwarithrth.*
ŋare z ze\far/ bäne=ma nafane kkauna
woman(ABS) already 2|3SG:RPST:PFV\set_off PH=CHAR 3SG.POSS things
zwa\ri/thrth.
2|3PL>3SG.F.IO:RPST:IPFV\give
'The woman has left already, because they gave back her belongings to her.'

### 1.4.2 Orthographic conventions

There is no writing tradition in Komnzo, but most people can read and write in one of the official languages, namely English and Motu. The mission school,

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which was based at Rouku during the 1960s, operated in Motu, but today English is the teaching language at the school in Morehead. Thus, reading and writing in Komnzo has not been promoted in the past. As a consequence, literacy in one's mother tongue is an alien concept for most Komnzo speakers.

The first attempt to develop an orthography for Komnzo took place at an alphabet workshop organised by Marco and Alma Bouvé of the Summer Institute of Linguistics (SIL) at Morehead Station in 2000. Representatives from several villages took part in this workshop, and the result was a number of different orthographies. The orthography developed for Komnzo was not in use at the time I began my work in 2010. Together with members of the community, the orthography was revised several times. The texts in this book make use of the graphemes shown in Table 1.6 and Figure 1.3.

Table 1.6: Consonant graphemes

| | bilabial | dental | alveolar | palato-alveolar | palatal | velar | labio-velar |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| stop & affricate | | | t | z | | k | kw |
| pren. stop & affricate | b | | d | nz | | g | gw |
| fricative | f | th | s | | | | |
| nasal | m | | n | | | ŋ | |
| lateral | | | r | | | | |
| semivowel | | | | | y | | w |

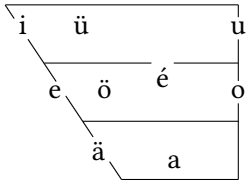



Figure 1.3: Vowel graphemes

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Note that the epenthetic vowel [ə] is not written in the orthography because it is entirely predictable from the syllable structure (cf. Döhler 2018: 67ff.). There are in fact many roots which lack specified vowels altogether, for example *mnz* [mə$^{n}$ts] 'house', *zfth* [tsəɸəθ] 'base, reason', and *ggrb* [$^{ŋ}$gə$^{ŋ}$gərə$^{m}$p] 'small, unripe coconut'. Only in word final position, the epethetic vowel will be written as <é>. The quality of the epenthetic vowel shows only little variation. In almost all environments, it is realised as a mid central vowel of very short duration [ə]. However, there is one exception, namely when it is inserted preceding one of the two approximants /w/ and /j/. In this environment it is realised as a short, high vowel. Examples are: *thwak* [ðŭwak] 'shoulder' and *nyak* [nĭjak] 'we go'.

## 1.5 Provenance

The provenance and metadata of the individual stories is given in the introductory text for each text. The documentation of Komnzo was part of my dissertation project at the Australian National University, Canberra. The project was funded by the DOBES initiative of the Volkswagen Foundation.[4]

### 1.5.1 Ethics

This project began with a pilot fieldtrip to the Morehead district in September of 2010. At the time, my goal was to establish contact to a community that speaks one of the Tonda languages. I did not know which village or variety I was going to work on when I first arrived in the provincial capital Daru. It was Abia Bai from Rouku (Komnzo) who invited me to accompany him to his natal village, where I received a warm and friendly welcome from the community. I explained my intentions and people agreed that I may return regularly. I stayed for eight weeks, and was eventually adopted in the Mrzar Mayawa clan. My village name is *Bäi* [$^{m}$bæi].

The community set up a language committee with representatives from all clans in Rouku to oversee the documentation project. Some members remained passive representatives, while others took on more active roles, such as suggesting topics and stories to be recorded, checking my dictionary, helping me with elicitation, showing me plants and animals, inviting me to various feasts, and visiting places with me. The committee consisted of the following individuals: Abraham Maembu, Albert Maembu, Anau Weni, Caspar Mokai, Daure Kaumb, Kalés

[4]Grant number: 85606, Title: "Nen and Tonda: Two languages of Southern Papua New Guinea" (Komnzo belongs to the "Tonda" subgroup of the Yam family.)

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Tawéth, Kaumb Bai, Maembu Kwozi, Mai Karémbu, Marua Bai, Mokai Orot, Railey Abia, Sémoi Weni, Steven Karémbu, Turaki Damaya, and Wermang Maembu. The two people I worked with most of the time were my adoptive father Abia Bai and his daughter Nakre. In particular, Nakre helped me with the transcription and translation of all the texts in this collection.

On my first fieldtrip, I took with me a written consent form as was required by the ethics committee at ANU. This did not work well for people who do not regularly come into contact with bureaucratic processes and who do not have to deal with forms that they have to sign. Moreover, official paperwork is hardly a substitute for a personal conversation. In my case, it worked much better to explain myself in casual conversation, and to ask later if people agree to being recorded. I have only made and archived recordings in which the speakers were clear about the further terms of use.

### 1.5.2 Archived material

The original recordings of this text collection are archived at different places. All audio-visual footage collected during the Komnzo documentation project can be accessed at The Language Archive (TLA) under the following link:

https://hdl.handle.net/1839/a4d3a01c-0705-4583-8fb7-2fb479fe4e11

All transcribed texts along with the audio-visual footage is stored at the Komnzo community[5] at Zenodo under the following link:

https://zenodo.org/communities/komnzo

While the footage files are stored in separate records at Zenodo, the corresponding annotation files (*.eaf) are available as a zip-file in a separate record entitled "Komnzo text corpus", which is updated at regular intervals. Footage files and annotation files are labelled with the same source code, e.g. tci20100905.pdf (scan of the notebook), tci20100905.eaf (transcription), tci20100905.wav (audio), tci20100905.mpg (video). All annotation files can be accessed under the following link:

https://zenodo.org/records/6759409

[5]"Communities" at Zenodo are topical collections. In addition to the Komnzo text corpus, the "Komnzo community" includes other publication types: the grammar, the dictionary, this text collection, scientific articles, specific datasets.

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### 1.5.3 Editing decisions

The texts in this collection are based on recordings that were made during my visits to Rouku between 2010 and 2017. With the help of various Komnzo teachers, especially Nakre Abia and her father Abia Bai, I have transcribed and translated these recordings. For this publication, I could not return to Rouku, which means that I was not able to consult with any of the original narrators or with my language teachers for the editing process. The editing choices are based on (1) my own understanding of the language, (2) comments made by my collaborators during the transcription which I noted down, (3) general comments made by my language teachers. As a consequence, the changes that I have made to the transcriptions are kept to a minimum. They involve standard procedures like removing some disfluencies such as pauses (14), false starts (12) and self-corrections (13) in order to make the texts better to read. I decided not to remove fillers such as the placeholder pro-form *bäne/baf* or the manner demonstrative *nima* since these are conventionalized lexical items (Döhler forthcoming(c)).[6]

(12) *tfrisam -/**ŋawa**/- ŋawathknwa.*
'He packed up at Téférisam.' [tci20110802 ABB 106]

(13) *nafane yf **zafgo** ... **zafo** Akrimogoma emoth.*
'Her name was Zafgo ... Zafo, a sister from Akrimongo.'
[tci20111107-01 MAK 92]

In many cases, the deletion of pauses has led to a rearrangement of units that correspond more to a sentence structure. For example, in the *Kukufia* story (§11), the speaker made several pauses which were removed. Consequently, the three annotation units in the transcription file in (14a-c) were merged into one line of text in (14′).

(14) a. *nä kayé ...*
'One day ...' [tci20100905 ABB 25]
b. *kukufia zenfara ...*
'Kukufia set off ...' [tci20100905 ABB 26]
c. *kofär.*
'to go fishing.' [tci20100905 ABB 27]

(14′) *nä kayé kukufia zenfara kofär.*
'One day, Kukufia set off to go fishing.' [text §11, line 15]

[6]These two items are glossed as *nima* [like_this] and *bäne/baf* [PH] in the texts.

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The opposite scenario is also possible, i.e., speakers often produced postposed elements (e.g. a clause, noun phrase, inflected verb) that is intonationally part of the following unit, but belongs with the former unit in terms of syntax and semantics. In these cases, I have rearranged the annotation units to better reflect a kind of sentence notion. Below is an example of such rearrangement. The verb *kwakwirwrmth* 'they ran away' belongs to the second intonation unit (in 15), but it is part of the topic construction in the first unit (15').

(15) a. *yaw kabe wathr mane enrära*
'As for the dancers'
b. *kwakwirwrmth ruga sagathifath dagon ra bramöwä egathikwath.*
'they ran away. They forgot about the pig, the food and everything else.' [tci20120909-06 KAB 72-73]

(15') a. *yaw kabe wathr mane enrära kwakwirwrmth*
'As for the dancers, they ran away.'
b. *ruga sagathifath dagon ra bramöwä egathikwath.*
'They forgot about the pig, the food and everything else.'
[text §13, lines 60-61]

Some texts are excerpts from a longer recording. For example, the text *Ausi* (in §16) comes from a recording session that includes a number of different stories. Such information about excerpts or possible thematic links between the texts are given in the introduction to each text, or sometimes in footnotes.

Meta-comments have not been removed from the texts. These include personal introductions, afterword comments, asides that respond to something that was going on during the recording session, or comments directed someone in the audience or myself. A typical example is given in (16), where the speaker addresses the linguist directly (16a). After a comment by his wife, he continues the narration (16b). There are also cases in which the linguist prompts the speaker by asking a clarification question or making a comment. Such situational information is given in the footnotes.

(16) a. *nä kayé fthé boba gnyako nima kwa ymarwr ane kafar wämne.*
'If you walk there one day, you will see that big tree.'
b. *z niyakako. zba mothfa mane ykogr füni.*
'Ah, you've already been there? The *füni* tree is right by the road.'
[text §9, lines 93-95]

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Insertions from other languages are kept in the texts. These include code-switches, usually into English, or ad-hoc borrowings. Some examples are words like *okay*, numbers (*15*, *fifteen*), place names (*Daru*, *Australia*). In such cases, the orthography is not adapted. Loanwords on the other hand are phonologically integrated and, thus, do not count as insertions. Loanwords are adapted to the Komnzo orthography (eg. *bicycle* > *basikol*, *hospital* > *ospitor*).

There a few code-switches for narrative purposes, for example in direct speech by someone from another place who speaks another language. This usually involves related languages or dialects, for example the code-switch to Wära in the two headhunting stories (in §6 and §7). Inserted material is not segmented or glossed in the interlinearised text.

In the English translations of the texts, I make some orthographic changes to proper nouns and place names to make them more readable. As mentioned earlier, there is no tradition of writing Komnzo words. Words that are commonly written are personal names and place names. Examples of such adaptations are the personal name *thbithé* [ðəᵐbiðə] which is spelled "Thémbithé" and the place name *karesa zfth* [karesa tsəɸəð] which is spelled "Karesa Zéféth" in the English translation. In the text line, I use the Komnzo orthography.

## 1.6 Genres and narrative style

Komnzo speakers have terms for only some of the text genres included in this text collection. The names of genres reflect content rather than narrative structure, performance style or other conventions. Narratives are described as *ebar trikasi* 'headhunting stories' (cf. §6 and §7), *menz trikasi* 'ancestor stories' (cf. §3 and §4), *nzürna trikasi* 'spirit stories' (cf. §8, §9, §10). The only exception is the genre *se zokwasi* 'bark torch speech', a type of public speech given during an all night feast that is unspecified for its content (Döhler 2019).

The titles of the stories reflect no indigenous naming strategy, nor were the titles given by the narrators. Titles were created during the transcription and translation by myself together with my language teachers, often they are descriptive titles such as *fiyaf trikasi* 'hunting story' (cf. §14 and §15).

Komnzo narratives are rarely the kind of staged performances that take place in a typical recording session. In most cases, narratives are told as "conversational narratives'' that involve a lot of interaction between the narrator and their audience. If it is a conversation between a small number of participants, the main narrator is often interrupted by clarification questions or by side comments. If the audience is larger, there will also be loud emotional reactions and applause.

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An example of the latter is the story about the introduction of matches (§13), especially the scene in which people run away in fear of the small matchbox.

## 1.7 Speakers/Narrators

In the table below there is basic information about the narrators who appear in this text collection. As becomes clear from the table, most narrators are from one particular clan, namely the *Mrzar Mayawa* clan from Masu, a small hamlet close to Rouku village. There is also a male bias in the selection of speakers. Biases like these are found already in the archived collection, i.e., in the recordings made during the documentation project. They were caused by the circumstances under which I was introduced to and later lived in Rouku. Because I was a man, I had more contact with men than with women. Because I was a Mayawa man, I spent more time with other men of the Mayawa clan than with men of other clans.

Table 1.7: Narrators sorted by age

| NAME | SEX | AGE[a] | CLAN | HOME | STORY |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ruth Abia | ♀ | 28 | Mrzar Mayawa | Rouku | §12 |
| Daure Kaumb | ♂ | 35 | Mrzar Mayawa | Rouku | §4 |
| Maembu Kwozi | ♂ | 35 | Banibani Mayawa | Rouku | §15 |
| Kurai Tawéth | ♂ | 40 | Nümgar Bangu | Yirko | §10 |
| Lucy Abia | ♀ | 55 | Sangara | Yokwa | §14, §16 |
| Maraga Kwozi | ♂ | 55 | BaniBani Mayawa | Firra | §6, §9 |
| Abia Bai | ♂ | 60 | Mrzar Mayawa | Masu | §3, §5, §7, §11 |
| Kaumb Bai | ♂ | 65 | Mrzar Mayawa | Masu | §13 |
| Marua Bai | ♂ | 70 | Mrzar Mayawa | Masu | §8 |

[a]Estimated age at the time of recording.

## 1.8 The texts

The texts in this collection are not grouped according to supposed genres, nor by speaker or time of recording. Instead they are arranged thematically, as shown in Table 1.8. The first three texts are about places of origin and the creation of people. The following two texts are historical reports of two headhunting raids. The next three stories belong to the genre of *nzürna trikasi* 'spirit stories' (cf.

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introduction to the text in §8). This is followed by three stories about other supernatural phenomena. The text collection ends with three personal stories, two hunting stories and one life history.

Originally, the texts in this collection were selected so as to cover a wide range of narrative genres. It was only during the curation phase that I decided to give this book a thematic twist by exploring concepts of landscape, place names and locality. To some extent, selecting the texts made me realise how deeply this topic is embedded in every aspect of Komnzo speech. Some of the texts lend themselves to this thematic analysis. For example, the first text *Kwafar* is a wandering creator myth (§3) and the second text *Masu* was recorded in a series sessions where I took the speaker to various named places (§4). Other texts were selected because they are related, for example, by genre or topic. There are three texts that belong to the genre of *nzürna trikasi* (§8-10). Another example are the two texts about headhunting in which one text (§7) is the continuation of the other text (§6). As the next chapter shows, all the texts address the topics of landscape, place names and locality.

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Table 1.8: Texts

| § | TITLE | TOPIC | WORDS |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | *Kwafar* | origin myth, wandering creator myth, yam cultivation | 1351 |
| 4 | *Masu* | myth and history about the home of the Mayawa clan | 690 |
| 5 | *Safak menz a faikore menz* | myth about two ancestors | 531 |
| 6 | *Ebar zan firran* | story about a headhunting attack on the village of *Firra* | 909 |
| 7 | *Faw brigsi* | story about the revenge attack against the village of *Téndöfi* | 780 |
| 8 | *Nzürna trikasi watayan* | spirit story at *Wataya* forest | 543 |
| 9 | *Nzürna trikasi firran* | spirit story at *Firra* village | 900 |
| 10 | *Nzürna trikasi bresanema* | spirit story at *Yirko* hamlet | 773 |
| 11 | *Kukufia* | story about two children and the short man Kukufia | 441 |
| 12 | *Fenz yonasi* | beliefs about sorcerers | 612 |
| 13 | *Masis* | story about the introduction of matchboxes | 619 |
| 14 | *Fiyaf trikasi* | short hunting story | 320 |
| 15 | *Fiyaf trikasi* | story about an all day hunting trip | 668 |
| 16 | *Ausi* | autobiographical story | 1102 |
| **total** | | | **10239** |

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# 2 Conceptualizing landscape and place

## 2.1 Introduction

Mary Ayres writes that "Morehead people never cease to amaze me with their ability to recall, to the square meter, the precise location where an event occurred" (1983: 174). To keep such memories alive, the Farem leave tangible traces in the physical world. They often cut marks into trees along a path to mark it. They tie leaves around trees to signal that a particular place should not be entered. They leave objects as a sign of remembrance of an important event. Figure 2.1 shows the broken shaft of an arrow that a man had set up on the side of a path after he had killed a large pig at this spot the previous year.



Figure 2.1: A broken arrow commemorates the hunter's luck

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The interest in places has also left its mark on the language of the Farem people. I will argue here that communication about route-finding and about shared locations is made possible by a sophisticated system of landscape terms and a dense network of place names. The words making up these subsystems are used to talk about everyday events, but they also bring the mythical past into the here and now. They help to regulate the rightful use of land, and in some case may even restrict access to it. Lastly, they provide a spatial anchor for a large part of social life, for example by linking people to their respective places of origin. As Thornton puts it in his overview of Native American place naming, they "tell us something not only about the structure and content of the physical environment itself but also how people perceive, conceptualize, classify, and utilize their environment" (Thornton 1997: 209).

While the study of place names has a long tradition, research from the perspective of semantic typology has gained momentum in the last ten years. Good examples for a set of systematic studies of the topic can be found in the contributions to (Burenhult 2008). A particularly useful distinction introduced by (Burenhult & Levinson 2008) looks at "feature names" versus "area names". While the former pick out particularly salient features of concrete geography, e.g. rivers, mountains, or valleys, the latter are not based on the physical environment, but more abstract concepts are involved, e.g. ownership, history, myth, or ethnicity. Feature names are good for individuating many different types of landscape, but they cannot reach a complete coverage of a given environment. After all, in this system you can only name what is there. Area names, on the other hand, can potentially reach complete coverage.

Feature names and area names show varying degrees of internal structure. An example for the hierarchical organisation of feature names in Komnzo comes from the expression *kafar fz* 'big forest' which is used for 'jungle; thick, dense, dark, cool forest'. There several subtypes of this vegetation type which vary in size and shape, for example *fokufoku* 'small patch of forest' and *fz minz* 'thin strip of forest'. For area names, we may take *kar* which describes an 'inhabited place', typically these are villages, but there is also the word *menz kar* 'story/creator place' for a place that was once or is still inhabited by a mythical creator spirit, and that has a creation story to it. Entering such places should be avoided at all costs, as it can lead to illness and death. There are many *menz kar* around Rouku, and each one has a place name.

The following description shows that Komnzo speakers employ a mix of both systems. Feature names capture a variety of landforms (e.g. hill, slope, creek, river mouth, island), man-made places (e.g. village, garden, path), and biological entities (e.g. forest, swamp, savannah, grove). Area names, especially in the form

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of place names, are abundant and this subsystem reaches almost complete coverage. Recall FE Williams' comment from the introduction to this book: "if you ask your guide where you stand at any moment, he will be able to give a name to the land" (1936: 207).

Area names and place names often develop from the names of features. Take the three major cities in the German federal state of Saxony, which all come from Slavic feature names: Dresden from *Draždany* 'swampy forest', Leipzig from *Lipsko* 'linden place', and Chemnitz from *Kamenica* 'stony river'. This pattern is also found in Komnzo place names such as *swäri zfth* '*swäri* base'. This must have started as a descriptor of a place with an especially large or beautiful *swäri* tree (*Alstonia actinifila*), but over time it has lost its descriptive function. Today it is used even though the *swäri* tree was cut down decades ago. Merlan (2001) has described place name systems of this kind as "non-arbitrary", because they establish a direct relationship to the designated places.

Although landscape terms and place names in Komnzo are well-developed semantic fields, it is place names that carry the greater part of the functional load. In other words, speakers almost always coordinate through shared knowledge of place names rather than physical features of the environment. The latter is used as a fallback option if there is no name for a particular place or if the speaker assumes that the other person does not know the name.

## 2.2 The physical environment

The landscape of the Morehead District has been characterized by outsiders as uneventful, boring, and featureless. An extreme comment to this end was made by Wilfried Norman Beaver, the Resident-Magistrate of the colonial administration, who had briefly visited the region in September 1908. He writes: "The timber is poor, consisting of stunted gum, ti-tree and paper bark. The grass is poor, and the soil is but third rate. I should say this is one vast swamp in the rainy, and parched up in the dry season"; concluding that "there is nothing to induce settlement, nor would I ever advise anyone to go there." (Murray 1909: 12). Having spent a total of two years in the region, I can only disagree with him. However, we do not need to move much further in time from Beaver, to find a more nuanced description of the landscape. Francis Edgar Williams, the Government Anthropologist for the Territory of Papua, who had visited the region repeatedly throughout the 1920s, introduces the area by stating that "its scenery often has a mild, almost dainty, attractiveness in detail, but represents on the whole the extreme of monotony" (1936: 1). As we shall see, it is the small details on the ground that are highly salient to the people.

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The wider area of Southern New Guinea, that part of the land between the Fly River in the north and the coastline in the south, has seen dramatic geomorphological changes over the last millennia. Recall that the initial settlement of the paleo-continent Sahul, consisting of New Guinea, mainland Australia, Tasmania, and the Aru Islands, is dated back to 40,000 BP (Allen & O'Connell 2008). Most of Southern New Guinea was inundated at the maximum height of the sea level at 6,000 BP (Chappell 2005). It was slowly rebuilt with sediments carried by the Fly River and Digul River. As a consequence, large parts of the land consists of alluvial soil of poor quality. A notable exception is the area under investigation here, the so-called "Morehead ridge" (Paijmans et al. 1971: 15), which is a slightly elevated stretch of land that runs in West-East direction. Here the soil is well drained and lies above the water level during the rainy season. For these reasons, most villages in the region are situated along the ridge. The village of Rouku is located on the highest part of the ridge.

The broader Southern New Guinea region lies in a zone of tropical savannah or sub-humid tropical climate. The annual rainfall is around 2000mm, and 70% of this falls during the wet season (Paijmans et al. 1971: 12).[1] The annual monsoon cycle brings a long dry season (June - November) and an intense wet season (December - May). Small differences in elevation are barely noticeable during the dry part of the year, but they become clear landmarks in the wet season. Rivers overflow their banks, ditches turn into creeks, recesses become stagnant ponds. All these changes affect the vegetation and other types of biota, e.g. the types of animals that occur in the different ecological niches at different times of the year. Figure 2.2 shows the high-water mark near the village of Rouku. During the previous rainy season, the paperbark trees on the right side of the picture were submerged to about 1 metre, while the bamboo groves on the left side remained dry.

Humans have interacted and changed the physical environment of the Morehead district, and they continue to do so. The most obvious result of these interventions are villages, roads and gardens that disrupt the natural environment. But even if a village was abandoned a long time ago or a garden has been left fallow for many years, there are unmistakable traces that remain. Old villages, for example, can be recognised not only by old house posts, but also by coconut palms that were once planted. Abandoned gardens can also be recognised by the absence of larger trees or dead trees whose naked trunks tower above the regrowing plants, or by bamboo groves that were once planted as building material for fences.

[1] As a comparison, the Berlin-Brandenburg area received 579 mm annually on average between 1991-2010 (Senatsverwaltung 2022).

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Figure 2.2: The high water mark is visible in the centre of the picture.

Human meddling with the physical environment has yet another, much more subtle dimension. Rouku men often go hunting carrying the smouldering inflorescence of a local species of banskia. This *dagu zthé* 'firestick' is used to burn small patches of land along their routes, resulting in many low-intensity fires during the dry season. I was told that this practice serves to create a favourable habitat for wallabies and bandicoots or to increase the local supply of certain plants. In other parts of the world, especially Australia, this technique of "cultural burning" has lead to substantial changes in the geographic range and demographic structure of many vegetation types (Flannery 2002: 217ff. Bowman 1998).

## 2.3 Landscape in the lexicon

The Komnzo lexicon marks off at least four major ecological zones: (i) *kafar fz* 'big forest', which is a type of monsoon rain forest (Fig. 2.3), (ii) *fz* 'forest', which is a much thinner forest type covered by a grass floor and dotted with red anthills (Fig. 2.4), (iii) *ksi kar* 'bushy place', which is a type of savannah that lacks trees, but is covered with high grass (Fig. 2.5), and (iv) *zra* 'swamp', which is a place entirely inundated during the wet season, often timbered by paperbark trees and a ground cover of dead leaves (Fig. 2.6). While there is a general distinction between *fz* 'forest', *ksi kar* 'open grassland' and *fath* 'clear place, savannah', we also find fine-grained distinctions like *fokufoku* 'small patch of forest', *fz minz* 'thin strip of forest', and *morthr* 'edge of forest with a smaller patch forest close by'. For a further description of the landscape types, see Döhler (2018: 10ff.).

Large parts of the Morehead district are inundated by rising water during the wet season. Consequently, small changes in the landscape may have drastic effects during this time. This has found its way into the lexicon of Komnzo. Moving

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Figure 2.3: A road through the rain forest (*kafar fz*)



Figure 2.4: Thinner type of forest (*fz*)

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Figure 2.5: Edge of the forest transitioning to savannah (*ksi kar*)



Figure 2.6: Villagers catching fish in the swamp (*zra*)

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from the highest point, usually the villages and settlements, to the lowest point, the Morehead River, we find a number of specific terms. I translate the term *töna* as 'high ground'. It is that part of the land, regardless of vegetation type, which is virtually never covered by water. Villages, hamlets, storage houses and yam gardens are located on *töna*. Small hills are referred to by *märmär* or by the Motu loan *ororo*. These areas may become islands (*bod*) during high floods. Wide, gentle slopes (*rsrs*) lacerated by many small creeks (*ttfö*) lead to lower areas. It is often along creeks where people plant sago palms. Taro gardens are made here if the ground stays wet throughout the year. Closer to the river, the ground can be very uneven and bumpy due to running water. This is called *kore*. A little lower lies that part of the land which is always covered by water during the rainy season. Often backwater stays in stagnant pools, which dry up only during the height of the dry season. These places are called *zra*, which I translate with 'swamp', but maybe the term 'billabong', commonly used in Australia, is more fitting. In this area, we find smaller pools of water which dry up (*nawan*) and larger pools which are permanent (*dmgu*). The ankle-deep, muddy water covered with leaves is called *nzäwi*. Walking towards the river, the land rises again in many places. This difference in elevation is almost unnoticeable, but it is enough so that this area dries up first at the end of the wet season. These places between the swamp and the river are called *for* and people plant cassava, sweet potato and taro here. The steep riverbanks along the Morehead river are called *rokuroku*, a word from which the village name Rouku originates. The sides of the river are covered with patches of *süfi* 'floating grass', and in some places this layer is called *tüf* when it is thick enough to support the cultivation of sweet potatoes. Finally, there is the Morehead River (Fig. 2.7), and much of daily life takes place between the village and the river as people go and fetch water, wash, catch fish, or simply enjoy sitting by the river during the hot part of the year. The word for river is *ŋars*, and there is the verb *frezsi* meaning 'to come up from the river' (cf. §2.7). Most of the words mentioned here can be found in the texts included in this book, either as descriptors or as parts of place names (cf. §2.5).

Other parts of the lexicon feature human-made structures. For example, *kar* 'village, place' describes a place that is suitable for settlement, or that is in fact settled permanently by people (Fig. 2.8). Garden structures are described as *dao* 'garden' and by metonymical extension as *ŋarake* 'fence, garden' (Fig. 2.9). There is more specialized terminology, for example in *thaba* which describes a clearing in the forest that is used for gardening (Fig. 2.10), or *dao kr* for an abandoned garden, *for ŋarake* for a garden by the river. Another example for a human-made structure is *swäyé* and somewhat archaic *ethf* for 'berth', or 'canoe place'.

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Figure 2.7: The Morehead River at *Kanathr*



Figure 2.8: Houses in Rouku village

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Figure 2.9: A newly constructed garden fence (*ŋarake*)



Figure 2.10: Two images of *thaba* 'forest garden' marked by dead trees

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Area names of mythological significance are called *menz kar* 'story place', in which the word *menz* stands for a mythical creator. These place are always connected to a creation story, and therefore I adopt Ayres' term 'story place' for them. More generally, sacred places are called *thak* and the reduplication of this word *thakthak* means 'law, taboo, rule'. This example illustrates something that Ayres (1983) argues for in her dissertation, namely that the abstract is often anchored in the concrete landscape in the Morehead district.

## 2.4 Landscape in metaphors

Other ways of conceptualizing landscape in language comes in the form of metaphorical expressions. Before discussing one example of a metaphor at length, I want to point to a gap. The domain of body parts, which is commonly used in many languages around the world (Tjuka 2019) for landscape features such as river mouths or mountain faces, is largely absent in Komnzo. So far, the only example is the word *thm* 'nose', which can be used for river bends or curves in a road. Speakers translate *thm* with English 'point', as in *ŋrs thm* 'point in the river' (lit. 'river nose').

Plants, especially trees, are a fertile source domain for landscape metaphors. The mouth of a creek or a river is referred to by the word *zfth*. This word is a colexification (François 2008) of a number of concepts. In its most basic sense, it means 'base of a tree'. It can also mean 'origin' and 'reason', much like 'root' in the English expression 'the root of all evil'. *Zfth* can also refer to one's clan and lineage.[2] While the tree metaphor is commonly found in languages around the world, its extension to landscape and bodies of water, as in 'river mouth', seems to be specific to the Morehead district. This is also found in other riverine terminology such as *ttfö tuti* 'creek branches, creek twigs' or *ttfö minz* 'creek vines', which can both be used to refer to smaller streams. The place where a creek starts can be called either *ttfö ker* 'creek tail', but also *ttfö zrminz* 'creek root'. The same terminology is applied to different parts of the much larger Morehead river.

The fact that bodies of water are conceptualized through a tree metaphor can be traced back to the myth of *Kwafar*, in which the place from which all humans descend is a tree. *Kwafar* is located somewhere in the Arafura Sea between New Guinea and Australia. In the myth, the tree burns down and the people are left homeless. The burning of the tree is connected to two brothers who kill a mythical creature. This event triggers a flood that drives the people to the north and

[2]In the text §7, the speakers uses the nominal compound *kabe zfth* [people tree_base] to refer to the elders of his clan.

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south. As the water rises, the channels in the ground left by the charred roots of the tree become creeks and rivers. In other versions of the myth, the tree falls to the north and the impressions left in the ground are filled by the water of the approaching flood. A version of the *Kwafar* myth is included in this text collection (§3). Other versions have been recorded by Williams (1936: 306) and Ayres (1983: 50).

## 2.5 Place names

The two quotations from Williams and Ayres cited in the introduction already indicate the abundance and importance of place names, or toponyms (cf. §1.1). In Figure 2.11, we can get an impression of what Ayres means when she writes that the system is "staggering in its elaboration" (1983: 38). The image shows a page from her notebook containing a map of Rouku and the surrounding area - no more than eight kilometers in diameter - with well over 100 named places. When I compared her sketch with my own data, I realised that the map is by no means exhaustive, and that there are many named places missing, especially closer to settlements.

While the place names are common knowledge and known to most Farem people, the details of each little path and the stories that go with them are only known to the rightful owners of that piece of land. In this sense, toponymic knowledge can be likened to a proof of ownership. For this reason, I have deliberately refrained from providing a complete list of the place names I have collected as well as a detailed map.

All place names in Komnzo are proper names, but they differ in their composition and meaning. Some place names have no other meaning than the places they refer to, for example *Fthi*, *Kanathr* or *ŋazäthe*. At some point in the past, they may have been segmentable into meaningful parts or formed a meaningful word in themselves, but this knowledge has faded. Place names usually preserve features that have become unproductive or lexemes that have become archaic. This can also be observed in Komnzo. For example, the place name *Thmefi* can be analysed as *thm* 'nose' and *efi* 'hair'. However, the word *efi* is archaic and *thäbu* is used instead. In fact, some speakers are not aware of the possible segmentation.

Komnzo place names usually consist of two nouns that form a compound. Semantically, they range from generic descriptions such as *Gani zfth* 'base of the *gani* tree' (*Endiandra brassii*) to specific illustrations such as in *Nzga warsi* 'vulva chewing', *Kwanz fath* 'baldness clearing'. Many of these compounds consist of a plant name and a landscape term or a term used for the part of a plant. The

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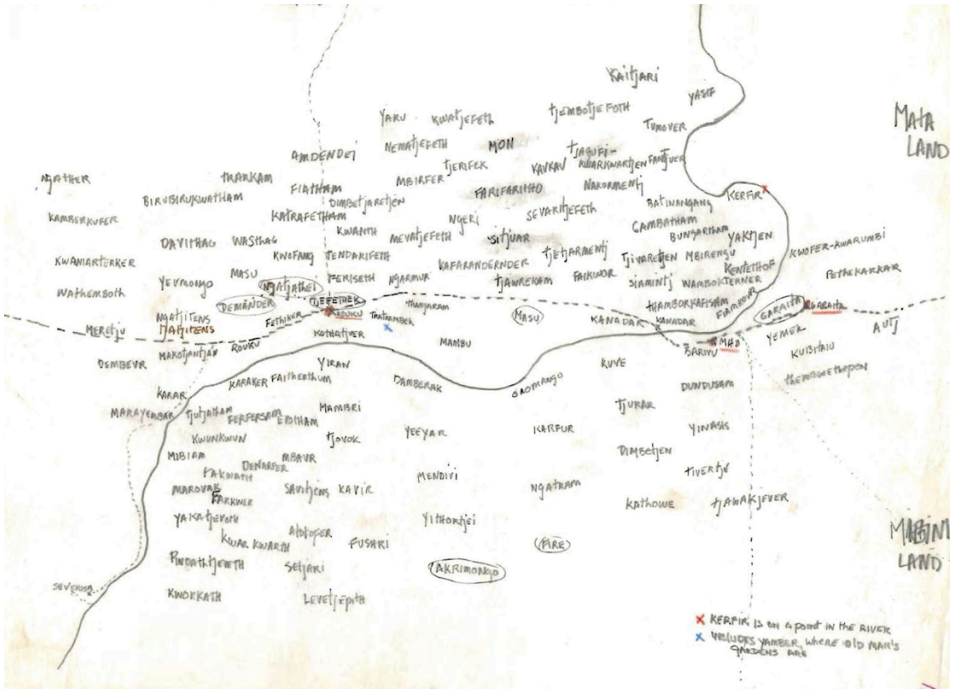



Figure 2.11: Place names around Rouku from Ayres' fieldnotes

most common landscape terms in these compounds are: *zra* 'swamp, waterhole' and *ttfö* 'creek'. The most common plant part terms are: *zfth* 'base' and *fr* 'stem, grove'. A few examples are: *Karesa zfth* '*karesa* base' (*Melaleuca sp*), *Atätö fr* '*atätö* stem' (*Pouteria sp*), *Wsws zra* '*wsws* swamp' (*Combretum sp*). These are not descriptions of places or plant parts, as the translation might indicate, but they are proper names. An expression like *karesa zfth* can refer to the base of any *karesa* tree, but the proper name *Karesa Zfth* refers only to a single place.

Only few place names are inflected verbs. The two above mentioned place names *Kanathr* and *ŋazäthe* look like verbs, but they are no longer analyzable as such. A clearer example is the place name *Karifthe* which relates to one of the texts in this collection (§5). *Karifthe* is the place where the protagonists set off in different directions after their argument. The place name is an inflected verb that can be translated as: 'You two should send each other away!'[3]

[3]Second person dual imperative of the verb *rifthaksi* 'send, send off'.

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## 2.6 Mixed-language place names

The study of toponymy is a fruitful source of data about prior linguistic occupations of an area. In many places, as in the case of Celtic place names through much of Central and Eastern Europe (Sims-Williams 2006), there is an inference that language choice in toponyms is evidence for land-language associations different from those that currently obtain. However, we should beware of assuming that reigning conditions of monolingualism are the most potent force shaping place naming. Traditional egalitarian multilingualism is still practised throughout the Morehead District, which is reflected in mixed-language toponyms. Two such examples are: the place name *Sandirmit* close to Bimadbn village, which mixes Nen *sandir* 'banksia species' and Idi *mit* 'stem' (N. Evans, pers.comm.), and the place name *Ormogo* close to Rouku village, which mixes Komnzo *or* 'Emerald dove' and Nama *mogo* 'house'.

Mixed-language place names account for a significant proportion of toponyms recorded for Komnzo. Table 2.1 gives a list of 20 of them. They involve words from almost all surrounding language varieties (cf. map in Fig. 1.1).[4] They are sorted by the order of elements: in the first set the second element comes from Komnzo, in the second set it is the first element. The last four place names involve cases, in which the second variety is very close to Komnzo. Thus, there is one word that belongs to both languages, and one word that clearly belongs to the other language. For each place name, I provide the English translation in the rightmost column. In the two columns labeled language 1 and language 2, I provide the translation of the mixed-language place name into each of the two languages; i.e. if it were a monolingual place name.

I have argued in (Döhler 2021) that mixed place names must have been coined in a deliberate act; in a conscious decision that a particular place would henceforth be labeled with a bilingual expression. The names themselves are proof of this, as they consist of semantically coherent expressions such as *Fotnz* 'short coconut' with Wartha Thuntai *fo* 'coconut' and Komnzo *tnz* 'short' or *Mnzärfr* 'ant post' with Nama *mnzär* 'ant' and Komnzo *fr* 'stem, post'. The point about semantic coherence is that it links words from two languages directly. One piece of evidence against intentional naming would be if mixed-language place names were formed from a semantically coherent expression in one language, e.g. *fo tg* 'short coconut' in Wartha Thuntai, which is then combined with a generic place name in another language, e.g. *thak* 'place' in Komnzo, resulting in *fo tg*

[4] Kémä and Namat are absent from the list. Both of these languages are so close to other varieties that a clear identification of the source language is difficult. In the case of Kémä these are Wära and Wèré, and in the case of Namat it is Nama.

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Table 2.1: Mixed-language toponyms

| NAME | LANGUAGE 1 | LANGUAGE 2 | TRANSLATION |
|---|---|---|---|
| *Düdüsam* | Na: ***düdü*** *wkwr* | Ko: *dödö* ***sam*** | 'broom liquid' |
| *Fakwr* | Na: ***fa*** *fak* | Ko: *thrma* ***kwr*** | 'after ashes' |
| *Fotnz* | Wt: ***fo*** *tg* | Ko: *ŋazi* ***tnz*** | 'coconut short' |
| *Füsari* | Na: ***fü*** *bilé* | Ko: *ŋanz* ***sari*** | 'garden plot axe' |
| *Makozanzan* | Ar: ***maxo*** *kamakama* | Ko: *nzga* ***zanzan*** | 'vagina beating' |
| *Mefath* | We: ***me*** *faf* | Ko: *mni* ***fath*** | 'fire place' |
| *Mnzärfr* | Na: ***mnzär*** *sèrásèr* | Ko: *msar* ***fr*** | 'ant post' |
| *Säzäri* | Wt: ***sä*** *ytho* | Ko: *karesa* ***zäri*** | 'paperbark bending' |
| *Tratratbäk* | Ka: ***tratra*** *bak* | Ko: *drädrä* ***bäk*** | 'lapwing's back' |
| *Wästhak* | Na: ***wäs*** *näk* | Ko: *wäsü* ***thak*** | 'tree (sp.) place' |
| *Märofak* | Ko: ***märo*** *kwr* | Na: *mane* ***fak*** | 'tree (sp.) ashes' |
| *Ormogo* | Ko: ***or*** *mnz* | Na: *bänz* ***mogo*** | 'dove house' |
| *Snzäzwär* | Ko: ***snzä*** *zfth* | Wt: *dawi* ***zwär*** | 'crayfish base' |
| *Wamamogo* | Ko: ***wama*** *mnz* | Na: *féfé* ***mogo*** | 'yam house' |
| *Yemgifaf* | Ko: ***yem*** *zan* ***faf*** | Na: *awyé* ***gi faf*** | 'cassow. hunt place' |
| *Zthékabir* | Ko: ***zthé*** *etfth* | Wä: *zthk* ***kabir*** | 'penis sleeping' |
| *Dimsathak* | An: ***dimsa thak*** | Ko: *nzrmsé* ***thak*** | 'sour place' |
| *Gawe* | Wt: ***ga we*** | Ko: *nzä* ***we*** | 'I also' |
| *Sizwär* | Ko: ***si*** *zfth* | Wt: ***si zwär*** | 'eye base' |
| *Zöfäthak* | Wä: ***zöfä thak*** | Ko: *ymnd* ***thak*** | 'bird place' |

Abbreviations: Anta (An), Arammba (Ar), Kánchá (Ka), Komnzo (Ko), Nama (Na), Wära (Wä), Wèré (We), Wartha Thuntai (Wt)

*thak*. However, such structures have not been documented for mixed-language place names. Further supporting evidence comes from the observation that these place names pattern roughly with geography, in that places containing a word from Wartha Thuntai are found west of Rouku, while places containing a word from Nama are found east of Rouku. Note that code-switching can be ruled out as a path of development, since code-switching is heavily sanctioned by the local language ideology. Instead, speakers converse in a dual-lingual mode (Lincoln 1976), sometimes also called receptive multilingualism (Singer 2023). The pattern of language use is such that in conversations between speakers of two different languages each consistently speaks one language in response to utterances in the other language.

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## 2.7 Talking about places

The first observation that can be made from the texts in this collection is the abundance of place names.[5] Almost all stories are anchored at some named place, and each scene takes place in a specific location. This becomes clear in the first text, the *Kwafar* myth (§3), which belongs to a genre of "traveling creator myths" known from Australia (cf. Evans 2010: 5ff.). They are also known from Wagner (1996), who shows that traveling myths are found along the New Guinea south coasts of the Western and Gulf Provinces, in adjoining areas of West Papua, in southern areas of the Simbu Province, and on the Torres Strait Islands.

In the *Kwafar* myth in this collection, the ancestor travels and creates the landscape, for example by dropping crumbs from his yamcake that turn into small pebbles, or carving a bow and arrows for himself, the remains of which turn into bamboo groves. He brings with him certain sacred items such as rainmaker stones, and he plays a role in the dispersal of people from this original place called *Kwafar*. His name and route may change depending on where the story is recorded, but what gives the story its ultimate credibility is the mention of the places he visited along the way. The version in this text collection tells the story of *Mathkwi*, the ancestor of the Mayawa clan in *Rouku*. In some episodes of the plot, the narrator Abia Bai lists the places like pearls on a string, as in the excerpt in (1).

(1) a. *watik foba yaniyaka misa zfth*
'Then he continued and came to *Misa Zéféth*.'
b. *mäbri misa zfth yrn*
'*Mämbri* was first, then *Misa Zéféth* and then *Yérén*.'
c. *fä zänrsöfätha fof yaniyaka benzü zfth*
'He went down there (to the river) and walked to *Benzü Zéféth*.' [text §3, line 150-152]

While such spatial anchoring is especially important for myths of origin (cf. texts §3 and §4), there is another genre that shows this connection clearly. For the genre of *nzürna trikasi* 'spirit stories', one must assume that each clan should have its own *nzürna trikasi* (Döhler forthcoming(a)). There are three *nzürna trikasi* in this text collection (cf. §8, §9, §10). In the introduction to the first story, I outline the common elements found in all *nzürna trikasi*. What is more important now are the differences, because within a broader genre that contains many

[5]Note that place names a typeset in italic font in the English translations of all texts in this book.

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stories, the uniqueness of one's own story must be emphasised. This is often achieved in the afterword by linking the story to one's clan land, and therby to one's lineage. In each of the three stories we can recognise the narrators' attempt to claim the respective story as his own by mentioning the place. As an example, I cite Maraga Kwozi's afterword to the *nzürna* story, which is set in his native village of *Firra* in (2).

(2) a. *nä karen nima näbuné bänema*
'There are other stories at other places.'
b. *nä nzürna ŋare zokwasi trikasi bä räro fi ane kar woga mane erä fi ane miyatha erä*
'There are other Nzürna stories, but the villagers there know them.'
c. *nzefé nzüwäbragwé nima ni miyatha nrä*
'I followed this one because we know it.'
d. *nzekaren ane yam kwafiyokwrm*
'This happened in our village.' [text §9, line 182-185]

On first mention of a particular place, narrators often provide additional explanations about certain features of the place or about its position in relation to other named places. Two examples are given below in (3) and (4). Such elaboration occurs somewhat more frequently in the stories than in natural language usage, since an unknowing outside linguist is involved in the recording situation. In (3), Lucy Abia points out a place that most people from Rouku would know very well. A case like (4) is different in that the place Maraga Kwozi mentions is further away and few people know the details of this location. In such circumstances, further explanations would also be used in more natural speech.

(3) a. *wati zenfarake zäzr mnz bä rä*
'So we departed and moved to *Zäzér Ménz*.'
b. *safs ane mothen rä nima ŋars zawe*
'That's on the road to *Safés*, on the side towards the river.' [text §16, line 108-109]

(4) a. *kafar wäsü sukogrm mrab fren waisamen*
'The big *Wäsü* tree stood in a bamboo grove at *Waisam*.'
b. *waisam ane kar yf rä*
'That's the name of the place, *Waisam*,'

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c. *mobo zwamnzrm*
'where she lived.'
d. *mrab fr thden*
'It is located in the middle of a bamboo grove.' [text §9, line 131-134]

Not only scenes within stories, but also people are explicitly associated with certain places. Narrators pay attention to this spatial anchoring even if (i) the character does not play a major role in the further course of the plot, (ii) the character is not mentioned by name or (iii) is identified only with a kinship term. Example (5) comes from the introduction of a story in which the speaker Kurai Tawéth mentions in passing that the protagonist has two wives.

(5) a. *okay, bres bä swamnzrm yirkon*
'Okay, Bres was living in *Yirko*.'
b. *edäwä ŋare swarärm*
'He had two wives.'
c. *nä kanfokma nä masuma*
'One was from *Kanfok* and the other one was from *Masu*.' [text §10, line 3-5]

Place names are often used metonymically referring to the inhabitants of that place, as in (6), where the notion of "people from place X" is inferred from the use of the dative case on the place name: *akrimogo kar=nm* [PLN village=DAT].

(6) *akrimogo karnm naf thätrifa*
'She told the Akrimongo people.' [text §6, line 77]

Especially in dry season much of people's daily life involves coming and going from the high ground to the river. This movement has left some impact in the verb lexicon. For example, the stem *frezsi* usually means 'take something out of the water'. The verb can be used in a quasi-reflexive construction with the meaning 'come up from the river'. The latter construction is used when disembarking a canoe, or when walking back from a river camp to the village. We can find *frezsi* with this meaning in a number of texts, for example in *Kwafar* (§3), *Faw brigsi* (§7), and *Kukufia* (§11). The verbs *rsörsi* 'climb down' and *sogsi* 'climb up', as in 'climb down or up a tree', can also be used to mean 'go downhill or uphill '. For example, in the hunting story *Fiyaf trikasi* (§15), we find two short episodes that make use of the two verbs (lines 60-62, 114-116). The first of these is given below

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in (7) with the verbs for 'climb up and down' printed in bold font. Note that these route descriptions are located in places where the difference in elevation is barely noticeable in the dry season.

(7) a. *wiyak e nä töna* ***kresöbätho***
'I walked up to the high ground.'
b. ***krärsöfäthé kresöbätho*** *mdüfi tönafo fof*
'I went down and went up again to the high ground at Méndüfi.' [text §15, line 60-62]

## 2.8 Conclusion

Komnzo speakers do not use vectors on a grid, such as maps, compasses or other cartographic aids for coordination. In lieu of a grid system, or a landscape with highly salient features such as mountains and valleys, people use established tracks between named places in order to navigate, or rather to talk about such navigation. Thus, the local system of orientation is one of "tracks-between-named-places." People do not just wander off and stroll around, except when hunting for an animal. When visiting unfamiliar territory, they are usually accompanied by someone who knows the area. Most tracks are visible even to the untrained eye, and should a track become overgrown because it has not been used for some time, people have a habit of cutting marks in the trees along the path.

Based on the abundance of place names in narratives and in Komnzo speech in general, I argue that the Farem conceptualise their environment through a network of named locations. The exact locations, as would be indicated on Western maps, are less important. What matters is a certain degree of coordination with other speakers. Such a mnemonic system is kept active in the memory and passed on to the next generation by constantly referring to places, which explains the abundance of place names in the texts. In that sense, the Farem people quite literally "speak the map".

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# 3 *Kwafar* - The place of origin in Kwafar

## 3.1 Introduction

*Kwafar* is a narrative lasting roughly 18min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on October 13th 2013, in video format.[1] The story is an excerpt from a longer recording session. The story teller is Abia Bai, and the recording took place outside his house in Rouku.

## 3.2 Summary & background

The text was prompted by my question "Where did the yams come from?" and it should be seen as a compendium rather than a single story line. The text can be cut into three story lines, which I have been told independently by others. The first part is the *Kwafar* flood myth, which also appears in (Williams 1936) and (Ayres 1983). *Kwafar* is a place off the coast between the island of New Guinea and the Australian continent.

According to the story, there was a large *wäsi* tree at *Kwafar* and the people of different tribes and languages lived together in this tree. Eventually, the tree burned down and the people started spreading out from there. Many clans of the Morehead district have an apical ancestor who came from *Kwafar*. One of the many stories located at *Kwafar* involves two brothers, who went hunting in the area. The brothers came across a mysterious creature that devours the bodies of those people who have died in the fire. The two brothers try to shoot the creature, but only the older brother is successful. As his arrow pierces the creature, a flood of water bursts out of the wound. In recent versions of the myth, the younger brother is said to be white like Europeans. He owns a shotgun instead of a bow. He runs south towards what is now Australia. The older brother runs north. He stops the flood by beating the water with branches of *dödö* (*Melaleuca sp*).

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20131013-01. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5653691

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At this point, Abia transitions into the second part. This is the story of *Mathkwi*, the apical ancestor of his clan. This story involves many small episodes about the route that *Mathkwi* took and all the things he carried and brought along.

The third part is about customs and traditions around yam cultivation, which involved a ritual about tasting the first yams of the season. In this part of the story, Abia also talks about a two magic stones that were passed down through the family, but lost in his father's generation.

## 3.3 Parallel text

*moba zrathkäfe?*

Where will we start?

CD: *wawa moba enrera?*

CD: Where did the yams come from?

*"wawa moba enrera?" okay! kwa zöbthé zrathkäfe nimame trikasi fof kwafar. nimame fof nzranyan e zbo zrabthe. ra nzigfu enfathwath. ra fofosa nzigfu enfathwath. watik zbo zf zrabthe aneme fof. trikasi näbi kwa wäniyak. zane trikasi mane rä ŋafyf bäyf mane ŋatrikwa. nzenm natrikwa. watik ane trikasi fof zena ŋaritakwr.*

"Where did the yams come from?" Okay! We will start the story in this way, with *Kwafar*. We will come like this and then finish up with the rain making stones. What rain stones they used to have. We will finish with this part. So it will be one story. As for this story, it was my father Bäi who told it. He told it to us. Well, this story will be passed on today.

*trikasi mane rä kwafarma rä. "kwafar" ŋafyf nima fof kwatrikwrm "kwafar mane rera thden rera." zane zena mane bad mane wythk. mazo mä ŋakonzr a australiane bad mä wythk. fä mä fi zfrärm ane. kwafar fof kabe mä kwamosinzrmth. wäsi warfo thfrugrm. wäsi bäne ykonzrth. nä bä bikogro zärkarä. kabe fä fof thwamnzrm fof zokwasi ffrümenzo. nä zfthen thwamnzrm, nä thden thwamnzrm, nä kerker thwamnzrm. watik zokwasi ane ffrümenzo kwanafrmth.*

This story is about *Kwafar*. "*Kwafar*", that's how father began the story, "*Kwafar* was in the centre, where this continent ends today and where the ocean begins, to where the Australian land ends." That is where *Kwafar* was located. The people used to live together in *Kwafar*. They stayed on top of a Wäsi tree. They call this one Wäsi. Over there is one with a shadow. The people were living there, and they spoke different languages. Some lived at the foot of the tree, others in the middle and still others at the top. They all spoke different languages.

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*nä kayé wäsi ane zäföfa fof. zästha fof. nä kabe nima kwakwirwrmth. nä kabe nima mnin kwarsirwrmth. watik wäsi ane kwot ŋarsira zäbtha. kabe bä mane thwägrm warfo nä mrmr, fi we nimäwä kwarsirwrmth. watik ezi kabe ane frümenzo tnägsi zethkäfath. bä frümenzo thwamnzrm. watik, mni fthé ŋarsira. kar ane bramöwä ŋarsira fof. thgathg zfrärm fath thefath. watik menzmenz ane fof yabun kafar thgathg dagonr ane fof zenfara kabe mane thfthnm kwosi.*

One day, the Wäsi tree started to burn. It really lit up. Some people ran away, while others burned in the fire. So the Wäsi tree burned to the ground. Those people who stayed at the top, and those who stayed inside, they also burned. Then, in the morning, people began to disperse. They lived all by themselves. When the fire burned, it burned down everything. It became a charred place, a clear place, a burnt place. There was a huge spirit being, a very big creature. It roamed around and ate people, the dead people who lay there.

*watik gwamf ŋatha thäsa ezi ane thefath thgathgen fof yaser. watik ŋatha anenzo fof sathkäfa. ŋatha ane swaruthrm gwam mon nima yarera. eda erna kabe. kafar yf mane thfrnm: nafangthrwä gwam muri. gwam yara nafanane, muri nafangth. wati gwamf ane fof ezi ŋatha thäsa thgathgen e anenzo fof ŋatha yayamgwa. yayamgwa. ane menznzo fof kabe maf änatha fof. fewakaf kwosi thwanathrm. gwamf zagr ymarwa fof "ra bäne yé?" nima né samara o "ra menzmenz yé?" kabe nrma fi fobo fof ŋagathikwa fof ane menzmenz. kabe ane zenthkäfath yak. ŋatha mane kwaruthrm. yf ŋatha yara ane tifr. wati sathkäfath. kabeyé ane dunzi kma sfruthrmth, keke!*

In the morning, Gwam called his dogs to go hunting at that burned place. He started with one of the dogs. The dog was barking, and Gwam was thinking like this. In fact, there were two men. They were well known: Gwam with his younger brother Muri. Gwam was the older brother and Muri was the younger brother. So it was Gwam who called the dogs in the morning to go hunting and that one dog stopped because of this creature. It was startled. It was that creature eating the human bodies. He ate the dead, the decaying corpses. Gwam saw it from a distance. "What's that?" he said and tried to take a look at it. "What creature is this?" The creature stopped with a full stomach. The survivors started to run. There was a dog by the name Tifér that was barking at the creature. Some people tried to shoot it, but without success.

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*gwamf nafangth sräkor "muri zba känrit nzuzawe nzefé biruthro!" ŋa naf nima "samg bänema näbuné fof yruthrth byé. keke kwosi yathizr." naf nima "keke fi miyamr erä fofosa mä rä. nze komnzo zimarwé fof." zirkn thfrnm. näbun kwanafrm, näbun kwanafrm. "watik ngth biruthé. famkaräsü gnräré!" nafananaf ane fof trikasi nima rä: nafangth kma markai nabikarä sfrärm. watik nafangth mane yara naf keke samga. nafananafnzo nabi ŋathunza zf sfthnm. yo kwan! fof sargosira fofosa fefen.*

Gwam told his small brother: "Muri, come over here to my side! I'll shoot him from here" and Muri said, "Shoot now! The others are shooting at it, but it's not dying." Gwam said: "No, they don't know where the heart is. Only I can see it from here." They kept on doing this. One was talking and then the other one was talking. Gwam said "Okay brother, I will shoot now! Watch out!" The story goes that it was the older brother who shot. The younger brother is said to have owned a shotgun. The younger brother did not hit the animal. The older brother drew the bow and hit it. The creature dropped down. He speared it. The arrow pierced right through to the heart.

*no fof zärftha. no ane zamatha. wati no mane kwakwirm fof. wäsi zrminz mä ŋanrsira fof, mni mä ŋanrsira, no fä kwanthorthrm fof ane zrminz fof. nof nä nima thäkothmako. nä nima thänkothma nzezawe. gwamane nima zenmathath muriane nima. mane ŋankwirwath zentnäthath. nä enrera bawi. wartha nima bämnzr wartha a kondomarin smärki. nafanme foba fof ŋankwira fof. fi foba fof ŋankwirwath bawi. watik gwamf fä fof mni bäne zafrafa fof. no dödöme zakwra. watik no fä fof zäkora. keke kwa nof zanmäyofa. fobo fof no ŋagathikwa fof.*

Water began to break out. Water was flowing. Water that was running everywhere. Where the roots of the Wäsi tree burned, where the fire burned them, the water flowed along those roots. The water chased away some of the people in this direction. Others were chased away towards our side here. The people from Gwam ran here and those from Muri in the other direction. Those who ran away scattered in various directions. Some came to *Bawi*. For example, the *Wartha* people who live over there, and the *Kondomarin* and the *Sémärki*. Those peoples' ancestors dispersed from there. They excaped first to *Bawi*. Then Gwam extinguished the fire. No! I mean, he hit the running wa-

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ter with the broom and stopped the flood. The water did not flow any further, it stopped there.

*watik fi mane enrera e zwari wartha fof. watik fä fof zwarin zämsath. zokwasi fthé emarwath ffrümenzo. watik kondomarin nima feräro. zena boba wazi fi berä merauken. nä mane erera zwarifa ŋafrezath thoro. watik thoron fä fthé zemarath we nimäwä fof zokwasi ffrümenzo. watik foba zethkäfath nimame kwasogwrmth. okay, nä mane enrera zwarifa e bäne thamgakar. nima bä ämnzr safs. wati fi fä fof thfyakm. nzenme mane yanra. mä ŋankwirwath komo fä ŋanfrezath komo. nzenme mayawama kabe nä fä thägathizath. we foba thden nä kwot we mayawama kabe fof. foba baguma kabe foba zena mifinin zämnzr. sagara fä thägathizath. okay fi nima erera mogarkam. nä mane erera nima erera bäne a drdr nä sagara fof. bagu mane enrera bäne mäta. sagara mane enrera garaita. mayawa ni zbo zf nnrera.*

So the people were coming up to *Zwari*, the *Wartha* people really. They settled there in *Zwari*, where they realised that they spoke different languages. So the *Kondomarin* people continued further this way. Nowadays, they live in *Merauke*. Others came up from *Zwari* towards *Thoro*. At *Thoro* it was the same again. They realised that they spoke different languages. So some of them moved further inland. Others came from *Zwari* straight to *Tamgakar*. For example, the people who live at *Safés*. They were walking this way. As for our ancestor and his people, they walked to *Komo*. They came up at *Komo*. They left some of our Mayawa people there. Some Mayawa people and some Bangu people live there in the centre. Nowadays, these people live at *Mibini*. The ancestor also left a few Sangara people there, and they spread out further to *Mogarkam*. Other Sangara people continued until *Déridéri*. Some of Bangu people continued further to *Mäta* and some of the Sangara people to *Garaita*. We Mayawas came right here.

*nzenme bada mrzarane bada mane yanra yf ane yanra mathkwi. mathkwif ane enfathwa wawa fofosa. naf ane ynfathwa fof. wati näbi ane komnzo fofosa yara. wawama nasi duga biskar*

As for our ancestor, the Mérzar's ancestor, his name was Mathkwi. Mathkwi was bringing along those things: the yam stone. He had this one. It was for the cultivation of yams, long

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*dagon nä berä fof. watik fi anekarä fof yanra fof. mane yanyaka e wm bä ythn zabrta. fä fof ŋanritakwath fof. kwanritakwrmth trkren. watik nima né fam zära "garaita zawe? keke nä kabe foba z sfyak." watik nima zethkäfa fi safs. nimame ane zethkäfa mothr mane yanra e akrimogo. yam fä fof thremar fof "oh nä nima z eräro." watik keräfi foba fof zäzira fof. e kar yf rä ymnz. watik fobo fof "oh kabe bä yé. watik nimame wiyak." watik foba fof akrimogofa zenfara fof. foba näbi yaniyaka. karane yf erä füsari. füsärifa rarafü kar. rarafü karfa kafrir. fä ttfön zänrita. e bäne zofok. zofok fä yamthiza. nabi komnzo bekogr. nabi ŋatr fä fof zurärm. zwafrmnzrm. zurzirakwa fof. nasi nömä yanatha. rfarrfar futhfuth mane erera wmr ane fof ŋakwthenzath fof. zäkwtherath. watik komnzo berästhgr. wm mane yé ynfathwa fof no nzigfu. watik ane fof yräza fof zofok kar. watik foba yaniyaka misa zfth. mäbri misa zfth yrn. fä zänrsöfätha fof yaniyaka benzü zfth. foba fof ymd threnkaris fof afa kfokfo ythama. fam zära "kar bä rä. ŋa kar töna fobo fof wiyak fof." yaniyaka. fä fof zänrita. fof rä. kukwrb fr zra. mnzärfr neba. wati fä fof yaniyaka fof mä zänfrefa. nömä futhfuth fä fof ŋantnägwath.*

yams, taro and cassava, and for other kinds of crops. He came with that stone. When he approached the place where the rocks are near *Zambérta*, he crossed the river. He crossed the river during the flood season. He thought to himself "Should I go to *Garaita*? No, someone's already gone there." So he started walking towards *Safés*. He got going and walked until *Akrimongo*. He saw footprints there. "Oh, others are already here." Then he shot an arrow that flew all the way to *Yéménz*. He heard people shouting from there and thought: "Oh, there's already someone there. Then I will go this way." He left *Akrimongo* and started walking. He came straight to a place called *Füsari*. From *Füsari* to *Rarafü Kar*. From *Rarafü Kar* to *Kafrir*, where he crossed the creek over to what's-that, to *Zofok*. He rested in *Zofok*. Those bamboos are still there, where he prepared his bow and arrow, where he put on the bowstring. He ate some yam cake. Those crumbs from the yam cake turned into rocks. They are still there. As for the stone that he had brought, the magic stone, he named it "*Zofok*" at that place. Then he continued further to *Misa Zéféth*. *Mämbri* was first, then *Misa Zéféth* and then *Yérén*. He went down to the river and walked to *Benzü Zéféth*. From there he heard birds calling, the butcherbird and the bird of paradise. "This must be high ground. I am going to walk up there." He continued a little further. He crossed the river at

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*Kukwérémb Fér*, opposite *Ménzär Fér*. That's where he walked up from the river. He dropped also some crumbs of the yam cake there.

*mane yanra e zrä zöfäthak. bä brä. zafe ŋazi fr nä fä fof ethn berä. watik nä fä fof ŋantnägwath fof. fä fof sakuka "oh zane zf zunthorakwé watik!" fz zamara afa kfokfo zakarisa. bäne zakarisa ythama. watik krenafth "nima wiyak. zbo kar rä farem kar." watik fthé yaka bobo foba krekaris "oh füthan nä zbo kabe yamnzr." we foba krekaris "oh farem karen kabe yé." watik yako. faremaneme kabe z sathora. bafane bada fof fatamaane. farem thden watik foba fof sräkor. foba fof "bä fä fof gnamnzé! ey, fisor bthanen käms!" wati we nä sräthoro wazu. fä fof sräkor watik "foba fof käms wazufa!"*

He came right here to *Zöfäthak*. There are some more crumbs over there by those old coconuts. He dropped some more over there. Then he stopped and said "That's the place I was looking for." He looked at the forest and again he heard the butcherbird and the other one, the bird of paradise. Then he said "I will go this way. There is a place, *Faremkar*." When he came there, he heard something and said "Someone is staying in *Fütha*." He listened again and said "Oh, there is already someone at *Faremkar*." He continued and saw that the ancestor of the *Farem* was already there. Those one's ancestor, Fatama's ancestor. He was staying in the centre of *Faremkar*. He said "You stay over there! You can settle in *Fisor Béthan*!" Then another ancestor arrived, from the *Wazu* clan. He said: "You can settle there in *Wazu*!"

*watik fthé zamara. katan fäth ane zfrärm "kwa nzä zä zf kwramnzr? nima ŋabrigwé." moba fthmäsü zänbrima. watik nasi nömä ane fof tnägsi thenthkäfa rrfar futhfuth. watik mane yaniyaka zä zf e zane zf zethno zerä. fä fof ane futhfuth thuntnägwrm. nä bä enthn e nima ziyaro ŋe masu. foba fof sathora "nzukar zä zf ämnzr." watik menz kar ane fof zräkorth yari.*

Mathkwi looked around and saw that it was a very small piece of land. He replied "Oh, this is where you want me to live? I will go back this way." On the way, he was dropping crumbs of the yam cake, those scraps. They're right here. They are lying here. He kept dropping these crumbs. There are some lying right over there. He continued along this way to *Masu*.

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When he arrived, he said: "This is my place. My people will live here." They call this story place *Yari*.

*yari sathora fof. watik fä fof no nzigfukarä fi fof sathora fof. fi mane yanra nzigfu nä fofosa yfathwa fof. nasi wawa duga biskar ranzo fä dagon eräro. anekaräsü swamnzrm fof. fthé wawa thuworthrmth. watik sfrärm e wawa taga kwot thkarthé kwafiyokwrmth. watik fthé fof wawa taga nä thurtnwrm. nasi taga kemar taga taga bäne berä biskar duga. watik nzigfu mrmr foba sfrärm. ane tagame sumyuknwrm. surdiknwrm. watik wawa zfthen swäzin. sfthnm e wawa fthé thwemar nima thkarthé zäkorth. watik ausiausi thukonzrm: "käthfe kabe!" ausiausi thfyakm ŋanz ffrümenzoma. wawa ane ebar fr wawa ebar fr kafar. watik nä ŋanzma wawa näbi nä ŋanzma nä ŋanzma nä ŋanzma nimanzo watik. mnime thufränzrmth. watik thufthakwrmth. foba karome thurzathrmth. zizi ane fof thfzänzrmth bobo far mä suräzrmth. mathkwi o karawa o kukuma o ote. watik ane far fof sfrästhgrm. wawa fobo fof thufnakwrm. fobo fefe né wawa kwanäbünzrmth. kwosi kwakonzrmth bänemr e tayo tfotfo.*

So he arrived in *Yari*. He brought the rain making stone and another stone, the yam stone, for long yam, yam, taro, and cassava, for all these other types of crops. He was holding on to those items. The planting season came. Then the leaves of the yams became dry. He pulled off some of the yam leaves or long yam leaves, or sweet potato leaves, all those ones, cassava leaves also. He put the stone inside the leaves and rolled it up. He tied it up in a bundle and put it down at the base of the plants. It stayed there until he saw that the yam leaves became really dried out and wrinkled. Then he called the women of the village: "Go people!" The women went and took one yam from each garden plot. They took one especially big yam. One yam from this plot, and another one from that plot, and so on. They burned off the hair on the yam tubers. Then they took them out of the fire and put them in the ground oven. In the afternoon they took them out and brought them to the place where they had set up a post. All those grandfathers were doing that: Mathkwi, Karawa, Kukuma and Ote. They had set up a post. They laid the yams at the base and left them there until they were about to spoil and start to rot. They waited until the other yams were almost ripe.

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*tayo wawa fthé kwakonzrmth. rfnaksir bobo zarfa thfrärm mäta garaita. nafa fthé kwänrfnth "ayo!" wrwr fof zefaro swänrifthth. watik we masu karé kwekaristh "oh nafa z zärfnth." we kwot we näbikakme we nä wawa thfrärmth. katan o kafar thuwoknzrmth. watik kwarzathrmth. tawar ane thfrärmth. ŋazi thurwrmth. kwot thufathwrmth kobakob. watik kwarfnakwrmth. watik nima kwanrzrmth. fatr nima thwafiyokwrmth "ayo farem benm fräro!" watik ane fthé kwärit ane tmatm rfnaksi tmatm. thumarwrmth e rrr kwan fthé bäne kwäkorth. tayo kwot thuwäkwrm. watik fthé fof yaka swefafth.*

When the yams were ready, they heard from *Mäta* or *Garaita* that they had already started tasting the yams. Every time they tasted the new yams, they shouted, "Listen up!" and the wind carried the message here. The *Masu* people heard it and said: "Oh, they have already tasted their yams." So they also took one yam from each plot. They chose big or small ones. They put it in the oven. They scraped the fibres out of the inside, mixed them with coconut and formed round balls. They tasted them and then threw some of the balls in this direction. They threw their arms in the air and shouted: "Listen, you Farem people, this is for you!" That's what they did. This tasting ritual then moved from place to place further west. Now, the leaves had really dried out and the yams were ready. They picked up the digging stick and started harvesting.

*anenzo fof, ane tmatm kwaritakwrm e zbo bäydbo. bäi kafar zäkora. nafaŋafyf ... nafane ŋafyf ane fof sara fof foba fof otef. watik naf we ane fof thwamonegwrm no bäne no nzigfu a fofosa frä dagon fofosa fof. foba e ni kafar ŋankonzake. nzesinenwä ane fof komnzo thfrnm ane eda rokar fof. e nama masun ane yam tmatm z zwabragwre fof. e watik foba zänbrimake zena mänwä zä namnzr. zf znrä. watik fi fthmäsü kwik kwosi yara. greg täwdben ane thfrärm ane bäne nzigfu thfrnm edawä. watik nzenme*

This ritual was passed down all the way to Bäi. When Bäi became a man, his father gave him the yam stone. His father, Ote had also looked after the rain stone and the yam stone. This continued until we became men and those two stones were under our care. Until recently, we have followed this tradition in *Masu*. But then we moved here, to where we live now. That was the time when father became ill and died. Those things were with Greg's father then, these two whatchamacallit, these two stones. Since our father

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*ŋafe fthmäsü kwosi yara. watik foba ni miyamr nrä mafadben zena ethn. z thrifthmath fof.*

passed away, we don't know who they are with now. Someone must have hidden them.

*watik trikasi mane nŋatrikwé fof, ŋafynm badafa ane fof ŋanritakwa fof. bada aki kwark benrera fof. zath kwark enrera e ŋafydbo we nzedbo fof né zänrita nima. watik zena maf keke wäbragwr ane.*

Okay, the story I just told was passed down from our ancestors to the grandfathers, until it came to our father. It was about to be passed down to us. But today, no one follows this tradition anymore.

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## 3.4

(1) *moba zrathkäfe*
moba zra\thkäf/e
where.ABL 1DU>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\start
'Where will we start?'[2]

(2) *"wawa moba enrera?" okay*
wawa moba en\rä/ra okay
round_yam where.ABL 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be okay
'"Where did the yams come from?" Okay!'

(3) *kwa zöbthé zrathkäfe nimame trikasi fof*
kwa zöbthé zra\thkäf/e nima=me trikasi fof
FUT first 1DU>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\start like_this=INS story EMPH
'We will start the story in this way,'

(4) *kwafar*
kwafar
PLN
'with Kwafar.'

(5) *nimame fof nzranyan e zbo zrabthe*
nima=me fof nzran\yan/ e zbo
like_this=INS EMPH 1DU:IRR:IPFV:VENT\come until PROX:ALL
zra\bth/e
1DU>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\finish
'We will come like this and then finish up'

(6) *ra nzigfu enfathwath*
ra nzigfu en\fath/wath
what.ABS rain_stone 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\hold
'with the rain stones.'

(7) *ra fofosa nzigfu enfathwath*
ra fofosa nzigfu en\fath/wath
what.ABS heart rain_stone 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\hold
'What rain stones they used to have.'

[2]I reply by asking the question: *wawa moba enrera?* 'Where did the yams come from?'

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(8) *watik zbo zf zrabthe aneme fof*
wati zbo zf zra\bth/e ane=me fof
then PROX:ALL ABSC 1DU>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\finish DEM=INS EMPH
'We will finish with this part.'

(9) *trikasi näbi kwa wäniyak*
trikasi näbi kwa wän\yak/
story one FUT 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come
'It will be one story.'

(10) *zane trikasi mane rä*
zane trikasi mane \rä/
DEM:PROX story which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'As for this story,'

(11) *ŋafyf bäyf mane ŋatrikwa*
ŋafe=f bäi=f mane ŋa\trik/wa
father=ERG.SG PN=ERG.SG which SG:PST:IPFV\tell
'it was my father Bäi who told it.'

(12) *nzenm natrikwa*
nzenm na\trik/wa
1NSG:DAT SG>1PL.IO:PST:IPFV\tell
'He told it to us.'

(13) *watik ane trikasi fof zena ŋaritakwr*
wati ane trikasi fof zena ŋa\ritak/wr
then DEM story EMPH today 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\cross
'Well, this story will be passed on today.'

(14) *trikasi mane rä kwafarma rä*
trikasi mane \rä/ kwafar=ma \rä/
story which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN=CHAR 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'This story is about Kwafar.'

(15) *"kwafar" ŋafyf nima fof kwatrikwrm*
kwafar ŋafe=f nima fof kwa\trik/wrm
PLN father=ERG.SG like_this EMPH SG>1SG.IO:PST:DUR\tell
'"Kwafar", that's how father told me'

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(16) *"kwafar mane rera thden rera"*
kwafar mane \rä/ra thd=en \rä/ra
PLN which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be middle=LOC 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be
'"Kwafar was in the centre,"'

(17) *zane zena mane bad mane wythk*
zane zena mane bad mane wa\ythk/
DEM:PROX today which ground which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\come_to_end
'where this continent ends today and'

(18) *mazo mä ŋakonzr a*
mazo mä ŋa\ko/nzr a
ocean where 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\become and
'where the ocean begins,'

(19) *australiane bad mä wythk*
australian=ane bad mä wa\ythk/
PLN=POSS.SG ground where 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\come_to_end
'to where the Australian land ends.'

(20) *fä mä fi zfrärm ane*
fä mä fi zf\rä/rm ane
DIST where 3.ABS 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be DEM
'That is where Kwafar was located.'

(21) *kwafar fof kabe mä kwamosinzrmth*
kwafar fof kabe mä kwa\mosi/nzrmth
Kwafar EMPH people where 2|3PL:PST:DUR\gather
'The people used to live together in Kwafar.'

(22) *wäsi warfo thfrugrm*
wäsi warfo thf\ru/grm
tree_species above 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sleep
'They stayed on top of a Wäsi tree.'[3]

(23) *wäsi bäne ykonzrth nä bä bikogro zärkarä*

[3] *wäsi* 'strangler fig' (*Ficus elastica*)

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wäsi bäne y\ko/nzrth nä bä
tree_species DEM:MED 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\speak INDF MED
b=y\ko/gro zär=karä
MED=3SG.M:NPST:STAT:AND\be_standing shade=PROP
'They call this one Wäsi. Over there is one with the shade.'

(24) *kabe fä fof thwamnzrm fof*
kabe fä fof thwa\m/nzrm fof
people DIST EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit EMPH
'The people were living there,'

(25) *zokwasi ffrümenzo*
zokwasi f~frü=me=nzo
speech REDUP~alone=INS=ONLY
'and they spoke different languages.'

(26) *nä zfthen thwamnzrm nä thden thwamnzrm nä kerker thwamnzrm*
nä zfth=en thwa\m/nzrm nä thd=en thwa\m/nzrm
INDF tree_base=LOC 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit INDF middle=LOC 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
nä kerker thwa\m/nzrm
INDF tail 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'Some lived at the foot of the tree, others in the middle and still others at the top.'

(27) *watik zokwasi ane ffrümenzo kwanafrmth*
wati zokwasi ane f~frü=me=nzo kwa\naf/rmth
then speech DEM REDUP~alone=INS=ONLY 2|3PL:PST:DUR\talk
'They all spoke different languages.'

(28) *nä kayé wäsi ane zäföfa fof*
nä kayé wäsi ane zä\föf/a fof
INDF one_day_away tree_species DEM SG:PST:PFV\burn EMPH
'One day, the Wäsi tree started to burn.'

(29) *zästha fof*
zä\sth/a fof
SG:PST:PFV\set_on_fire EMPH
'It really lit up.'

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(30) *nä kabe nima kwakwirwrmth*
nä kabe nima kwa\kwir/wrmth
INDF people like_this 2|3PL:PST:DUR\run
'Some people ran away, while'

(31) *nä kabe nima mnin kwarsirwrmth*
nä kabe nima mni=en kwa\rsir/wrmth
INDF people like_this fire=LOC 2|3PL:PST:DUR\burn
'others burned in the fire.'

(32) *watik wäsi ane kwot ŋarsira zäbtha*
wati wäsi ane kwot ŋa\rsir/a zä\bth/a
then tree_species DEM properly SG:PST:IPFV\burn SG:PST:PFV\finish
'So the Wäsi tree burned to the ground.'

(33) *kabe bä mane thwägrm warfo nä mrmr*
kabe bä mane th\wä/grm warfo nä mrmr
people MED which 2|3SG:PST:DUR:STAT\be_up_high above INDF inside
'Those people who stayed at the top, and those (who stayed) inside,'

(34) *fi we nimäwä kwarsirwrmth*
fi we nima=wä kwa\rsir/wrmth
3.ABS also like_this=EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR\burn
'they also burned.'

(35) *watik ezi kabe ane frümenzo tnägsi zethkäfath*
wati ezi kabe ane frü=me=nzo tnäg-si ze\thkäf/ath
then morning people DEM alone=INS=ONLY lose-NMLZ 2|3PL:PST:PFV\start
'Then, in the morning, people began to disperse.'

(36) *bä frümenzo thwamnzrm*
bä frü=me=nzo thwa\m/nzrm
MED alone=INS=ONLY 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'They lived all by themselves.'

(37) *watik, mni fthé ŋarsira*
wati mni fthé ŋa\rsir/a
then fire when SG:PST:IPFV\burn
'When the fire burned,'

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(38) *kar ane bramöwä ŋarsira fof*
kar ane bramöwä ŋa\rsir/a fof
place DEM all SG:PST:IPFV\burn EMPH
'it burned down everything.'

(39) *thgathg zfrärm fath thefath*
thgathg zf\rä/rm fath thefath
burned_place 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be clear_place bushfire
'It became a charred place, a clear place, a burnt place.'

(40) *watik menzmenz ane fof yabun kafar*
wati menz~menz ane fof yabun kafar
then REDUP~story_man DEM EMPH big big
'Then (there was) a huge spirit being, a very big creature.'

(41) *thgathg dagonr ane fof zenfara*
thgathg dagon=r ane fof zen\far/a
burned_place food=PURP DEM EMPH SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off
'It roamed around and ate (people),'

(42) *kabe mane thfthnm kwosi*
kabe mane thf\thn/m kwosi
people which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\lie_down corpse
'the dead people who lay there.'

(43) *watik gwamf ŋatha thäsa ezi*
wati gwam=f ŋatha thä\s/a ezi
then PN=ERG.SG dog SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\call morning
'In the morning, Gwam called his dogs'

(44) *ane thefath thgathgen fof yaser*
ane thefath thgathg=en fof yase=r
DEM bushfire burned_place=LOC EMPH game=PURP
'(to go) hunting at that burned place.'

(45) *watik ŋatha anenzo fof sathkäfa*
wati ŋatha ane=nzo fof sa\thkäf/a
then dog DEM=ONLY EMPH SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\start
'He started with one of the dogs.'

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(46) *ŋatha ane swaruthrm gwam mon nima yarera*
ŋatha ane swa\ru/thrm gwam mon nima
dog DEM SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:DUR\bark PN how like_this
ya\rä/ra
SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:IPFV\do
'The dog was barking, and Gwam was thinking like this.'

(47) *eda erna kabe*
eda e\rn/a kabe
two 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be man
'In fact, there were two men.'

(48) *kafar yf mane thfrnm*
kafar yf mane thf\rn/m
big name which 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be
'They were well known:'

(49) *nafangthrwä gwam muri*
nafa-ngth=r=wä gwam muri
3.POSS-younger_sibling=ASSOC.DU=EMPH PN PN
'Gwam with his younger brother Muri.'

(50) *gwam yara nafanane muri nafangth*
gwam ya\r/a nafa-nane muri
PN 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be 3.POSS-elder_sibling PN
nafa-ngth
3.POSS-younger_sibling
'Gwam was the older brother and Muri was the younger brother.'

(51) *wati gwamf ane fof ezi ŋatha thäsa thgathgen e*
wati gwam=f ane fof ezi ŋatha thä\s/a
then PN=ERG.SG DEM EMPH morning dog SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\call
thgathg=en e
burned_place=LOC until
'So it was Gwam who called the dogs in the morning (to go hunting) and'

(52) *anenzo fof ŋatha yayamgwa*
ane=nzo fof ŋatha ya\yamg/wa
DEM=ONLY EMPH dog SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:IPFV\surprise
'that one dog stopped because of this (creature).'

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(53) *yayamgwa*
ya\yamg/wa
SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:IPFV\surprise
'It was startled.'

(54) *ane menznzo fof kabe maf änatha fof*
ane menz=nzo fof kabe maf ä\na/tha
DEM story_man=ONLY EMPH people who.ERG.SG SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\eat
fof
EMPH
'It was that creature eating the human bodies.'

(55) *fewakaf kwosi thwanathrm*
fewa=kaf kwosi thwa\na/thrm
smell=PROP corpse SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\eat
'He ate the dead, the decaying corpses.'

(56) *gwamf zagr ymarwa fof*
gwam=f zagr y\mar/wa fof
PN=ERG.SG far SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\see EMPH
'Gwam saw it from a distance.'

(57) *"ra bäne yé?" nima né samara*
ra bäne \yé/ nima n sa\mar/a
what.ABS PH.ABS 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be like_this IMN SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\see
'"What's that?' (he said) and tried to take a look at it.'

(58) *o "ra menzmenz yé?"*
o ra menz~menz \yé/
or what.ABS REDUP~story_man 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'"What creature is this?"'

(59) *kabe nrma fi fobo fof ŋagathikwa fof ane menzmenz*
kabe nr=ma fi fobo fof ŋa\gathik/wa fof ane
people belly=CHAR 3.ABS DIST:ALL EMPH 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\leave EMPH DEM
menz~menz
REDUP~story_man
'The creature stopped with a full stomach.'

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(60) *kabe ane zenthkäfath yak*
kabe ane zen\thkäf/ath yak
people DEM 2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\start run
'The (survivors) started to run.'

(61) *ŋatha mane kwaruthrm*
ŋatha mane kwa\ru/thrm
dog which SG:PST:DUR\bark
'That dog who was barking,'

(62) *yf ŋatha yara ane tifr*
yf ŋatha ya\r/a ane tifr
name dog 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be DEM PN
'its name was Tifér.'

(63) *wati sathkäfath*
wati sa\thkäf/ath
then 2|3PL>3SG.M.IO:PST:PFV\start
'It started (to bark at the creature)'

(64) *kabeyé ane dunzi kma sfruthrmth, keke*
kabe=é ane dunzi kma sf\ru/thrmth keke
people=ERG.NSG DEM arrow POT 2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:DUR\shoot NEG
'and the people tried to shoot it. But they didn't (succeed).'

(65) *gwamf nafangth sräkor*
gwam=f nafa-ngth srä\kor/
PN=ERG.SG 3.POSS-younger_sibling 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\speak
'Gwam told his small brother:'

(66) *"muri zba känrit nzuzawe nzefé biruthro" ŋa*
muri zba kän\rit/ nzu-zawe nzefé
Muri PROX:ABL 2SG:IMP:PFV:VENT\cross 1SG.POSS-side 1SG.ERG.EMPH
b=y\ru/thro a
MED=SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:AND\shoot and
'"Muri, come over here to my side. I'll shoot him from here" and'

(67) *naf nima "samg bänema näbuné fof yruthrth byé keke kwosi yathizr"*

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naf nima sa\mg/ bäne=ma näbun=é
3SG.ERG like_this 2SG>3SG.M:IMP:PFV\shoot PH.ABS=CHAR INDF=ERG.NSG
fof y\ru/thrth b=\yé/ keke kwosi
EMPH 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\shoot MED=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be NEG dead
ya\thiz/r
3SG:NPST:IPFV\die
'(Muri) said, "Shoot now! because the others are shooting, but it's not dying."'

(68) *naf nima "keke fi miyamr erä fofosa mä rä nze komnzo zimarwé fof"*
naf nima keke fi miyamr e\rä/ fofosa mä
3SG.ERG like_this NEG 3.ABS ignorance 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be heart where
\rä/ nze komnzo z=y\mar/wé fof
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be 1SG.ERG only PROX=1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\see EMPH
'Gwam said: "No, they don't know where the heart is. Only I can see it from here."'

(69) *zirkn thfrnm näbun kwanafrm näbun kwanafrm*
zirkn thf\rn/m näbun kwa\naf/rm näbun
insistence 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be INDF SG:PST:DUR\talk INDF
kwa\naf/rm
SG:PST:DUR\talk
'They kept on doing this. One was talking and then the other one was talking.'

(70) *"watik ngth biruthé famkaräsü gnräré"*
wati ngth b=y\ru/thé
then younger_sibling MED=1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\shoot
fam=karä=sü gn\rä/ré
thought=PROP=ETC 2SG:IMP:IPFV\be
'(Gwam said) "Okay brother, I will shoot now! Watch out!"'

(71) *nafananaf ane fof trikasi nima rä*
nafa-nane=f ane fof trikasi nima
3.POSS-elder_sibling=ERG.SG DEM EMPH story like_this
\rä/
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'The story goes that it was the older brother (who shot).'

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(72) *nafangth kma markai nabikarä sfrärm*
nafa-ngth kma markai nabi=karä sf\rä/rm
3.POSS-younger_sibling POT outsider bow=PROP 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'The younger brother is said to have owned a shotgun.'[4]

(73) *watik nafangth mane yara naf keke samga*
wati nafa-ngth mane ya\r/a naf keke
then 3.POSS-younger_sibling which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be 3SG.ERG NEG
sa\mg/a
SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\shoot
'The younger brother did not hit the animal.'

(74) *nafananafnzo nabi ŋathunza zf sfthnm*
nafa-nane=f=nzo nabi ŋa\thu/nza zf
3.POSS-elder_sibling=ERG.SG=ONLY bow SG:PST:IPFV\fold ABSC
sf\thn/m
3SG.M:PST:DUR\lie_down
'The older brother drew the bow (and hit it). The creature dropped down.'

(75) *yo kwan*
yo kwan
sound_of_arrow_hitting_sth shout
'He speared it.'

(76) *fof sargosira fofosa fefen*
fof sa\rgosir/a fofosa fefe=en
EMPH SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:PFV\penetrate heart real=LOC
'The arrow bored right through to the heart.'

(77) *no fof zärftha*
no fof zä\rfth/a
water EMPH SG:PST:PFV\burst
'Water began to break out.'

(78) *no ane zamatha*
no ane za\math/a
water DEM SG:PST:PFV\run
'Water was flowing.'

[4]While the older brother was shooting with bow and arrow.

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(79) *wati no mane kwakwirm fof*
wati no mane kwa\kwir/m fof
then water which SG:PST:DUR\run EMPH
'Water that was running'

(80) *wäsi zrminz mä ŋanrsira fof*
wäsi zrminz mä ŋan\rsir/a fof
tree_species root where SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\burn EMPH
'Where the roots of the Wäsi tree burned,'

(81) *mni mä ŋanrsira*
mni mä ŋan\rsir/a
fire where SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\burn
'where the fire burned them,'

(82) *no fä kwanthorthrm fof ane zrminz fof*
no fä kwan\thor/thrm fof ane zrminz fof
water DIST SG:PST:DUR:VENT\enter EMPH DEM root EMPH
'the water flowed along those roots.'

(83) *nof nä nima thäkothmako*
no=f nä nima thä\kothm/ako
water=ERG.SG INDF like_this SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV:AND\chase
'The water chased away some of the people in this direction.'

(84) *nä nima thänkothma nzezawe*
nä nima thän\kothm/a nze-zawe
INDF like_this SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\chase 1NSG.POSS-side
'Others were chased away towards our side here.'

(85) *gwamane nima zenmathath muriane nima*
gwam=ane nima zen\math/ath muri=ane nima
PN=POSS.SG like_this 2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\run PN=POSS.SG like_this
'The people from Gwam ran here and those from Muri in the other direction.'

(86) *mane ŋankwirwath zentnäthath*
mane ŋan\kwir/wath zen\tnäth/ath
which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\run 2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\lose
'Those who ran away scattered.'

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(87) *nä enrera bawi*
nä en\rä/ra bawi
INDF 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be PLN
'Some came to Bawi'[5]

(88) *wartha nima bämnzr wartha a kondomarin smärki*
wartha nima b=ä\m/nzr wartha a kondomarin smärki
PN like_this MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit PN and PN PN
'For example, the Wartha people who live over there, and the Kondomarin and the Sémärki.'[6]

(89) *nafanme foba fof ŋankwira fof*
nafanme foba fof ŋan\kwir/a fof
3NSG.POSS DIST:ABL EMPH SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\run EMPH
'Those peoples' (ancestor) ran from there.'

(90) *fi foba fof ŋankwirwath bawi*
fi foba fof ŋan\kwir/wath bawi
3.ABS DIST:ABL EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\run PLN
'They ran from there to Bawi.'

(91) *watik gwamf fä fof mni bäne zafrafa fof*
wati gwam=f fä fof mni bäne za\fraf/a
then PN=ERG.SG DIST EMPH fire PH.ABS SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\extinguish
fof
EMPH
'Then Gwam extinguished the fire.'

(92) *no dödöme zakwra*
no dödö=me za\kwr/a
water broom=INS SG.M>3SG.F:PST:PFV\hit
'No, he hit the running water with the broom and'[7]

(93) *watik no fä fof zä... zäkora*
wati no fä fof zä zä\kor/a
then water DIST EMPH PROX SG:PST:PFV\become
'the water stopped flowing.'

[5]Bawi is a place on the coast between Bula and Jarai.
[6]Kondomarin are the speakers of Marind and various Kanum languages.
[7]*dödö* 'plant species (used as broom)' (*Melaleuca sp.*)

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(94) *keke kwa nof zanmäyofa fobo fof no ŋagathikwa fof*
keke kwa no=f zan\mäyof/a fobo fof
NEG FUT water=ERG.SG SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\continue DIST:ALL EMPH
no ŋa\gathik/wa fof
water 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\leave EMPH
'The water did not continue, it stopped there.'

(95) *watik fi mane enrera e zwari wartha fof*
wati fi mane en\rä/ra e zwari wartha fof
then 3.ABS which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be until PLN PN EMPH
'So the people were coming to Zwari, the Wartha people really.'

(96) *watik fä fof zwarin zämsath*
wati fä fof zwari=en zä\ms/ath
then DIST EMPH PLN=LOC 2|3PL:PST:PFV\sit
'They settled there in Zwari.'

(97) *zokwasi fthé emarwath ffrümenzo*
zokwasi fthé e\mar/wath f~frü=me=nzo
speech when 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\see REDUP~alone=INS=ONLY
'They realised that they spoke different languages.'

(98) *watik kondomarin nima feräro*
wati kondomarin nima f=e\rä/ro
then PN like_this DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'So the Kondomarin people went further this way.'

(99) *zena boba wazi fi berä merauken*
zena boba wazi fi b=e\rä/ merauke=en
today MED:ABL side 3.ABS MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be PLN=LOC
'Nowadays, they live in Merauke.'

(100) *nä mane erera zwarifa ŋafrezath thoro*
nä mane e\rä/ra zwari=fa
INDF which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be PLN=ABL
ŋa\frez/ath thoro
2|3PL:PST:IPFV\come_up_from_river PLN
'Others came up from Zwari towards Thoro.'[8]

[8]Thoro is located somewhere between Bensbach and Wämnefér.

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(101) *watik thoron fä fthé zemarath we nimäwä fof zokwasi ffrümenzo*
wati thoro=en fä fthé ze\mar/ath we nima=wä fof
then PLN=LOC DIST when 2|3PL:PST:PFV\see also like_this=EMPH EMPH
zokwasi f~frü=me=nzo
speech REDUP~alone=INS=ONLY
'At Thoro it was the same again. They realised that they spoke different languages.'

(102) *watik foba zethkäfath nimame kwasogwrmth*
wati foba ze\thkäf/ath nima=me kwa\sog/wrmth
then DIST:ABL 2|3PL:PST:PFV\start like_this=INS 2|3PL:PST:DUR\ascend
'So they moved further inland.'

(103) *okay, nä mane enrera zwarifa e bäne thamgakar*
okay nä mane en\rä/ra zwari=fa e thamgakar
okay INDF which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be PLN=ABL until PLN
'Others came from Zwari straight to Tamgakar.'[9]

(104) *nima bä ämnzr safs*
nima bä ä\m/nzr safs
like_this MED 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit PLN
'For example, the people who live at Safés.'

(105) *wati fi fä fof thfyakm*
wati fi fä fof thf\yak/m
then 3.ABS DIST EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR\walk
'They were walking this way.'

(106) *nzenme mane yanra*
nzenme mane yan\r/a
1NSG.POSS which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'As for our ancestor and his people,'

(107) *mä ŋankwirwath komo fä ŋanfrezath komo*
mä ŋan\kwir/wath komo fä
where 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\run PLN DIST
ŋan\frez/ath komo
2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come_up_from_river PLN
'they walked to Komo. They came up at Komo.'[10]

[9]Tamgakar is located south of Mibini.
[10]Komo is a place in the between Mibini, Jarai, Bula, and Wämnefér.

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(108) *nzenme mayawama kabe nä fä thägathizath*
nzenme mayawa=ma kabe nä fä thä\gathiz/ath
1NSG.POSS Mayawa=CHAR man INDF DIST 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\leave
'They left some of our Mayawa people there.'

(109) *we foba thden nä kwot we mayawama kabe fof*
we foba thd=en nä kwot we mayawa=ma kabe fof
also DIST:ABL middle=LOC INDF properly also PN=CHAR people EMPH
'Some Mayawa people live there in the middle,'

(110) *foba baguma kabe*
foba bagu=ma kabe
DIST:ABL PN=CHAR people
'and also some Bangu people.'

(111) *foba zena mifinin zämnzr*
foba zena mifini=en z=ä\m/nzr
DIST:ABL today PLN=LOC PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit
'Nowadays, these people live at Mibini.'

(112) *sagara fä thägathizath*
sagara fä thä\gathiz/ath
PN DIST 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\leave
'He also left some Sangara people there.'

(113) *okay fi nima erera mogarkam*
okay fi nima e\rä/ra mogarkam
okay 3.ABS like_this 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be PLN
'Okay, they spread further to Mongarkam.'[11]

(114) *nä mane erera nima erera bäne a drdr nä sagara fof*
nä mane e\rä/ra nima e\rä/ra bäne a
INDF which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be like_this 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be PH.ABS and
drdr nä sagara fof
PLN INDF PN EMPH
'Other Sangara people continued until Déridéri.'

[11]Mongarkam is located north of Mibini.

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(115) *bagu mane enrera bäne mäta*
bagu mane en\rä/ra bäne mata
PN which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be PH PLN
'The Bangu people came to Mäta, and'

(116) *sagara mane enrera garaita*
sagara mane en\rä/ra garaita
PN which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be PLN
'the Sangara people to Garaita.'

(117) *mayawa ni zbo zf nnrera*
mayawa ni zbo zf nn\rä/ra
PN 1NSG PROX:ALL ABSC 1PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'We Mayawas came here.'

(118) *nzenme bada mrzarane bada mane yanra yf ane yanra mathkwi*
nzenme bada mrzar=ane bada mane
1NSG.POSS ancestor Mrzar=POSS.SG ancestor which
yan\r/a yf ane yan\r/a mathkwi
3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be name DEM 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be PN
'As for our ancestor, the Mérzar's ancestor, his name was Mathkwi.'

(119) *mathkwif ane enfathwa*
mathkwi=f ane en\fath/wa
PN=ERG.SG DEM SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\hold
'Mathkwi was bringing along those things:'

(120) *wawa fofosa*
wawa fofosa
round_yam heart
'the yam stone.'[12]

(121) *naf ane ynfathwa fof*
naf ane yn\fath/wa fof
3SG.ERG DEM SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\hold EMPH
'He had this one.'

[12] A magic stone for planting yams.

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(122) *wati näbi ane komnzo fofosa yara wawama nasi duga biskar*
wati näbi ane komnzo fofosa ya\r/a wawa=ma
then one DEM only heart 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be round_yam=CHAR
nasi duga biskar
long_yam taro cassava
'It was for (the cultivation of) yams, long yams, taro and cassava,'

(123) *dagon nä berä fof*
dagon nä b=e\rä/ fof
food INDF MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be EMPH
'and for other kinds of crops.'

(124) *watik fi anekarä fof yanra fof*
wati fi ane=karä fof yan\r/a fof
then 3.ABS DEM=PROP EMPH 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be EMPH
'He came with that (stone).'

(125) *mane yanyaka e*
mane yan\yak/a e
which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come until
'As he walked towards'

(126) *wm bä ythn zabrta*
wm bä y\thn/ zabrta
stone MED 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\lie_down PLN
'the place where the stones lay near Zambérta,'

(127) *fä fof ŋanritakwath fof kwanritakwrmth trkren*
fä fof ŋan\ritak/wath fof kwan\ritak/wrmth
DIST EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\cross EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\cross
trkr=en
flood=LOC
'they crossed the river. They crossed the river during the flood season.'

(128) *watik nima né fam zära*
wati nima n fam zä\r/a
then like_this IMN thought SG:PST:PFV\do
'Then he thought to himself'

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(129) *“garaita zawe? keke nä kabe foba z sfyak”*
garaita zawe keke nä kabe foba z sf\yak/
PLN side NEG INDF man DIST:ABL IAM 3SG.M:RPST:IPFV\walk
‘“Should I go to Garaita? No, someone’s already gone there.”’

(130) *watik nima zethkäfa fi safs*
wati nima ze\thkäf/a fi safs
then like_this SG:PST:PFV\start 3.ABS PLN
‘So he started walking towards Safés.’

(131) *nimame ane zethkäfa mothr mane yanra e akrimogo*
nima=me ane ze\thkäf/a moth=r mane
like_this=INS DEM SG:PST:PFV\start path=PURP which
yan\r/a e akrimogo
3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be until PLN
‘He got going and walked until Akrimongo.’

(132) *yam fä fof thremar fof*
yam fä fof thre\mar/ fof
footprint DIST EMPH 2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\see EMPH
‘He saw footprints there.’

(133) *“oh nä nima z eräro”*
oh nä nima z e\rä/ro
oh INDF like_this IAM 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
‘“Oh, others are already here.”’

(134) *watik keräfi foba fof zäzira fof e kar yf rä ymnz*
wati keräfi foba fof zä\zir/a fof e kar
then palm_species DIST:ABL EMPH SG:PST:PFV\throw EMPH until place
yf \rä/ ymnz
name 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN
‘Then he shot an arrow that flew all the way to Yéménz.’

(135) *watik fobo fof “oh kabe bä yé*
wati fobo fof oh kabe bä \yé/
then DIST:ALL EMPH oh man MED 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
‘Then (he heard people) from there and said: “Oh, there’s already someone there.’

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(136) *watik nimame wiyak"*
wati nima=me w\yak/
then like_this=INS 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk
'Then I will go this way."'

(137) *watik foba fof akrimogofa zenfara fof*
wati foba fof akrimogo=fa zen\far/a fof
then DIST:ABL EMPH PLN=ABL SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off EMPH
'So he left Akrimongo and started walking.'

(138) *foba näbi yaniyaka karane yf erä füsari*
foba näbi yan\yak/a kar=ane yf
DIST:ABL one 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come place=POSS.SG name
e\rä/ füsäri
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be PLN
'He came straight to a place called Füsari.'

(139) *füsärifa rarafü kar*
füsäri=fa rarafü_kar
PLN=ABL PLN
'From Füsari to Rarafü Kar.'

(140) *rarafü karfa kafrir fä ttfön zänrita*
rarafü_kar=fa kafrir fä ttfö=en zän\rit/a
PLN=ABL PLN DIST creek=LOC SG:PST:PFV:VENT\cross
'From Rarafü Kar to Kafrir, where he crossed the stream,'

(141) *e bäne zofok*
e bäne zofok
until PH PLN
'until whatsthat, until Zofok.'

(142) *zofok fä yamthiza*
zofok fä ya\mthiz/a
PLN DIST 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\rest
'He was resting in Zofok.'

(143) *nabi komnzo bekogr*
nabi komnzo b=e\ko/gr
bamboo only MED=2|3PL:NPST:STAT\be_standing
'The bamboo trees are still there.'

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(144) *nabi ŋatr fä fof zurärm zwafrmnzrm zurzirakwa fof*
nabi ŋatr fä fof zu\rä/rm
bow bowstring DIST EMPH SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\do
zwa\frmnz/rm zu\rzirak/wa fof
SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\prepare SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\bend EMPH
'There he fixed his bow and tied the string there.'

(145) *nasi nömä yanatha*
nasi nömä ya\na/tha
long_yam yamcake SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat
'He ate some yamcake.'

(146) *rfarrfar futhfuth mane erera wmr ane fof ŋakwthenzath fof zäkwtherath*
rfarrfar futhfuth mane e\rä/ra wm=r ane fof
rests scraps which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be stone=PURP DEM EMPH
ŋa\kwthe/nzath fof zä\kwther/ath
2|3PL:PST:IPFV\change EMPH 2|3PL:PST:PFV\change
'Those crumbs from the yamcake turned into stones.'

(147) *watik komnzo berästhgr*
wati komnzo b=e\räs/thgr
then still MED=2|3PL:NPST:STAT\be_erected
'They still exist.'

(148) *wm mane yé ynfathwa fof no nzigfu*
wm mane \yé/ yn\fath/wa fof
stone which 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\hold EMPH
no nzigfu
water rain_stone
'That stone that he had brought, that rain stone,'

(149) *watik ane fof yräza fof zofok kar*
wati ane fof y\räz/a fof zofok kar
then DEM EMPH SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\erect EMPH PLN place
'he put (the name) Zofok at that place.'

(150) *watik foba yaniyaka misa zfth*
wati foba yan\yak/a misa_zfth
then DIST:ABL 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come PLN
'Then he continued and came to Misa Zéféth.'

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(151) *mäbri misa zfth yrn*
mäbri misa_zfth yrn
PLN PLN PLN
'Mämbri was first, then Misa Zéféth and then Yérén.'

(152) *fä zänrsöfätha fof yaniyaka benzü zfth*
fä zän\rsöfäth/a fof yan\yak/a
DIST SG:PST:PFV:VENT\descend EMPH 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come
benzü_zfth
PLN
'He went down there (to the river) and walked to Benzü Zéféth.'

(153) *foba fof ymd threnkaris fof afa kfokfo ythama*
foba fof ymd thren\karis/ fof afa_kfokfo
DIST:ABL EMPH bird 2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV:VENT\hear EMPH butcherbird
ythama
bird_of_paradise
'From there he heard the birds calling, the butcherbird and the bird of paradise.'

(154) *fam zära "kar bä rä ŋa kar töna fobo fof wiyak fof"*
fam zä\r/a kar bä \rä/ a kar
thought SG:PST:PFV\do place MED 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be and place
töna fobo fof w\yak/ fof
high_ground DIST:ALL EMPH 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk EMPH
'He thought: "This must be high ground. I am going to walk there."'

(155) *yaniyaka fä fof zänrita fof rä kukwrb fr zra mnzärfr neba*
yan\yak/a fä fof zän\rit/a fof
3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come DIST EMPH SG:PST:PFV:VENT\cross EMPH
\rä/ kukwrb_fr zra mnzär_fr neba
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN swamp PLN opposite
'He came there and crossed (the river) at Kukwérémb Fér, opposite Ménzär Fér.'

(156) *wati fä fof yaniyaka fof mä zänfrefa*
wati fä fof yan\yak/a fof mä
then DIST EMPH 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come EMPH where
zän\fref/a
2|3SG:PST:PFV:VENT\come_up_from_river
'That's where he came and where he walked up (from the river).'

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(157) *nömä futhfuth fä fof ŋantnägwath*
nömä futhfuth fä fof ŋan\tnäg/wath
yamcake scraps DIST EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\scatter
'He dropped some crumbs of the yamcake there.'

(158) *mane yanra e zrä zöfäthak*
mane yan\r/a e z=\rä/ zöfäthak
which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be until PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN
'He came here to Zöfäthak.'

(159) *bä brä zafe ŋazi fr nä fä fof ethn berä*
bä b=\rä/ zafe ŋazi fr nä fä fof
MED MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be old coconut post INDF DIST EMPH
e\thn/ b=e\rä/
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\lie_down MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'Over there, by the old coconuts, there are some more (crumbs) there.'

(160) *watik nä fä fof ŋantnägwath fof*
wati nä fä fof ŋan\tnäg/wath fof
then INDF DIST EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\scatter EMPH
'He dropped some more there.'

(161) *fä fof sakuka "oh zane zf zunthorakwé watik"*
fä fof sa\kuk/a oh zane zf
DIST EMPH 3SG.M:PST:PFV\stand oh DEM:PROX ABSC
zun\thorak/wé wati
1SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV:VENT\search then
'Then he stopped (and said) "I was looking for this (place)."'

(162) *fz zamara afa kfokfo zakarisa*
fz za\mar/a afa_kfokfo za\karis/a
forest SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\see butcherbird SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\hear
'He looked at the forest and he heard the butcherbird'

(163) *bäne zakarisa ythama*
bäne za\karis/a ythama
PH.ABS SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\hear bird_of_paradise
'and he heard the other one, the bird of paradise.'

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(164) *watik krenafth nima wiyak*
wati kre\nafth/ nima w\yak/
then 2|3PL:IRR:PFV\talk like_this 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk
'Then he said "I will go this way.'

(165) *zbo kar rä farem kar*
zbo kar \rä/ farem_kar
PROX:ALL place 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN
'There is a place, Faremkar."'

(166) *watik fthé yaka bobo*
wati fthé \yak/a bobo
then when 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\walk MED:ALL
'When he came there,'

(167) *foba krekaris "oh füthan nä zbo kabe yamnzr"*
foba kre\karis/ oh fütha=en nä zbo kabe
DIST:ABL 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\hear oh PLN=LOC INDF PROX:ALL man
ya\m/nzr
3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\sit
'he heard something (and said) "Someone is staying in Fütha."'

(168) *we foba krekaris "oh farem karen kabe yé"*
we foba kre\karis/ oh farem_kar=en kabe
also DIST:ABL 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\hear oh PLN=LOC man
\yé/
3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'He listened again (and said) "Oh, there is someone in Faremkar already."'

(169) *watik yako*
wati \yak/o
then 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:AND\walk
'So he continued to walk.'

(170) *faremaneme kabe z sathora*
farem=aneme kabe z sa\thor/a
PN=POSS.NSG man IAM 3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear
'The ancestor of the Farem was already there.'

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(171) *bafane bada fof fatamaane*
baf=ane bada fof fatama=ane
PH=POSS.SG ancestor EMPH PN=POSS.SG
'Those one's ancestor, Fatama's ancestor.'

(172) *farem thden watik foba fof sräkor*
farem thd=en wati foba fof srä\kor/
PLN middle=LOC then DIST:ABL EMPH 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\speak
'He was staying in the centre of Faremkar. He said to him'

(173) *foba fof "bä fä fof gnamnzé ey*
foba fof bä fä fof gna\m/nzé ey
DIST:ABL EMPH MED DIST EMPH 2SG:IMP:IPFV\sit hey
'"You stay over there!'

(174) *fisor bthanen käms"*
fisor_bthan=en kä\ms/
PLN=LOC 2SG:IMP:PFV\sit
'You can settle in Fisor Béthan!"'

(175) *wati we nä sräthoro wazu*
wati we nä srä\thor/o wazu
then also INDF 3SG.M:IRR:PFV:AND\appear PN
'Then another ancestor arrived, from the Wazu clan.'

(176) *fä fof sräkor watik "foba fof käms wazufa"*
fä fof srä\kor/ wati foba fof
DIST EMPH 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\speak then DIST:ABL EMPH
kä\ms/ wazu=fa
2SG:IMP:PFV\sit PLN=ABL
'He said: "You can settle there in Wazu!"'

(177) *watik fthé zamara katan fäth ane zfrärm "kwa nzä zä zf kwramnzr?*
wati fthé za\mar/a katan fäth ane zf\rä/rm kwa
then when SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\see small DIM DEM 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be FUT
nzä zä zf kwra\m/nzr
1SG.ABS PROX ABSC 1SG:IRR:IPFV\sit
'(Mathkwi) saw that it was a small piece of land (and he said) 'Oh, this is where you want me to live?'

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(178) *nima ŋabrigwé"*
nima ŋa\brig/wé
like_this 1SG:NPST:IPFV\return
'I will go back this way."'

(179) *moba fthmäsü zänbrima watik*
moba fthmäsü zän\brim/a wati
where.ABL meanwhile SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return then
'While he returned from there,'

(180) *nasi nömä ane fof tnägsi thenthkäfa rrfar*
nasi nömä ane fof tnäg-si then\thkäf/a
long_yam yamcake DEM EMPH lose-NMLZ SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\start
rfarrfar
scraps
'he was dropping crumbs of the yamcake'

(181) *futhfuth*
futhfuth
scraps
'those scraps,'

(182) *watik mane yaniyaka*
wati mane yan\yak/a
then which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come
'while he was on his way.'

(183) *zä zf e zane zf zethno zerä*
zä zf e zane zf z=e\thn/o
PROX ABSC until DEM:PROX ABSC PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\lie_down
z=e\rä/
PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'They're right here. They are lying here.'

(184) *fä fof ane futhfuth thuntnägwrm*
fä fof ane futhfuth thun\tnäg/wrm
DIST EMPH DEM scraps SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\scatter
'He kept dropping these crumbs.'

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(185) *nä bä enthn*
nä bä en\thn/
INDF MED 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\lie_down
'There are some lying over there.'

(186) *e nima ziyaro ŋe masu*
e nima z=ya\r/o e masu
until like_this PROX=3SG.M:PST:IPFV:AND\be until PLN
'In this way, he continued on to Masu.'

(187) *foba fof sathora "nzukar zä zf ämnzr*
foba fof sa\thor/a nzu-kar zä zf
DIST:ABL EMPH 3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear 1SG.POSS-place PROX ABSC
ä\m/nzr
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit
'As he arrived "This is my place. My people will live here."'

(188) *watik menz kar ane fof zräkorth yari*
wati menz kar ane fof zrä\kor/th yari
then story_man place DEM EMPH 2|3PL>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\speak PLN
'They call this story place Yari.'

(189) *yari sathora fof*
yari sa\thor/a fof
PLN 3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear EMPH
'So he arrived in Yari.'

(190) *watik fä fof no nzigfukarä fi fof sathora fof*
wati fä fof no nzigfu=karä fi fof
then DIST EMPH water rain_stone=PROP 3.ABS EMPH
sa\thor/a fof
3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear EMPH
'He arrived with the rain stone.'

(191) *fi mane yanra*
fi mane yan\r/a
3.ABS which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'As he came,'

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(192) *nzigfu nä fofosa yfathwa fof*
nzigfu nä fofosa y\fath/wa fof
rain_stone INDF heart SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\hold EMPH
'he brought another stone, the yam stone'

(193) *nasi wawa duga biskar*
nasi wawa duga biskar
long_yam round_yam taro cassava
'for long yam, yam, taro, and cassava.'

(194) *ranzo fä dagon eräro*
ra=nzo fä dagon e\rä/ro
what.ABS=ONLY DIST food SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'for all these other types of crops.'

(195) *anekaräsü swamnzrm fof*
ane=karä=sü swa\m/nzrm fof
DEM=PROP=ETC 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit EMPH
'He was staying with those items.'

(196) *fthé wawa thuworthrmth*
fthé wawa thu\wor/thrmth
when round_yam 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\plant
'When planting season came.'

(197) *watik sfrärm e wawa taga kwot thkarthé kwafiyokwrmth*
wati sf\rä/rm e wawa taga kwot thkar-thé
then 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be until round_yam leaf properly thick-ADLZR
kwa\fiyok/wrmth
2|3PL:PST:DUR\make
'Then the leaves of the yam plants became dry.'

(198) *watik fthé fof wawa taga nä thurtnwrm*
wati fthé fof wawa taga nä
then when EMPH round_yam leaf INDF
thu\rtn/wrm
SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\pull_off_leaves
'and he pulled off some of the yam leaves'

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(199) *nasi taga kemar taga taga bäne berä biskar duga*
nasi taga kemar taga taga bäne b=e\rä/
long_yam leaf yam_species leaf leaf PH.ABS MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
biskar duga
cassava taro
'or long yam leaves, or sweet potato leaves. All those leaves like cassava leaves, taro leaves'

(200) *watik nzigfu mrmr foba sfrärm*
wati nzigfu mrmr foba sf\rä/rm
then rain_stone inside DIST:ABL 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'He put the stone inside those (leaves).'

(201) *ane tagame sumyuknwrm*
ane taga=me su\myukn/wrm
DEM leaf=INS SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\twist
'He rolled them up in these leaves.'

(202) *surdiknwrm watik wawa zfthen swäzin*
su\rdikn/wrm wati wawa zfth=en
SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\tie.around then round_yam tree_base=LOC
swä\zin/
2|3SG>3SG.M:ITER\put_down
'He tied it up and put down (the bundle) at the base of the plants.'

(203) *sfthnm e*
sf\thn/m e
3SG.M:PST:DUR\lie_down until
'It lay there until'

(204) *wawa fthé thwemar nima thkarthé zäkorth*
wawa fthé thwe\mar/ nima thkar-thé
round_yam when SG>2|3PL:ITER\see like_this thick-ADLZR
zä\kor/th
2|3PL:RPST:PFV\become
'he saw that the yam leaves are really dried up.'

(205) *watik ausiausi thukonzrm*
wati ausi~ausi thu\ko/nzrm
then REDUP~old_woman SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\speak
'Then he called the women:'

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(206) *käthfe kabe*
kä\thf/e kabe
2PL:IMP:PFV\walk people
'"Go people!"'

(207) *ausiausi thfyakm ŋanz ffrümenzoma*
ausi~ausi thf\yak/m ŋanz
REDUP~old_woman 2|3PL:PST:DUR\walk garden_row
f~frü=me=nzo=ma
REDUP~alone=INS=ONLY=CHAR
'The women went and took one yam from each plot.'

(208) *wawa ane ebar fr wawa ebar fr kafar*
wawa ane ebar fr wawa ebar fr kafar
round_yam DEM head post round_yam head post big
'(They took) one big yam, the really big ones.'

(209) *watik nä ŋanzma wawa näbi nä ŋanzma nä ŋanzma nä ŋanzma nimanzo watik*
wati nä ŋanz=ma wawa näbi nä ŋanz=ma
then INDF garden_row=CHAR round_yam one INDF garden_row=CHAR
nä ŋanz=ma nä ŋanz=ma nima=nzo wati
INDF garden_row=CHAR INDF garden_row=CHAR like_this=ONLY then
'One yam from this plot, and another one from that plot, and so on.'

(210) *mnime thufränzrmth*
mni=me thu\frä/nzrmth
fire=INS 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\singe_off
'They burned off the hair (on the tubers).'

(211) *watik thufthakwrmth foba karome thurzathrmth*
wati thu\fthak/wrmth foba karo=me
then 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\take_out_off_fire DIST:ABL ground_oven=INS
thu\rza/thrmth
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\bake
'They took them out of the fire and put them in the oven.'

(212) *zizi ane fof thfzänzrmth bobo far mä suräzrmth*

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zizi ane fof thf\zä/nzrmth bobo far mä
afternoon DEM EMPH 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\carry MED:ALL stem where
su\räz/rmth
2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:DUR\erect
'In the afternoon, they took them to where they had set up the post.'

(213) *mathkwi o karawa o kukuma o ote*
mathkwi o karawa o kukuma o ote
PN or PN or PN or PN
'(All those ancestors were doing that:) Mathkwi, Karawa, Kukuma and Ote.'

(214) *watik ane far fof sfrästhgrm wawa fobo fof thufnakwrm*
wati ane far fof sf\räs/thgrm wawa
then DEM stem EMPH 3SG.M:PST:DUR:STAT\be_erected round_yam
fobo fof thuf\nak/wrm
DIST:ALL EMPH SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\put_down
'They had set up the post and they put the yams down at the base.'

(215) *fobo fefe né wawa kwanäbünzrmth kwosi kwakonzrmth*
fobo fefe n wawa kwa\näbü/nzrmth kwosi
DIST:ALL really IMN round_yam 2|3PL:PST:DUR\smash dead
kwa\ko/nzrmth
2|3PL:RPST:DUR\become
'Then these yams were on the verge of decay, they started to rot.'

(216) *bänemr e tayo tfotfo*
bäne=r e tayo tfotfo
PH.ABS=PURP until ripe almost
'Time went by until (the other yams were) almost ripe.'

(217) *tayo wawa fthé kwakonzrmth*
tayo wawa fthé kwa\ko/nzrmth
ripe round_yam when 2|3PL:RPST:DUR\become
'When the yams were ripe,'

(218) *rfnaksir bobo zarfa thfrärm mäta garaita*
rfnak-si=r bobo zarfa thf\rä/rm mata garaita
taste-NMLZ=PURP MED:ALL ear 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be PLN PLN
'they heard about the tasting in Mäta or Garaita.'

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(219) *nafa fthé kwänrfnth "ayo"*
nafa fthé kwän\rfn/th ayo
3NSG.ERG when 2|3PL:ITER:VENT\taste watch_out
'Each time they tried the yams, (they shouted) "Listen up!"'

(220) *wrwr fof zefaro swänrifthth*
wrwr fof ze\far/o swän\rifth/th
wind EMPH SG:RPST:PFV:AND\set_off 2|3PL>3SG.M:ITER:VENT\send
'The wind blew and carried the message here.'

(221) *watik we masu karé kwekaristh "oh nafa z zärfnth"*
wati we masu kar=é kwe\karis/th oh nafa z
then also PLN place=ERG.NSG 2|3PL:ITER\hear oh 3NSG.ERG IAM
zä\rfn/th
2|3PL:RPST:PFV\taste
'The Masu people heard it and said: "Oh, they have already tasted the yams."'

(222) *we kwot we näbikakme we nä wawa thfrärmth katan o kafar thuwoknzrmth*
we kwot we näbi-kak=me we nä wawa
also properly also one-DISTR=INS also INDF round_yam
thf\rä/rmth katan o kafar thu\wok/nzrmth
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\do small or big 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\choose
'So they also took one yam each. They chose a big or small one.'

(223) *watik kwarzathrmth*
wati kwa\rza/thrmth
then 2|3PL:PST:DUR\bake
'They put it in the oven.'

(224) *tawar ane thfrärmth ŋazi thurwrmth*
tawar ane thf\rä/rmth ŋazi
yam_pulp DEM 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\do coconut
thu\r/wrmth
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\scrape
'They scraped the inside fibre out, mixed it with coconut,'

(225) *kwot thufathwrmth kobakob*

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kwot thu\fath/wrmth kobakob
properly 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hold round_object
'and formed round balls.'

(226) *watik kwarfnakwrmth watik nima kwanrzrmth*
wati kwa\rfnak/wrmth wati nima kwan\rz/rmth
then 2|3PL:PST:DUR\taste then like_this 2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\throw
'They tasted these and then they threw the balls this way.'

(227) *fatr nima thwafiyokwrmth "ayo farem benm fräro!"*
fatr nima thwa\fiyok/wrmth ayo farem
upper_arm like_this 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\make watch_out PN
benm f=\rä/ro
2NSG:DAT DIST=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'They threw their arms in the air and shouted: "Listen, you Farem people, this is for you!"'

(228) *watik ane fthé kwärit ane tmatm rfnaksi tmatm*
wati ane fthé kwä\rit/ ane tmatm rfnak-si tmatm
then DEM when SG:ITER\cross DEM action taste-NMLZ action
'And so it happened. This tasting ritual passed by (heading west).'

(229) *thumarwrmth e rrr kwan fthé bäne kwäkorth tayo kwot thuwäkwrm*
thu\mar/wrm-thé e rrr kwan fthé bäne
SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\see-ADLZR until rustling_sound shout when PH.ABS
kwä\kor/th tayo kwot thu\wäk/wrm
2|3PL:ITER\become ripe properly SG:PST:DUR\become_ripe
'Next, they saw that the leaves had really dried up and the yam were ready.'

(230) *watik fthé fof yaka swefafth*
wati fthé fof yaka swe\faf/th
then when EMPH digging_stick 2|3PL>3SG.M:ITER\hold
'So they picked up the digging stick (and started harvesting).'

(231) *anenzo fof, ane tmatm kwaritakwrm e zbo bäydbo*
ane=nzo fof ane tmatm kwa\ritak/wrm e zbo
DEM=ONLY EMPH DEM action 2|3SG:PST:DUR\cross until PROX:ALL
bäi=dbo
PN=ALL.ANIM.SG
'This ritual was passed on all the way to Bäi.'

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(232) *bäi kafar zäkora*
bäi kafar zä\kor/a
PN big SG:PST:PFV\become
'When Bäi became a man,'

(233) *nafaŋafyf ... nafane ŋafyf ane fof sara fof*
nafa-ŋafe=f nafane ŋafe=f ane fof
3.POSS-father=ERG.SG 3SG.POSS father=ERG.SG DEM EMPH
sa\r/a fof
SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:PFV\give EMPH
'his father gave him (the yam stone).'

(234) *foba fof otef*
foba fof ote=f
DIST:ABL EMPH PN=ERG.SG
'(His father) Ote'

(235) *watik naf we ane fof thwamonegwrm no bäne no nzigfu*
wati naf we ane fof thwa\moneg/wrm no bäne
then 3SG.ERG also DEM EMPH SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\take.care rain PH.ABS
no nzigfu
rain rain_stone
'had also looked after the rain stone'

(236) *a fofosa frä dagon fofosa fof*
a fofosa f=\rä/ dagon fofosa fof
and heart DIST=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be food heart EMPH
'and the yam stone, the food stone.'

(237) *foba e ni kafar ŋankonzake*
foba e ni kafar ŋan\ko/nzake
DIST:ABL until 1NSG big 1PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\become
'This continued until we became men.'

(238) *nzesinenwä ane fof komnzo thfrnm ane eda rokar fof*
nze-si=en=wä ane fof komnzo thf\rn/m ane eda
1PL.POSS-eye=LOC=EMPH DEM EMPH only 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be DEM two
rokar fof
thing EMPH
'Those two stones where under our eyes.'

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(239) *e nama masun ane yam tmatm z zwabragwre fof*
e nama masu=en ane yam tmatm z
until two_days_away PLN=LOC DEM event action IAM
zwa\brag/wre fof
1PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\follow EMPH
'Until recently, we followed this tradition in Masu.'

(240) *e watik foba zänbrimake zena mänwä zä namnzr*
e wati foba zän\brim/ake zena mänwä zä
until then DIST:ABL 1PL:PST:PFV:VENT\return today where.EMPH PROX
na\m/nzr
1PL:NPST:IPFV\sit
'Then we moved to where we live now.'

(241) *znrä*
zf z=n\rä/
ABSC PROX=1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'We are here now.'

(242) *watik fi fthmäsü kwik kwosi yara.*
wati fi fthmäsü kwik kwosi ya\r/a
then 3.ABS meanwhile sick dead 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'That was the time when (father) became ill and died.'

(243) *greg täwdben ane thfrärm*
greg täw=dben ane thf\rä/rm
PN father=LOC.ANIM.SG DEM 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'Those things were with Greg's father,'

(244) *ane bäne nzigfu thfrnm edawä*
ane bäne nzigfu thf\rn/m eda=wä
DEM PH.ABS rain_stone 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be two=EMPH
'these two whatchamacallit, these two stones.'

(245) *watik nzenme ŋafe fthmäsü kwosi yara*
wati nzenme ŋafe fthmäsü kwosi ya\r/a
then 1NSG.POSS father meanwhile dead 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'Then, our father passed away'

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(246) *watik foba ni miyamr nrä mafadben zena ethn*
wati foba ni miyamr n\rä/ mafa=dben zena
then DIST:ABL 1NSG ignorance 1PL:NPST:IPFV\be who=LOC.ANIM.SG today
e\thn/
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\lie_down
'and we don't know with whom they are now.'

(247) *z thrifthmath fof*
z th\rifthm/ath fof
IAM 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hide EMPH
'Someone must have hidden them.'

(248) *watik trikasi mane nŋatrikwé fof*
wati trikasi mane n=ŋa\trik/wé fof
then story which IPST=1SG:NPST:IPFV\tell EMPH
'Okay, the story I just told'

(249) *ŋafynm badafa ane fof ŋanritakwa fof*
ŋafe=nm bada=fa ane fof ŋan\ritak/wa
father DAT.NSG ancestor=ABL DEM EMPH
fof
SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\cross EMPH
'was passed down from our ancestors to our fathers,'

(250) *bada aki kwark benrera fof*
bada aki kwark b=en\rä/ra fof
ancestor grandparent deceased MED=2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be EMPH
'to the grandfathers,'

(251) *zath kwark*
zath kwark
grandparent deceased
'to the late grandfather'

(252) *enrera e ŋafydbo we nzedbo fof né zänrita nima*
en\rä/ra e ŋafe=dbo we nzedbo fof
2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be until father=ALL.ANIM.SG also 1NSG.ALL EMPH
n zän\rit/a nima
IMN SG:PST:PFV:VENT\cross like_this
'until it came to our father. It was about to pass to us like this.'

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(253) *watik zena maf keke wäbragwr ane*
wati zena maf keke wä\brag/wr ane
then today who.ERG.SG NEG 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\follow DEM
'But nobody follows (this tradition) any more.'

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# 4 *Masu* - The village of Masu

## 4.1 Introduction

*Masu* is a recording lasting roughly 6min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on September 22nd 2012, in both audio and video.[1] The story teller is Daure (Srik) Kaumb. The recording took place in Masu, a garden place about 2km East of Rouku.

## 4.2 Summary & background

The story is about the first ancestors of the two Mayawa clans at Rouku. His name was Mathkwi. The story describes the path the ancestor took, and how he chose and settled down at the place. In the second part, Daure explains the traditional settlement pattern, which was in small-scale hamlets, and how the people consolidated into the larger village of Rouku.

## 4.3 Parallel text

| | |
|---|---|
| *trikasi kwa wthkärwé masuma. kar yf fä mane znthkäfe yabär, tratrabäk, mdri. masu zf rä. masu zf rä kar.* | I will start the story about *Masu*. We started walking and came from *Yambär*, to *Tratrambäk*, to *Méndri*, and now to *Masu* right here. |
| *nzenme menz zöbthé fefe mobo sathora. menz frükakmenzo fthé kwankwirwrmth, mrn frükakmenzo. menz berä mayawa bagu sagara. nafanme mothme zumarwrmth nimame kwakwirwrmth. kar fthé thunthorakwrmth.* | This is the village of *Masu*, where our ancestor first arrived. The ancestors came one by one, each clan. There were different ancestors of the Mayawa, the Bangu, and the Sangara. They were looking for their way when they came. They were looking for a place where they could settle down. |

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20120922-08. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189733

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*nzenmenz zä zf ŋankwira. komo foba fthé kwankwirwrm. swänze bä zänrita. mare komnzo bithn bä mä zänrita. zä zf ŋakwira zf zyé. sathora zyé ymd foba zankarisa afa kfokfo: "kar töna bä rä brä" santhora zamara yf zwärako kar yf masu. wati, nimame komnzo zäritako ziyaro. nimame "kwa n komnzo wiyako."*

Our ancestor came to this place here. He came from *Komo* and he crossed over the creek at *Swänze*. That log bridge is still there, where he went across. Then he came right here. He heard the butcherbird calling out and thought "This is a place on the high ground." He looked at the place, and he gave the name *Masu* to it. Then he continued further saying: "I will try and walk a little further."

*fi yakako farem kar afa kfo kfo mane zakarisa: "kar bä rä brä" yakako nima n sräzigrthm: "kabe z zämsa" kabe zöbthwé z zämsa ane fof farem. farem thdma bres orot. nafane menz zöbthé z zämsa. thartharfa näbun mane thwaniyakm nima wazu berä muthrata. kar yf fä z erä. kar yf rä wazu farem kar thartharfa. neba tharthar foba bräro muthrata. neba wazi zba zünrä fisor bthan. ane fof nzenme menz moba zänbrima. kma zanmara "keke kabe z zäms" zäbrimo. watik yfnzo zwänra fisor bthan. zänbrima zbo zf masu. zf rä ane menz kar. zä zf zämsa zf nzenme menz masu mayawanme menz. edawä mrn mrzar mayawa a banibani mayawa.*

He got to *Faremkar*, when he heard a butcherbird again: "There is a settlement there." He walked further and he looked around: "Someone has settled here already." The ancestors of the Farem clan had settled down there first in the middle of *Faremkar*, from Bres and Orot's lineage. Their ancestor had settled there first. Others like the Wazu clan and Muthérata clan settled on the side of *Faremkar*. They have named places of their own there, for example *Wazu* right beside *Faremkar*. And there is *Muthérata* on the other side. In this direction is *Fisor Béthan*, the place from where our ancestor returned here. He must have looked thinking "Someone has settled here already." So he only named that place *Fisor Béthan*, and then he returned to *Masu*. So this is the story place right here. Our ancestor settled down right here, the ancestor of the Masu Mayawas. There are two clans: Mérzar Mayawa and Banibani Mayawa.

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*zä fof zämsa. nafane msaksi zn zane zf rä. zane zf kar töna rä no trkr kafar fthé rera. zane faf zn ke nof zafafa. nä karnzo nof thefafa. zane keke masu. manema nzräkorth masu kar. masu kar ni zf nrä. kar yf zane zf rä masu.*

He settled down right here. His house was right here. This is high ground. When the water level rises during the rainy season, this place won't be affected by the water. Only other places are submerged, not *Masu* here. This is why they call us *Masu* people. We are the *Masu* people. It is based on this place *Masu*.

*fz rera zane kafar fz. daor zufarwrmth zane brä fz. zena keke nima rä fz brä. zena yusi frnzo rä. kafar fz rera zane. ŋafyé ethawä erera. foba we enrera. bada ethäwä erera ŋafyé ethäwä enrera we foba nanfiyokwath. ni zena znrä tüfr. niwä komnzo ŋarake bäfiyokwre we zane faf znen zf zerä. zagathinzake kwa we bä nzfräro ŋazäthe. nä bad bäne bä mane eräro bad tnztnz nzenme bä mane eräro. bä fof nzfrä e fthmäsü zabthe bä we kwanbrigwre we znrä zena. zane ysakwren zf zathkäfe zrä ŋarake thunbrigwre zena. wawa mnz bthuwore. fof we zathkäfe we fof ŋarakeme fof ŋarake thikysime.*

There used to be a dense forest here. They cut down the forest to create gardens. Today there is no more forest here, only savannah grass. It used to be a thick forest. In our fathers generation, there were only few people. All the way back. There were only a few people in the generation of our ancestors and fathers. They made us what we are today. And we are now many people. We are still gardening here, right here, in this place. At the moment, we are letting this place recover and have our gardens in *Ŋazäthe* where we also have some land. We have a small piece of land there. When we have used up the land there, we will return here. We have already started to bring some of the gardens back here. We have started building some storehouses. Next season we will start the actual layout of the gardens and put up fences.

*watik trikasi masuanema nima zf rä brä. ni zf kar zf rä zf masu manema nzräkorth masu kar. ni masu kar zf nrä zf. trikasi fof zwaythk katan brä nimame.*

This is the story about *Masu*. This place here is *Masu*, and that is why they called us *Masu* people. We are the *Masu* people. The story ends like this.

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CD: *rma kabe zefarath zane karfa?*

CD: Why did the people move away?

*zba kabe bänema zefarath. zöbthé mane thfrärm fthé kafmd kwot kafmd fthé keke zfrärm. wati, frükakmenzo kabe thwamnzrmo katan karen. nafanme menz mä zämsa. fi fobo thwamnzrm nima ni masun z nzwamnzrm. boba wazi bämnzr nima mifinin akrimogon nä thwamnzrm. kar katakatan beräro nima safsen berä. nä nima thwamnzrm kwaikr. nä fä thwamnzrm nimame mefath. wati, markai fthé yaniyaka kwayan kabe fthé yaniyaka. wati, näbi karfonzo nmosinza. wati, näbi kafar kar thwafiyokwrme. masuma eyakako näbi roukufo. ŋazäthema äniyaka, farem kar, dmädr. näbi karfonzo ŋamosinzrake. kafar kar wäfiyokwrake rouku.*

When they used to live here, there was no government. People used to live in their clans, in small settlements, where their ancestors had settled initially. They were living like this. We were here at *Masu*, and those other people lived on the other side of the river, for example in *Mibini* or *Akrimogo*. There used to be small hamlets like *Safés* or *Kwaikér*. Others lived in *Mefath*. When the white man came, we shifted to one place. We built larger villages. The *Masu* people went to *Rouku* for good, likewise those ones from *Ŋazäthe*, *Faremkar*, and *Démändér*. We came together in one village. We built one big village, and that's *Rouku*.

*zöbthé mane nzfrärm frükakmenzo nzwamnzrm. ane mrn fämnzr. ane mrn fämnzr. ane mrn fämnzr. nimame mrnmenzo nzwamnzrm. zagr sime kwamarwrme. markai fthé yanyaka fof baibel buk trikasi fthé änyaka fof. wati, bäne naf wnzänza nima yuniti wnzänza. wati, näbi kwot ŋawagrwake fof. tar ŋakonzrake. zena znrä nimame. watik, anema nimame fof nrä fof. näbi karenzo bä bnamnzr anema zane zf. kar mä nzenme bada zämsa o menz zämsa kar anema thugathikwrame näbi karenzo bobo fof nzfiyakmo*

Before we were like this, we lived individually. This clan lived over there, that clan lived over there and the third clan lived over there. We each lived in our clans. We only saw each other from a distance. When the white man came, when the gospel came, it also brought whatchamacallit, it brought unity. From then on, we met regularly. We became friends. That's how we still live today. So that is the reason why we live like this, why we live in one village. As for the places where our ancestors had first settled, our story men, we have left these places. We've moved into a village together.

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*trikasi mane rä nima komnzo fof rä nima. nzenme kar fefe zane zfrä masu. nzenme menz mä zämsa zöbthé fefe. nä mrn we beräro nima trikasikaräsü fi we nimäwä eräro. nimame fof brä. eso.*

This was how the story goes. This is really our place here, *Masu*, where our ancestor settled down first. Other clans also have their (places) with their stories. It is just like this! Thank you!

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## 4.4 Glossed text

(1) *trikasi kwa wthkärwé masuma*
trikasi kwa w\thkär/wé masu=ma
story FUT 1SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\start PLN=CHAR
'I will start the story about Masu.'

(2) *kar yf fä mane znthkäfe yabär*
kar yf fä mane zn\thkäf/e yabär
place name DIST which 1PL>3SG.F:RPST:PFV:VENT\start PLN
'We started walked and came from Yambär,'

(3) *tratrabäk mdri*
tratrabäk mdri
PLN PLN
'to Tratrambäk, to Méndri,'

(4) *masu zf rä*
masu zf \rä/
PLN ABSC 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'and now to Masu right here.'

(5) *masu zf rä kar*
masu zf \rä/ kar
PLN ABSC 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be village
'This is the village of Masu,'

(6) *nzenme menz zöbthé fefe mobo sathora*
nzenme menz zöbthé fefe mobo sa\thor/a
1NSG.POSS story_man first really where.ALL 3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear
'where our ancestor first arrived.'

(7) *menz frükakmenzo fthé kwankwirwrmth*
menz frü-kak=me=nzo fthé kwan\kwir/wrmth
story_man alone-DISTR=INS=ONLY when 2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\run
'The ancestors came one by one,'

(8) *mrn frükakmenzo*
mrn frü-kak=me=nzo
family alone-DISTR=INS=ONLY
'each clan.'

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(9) *menz berä mayawa bagu sagara*
menz b=e\rä/ mayawa bagu sagara
story_man MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be PN PN PN
'There were different ancestors of the Mayawa, the Bangu, and the Sangara.'

(10) *nafanme mothme zumarwrmth nimame kwakwirwrmth*
nafanme moth=me zu\mar/wrmth nima=me
3NSG.POSS path=INS 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR\see like_this=INS
kwa\kwir/wrmth
2|3PL:PST:DUR\run
'They were looking for their way when they came.'

(11) *kar fthé thunthorakwrmth*
kar fthé thun\thorak/wrmth
village when 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\search
'They were looking for a place (to settle down).'

(12) *nzenmenz zä zf ŋankwira*
nzen-menz zä zf ŋan\kwir/a
1NSG:POSS-story_man PROX ABSC SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\run
'Our ancestor came to this place here.'

(13) *komo foba fthé kwankwirwrm*
komo foba fthé kwan\kwir/wrm
PLN DIST:ABL when 2|3SG:PST:DUR:VENT\run
'He came from Komo and'

(14) *swänze bä zänrita*
swänze bä zän\rit/a
PLN MED SG:PST:PFV:VENT\cross
'he crossed over (the creek) at Swänze.'

(15) *mare komnzo bithn bä mä zänrita*
mare komnzo b=y\thn/ bä mä
log_bridge still MED=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\lie_down MED where
zän\rit/a
SG:PST:PFV:VENT\cross
'That log bridge is still there, where he went across.'

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(16) *zä zf ŋakwira zf zyé*
zä zf ŋa\kwir/a zf z=\yé/
PROX ABSC SG:PST:IPFV\run ABSC PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'Then he came right here.'

(17) *sathora zyé ymd foba zankarisa afa kfokfo*
sa\thor/a z=\yé/ ymd foba
3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be bird DIST:ABL
zan\karis/a afa_kfokfo
SG:PST:PFV:VENT\hear butcherbird
'He arrived here and heard a butcherbird calling out:'[2]

(18) *"kar töna bä rä brä"*
kar töna bä \rä/ b=\rä/
place high_ground MED 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'"This is a place on the high_ground."'

(19) *santhora zamara yf zwärako kar yf masu*
san\thor/a za\mar/a yf
3SG.M:PST:PFV:VENT\appear SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\see name
zwä\r/ako kar yf masu
SG>3SG.F:IO:PST:PFV:AND\give village name PLN
'He looked at the place, and he gave the name Masu to it.'

(20) *wati, nimame komnzo zäritako ziyaro*
wati nima=me komnzo zä\rit/ako
then like_this=INS only SG:PST:PFV:AND\cross
z=ya\r/o
PROX=3SG.M:PST:IPFV:AND\be
'Then he continued further saying:'

(21) *nimame kwa n komnzo wiyako*
nima=me kwa n komnzo w\yak/o
like_this=INS FUT IMN only 1SG:NPST:IPFV:AND\walk
'"I will try and walk a little further."'

(22) *fi yakako farem kar afa kfokfo mane zakarisa*

[2] *afa kfokfo* 'hooded butcherbird' (*Cracticus cassicus*)

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fi \yak/ako farem_kar afa_kfokfo mane
3.ABS 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:AND\walk PLN butcherbird which
za\karis/a
SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\hear
'He got to Faremkar, when he heard the butcherbird again:'

(23) *"kar bä rä brä"*
kar bä \rä/ b=\rä/
village MED 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'"There is a settlement there."'

(24) *yakako nima n sräzigrthm "kabe z zämsa"*
\yak/ako nima n srä\zigrthm/ kabe z
3SG.M:PST:IPFV:AND\walk like_this IMN 3SG.F:IRR:PFV\look man IAM
zä\ms/a
SG:PST:PFV\sit
'He walked further and he looked around "Someone has settled here already."'

(25) *kabe zöbthwé z zämsa ane fof farem*
kabe zöbthé=wä z zä\ms/a ane fof farem
man first=EMPH IAM SG:PST:PFV\sit DEM EMPH PLN
'The ancestor of the Farem clan had settled down there first'

(26) *farem thdma bres orot*
farem thd=ma bres orot
PLN middle=CHAR PN PN
'at the center Faremkar, from Bres and Orot.'

(27) *nafane menz zöbthé z zämsa*
nafane menz zöbthé z zä\ms/a
3SG.POSS story_man first IAM SG:PST:PFV\sit
'Their ancestor had settled there first.'

(28) *thartharfa näbun mane thwaniyakm nima wazu berä muthrata*
tharthar=fa näbun mane thwan\yak/m nima wazu
beside=ABL INDF which 2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\come like_this PLN
b=e\rä/ muthrata
MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be PLN
'Others like the Wazu clan and Muthérata clan settled on the side (of Faremkar).'

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(29) *kar yf fä z erä*
kar yf fä z e\rä/
place name DIST IAM 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'They have named places of their own there,'

(30) *kar yf rä wazu farem kar thartharfa*
kar yf \rä/ wazu farem_kar tharthar=fa
place name 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN PLN beside=ABL
'for example Wazu right beside Faremkar.'

(31) *neba tharthar foba bräro muthrata*
neba tharthar foba b=\rä/ro muthrata
opposite beside DIST:ABL MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:AND\be PLN
'And there is Muthérata on the other side.'

(32) *neba wazi zba zünrä fisor bthan*
neba wazi zba z=wn\rä/ fisor_bthan
opposite side PROX:ABL PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be PLN
'And on the other side, in this direction, is Fisor Béthan.'

(33) *ane fof nzenme menz moba zänbrima*
ane fof nzenme menz moba zän\brim/a
DEM EMPH 1NSG.POSS story_man where.ABL SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return
'That was the place from where our ancestor returned.'

(34) *kma zanmara keke kabe z zäms zäbrimo*
kma zan\mar/a keke kabe z zä\ms/
POT SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\see NEG man IAM 2|3SG:RPST:PFV\sit
zä\brim/o
SG:PST:PFV:AND\return
'He must have looked (and said) "Someone has settled here already."'

(35) *watik yfnzo zwänra fisor bthan*
watik yf=nzo zwän\r/a fisor_bthan
then name=ONLY SG>3SG.F:IO:PST:PFV:VENT\give PLN
'So he only named that place Fisor Béthan,'

(36) *zänbrima zbo zf masu*
zän\brim/a zbo zf masu
SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return PROX:ALL ABSC PLN
'and then he returned here to Masu.'

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(37) *zf rä ane menz kar*
zf \rä/ ane menz kar
ABSC 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be DEM story_man place
'This is the story place right here.'

(38) *zä zf zämsa zf nzenme menz*
zä zf zä\ms/a zf nzenme menz
PROX ABSC SG:PST:PFV\sit ABSC 1NSG.POSS story_man
'Our ancestor settled down right here,'

(39) *masu mayawanme menz*
masu mayawa=aneme menz
PLN PN=POSS.NSG story_man
'the ancestor of the Masu Mayawas.'

(40) *edawä mrn mrzar mayawa a banibani mayawa*
eda=wä mrn mrzar mayawa a banibani mayawa
two=EMPH family PN PN and PN PN
'There are two families: Mérzar Mayawa and Banibani Mayawa.'

(41) *zä fof zämsa*
zä fof zä\ms/a
PROX EMPH SG:PST:PFV\sit
'He settled down right here.'

(42) *nafane msaksi zn zane zf rä*
nafane msak-si zn zane zf \rä/
3SG.POSS sit-NMLZ place DEM:PROX ABSC 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'His house was right here.'

(43) *zane zf kar töna rä no trkr kafar fthé rera*
zane zf kar töna \rä/ no trkr kafar
DEM:PROX ABSC place high_ground 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be water flood big
fthé \rä/ra
when 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be
'This is a high place. When the water level rises in the rainy season,'

(44) *zane faf zn ke nof zafafa*
zane faf zn keke no=f za\faf/a
DEM:PROX place place NEG water=ERG.SG SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\hold
'this place is not affected by the water.'

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(45) *nä karnzo nof thefafa*
nä kar=nzo no=f the\faf/a
INDF place=ONLY water=ERG.SG SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hold
'Only other places are affected,'

(46) *zane keke masu*
zane keke masu
DEM:PROX NEG PLN
'not Masu here.'

(47) *manema nzräkorth masu kar*
mane=ma nzrä\ko/rth masu kar
which=CHAR 2|3PL>1PL:IRR:PFV\speak PLN village
'This is why they call us Masu people.'

(48) *masu kar ni zf nrä*
masu kar ni zf n\rä/
PLN village 1NSG ABSC 1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'We are the Masu people.'

(49) *kar yf zane zf rä masu*
kar yf zane zf \rä/ masu
place name DEM:PROX ABSC 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN
'It is based on this place Masu.'

(50) *fz rera zane kafar fz*
fz \rä/ra zane kafar fz
forest 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be DEM:PROX big forest
'There used to be a dense forest here.'

(51) *daor zufarwrmth zane brä fz*
dao=r zu\far/wrmth zane b=\rä/
garden=PURP 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR\fell DEM:PROX MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
fz
forest
'They cut down the forest to create gardens.'

(52) *zena keke nima rä fz brä*
zena keke nima \rä/ fz b=\rä/
today NEG like_this 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be forest MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'Today there is no more forest here,'

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(53) *zena yusi frnzo rä*
zena yusi fr=nzo \rä/
today grass post=ONLY 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'only savannah grass.'

(54) *kafar fz rera zane*
kafar fz \rä/ra zane
big forest 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be DEM:PROX
'It used to be a thick forest.'

(55) *ŋafyé ethawä erera*
ŋafy=é etha=wä e\rä/ra
father=ABS.NSG few=EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be
'In our fathers generation, there were only few people.'

(56) *foba we enrera*
foba we en\rä/ra
DIST:ABL also 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'All the way back.'

(57) *bada ethäwä erera ŋafyé ethäwä enrera we foba nanfiyokwath*
bada etha=wä e\rä/ra ŋafy=é etha=wä
ancestor few=EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be father=ABS.NSG few=EMPH
en\rä/ra we foba nan\fiyok/wath
2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be also DIST:ABL 2|3PL>1PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\make
'There were only a few people in the generation of our ancestors and fathers. They made us what we are today.'

(58) *ni zena znrä tüfr*
ni zena z=n\rä/ tüfr
1NSG today PROX=2SG:NPST:IPFV\be plenty
'And we are now many people.'

(59) *niwä komnzo ŋarake bäfiyokwre we*
ni=wä komnzo ŋarake b=ä\fiyok/wre we
1NSG=EMPH still garden MED=1PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\make also
'We are still gardening here,'

(60) *zane faf znen zf zerä*

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zane faf zn=en zf z=e\rä/
DEM:PROX place place=LOC ABSC PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'right here, in this place.'

(61) *zagathinzake kwa we*
za\gathinz/ake kwa we
1PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\leave FUT also
'We are leaving this place alone (to grow back),'

(62) *bä nzfräro ŋazäthe nä bad bäne bä mane eräro*
bä nzf\rä/ro ŋazäthe nä bad bäne bä mane
MED 1PL:RPST:IPFV:AND\be ŋazäthe INDF ground PH.ABS MED which
e\rä/ro
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'and we (have gardens) there at ŋazäthe, where we also have some land.'

(63) *bad tnztnz nzenme bä mane eräro bä fof nzfrä*
bad tnz~tnz nzenme bä mane e\rä/ro bä
ground REDUP~short 1NSG.POSS MED which 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\be MED
fof nzf\rä/
EMPH 1PL:RPST:IPFV\be
'We have a small piece of land there.'

(64) *e fthmäsü zabthe bä we kwanbrigwre we znrä zena*
e fthmäsü za\bth/e bä we
until meanwhile 1PL>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\finish MED also
kwan\brig/wre we z=n\rä/ zena
1PL:RPST:IPFV:VENT\return also PROX=1PL:NPST:IPFV\be today
'When we have used up the land there, we will return here.'

(65) *zane ysakwren zf zathkäfe zrä ŋarake thunbrigwre zena*
zane ysakwr=en zf za\thkäf/e
DEM:PROX rainy_season=LOC ABSC 1PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\start
z=\rä/ ŋarake thun\brig/wre zena
PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be garden 1PL>2|3PL:RPST:IPFV:VENT\return today
'We have already started to bring back the gardens back here this season.'

(66) *wawa mnz bthuwore*
wawa mnz b=thu\wor/e
round_yam house MED=1PL>2|3PL:RPST:IPFV\plant
'We have built some storage houses there.'

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(67) *fof we zathkäfe we fof ŋarakeme fof*
fof we za\thkäf/e we fof ŋarake=me fof
EMPH also 1PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\start also EMPH garden=INS EMPH
'Next, we start with the actual design of the gardens,'

(68) *ŋarake thikysime*
ŋarake thiky-si=me
garden tie_fence-NMLZ=INS
'and building the fence.'

(69) *watik trikasi masuanema nima zf rä brä*
watik trikasi masu=ane=ma nima zf \rä/
then story PLN=POSS.SG=CHAR like_this ABSC 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
b=\rä/
MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'This is the story about Masu.'

(70) *ni zf kar zf rä zf masu manema nzräkorth masu kar*
ni zf kar zf \rä/ zf masu mane=ma
1NSG ABSC place ABSC 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be ABSC PLN which=CHAR
nzrä\ko/rth masu kar
2|3PL>1PL:IRR:PFV\speak PLN place
'This place here is Masu, and that is why they called us Masu people.'

(71) *ni masu kar zf nrä zf*
ni masu kar zf n\rä/ zf
1NSG PLN place ABSC 1PL:NPST:IPFV\be ABSC
'We are the Masu people.'

(72) *trikasi fof zwaythk katan brä nimame*
trikasi fof zwa\ythk/ katan b=\rä/
story EMPH 3SG.F:RPST:PFV\come_to_end small MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
nima=me
like_this=INS
'The story ends like_this.'[3]

(73) *zba kabe bänema zefarath*

[3]CD asks: rma kabe zefarath zane karfa? "Why did the people leave this place?"

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zba kabe bäne=ma ze\far/ath
PROX:ABL man PH=CHAR 2|3PL:PST:PFV\set_off
'The people left because,'

(74) *zöbthé mane thfrärm fthé*
zöbthé mane thf\rä/rm fthé
first which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be when
'when they were living here first,'

(75) *kafmd kwot fthé keke zfrärm*
kafmd kwot fthé keke zf\rä/rm
government properly when NEG 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
'there was no government.'

(76) *wati, frükakmenzo kabe thwamnzrmo katan karen*
wati frü-kak=me=nzo kabe thwa\m/nzrmo katan
then alone-DISTR=INS=ONLY people 2|3PL:PST:DUR:AND\sit small
kar=en
place=LOC
'The people used to live in their respective groups in small settlements,'

(77) *nafanme menz mä zämsa*
nafanme menz mä zä\ms/a
3NSG.POSS story_man where SG:PST:PFV\sit
'where their respective ancestors had settled.'

(78) *fi fobo thwamnzrm nima*
fi fobo thwa\m/nzrm nima
3.ABS DIST:ALL 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit like_this
'They were living in this way:'

(79) *ni masun z nzwamnzrm*
ni masu=en z nzwa\m/nzrm
1NSG PLN=LOC IAM 1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'We were here at Masu,'

(80) *boba wazi bämnzr nima mifinin akrimogon nä thwamnzrm*

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boba wazi b=ä\m/nzr nima mifini=en akrimogo=en
MED:ABL side MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit like_this PLN=LOC PLN=LOC
nä thwa\m/nzrm
INDF 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'and those other people lived on the other side of the river, for example in Mibini and Akrimogo.'

(81) *kar katakatan beräro nima safsen berä*
kar kata~katan b=e\rä/ro nima safs=en
place REDUP~small MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\be like_this PLN=LOC
b=e\rä/
MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'There were small settlements like Safés.'

(82) *nä nima thwamnzrm kwaikr*
nä nima thwa\m/nzrm kwaikr
INDF like_this 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit PLN
'Others lived in Kwaikér.'

(83) *nä fä thwamnzrm nimame mefath*
nä fä thwa\m/nzrm nima=me mefath
INDF DIST 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit like_this=INS PLN
'Others lived like_this in Mefath.'

(84) *wati, markai fthé yaniyaka kwayan kabe fthé yaniyaka*
wati markai fthé yan\yak/a kwayan kabe fthé
then outsider when 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come light man when
yan\yak/a
3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come
'When the white man came,'

(85) *wati, näbi karfonzo nmosinza*
wati näbi kar=fo=nzo n\mosi/nza
then one place=ALL=ONLY SG>1PL:PST:IPFV\gather
'he wanted to bring us together in one place.'

(86) *wati, näbi kafar kar thwafiyokwrme*
wati näbi kafar kar thwa\fiyok/wrme
then one big place 1PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\make
'So we built larger villages.'

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(87) *masuma eyakako näbi roukufo*
masu=ma e\yak/ako näbi rouku=fo
PLN=CHAR 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:AND\walk one PLN=ALL
'The Masu people went to Rouku for good,'

(88) *ŋazäthema äniyaka farem kar dmädr*
ŋazäthe=ma än\yak/a farem_kar dmädr
ŋazäthe=CHAR 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come PLN PLN
'likewise those ones from ŋazäthe, Faremkar, and Démändér.'

(89) *näbi karfonzo ŋamosinzrake*
näbi kar=fo=nzo ŋa\mosi/nzrake
one place=ALL=ONLY 1PL:PST:IPFV\gather
'We came together in one village.'

(90) *kafar kar wäfiyokwrake rouku*
kafar kar wä\fiyok/wake rouku
big place 1PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make PLN
'We built one big village, that's Rouku.'

(91) *zöbthé mane nzfrärm frükakmenzo nzwamnzrm*
zöbthé mane nzf\rä/rm frü-kak=me=nzo nzwa\m/nzrm
first which 1PL:PST:DUR\be alone-DISTR=INS=ONLY 1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'Before we were like_this, we lived individually.'

(92) *ane mrn fämnzr ane mrn fämnzr*
ane mrn f=ä\m/nzr ane mrn f=ä\m/nzr
DEM family DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit DEM family DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit
'This clan lived over there and that clan lived over there,'

(93) *ane mrn fämnzr nimame mrnmenzo nzwamnzrm*
ane mrn f=ä\m/nzr nima=me mrn=me=nzo
DEM family DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit like_this=INS family=INS=ONLY
nzwa\m/nzrm
1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'and that other clan lived over there. We were staying in the clan.'

(94) *zagr sime kwamarwrme*
zagr si=me kwa\mar/wrme
far eyes=INS 1PL:PST:DUR\see
'We saw each other from a distance.'

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(95) *markai fthé yanyaka fof*
markai fthé yan\yak/a fof
outsider when 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come EMPH
'When the white man came,'

(96) *baibel buk trikasi fthé änyaka fof*
baibel buk trikasi fthé än\yak/a fof
bible book story when 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come EMPH
'when the gospel came,'

(97) *wati, bäne naf wnzänza nima yuniti wnzänza*
wati bäne naf wn\zä/nza nima yuniti
then PH.ABS 3SG.ERG SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV:VENT\carry like_this unity
wn\zä/nza
SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV:VENT\carry
'it also brought whatchamacallit, it brought unity.'

(98) *wati, näbi kwot ŋawagrwake fof*
wati näbi kwot ŋa\wagr/wake fof
then one properly 1PL:PST:IPFV\meet EMPH
'That's when we really met up regularly.'

(99) *tar ŋakonzrake*
tar ŋa\ko/nzrake
mate 1PL:PST:IPFV\become
'We became friends.'

(100) *zena znrä nimame*
zena z=n\rä/ nima=me
today PROX=1PL:NPST:IPFV\be like_this=INS
'That's how we still live today.'

(101) *watik, anema nimame fof nrä fof*
watik ane=ma nima=me fof n\rä/ fof
then DEM=CHAR like_this=INS EMPH 1PL:NPST:IPFV\be EMPH
'So that is reason why we live like_this,'

(102) *näbi karenzo bä bnamnzr anema zane zf*

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näbi kar en=nzo bä b=na\m/nzr ane=ma zane
one place LOC=ONLY MED MED=1PL:NPST:IPFV\sit DEM=CHAR DEM:PROX
zf
ABSC
'why we live in one village.'

(103) *kar mä nzenme bada zämsa o*
kar mä nzenme bada zä\ms/a o
place where 1NSG.POSS ancestor SG:PST:PFV\sit or
'As for the places where our ancestor had settled (first),'

(104) *menz zämsa*
menz zä\ms/a
story_man SG:PST:PFV\sit
'our story man,'

(105) *kar anema thugathikwrame näbi karenzo bobo fof nzfiyakmo*
kar ane=ma thu\gathik/wrame näbi kar=en=nzo
place DEM=CHAR 1PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\leave one place=LOC=ONLY
bobo fof nzf\yak/mo
MED:ALL EMPH 1PL:PST:DUR:AND\walk
'we have left these places, and instead we moved to one village.'

(106) *trikasi mane rä nima komnzo fof rä nima*
trikasi mane \rä/ nima komnzo fof
story which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be like_this only EMPH
\rä/ nima
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be like_this
'This was how the story goes.'

(107) *nzenme kar fefe zane zfrä masu*
nzenme kar fefe zane zf\rä/ masu
1NSG.POSS place really DEM:PROX 3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\be PLN
'This is really our place here, Masu,'

(108) *nzenme menz mä zämsa zöbthé fefe*
nzenme menz mä zä\ms/a zöbthé fefe
1NSG.POSS story_man where SG:PST:PFV\sit first really
'where our ancestor settled down first.'

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(109) *nä mrn we beräro nima trikasikaräsü fi we nimäwä eräro*
nä mrn we b=e\rä/ro nima
INDF family also MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\be like_this
trikasi=karä=sü fi we nimä=wä e\rä/ro
story=PROP=ETC 3.ABS also like_this=EMPH 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'Other clans also have their (places) with their stories.'

(110) *nimame fof brä*
nima=me fof b=\rä/
like_this=INS EMPH MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'It is just like_this!'

(111) *eso*
eso
thanks
'Thank you!'

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# 5 *Safak menz a faikore menz* - Saratoga and Bushfowl man

## 5.1 Introduction

*Safak menz a faikore menz* is a narrative lasting roughly 6min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on August 2nd 2010, in both audio and video formats.[1] The story teller is Abia Bai, and the recording took place in his house at Rouku village.

## 5.2 Summary & background

The story is about two ancestors who each represent a totemic animal and are connected to a specific clan. There is the Bushfowl man of the Masu-Mayawa clan and the Saratoga man of the Garaita-Sangara clan. They used to live in good neighbourhood and shared the land on the same side of the Morehead River. At the same time, each held back a certain resource from the other. The Saratoga man hid Saratoga fish from his neighbour, and likewise the Bushfowl man hid the bushfowls.

One day they learn of each other's deeds and after an argument, the Saratoga man decides to move further east to the other side of the river. The Bushfowl man destroys the crossing over the river and moves further west.

The story explains some physical and cultural aspects of contemporary life, such as the location of the settlement of the two clans. Another example is the totemic relationship of the two groups to the respective animal species. The Garaita Sangara do not fish or eat saratogas, and the Masu Mayawas do not hunt bush fowl. Furthermore, the story is intended to explain why the two clans do not intermarry, but give each other wives if one of the groups lacks a sister for the system of exchange marriages.

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20110802. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189770

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## 5.3 Parallel text

*namä ezi. zena thweksikarä ezi wnrä. füsfüs yfsgwr. kar wänrenzr namänzo. thweksi ŋanbrigwr zena efoth. zena ezi nze kwa trikasi ŋatrikwé bänema safak menz a faikore menz. safak menz mane yara sagaraneme yara garaita sagara. faikore menz mayawaneme yara masun mayawanme. trikasi zane mane wnrä nzä mane ŋatrikwé badababadanmedba wnrä. nzone ŋafyn bäin ane trikasi yatrikwath. nzunwä ŋafyf bäyf zwafäsa. nima "zrä ane kar. safak fur zä thuthkagrm. zä zf ŋafnnath. wm bä mane kanathren ythn. fthé ane fof yrtmaknath. wm mane sfrärm boba wazi neba kwaritakwrm." wati anema trikasi zena kwa ŋatrikwé. fof nimame zrethkäfé zane ezi mrmren.*

Good morning! A happy morning is coming. The wind is blowing. The village is looking very good. Happiness is coming back today. This morning I will tell a story about the Saratoga man and the Bushfowl man. As for the Saratoga man, he was the Sangaras' story man, the Sangaras from *Garaita*. The Bushfowl man was the Mayawas' story man, the Mayawas from *Masu*. The story that is coming, that I will tell, comes from the ancestors. They told that story to my father Bäi, and my father Bäi told me the story. He was talking like this: "This is the place here. The saratoga fishlings were inside here. Those two were fighting right here. The stone bridge at *Kanathér*, that was time when they destroyed it. The stone crossed from one side (of the river) to the other side." Okay, I will tell this story now. I will start this story now in these morning hours.

*eda kabe thfrnm. monwä kwanafé nima sagarama garaita sagaraane safak menzma. kanathren swamnzrm. nzone mayawa menz monegsi kabe mane sfrärm. faikore thumgthkwrm naf tfrisamen. wati, wm fä sfrärm. wm mane sfrärm neba kwaritakwrm boba wazi. neba ŋars bänemr boba wazi. watik sagara mane yara. naf safak fur boba zran thumgthkwrm kanathren bobafa. okay, bänema mane yara mayawa menz, faikore maf thu-*

There were two men. Just like I was saying before: It is about the Sangara, about the *Garaita* Sangaras' Saratoga man. He was living at *Kanathér*. As for my Mayawa man, who was our protector, he was feeding bushfowls at *Téférisam*. There used to be a stone bridge there. That stone bridge went across from one side to the other side, from one side of the river to the other side. As for that Sangara, he was feeding Saratoga fishlings there in the

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*mgthkwrm. fi tfrisamen swamnzrm. nafane faikore fä fof thumgthkwrm faikore furfur katakatan.*

swamp, at the *Kanathér* side. Okay, that other one, the Mayawa story man, who was feeding the bushfowls, he lived at *Téférisam*. He was feeding the bushfowls there, very small bushfowls.

*wati krsi zn we fä thwarnm edawänme. safak menz kabe ane mane swarärm kanathren fä zfrärm fof. wmen fä fof zufnakwrm gufiyar. kofä mane bafen kwathorthrmth gufiyaren. tfrisamen mane sfrärm nafane fä gufiyar we zfrärm, fi naf keke kafar kofä thurärm. thwanathrm katakatanzo. kanathren mane swamnzrm sagara menz. nafnzo ane kafar kofä thwanathrm.*

They had a place for a fish trap, one for each. The Saratoga man had his at *Kanathér*. He placed his fish basket by the stone bridge. The fish went inside that whatchamacallit, inside the fish basket. The other man placed his fish basket at *Téférisam*, but he wasn't catching big fish. He was eating only the smaller ones. It was the one at *Kanathér*, the Sangara story man, who was eating the really big ones.

*nä kayé zefarako tfrisamfa faikore menz. fthé yakako. fi nafane fä fof krara ymd swägrm. maf swatrikwrm nomai nima "oh kabe yaniyak. käfrms! kofä thärifthm!" wati fi sräthoro krara yanor. wati fi sräthoro fof. wati kofä ane mane erä erifthza fof safak menzf. "nzungath rar karo zane erä?" "keke, kadakada sutränwé kayé. kaythamane karo rä," fi swathugrm gaso. nimanzo nomai swafiyokwrm e nomai nomai nomai. fam zära "ah nzungathf nzä wathugwr. bänema kam fof ethn berä kafar kofä kam. watik nä kayé zba kwa tönafa wiyak."*

One day, the Bushfowl man set off from *Téférisam*. As he was making his way, the other man's parrot was sitting above. He was always talking like this: "Oh, there is a man coming." Get ready! Hide the fish!" While he was coming, the parrot called out. When he arrived, the Saratoga man had hidden the fish already. The Bushfowl man asked "My friend, what is this oven for?" The Saratoga man replied: "No, I made yamcake yesterday. This is yesterday's oven." He deceived him badly. He was doing this to him again and again. The Bushfowl man thought to himself "Ah, my friend is tricking me because there were large fish bones lying around. Next time I will walk along the high ground."

*watik tönafa mane yanyak nä kayé*

This time he was coming from the

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*kanathr. tfrisamfa zefara e boba santhora. boba fthmäsü thoraksir kwanrärm. watik safak fur ane fof yayamgwa. "nzungathane zane safak fur rä" srethkäf zran ane efnza. safak fur thräbth. näbinzo sränthor. krara thrma santhora. fafen sathora fof. "nzungath ra karo rä ane?" zokwasimär ŋafiyokwa keke nä zokwasi. bänema kofä karo ane fof yayamgwa fof. monkwk! zakarath fof. safak fur sraziro. "be nzun fof kwathugwr. bukaren ane fof bä safak emgthkwa." zakarath ŋafnnath ŋafnnath ŋafnnath. wati safak menz mane yanra tfrisam. tfrisamen fä fof faikore efnza efnza efnza nezä. we näbi srefafo. sräthoro. "nzone bä nima thuwafiyokwrm berä nagayé fof?"*

high ground to *Kanathér*. He departed from *Téferisam* and walked until he arrived there. As he was approaching the place, he was startled seeing those saratoga fishlings. He said "These are my friend's saratoga fishlings." He began to kill those saratoga fishlings there in the swamp. He finished them off. He only took one with him. The parrot arrived late, only after he already got there. He said to the Saratoga man "My friend, what oven is this?" He was speechless. They said nothing at all, because they were surprised about the fish oven. Anyway, they wrestled each other. He threw away the saratoga fishling. He said "You have tricked me. You fed the saratoga fish at your place." They pulled each other and hit each other. They were fighting and fighting. The Saratoga man came to *Téférisam*, and now he was killing the other one's bushfowls. He also took one and carried it away. "What are you doing to my children?" the Bushfowl man said.

*wati faikore menz krär. wm ane fof kanathren bä mane ythn. tnz erästhgr. ane srethkäf rtmaksi. ausi safak menzf zräkor. "ni krafare garaita bobo ŋafänizne thfn." wati wm ane bänemr tfotfo sfrärm. thfn kar fi zärita. safak menz sagarama mane yara e garaita krärsöfäth. thfnen bä fof zena yamnzr. nzenme, masu karaneme, faikore menz mane yanra. yanyaka zänbrima. tfrisam ŋawathknwa. zenfara e masu.*

He got up and started destroying that stone bridge at *Kanathér*, those rocks sticking out of the water. The Saratoga man said to his wife: "Let's go to *Garaita*. We will move to *Théfén*." The stone bridge was just about to disappear when the Saratoga man went across to *Théfén*. That is a Sangara place and over at *Garaita*. Nowadays, he lives there at *Théfén*. As for ours, the Masu people's guy, that Bushfowl man, he returned. He packed up his

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belongings at *Téférisam*, set off and walked to *Masu*. Then he arrived at *Masu*.

*watik masufo sathora fof. watik nafane trikasi katan nima zbo zf zwaythk fof. keke zanfr. watik zena anema mane ern fof, sagara garaitan a mayawa masu emoth nafa ŋarinth fof. zba nezä ärithroth fäms ŋarer boba nezä änrithrth fäms ŋarer. watik trikasi zbo zf zwaythk trikasi tnz. eso kafar namä yarizsima. gadmöwä.*

Okay, his little story ends right here. It is not a long story. Okay, that is why these two, the Sangaras at *Garaita* and the *Masu* Mayawas, give each other sisters. They give them sisters from here as exchange women and in return they give sisters to us to be exchanged. The story ends right here. It was a short story. Thank you for listening. Thank you.

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## 5.4 Glossed text

(1) *namä ezi*
namä ezi
good morning
'Good morning!'

(2) *zena thweksikarä ezi wnrä*
zena thwek-si=karä ezi wn\rä/
today rejoice-NMLZ=PROP morning 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be
'A happy morning is coming.'

(3) *füsfüs yfsgwr*
füsfüs y\fsg/wr
wind 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\blow
'The wind is blowing.'

(4) *kar wänrenzr namänzo*
kar wän\re/nzr namä=nzo
village 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\look good=ONLY
'The village is looking very good.'

(5) *thweksi ŋanbrigwr zena efoth*
thwek-si ŋan\brig/wr zena efoth
rejoice-NMLZ 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\return today day
'Happiness is coming back today.'

(6) *zena ezi nze kwa trikasi ŋatrikwé bänema*
zena ezi nze kwa trikasi ŋa\trik/wé bäne=ma
today morning 1SG.ERG FUT story 1SG:NPST:IPFV\tell PH=CHAR
'This morning I will tell a story about'

(7) *safak menz a faikore menz*
safak menz a faikore menz
saratoga story_man and bushfowl story_man
'the Saratoga man and the Bushfowl man.'[2]

[2] *safak* = Gulf saratoga, Australian bonytongue (*Scleropages jardinii*); *faikore* = Orange-footed megapode or scrubfowl (*Megapodius reinwardt*)

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(8) *safak menz mane yara sagaraneme yara garaita sagara*
safak menz mane ya\r/a sagara=aneme
saratoga story_man which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be PN=POSS.NSG
ya\r/a garaita sagara
3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be PLN PN
'As for the Saratoga man, he was the Sangaras' story man, the Sangaras from Garaita.'[3]

(9) *faikore menz mayawaneme yara masun mayawanme*
faikore menz mayawa=aneme ya\r/a masu=en
bushfowl story_man PN=POSS.NSG 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be PLN=LOC
mayawa=aneme
PN=POSS.NSG
'The Bushfowl man was the Mayawas' story man, the Mayawas from Masu.'[4]

(10) *trikasi zane mane wnrä*
trikasi zane mane wn\rä/
story DEM:PROX which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be
'The story that is coming,'

(11) *nzä mane ŋatrikwé*
nzä mane ŋa\trik/wé
1SG.ABS which 1SG:NPST:IPFV\tell
'that I will tell,'

(12) *badabadanmedba wnrä*
badabada=nmedba wn\rä/
ancestor=ABL.ANIM.NSG 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be
'comes from the ancestors.'

(13) *nzone ŋafyn bäin ane trikasi yatrikwath*
nzone ŋafe=n bäi=n ane trikasi ya\trik/wath
1SG.POSS father=DAT.SG PN=DAT.SG DEM story 2|3PL>1SG.IO:PST:IPFV\tell
'They told that story to my father Bäi,'

(14) *nzunwä ŋafyf bäyf zwafäsa*

[3]Sagara = non-local exogamous group, Garaita Sangara = local clan from Morehead
[4]Mayawa = non-local exogamous group, Masu Mayawa = local clan from Rouku, speaker's clan

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nzun=wä ŋafe=f bäi=f zwa\fäs/a
1SG.DAT=EMPH father=ERG.SG PN=ERG.SG SG>1SG.IO:PST:PFV\show
'and my father Bäi told me the story.'

(15) *nima "zrä ane kar*
nima z=\rä/ ane kar
like_this PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be DEM place
'He was talking like this: "This is the place here.'

(16) *safak fur zä thuthkagrm*
safak fur zä thu\th/kagrm
saratoga bundle PROX 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be_inside
'The saratoga fishlings were inside here.'

(17) *zä zf ŋafnnath*
zä zf ŋa\fn/nath
PROX ABSC 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\hit
'Those two were fighting right here.'

(18) *wm bä mane kanathren ythn*
wm bä mane kanathr=en y\thn/
stone MED which PLN=LOC 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\lie_down
'The stone bridge at Kanathér,'

(19) *fthé ane fof yrtmaknath*
fthé ane fof y\rtmak/nath
when DEM EMPH 2|3DU>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\cut
'that was time when they destroyed it.'

(20) *wm mane sfrärm boba wazi neba kwaritakwrm"*
wm mane sf\rä/rm boba wazi neba
stone which 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be MED:ABL side opposite
kwa\ritak/wrm
2|3SG:PST:DUR\cross
'The stone crossed from one side (of the river) to the other side."'

(21) *wati anema trikasi zena kwa ŋatrikwé fof*
wati ane=ma trikasi zena kwa ŋa\trik/wé fof
then DEM=CHAR story today FUT 1SG:NPST:IPFV\tell EMPH
'Okay, I will tell this story now.'

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(22) *nimame zrethkäfé zane ezi mrmren*
nima=me zre\thkäf/é zane ezi mrmr=en
like_this=INS 1SG:IRR:PFV\start DEM:PROX morning inside=LOC
'I will start this story now in these morning hours.'

(23) *eda kabe thfrnm*
eda kabe thf\rn/m
two man 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be
'There were two men.'

(24) *monwä kwanafé nima*
mon=wä kwa\naf/é nima
how=EMPH 1SG:PST:IPFV\speak like_this
'Just like I was saying before:'

(25) *sagarama garaita sagaraane safak menzma*
sagara=ma garaita sagara=ane safak menz=ma
PN=CHAR PLN PN=POSS.SG saratoga story_man=CHAR
'It is about the Sangara, about the Garaita Sangaras' Saratoga man.'

(26) *kanathren swamnzrm*
kanathr=en swa\m/nzrm
PLN=LOC 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit
'He was living at Kanathér.'

(27) *nzone mayawa menz monegsi kabe mane sfrärm*
nzone mayawa menz moneg-si kabe mane
1SG.POSS PN story_man take_care-NMLZ man which
sf\rä/rm
3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'As for my Mayawa man, who was our protector,'

(28) *faikore thumgthkwrm naf tfrisamen*
faikore thu\mgthk/wrm naf tfrisam=en
bushfowl SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\feed 3SG.ERG PLN=LOC
'he was feeding bushfowls at Téférisam.'

(29) *wati, wm fä sfrärm*
wati wm fä sf\rä/rm
then stone DIST 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'There used to be a stone bridge there.'

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(30) *wm mane sfrärm neba kwaritakwrm boba wazi*
wm mane sf\rä/rm neba kwa\ritak/wrm boba
stone which 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be opposite 2|3SG:PST:DUR\cross MED:ABL
wazi
side
'That stone bridge went across from one side to the other side,'

(31) *neba ŋars bänemr boba wazi*
neba ŋars bänemr boba wazi
opposite river until MED:ABL side
'from one side of the river to the other side.'

(32) *watik sagara mane yara*
watik sagara mane ya\r/a
then PN which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'As for that Sangara,'

(33) *naf safak fur boba zran thumgthkwrm kanathren bobafa*
naf safak fur boba zra=en thu\mgthk/wrm
3SG.ERG saratoga bundle MED:ABL swamp=LOC SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\feed
kanathr=en boba=fa
PLN=LOC MED:ABL=ABL
'he was feeding Saratoga fishlings there in the swamp, at the Kanathér side.'

(34) *okay, bänema mane yara mayawa menz*
okay bäne=ma mane ya\r/a mayawa menz
okay PH=CHAR which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be PN story_man
'Okay, that other one, the Mayawa story man,'

(35) *faikore maf thumgthkwrm*
faikore maf thu\mgthk/wrm
bushfowl who.ERG.SG SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\feed
'who was feeding the bushfowls,'

(36) *fi tfrisamen swamnzrm*
fi tfrisam=en swa\m/nzrm
3.ABS PLN=LOC 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit
'he lived at Téférisam.'

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(37) *nafane faikore fä fof thumgthkwrm faikore furfur katakatan*
nafane faikore fä fof thu\mgthk/wrm faikore
3SG.POSS bushfowl DIST EMPH SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\feed bushfowl
fur~fur kata~katan
REDUP~bundle REDUP~small
'He was feeding the bushfowls there, very small bushfowls.'

(38) *wati krsi zn we fä thwarnm edawänme*
wati kr-si zn we fä thwa\rn/m
then block-NMLZ place also DIST 2|3DU.IO:PST:DUR\be
eda=wä=aneme
TWO=EMPH=POSS.NSG
'They had a place for a (fish) trap, one for each.'

(39) *safak menz kabe ane mane swarärm kanathren fä zfrärm fof*
safak menz kabe ane mane swa\rä/rm kanathr=en
saratoga story_man man DEM which 3SG.M.IO:PST:DUR\be PLN=LOC
fä zf\rä/rm fof
DIST 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be EMPH
'The Saratoga man had his at Kanathér.'

(40) *wmen fä fof zufnakwrm gufiyar*
wm=en fä fof zf\nak/wrm gwfiyar
stone=LOC DIST EMPH SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\put_down fish_basket
'He placed his fish basket by the stone bridge.'

(41) *kofä mane bafen kwathorthrmth gufiyaren*
kofä mane baf=en kwa\thor/thrmth gwfiyar=en
fish which PH=LOC 2|3PL:PST:DUR\enter fish_basket=LOC
'The fish went inside that whatchamacallit, inside the fish basket.'

(42) *tfrisamen mane sfrärm nafane fä gufiyar we zfrärm fi*
tfrisam=en mane sf\rä/rm nafane fä gwfiyar we
PLN=LOC which 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be 3SG.POSS DIST fish_basket also
zf\rä/rm fi
3SG.F:PST:DUR\be but
'The other man placed his fish basket at Téférisam, but'

(43) *naf keke kafar kofä thurärm*

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naf keke kafar kofä thu\rä/rm
3SG.ERG NEG big fish 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'he wasn't catching big fish.'

(44) *thwanathrm katakatanzo*
thwa\na/thrm kata~katan=nzo
SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\eat REDUP~small=ONLY
'He was eating only the smaller ones.'

(45) *kanathren mane swamnzrm sagara menz*
kanathr=en mane swa\m/nzrm sagara menz
PLN=LOC which 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit PN story_man
'It was the one at Kanathér, the Sangara story man,'

(46) *nafnzo ane kafar kofä thwanathrm*
naf=nzo ane kafar kofä thwa\na/thrm
3SG.ERG=ONLY DEM big fish SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\eat
'who was eating the really big ones.'

(47) *nä kayé zefarako tfrisamfa faikore menz*
nä kayé ze\far/ako tfrisam=fa faikore
INDF one_day_away SG:PST:PFV:AND\set_off PLN=ABL bushfowl
menz
story_man
'One day, the bushman set off from Téférisam.'

(48) *fthé yakako*
fthé \yak/ako
when 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:AND\walk
'As he was making his way,'

(49) *fi nafane fä fof krara ymd swägrm*
fi nafane fä fof krara ymd
but 3SG.POSS DIST EMPH parrot_species bird
s\wä/grm
3SG.M:PST:DUR:STAT\be_up_high
'the (other man's) parrot was sitting above.'[5]

[5] *krara* = Papuan eclectus parrot or New Guinea eclectus parrot (*Eclectus polychloros*)

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(50) *maf swatrikwrm nomai*
maf swa\trik/wrm nomai
who.ERG.SG SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:DUR\tell HAB
'He was always talking'

(51) *nima "oh kabe yaniyak*
nima oh kabe yan\yak/
like_this oh man 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come
'like this: "Oh, there is a man coming."'

(52) *käfrms kofä thärifthm"*
kä\frms/ kofä thä\rifthm/
2SG:IMP:PFV\prepare fish 2SG>3PL:IMP:PFV\hide
'Get ready! Hide the fish!"'

(53) *wati fi sräthoro krara yanor*
wati fi srä\thor/o krara
then 3.ABS 3SG.M:IRR:PFV:AND\appear parrot_species
ya\nor/
3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\shout
'While he was coming, the parrot called out.'

(54) *wati fi sräthoro fof*
wati fi srä\thor/o fof
then 3.ABS 3SG.M:IRR:PFV:AND\appear EMPH
'When he arrived,'

(55) *wati kofä ane mane erä erifthza fof safak menzf*
wati kofä ane mane e\rä/ e\rifthz/a fof
then fish DEM which 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hide EMPH
safak menz=f
saratoga story_man=ERG.SG
'the Saratoga man had hidden the fish already.'

(56) *"nzungath rar karo zane erä"*
nzu-ngath rar karo zane e\rä/
1SG.POSS-mate what.PURP ground_oven DEM:PROX 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'(The Bushfowl man asked) "My friend, what is this oven for?"'

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(57) *"keke kadakada sutränwé kayé*
keke kadakada su\trän/wé kayé
NEG yamcake 1SG>3SG.M:RPST:IPFV\slice one_day_away
'(The Saratoga man replied:) "No, I made yamcake yesterday.'

(58) *kaythamane karo rä"*
kayé=thamane karo \rä/
one_day_away=TEMP.POSS ground_oven 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'This is yesterday's oven."'

(59) *fi swathugrm gaso*
fi swa\thug/rm gaso
3.ABS SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\trick badly
'He deceived him badly.'

(60) *nimanzo nomai swafiyokwrm e nomai nomai nomai*
nima=nzo nomai swa\fiyok/wrm e nomai nomai nomai
like_this=ONLY HAB SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\make until HAB HAB HAB
'He was doing this to him again and again.'

(61) *fam zära "ah nzungathf nzä wathugwr*
fam zä\r/a ah nzu-ngath=f nzä
thought SG:PST:PFV\do ah 1SG.POSS-mate=ERG.SG 1SG.ABS
wa\thug/wr
2|3SG>1SG:NPST:IPFV\trick
'(The bushfowl man) thought to himself "Ah, my friend is tricking me'

(62) *bänema kam fof ethn berä kafar kofä kam*
bäne=ma kam fof e\thn/ b=e\rä/
PH=CHAR bone EMPH 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\lie_down MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
kafar kofä kam
big fish bone
'because there were large fish bones lying around.'

(63) *watik nä kayé zba kwa tönafa wiyak"*
wati nä kayé zba kwa töna=fa
then INDF one_day_away PROX:ABL FUT high_ground=ABL
w\yak/
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk
'Next time I will walk along the high ground."'

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(64) *watik tönafa mane yanyak nä kayé kanathr*
wati töna=fa mane yan\yak/ nä
then high_ground=ABL which 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come INDF
kayé kanathr
one_day_away PLN
'This time he was coming from the high ground to Kanathér.'

(65) *tfrisamfa zefara e boba santhora*
tfrisam=fa ze\far/a e boba san\thor/a
PLN=ABL SG:PST:PFV\set_off until MED:ABL 3SG.M:PST:PFV:VENT\appear
'He departed from Téferisam (and walked) until he arrived there.'

(66) *boba fthmäsü thoraksir kwanrärm*
boba fthmäsü thorak-si=r kwan\rä/rm
MED:ABL meanwhile arrive-NMLZ=PURP 2|3SG:PST:DUR:VENT\do
'As he was approaching the place,'

(67) *watik safak fur ane fof yayamgwa*
wati safak fur ane fof ya\yamg/wa
then saratoga bundle DEM EMPH SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:IPFV\surprise
'he was startled seeing those saratoga fishlings.'

(68) *"nzungathane zane safak fur rä"*
nzu-ngath=ane zane safak fur \rä/
1SG.POSS-mate=POSS.SG DEM:PROX saratoga bundle 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'(He said) "These are my friend's saratoga fishlings."'

(69) *srethkäf zran ane efnza safak fur*
sre\thkäf/ zra=en ane e\fn/za
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\start swamp=LOC DEM SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit
safak fur
saratoga bundle
'He began to kill those saratoga fishlings there in the swamp.'

(70) *thräbth*
thrä\bth/
2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\finish
'He finished them off.'

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(71) *näbinzo sränthor*
näbi=nzo srän\thor/
one=ONLY 3SG.M:IRR:PFV:VENT\carry
'He only took one with him.'

(72) *krara thrma santhora fafen sathora fof*
krara thrma san\thor/a fafen fi z
parrot_species later 3SG.M:PST:PFV:VENT\appear meanwhile 3.ABS IAM
sa\thor/a fof
3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear EMPH
'The parrot arrived late, only after he already got there.'

(73) *"nzungath ra karo rä ane?"*
nzu-ngath ra karo \rä/ ane
1SG.POSS-mate what.ABS ground_oven 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be DEM
'He said (to the Saratoga man) "My friend, what oven is this?"'

(74) *zokwasimär ŋafiyokwa keke nä zokwasi*
zokwasi=mär ŋa\fiyok/wa keke nä zokwasi
speech=PRIV 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\make NEG INDF speech
'He was speechless. They said nothing at all,'

(75) *bänema kofä karo ane fof yayamgwa fof*
bäne=ma kofä karo ane fof ya\yamg/wa
PH=CHAR fish ground_oven DEM EMPH SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:IPFV\surprise
fof
EMPH
'because they were surprised about the fish oven.'

(76) *monkwk zakarath fof*
monkwk za\kar/ath fof
anyway 2DU:PST:PFV\pull EMPH
'Anyway, they wrestled each other.'

(77) *safak fur sraziro*
safak fur sra\zir/o
saratoga bundle SG>3SG.M.IO:IRR:PFV:AND\throw
'He threw away the saratoga fishling.'

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(78) *"be nzun fof kwathugwr*
be nzun fof kwa\thug/wr
2SG.ERG 1SG.DAT EMPH SG>1SG:RPST:IPFV\trick
'(He said) "You have tricked me.'

(79) *bukaren ane fof bä safak emgthkwa"*
bu-kar=en ane fof bä safak e\mgthk/wa
2SG.POSS-village=LOC DEM EMPH MED saratoga SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\feed
'You fed the saratoga fish at your place."'

(80) *zakarath ŋafnnath ŋafnnath ŋafnnath*
za\kar/ath ŋa\fn/nath ŋa\fn/nath ŋa\fn/nath
2DU:PST:PFV\pull 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\hit 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\hit 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\hit
'They pulled each other and hit each other. They were fighting and fighting.'

(81) *wati safak menz mane yanra tfrisam*
wati safak menz mane yan\r/a tfrisam
then saratoga story_man which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be PLN
'Next the Saratoga man came to Téférisam, and'

(82) *tfrisamen fä fof faikore efnza efnza efnza nezä we näbi srefafo*
tfrisam=en fä fof faikore e\fn/nza
PLN=LOC DIST EMPH bushfowl SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit
e\fn/nza e\fn/nza nezä we näbi
SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit in_return also one
sre\faf/o
SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV:AND\hold
'now he was killing those bushfowls over there in Téférisam. He also took one'

(83) *sräthoro*
srä\thor/o
3SG.M:IRR:PFV:AND\carry
'and carried it away.'

(84) *nzone bä nima thuwafiyokwrm berä nagayé fof*

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nzone bä nima thuwa\fiyok/wrm b=e\rä/
1SG.POSS MED like_this SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\make MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
nagayé fof
children EMPH
"'What are doing you to my children?"'

(85) *wati faikore menz krär*
wati faikore menz krä\r/
then bushfowl story_man 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\do
'The Bushfowl man got up.'

(86) *wm ane fof kanathren bä mane ythn*
wm ane fof kanathr=en bä mane y\thn/
stone DEM EMPH PLN=LOC MED which 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\lie_down
'That stone bridge at Kanathér'

(87) *tnz erästhgr*
tnz e\räs/thgr
short 2|3PL:NPST:STAT\be_erected
'that sticks out (of the water) a little bit,'

(88) *ane srethkäf rtmaksi*
ane sre\thkäf/ rtmak-si
DEM 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\start cut-NMLZ
'he started destroying it.'

(89) *ausi safak menzf zräkor*
ausi safak menz=f zrä\kor/
old_woman saratoga story_man=ERG.SG 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\speak
'The Saratoga man said to his wife:'

(90) *"ni krafare garaita bobo ŋafänizne thfn"*
ni kra\far/e garaita bobo ŋa\fäniz/ne thfn
1NSG 1DU:IRR:PFV\set_off PLN MED:ALL 1DU:NPST:IPFV\shift_place PLN
"'Let's go to Garaita. We will move to Théfén."'

(91) *wati wm ane bänemr tfotfo sfrärm*
wati wm ane bänemr tfotfo sf\rä/rm
then stone DEM until almost 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'The stone bridge was just about to disappear'

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(92) *thfn kar fi zärita safak menz sagarama mane yara*
thfn kar fi zä\rit/a safak menz sagara=ma
PLN place 3.ABS 2|3SG:PST:PFV\cross saratoga story_man PN=CHAR
mane ya\r/a
which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'when the Saratoga man went across to Théfén, to that Sangara place'

(93) *e garaita krärsöfäth*
e garaita krä\rsöfäth/
until PLN 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\descend
'and he went down at Garaita.'

(94) *thfnen bä fof zena yamnzr*
thfn=en bä fof zena ya\m/nzr
PLN=LOC MED EMPH today 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\sit
'Nowadays, he stays there at Théfén.'

(95) *nzenme, masu karaneme,*
nzenme masu kar=aneme
1NSG.POSS PLN place=POSS.NSG
'As for ours, the Masu people's guy,'

(96) *faikore menz mane yanra*
faikore menz mane yan\r/a
bushfowl story_man which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'that Bushfowl man,'

(97) *yanyaka zänbrima*
yan\yak/a zän\brim/a
3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come 2|3SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return
'he was coming back, he returned.'

(98) *tfrisam ŋawathknwa*
tfrisam ŋa\wathkn/wa
PLN 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\pack_up
'He packed up his belongings at Téférisam'

(99) *zenfara e masu*
zen\far/a e masu
SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off until PLN
'and set off and walked to Masu.'

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(100) *watik masufo sathora fof*
wati masu=fo sa\thor/a fof
then PLN=ALL 3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear EMPH
'Then he arrived at Masu.'

(101) *watik nafane trikasi katan nima zbo zf zwaythk fof*
wati nafane trikasi katan nima zbo zf
then 3SG.POSS story small like_this PROX:ALL ABSC
zwa\ythk/ fof
3SG.F:RPST:PFV\come_to_end EMPH
'Okay, his little story ends right here.'

(102) *keke zanfr*
keke zanfr
NEG long
'It is not a long story.'

(103) *watik zena anema mane ern fof*
wati zena ane=ma mane e\rn/ fof
then today DEM=CHAR which 2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\be EMPH
'Okay, that is why these two,'

(104) *sagara garaitan a mayawa masu*
sagara garaita=en a mayawa masu
PN PLN=LOC and PN PLN
'the Sangaras at Garaita and the Masu Mayawas,'

(105) *emoth nafa ŋarinth fof*
emoth nafa ŋa\ri/nth fof
sister 3NSG.ERG 2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\give EMPH
'give each other sisters.'

(106) *zba nezä ärithroth fäms ŋarer boba nezä änrithrth fäms ŋarer*
zba nezä ä\ri/throth fäms
PROX:ABL in_return PL>2|3PL.IO:NPST:IPFV:AND\give exchange
ŋare=r boba nezä än\ri/thrth
wife=PURP MED:ABL in_return 2|3PL>2|3PL.IO:NPST:IPFV:VENT\give
fäms ŋare=r
exchange wife=PURP
'They give them (sisters) from here as exchange women and in return

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they give them to us to be exchanged.'[6]

(107) *watik trikasi zbo zf zwaythk*
wati trikasi zbo zf zwa\ythk/
then story PROX:ALL ABSC 3SG.F:RPST:PFV\come_to_end
'The story ends right here.'

(108) *trikasi tnz*
trikasi tnz
story short
'It was a short story.'

(109) *eso kafar namä yarizsima*
eso kafar namä yariz-si=ma
thanks big good hear-NMLZ=CHAR
'Thank you for listening.'

(110) *gadmöwä*
gadmöwä
thanks
'Thank you.'

[6]The two groups do not intermarry, but they give each other women to be exchanged with another group. This relationship is called *ft kabe* in Komnzo.

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# 6 *Ebar zan firran* - The headhunting raid at Firra

## 6.1 Introduction

*Ebar zan firran* is a narrative lasting roughly 10min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on November 7th 2011, in both audio and video formats.[1] The story teller is Maraga Kwozi, and the recording took place in the garden of his house at Morehead Station. Maraga was around 55 years old at the time of recording. He belongs to the *banibani mayawa* clan from Firra, and he lives with his family at Morehead Station. In fact all of Firra had become a semi-permanent settlement, which is mostly used as a garden place. The story focusses on a headhunting raid that must have taken place in the 1930s. The exact date can only be guessed from the age of one of the protagonists, Yasi, who was Maraga's grandfather. The story explains why there are only few people from Firra, and all of them are from the Mayawa section. The transcription of the recording prompted Abia Bai to tell me the story of the revenge (cf. §7).

## 6.2 Summary & background

A group of headhunters from *Mere*, *Wartha*, *Safés*, and *Nzrari* planned an attack on the village of *Firra*. One of the elders of the Mayawa clan named Yasi knew about the attack and left the village. He tried to convince his brother Srank to leave also, but Srank stayed behind. Srank survived the attack and ran to *Masu* where he informed his Mayawa brothers.

Only few people survived the attack. Among them was Srank, a young woman named Zafo from *Akrimongo*, and a man named Géfi from *Safés*. Zafo from *Akrimongo* had overheard the headhunters and could identify where they had come from. Most of the other families residing at *Firra* at the time were killed, and

[1] The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20111107. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189781

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their patrilines were cut off because of the attack. The speaker emphasizes that his patriline is the only one from *Firra* that has survived until today.

The Mayawa elders from *Masu*, together with Yasi and Srank, took revenge on the headhunters, but the story does not go into detail about this payback raid.

The story ends in statement that these events were the last headhunting raids in the region. Not long after the raids, the colonial administration and the local missionaries "pacified" the region.

## 6.3 Parallel text

*zöbthé kabe mane thwamnzrm kabe yf ane thfrärm. nzone miyatha monme rä, manenzo z ŋafyé thebräknath anenzo né threbräkné. tüfr kabe thwamnzrm mayawama. mayawa mrmrma o mayawama kafar mane thwamnzrm. yasi nzone aki a srank fi mayawama fof thfrnm. bagu fi tüfrwä thwamnzrm fi baguanme kafar mane swamnzrm a mawoi. firra kar mrmren sagarama bthi. okay, ane etha mrn mrmren ane fof thwamnzrm fi kabe tüfr thwamnzrm firra kar mrmren.*

The people who lived in *Firra* before, they all had names. I only know the ones my fathers have mentioned. So I will only mention them. Many people from the Mayawa used to live there. They belonged to the Mayawa clan or were elders of the Mayawa. Yasi, my grandfather, and Srank. They were from the Mayawa clan. The Bangu were numerous. One of the Bangu elders who lived there was Mawoi. And there was Béthi of the Sangara. Okay, there were a lot of people within these three clans in *Firra* village.

*ane ebar yam fthé zewära firran. nafa wäfiyokwath bobafa mere. mere mane enrera. warthaŋä zänthafrath. a näbun mane erera nzrarima. safs kabe zena mane ekonzrth. nzrari mane thfamnzrm. ane kabe fof enrera. firran mafa thäkwrath kabe.*

At this time, a headhunt was taking place in *Firra*. Those who did this came from *Mere*. The ones from *Mere* have joined forces with the *Wartha* people. Others cames from *Nzrari*. Nowadays, they call them *Safés* people, including the ones living at *Nzrari*. These were the men who killed the people at *Firra*.

*okay, ane ebar fthé ŋafiyokwa. nzone aki yasi, nzone ŋafe fthé fof katan fäth sfrärm, fi zizi zenfara. nima zena*

When that headhunting raid took place, my grandfather Yasi, my father was a young baby boy, he left in the

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*zf thräkwrth ebar zan nafaŋarerwä. nafaŋare yf noko. matama emoth. nge nzone ŋafe ane fof kwozi. nafä fof zenfarath zizi fefe. fthé efoth kwabthakwrm. fi z miyatha zäkora nafanemäwä bad yamme. nima "zena kwa zan zbo ŋathorthr. kabe kwa zena efnzrth firran." watik, srank kma sakora "srank ni krafare!" srankf zenaftha "keke efoth zizi fefe rä. nzä kayé woräro." watik, fi yasi mane yara fi fefe zenfara masu. masufo fam thänra. karbu ote mane fobo thwamnzrm ane badabada. koyä ttfr mayawama kkafar. watik, fi ane fé zenfara ane miyathan ane zizi.*

afternoon. He knew that "They will kill them today." He left with his wife. His wife's name was Noko, a woman from *Mata*. The child, my father, was Kwozi. They set off together very late in the afternoon when the sun was going down. He had already worked it out with his own magic. He thought something like this: "Today the killing will come here" or "They will kill the people today in *Firra*." He tried to tell Srank, "Srank, let's go!" Srank said: "No, it's already late in the day. I'll come tomorrow." Then Yasi really went to *Masu*. He thought of the people in *Masu*, Karémbu and Ote, who lived over there, these ancestors. Koyä and Tétéfér, the elders of the Mayawa. With this goal in mind, he set off in the afternoon.

*zan woga thäthora zbär. z ekrkwath nwir. thden kar zakorath zbär zäthbath. zan thefafath. srank a nafangth mane yara. srank sakwrath. zätra. fi keke kwosirwä sakwrath. watik, thogr thwarenzrm mr rtmaksir. z zäbrimakoth thogr. thwarenzrm. srank fthé mane yara yakä. nafangth fi z kwosirwä sakwrath. watik, srank näbi yasi fam sanra. yasi ynbragwa masu. naf fof zätrifa fobo nima "firran z thäkwrth!"*

The headhunters arrived at night. They were already blocking the space for the attack. They surrounded the village and came in at night and killed them. As for Srank and his little brother, they struck Srank down. But they did not kill him. They looked around for the small bamboo with which they wanted to cut his neck. When they returned to look for the bamboo knife, Srank ran off. They had already killed his little brother. Srank thought only of Yasi. He followed Yasi to *Masu*. On the way he told everyone: "They have already killed them in *Firra*."

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*fthé kwan swanorm ŋarsen masun neba wazifa. yasif karbu sakora "srank byanor garda garda sarofäth! kayé kma fof fi sanmisé. kma né sräkwrmth zan wogané." watik, srank trtha byara srank ngemäre. ane efoth yföyfön fthé kwankwirmth. foba kwanfarkwrmth. fobo nä karma thwamnzrm nima safsma. safsma woga nä fobo swamnzrm. gfi yf. mafnemäwä bamu yé thbithé. zena mafnemäwä erä. fi z zenfara ane kayé nima kayé zan zrarä fi z zenfara. fi anema trtha zena zf erä. fi fthé nyamnzrm nafäsü kwa thräkwrmth. kabe fobo nä firran mane erera. kabe karma mane ämnza fi z thäkwrath. fobo nafä thäthfrath. fi anenzo trtha woga ferna srank yasi. yasifa foba fof ni zane zewärake zena znrä. nzenme ŋafyé berna: nzone ŋafe kwozi maiti. fi trtha berna. srank ngemäre zäbtha. ŋare ffé zefafa fi ngemär bana yara.*

Then he shouted at the river in *Masu* from the other side. Yasi said to Karémbu "Srank is shouting there. Take the canoe for him! I tried to take him with me yesterday. These headhunters nearly killed him." So Srank survived, but he didn't leave any children behind. Back then, when they ran away and left, other people had settled there, for example people from *Safés*. There was a man from *Safés* by the name of Géfi. His father was Bamu, but they actually come from *Thémbithé*. Géfi had left already. He knew there would be an attack. So he left. That's why they his children are still alive. If he had stayed, he would have been killed along with others. The other people in *Firra*, people from other villages who had lived there, were also killed and mixed with them. Only those two survived, Srank and Yasi. We go back to Yasi; from that time until today. Our fathers were Kwozi and Maiti. This family line survived, but Srank died later without leaving children. He did get married, but the poor chap had no children.

*ausi fäth mä rera ane zan mrmren. nafane yf zafo. akrimogma emoth zafo. watik fi mane rera. mathmath gamo zäzira. nasi yfön zäthba. watik, zan wogané komnzo zfnagwrmth. watik zan woga fthé zäzinbrath. fi fthé fof zänmätra nasi yföfa akrimogo. akrimogo karnm naf thätrifa "mawoi z sakwrth!" kafar mane yara firrama kafar mawoi. "mawoi z safafth." watik,*

There was another woman in that headhunting raid. Her name was Zafo. Zafo was from *Akrimongo*. She used magic and hid in the hole of a long yam. The headhunters simply missed her. When the headhunters had passed, she came out of the long yam hole and ran to *Akrimongo*. She told the *Akrimongo* people "They've already killed Mawoi." Mawoi was an elder

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*fobo fof miyatha zäkorath "oh, firran z thäkwrth!" nezä faw brigsir mane rera, thrmawä eyaka. ŋarsen kma thethräfath. fi z zaföwä zäritakoth. naf fof ŋariza yf fof. wära zokwasime mane kwanafrmth fobo. wartha zokwasime kwanafrmth, kanza zokwasime. wära zokwasi woga nä foba yariza. woga mane ŋanafa emoth wäthräkwa "nzone ymoth fob rä mafo kmam zethfro!" nafadba ane ausi fäthdba miyatha zokwasi fof zathorath nima "okay, keke zagr woga zanr thwaniyak. fi zba zrä. safsma woga thwaniyak, nzrarima."*

from *Firra*. "They've already got Mawoi." That's how they found out: "Oh, they killed them in *Firra*." As for their revenge, that came much later. They should have stopped the headhunters at the river, but they had already crossed the river. The woman had heard their names. Some were talking in Wära language. Some talked in Wartha and Kánchá. She heard one guy speaking Wära, a man who prevented the others from killing his sister saying "That's my sister over there. Don't mix her up with the others!" From this young woman the knowledge spread and people said "Okay, they did not come from far away to kill them. There are from close by, from *Safés*, from *Nzrari*."

*watik, nezä faw mane rera. ane firra zanane faw. nezä faw z wbrigrnath nzenme aki a ote. mafanemäwä zena kaunsl yé. nane marua ane family bramöwä, kadikafu. okay, nafa nezä z faw wbrigrnath. bänema nafanme mayawa kakafar z bramöwä thäkwrath firran. ane ebar mane rera fawkaräsü rera. nezä mane erera zagr keke eyaka. mane né merefo themiyarath nezä faw merema woga kma thräkwrmth. komnzo zäwthefath. safsma woga thäkwrath nzrarin. krsi znen fobo fof thethräfath. fobo fof thäkwrath. watik, faw z ŋabrigwa. ane ebar nimame firran fof rera ane.*

Well, the revenge that took place was the payback for *Firra*. Our grandfathers paid them back and also Ote whose grandson is now the councillor, brother Marua, Kadikafu and the whole family. Okay, they took revenge because all their Mayawa elders were killed at *Firra*. Those cut-off heads would be avenged. They did not go far for their revenge. They were about to go to *Mere*. They almost took revenge on the people from *Mere*. But they decided to turn around and kill the *Safés* people at *Nzrari*. They surrounded them there and killed them. That was the revenge. This is what happened during the *Firra* headhunt.

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*fobafa mane rä fobo fof kerker kwanbthakrm ane fof. monme zane ebarane zan zfrärm fof. woga thufnzrmth. ebar thwärtmth. thfzänzrmth karfo. ane mane rera edaŋane ane fof rera. ane fof rera. last fefe mä zermäna fethkakaren. zbo mane thäkwrath. fethkakar karen fthé thäkwrath. näbi fthé fof zemathakoth. fobo fof zäkora ebar fobo fof zäbtha. zanemr zena znrä. wati, zenafa ni tüfr nagayé kwakonzre. fi ane ebarane zokwasi fthé z maf kratrikwro. fi zena mrmren fthé niné wbrigwre näbuné. fthé zmarwre zane nzenme kar mrmren thd moreheaden. nimame krenafth-mé thd moreheaden kar mane erä. ni woga tüfrmäre nrä. bänema nzenme thden ane fof kwakwirm. woga finzo finzo kwafnzrmth. nä kar wogané nä kar thwemiyarth. nä kar wogané nä kar woga thwemiyarth. okay, ni nimame fof ŋafiyokwake.*

From then on, the hunting raids came to an end. What they did in the headhunt, they killed the people, cut off their heads and carried them to the village. This incident that was the second last headhunt. The very last one, where they killed people, took place at *Fethka*. When they killed the people of *Fethka*, the survivors ran away for good. From this point on, headhunting was over. That is why we are alive today. We are many children now. But this headhunting story, whoever may tell it, when we or others retell it, you just need to look inside our village, in the middle of *Morehead*. I can tell you, in the middle of *Morehead*, those are the villages where people came from. We are not many people, because this happened in our midst. People killed each other. One group of villagers attacked other villages, and again another group of villagers attacked other villagers. Okay, that is what we have done.

*nzenme mrmren nima fof ŋakwira yam. anema kabekaräsü ni nrera. ni mrnmäwä nrera. firran mane thäkwrath woga fi fefe zäbthath. nafane story nimame firraŋane fof rä brä. nä keke mane fä sathfära ninzo fefe nznethfära. yasiane family zena znrä. ni yasiane mrnma. nge nafane. nima ni nafane ane bababadama fof nrä. nzenme mrn mrmren z monme miyatha ŋakwir. gadmewä fi zbo komnzo ämrna karbu ote firranzo bä bthrarärm. mane fthé z thräkwrmth fobo fof. keke*

This custom was common with us. We were part of that. We come from that clan. The *Firra* headhunt really finished off these other clans. This is the story about the *Firra* headhunt. Nobody could escape there, only we could escape. From Yasi's family to us today. We are from Yasi's family. We are his children. We go back to his ancestors. We know about this in our family. Fortunately, Ote and Karémbu had stayed here. If they had been there at *Firra*, they would have

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*kwa ni tüfr nzrarärm. fi mon zbo ämrna yasif ane fof fam thnra. nafanemäwä mrn fof. watik zänbrima fi zanmatha. nzone ŋafe näbinzo finzo.*

been killed too, and we would not be many people today. Because those two were staying here, Yasi thought of them, really his own clan, he came back, he ran really. My father was the only son.

*fobo fof wythik ane zokwasi fof firra ebarma. keke zanfrme rä. fobo komnzo zänbtha fof. nima kerkeren efothen zfwiyakm. monwä z nznanafthmé kerker efothen zfwiyakm. fthé fefe markai zänthba we mizi zänthbath. fobo fof wythka. fthé dibura fathasi thethkäfath mafa ane woga thufnzrmth nimame. fobo fof zuwythk ane zokwasi.*

The story of the *Firra's* headhunt ends here. It is not a long story. At that time it ended in the last days of headhunting. Like I just told you. This happened in the last days of headhunting. This happened when the white man came and also when the missionaries arrived. After that, the headhunting ended. They started throwing people in prison who had killed someone. This story is now over.

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## 6.4 Glossed text

(1) *zöbthé kabe mane thwamnzrm kabe yf ane thfrärm*
zöbthé kabe mane thwa\m/nzrm kabe yf ane thf\rä/rm
first man which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit man name DEM 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'The people who lived (in Firra) before had names.'

(2) *nzone miyatha monme rä manenzo z ŋafyé thebräknath anenzo né threbräkné*
nzone miyatha mon=me \rä/ mane=nzo z
1SG.POSS knowledge how=INS 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be which=ONLY IAM
ŋafe=é the\bräkn/ath ane=nzo n
father=ERG.NSG 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\call_out DEM=ONLY IMN
thre\bräkn/é
1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\call_out
'I only know the ones my fathers have mentioned. So I will only mention them.'

(3) *tüfr kabe thwamnzrm mayawama*
tüfr kabe thwa\m/nzrm mayawa=ma
plenty man 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit PN=CHAR
'Many people from the Mayawa used to live there.'

(4) *mayawa mrmrma o mayawama kafar mane thwamnzrm*
mayawa mrmr=ma o mayawa=ma kafar mane thwa\m/nzrm
PN inside=CHAR or PN=CHAR big which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'They belonged to the Mayawa clan or were elders of the Mayawa.'

(5) *yasi nzone aki a srank*
yasi nzone aki a srank
PLN 1SG.POSS grandparent and PN
'Yasi, my grandfather, and Srank.'

(6) *fi mayawama fof thfrnm*
fi mayawa=ma fof thf\rn/m
3.ABS PN=CHAR EMPH 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be
'They were from the Mayawa clan.'

(7) *bagu fi tüfrwä thwamnzrm fi baguanme kafar mane swamnzrm a mawoi*

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bagu fi tüfr=wä thwa\m/nzrm fi bagu=aneme kafar
PN 3.ABS plenty=EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit 3.ABS PN=POSS.NSG big
mane swa\m/nzrm a mawoi
which 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit and PN
'The Bangu were numerous. One of the Bangu elders who lived there was Mawoi.'

(8) *firra kar mrmren sagarama bthi*
firra kar mrmr=en sagara=ma bthi
PLN village inside=LOC PN=CHAR PN
'And there was Béthi of the Sangara.'

(9) *okay, ane etha mrn mrmren ane fof thwamnzrm fi kabe tüfr thwamnzrm*
okay ane etha mrn mrmr=en ane fof thwa\m/nzrm fi
okay DEM three family inside=LOC DEM EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit 3.ABS
kabe tüfr thwa\m/nzrm
man plenty 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'Okay, there were a lot of people within these three clans'

(10) *firra kar mrmren*
firra kar mrmr=en
PLN village inside=LOC
'in Firra village.'

(11) *ane ebar yam fthé zewära firran*
ane ebar yam fthé ze\wär/a firra=en
DEM head event when SG:PST:PFV\happen PLN=LOC
'At this time, a headhunt was taking place in Firra.'

(12) *nafa wäfiyokwath bobafa mere*
nafa wä\fiyok/wath boba=fa mere
3NSG.ERG 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make MED:ABL=ABL PLN
'Those who did this came from Mere.'

(13) *mere mane enrera*
mere mane en\rä/ra
PLN which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'The ones from Mere'

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(14) *warthaŋä zänthafrath*
wartha=ä zän\thafr/ath
PLN=ASSOC 2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\add
'have joined forces with the Wartha people.'

(15) *a näbun mane erera nzrarima*
a näbun mane e\rä/ra nzrari=ma
and INDF which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be PLN=CHAR
'Others cames from Nzrari.'

(16) *safs kabe zena mane ekonzrth*
safs kabe zena mane e\ko/nzrth
PLN people today which 2|3PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\speak
'Nowadays, they call them Safés people,'

(17) *nzrari mane thfamnzrm*
nzrari mane thfa\m/nzrm
PLN which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'including the ones living at Nzrari.'

(18) *ane kabe fof enrera*
ane kabe fof en\rä/ra
DEM man EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'These were the men'

(19) *firran mafa thäkwrath kabe*
firra=en mafa thä\kwr/ath kabe
PLN=LOC who.ERG.NSG 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit people
'who killed the people at Firra.'

(20) *okay, ane ebar fthé ŋafiyokwa*
okay ane ebar fthé ŋa\fiyok/wa
okay DEM head when SG:PST:IPFV\make
'When that headhunting raid took place,'

(21) *nzone aki yasi*
nzone aki yasi
1SG.POSS grandparent PN
'my grandfather Yasi,'

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(22) *nzone ŋafe fthé fof katan fäth sfrärm*
nzone ŋafe fthé fof katan fäth sf\rä/rm
1SG.POSS father when EMPH small DIM 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'my father was a young baby boy,'

(23) *fi zizi zenfara*
fi zizi zen\far/a
3.ABS afternoon SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off
'he left in the afternoon.'

(24) *nima zena zf thräkwrth ebar zan*
nima zena zf thrä\kwr/th ebar zan
like_this today ABSC 2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hit head fight
'He knew that "They will kill them today."'

(25) *nafaŋarerwä*
nafa-ŋare=r=wä
3.POSS-woman=ASSOC.DU=EMPH
'(He left) with his own wife.'

(26) *nafaŋare yf noko*
nafa-ŋare yf noko
3.POSS-wife name Noko
'His wife's name was Noko,'

(27) *matama emoth*
mata=ma emoth
Mata=CHAR girl
'a girl from Mata.'

(28) *nge nzone ŋafe ane fof kwozi*
nge nzone ŋafe ane fof kwozi
child 1SG.POSS father DEM EMPH Kwozi
'The child, my father, was Kwozi.'

(29) *nafä fof zenfarath zizi fefe fthé efoth kwabthakwrm*
nafä fof zen\far/ath zizi fefe fthé efoth
3PL.ASSOC EMPH 2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off afternoon really when sun
kwa\bthak/wrm
SG:PST:DUR\finish
'They set off together very late in the afternoon when the sun was going down.'

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(30) *fi z miyatha zäkora nafanemäwä bad yamme*
fi z miyatha zä\kor/a nafane=ma=wä bad
3.ABS IAM knowledge SG:PST:PFV\become 3SG.POSS=CHAR=EMPH ground
yam=me
event=INS
'He had already worked it out with his own magic.'

(31) *nima zena kwa zan zbo ŋathorthr kabe kwa zena efnzrth firran*
nima zena kwa zan zbo ŋa\thor/thr kabe kwa zena
like_this today FUT fight PROX:ALL 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\enter man FUT today
e\fn/nzrth firra=en
2|3PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\hit PLN=LOC
'(He thought) something like this: "Today the killing will come here" or "They will kill the people today in Firra."'

(32) *watik, srank kma sakora "srank ni krafare"*
wati srank kma sa\kor/a srank ni kra\far/e
then PN POT SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\speak PN 1NSG 1DU:IRR:PFV\set_off
'He tried to tell Srank, "Srank, let's go!"'

(33) *srankf zenaftha "keke efoth zizi fefe rä nzä kayé woräro"*
srank=f ze\nafth/a keke efoth zizi fefe
PN=ERG.SG SG:PST:PFV\speak NEG day afternoon really
\rä/ nzä kayé wo\rä/ro
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be 1SG.ABS one_day_away 1SG:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'Srank said: "No, it's already late in the day. I'll come tomorrow."'

(34) *watik, fi yasi mane yara fi fefe zenfara masu*
wati fi yasi mane ya\r/a fi fefe
then 3.ABS PN which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be 3.ABS really
zen\far/a masu
SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off PLN
'Then Yasi really went to Masu.'

(35) *masufo fam thänra*
masu=fo fam thän\r/a
PLN=ALL thought SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\do
'He thought of the people in Masu,'

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(36) *karbu ote mane fobo thwamnzrm ane badabada*
karbu ote mane fobo thwa\m/nzrm ane badabada
Karémbu PN which DIST:ALL 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit DEM ancestor
'Karémbu and Ote, who lived over there, these ancestors.'

(37) *koyä ttfr mayawama kkafar*
koyä ttfr mayawa=ma k~kafar
PN PN PN=CHAR REDUP~big
'Koyä and Tétéfér, the elders of the Mayawa.'

(38) *watik, fi ane fé zenfara ane miyathan ane zizi*
wati fi ane fefe zen\far/a ane miyatha=en ane
then 3.ABS DEM really SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off DEM knowledge=LOC DEM
zizi
afternoon
'With this goal in mind, he set off in the afternoon.'

(39) *zan woga thäthora zbär*
zan woga thä\thor/a zbär
fight man 2|3PL:PST:PFV\appear night
'The headhunters arrived at night.'

(40) *z ekrkwath nwir*
z e\kr/kwath nwi=r
IAM 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\block attack=PURP
'They were already blocking the space for the attack.'

(41) *thden kar zakorath zbär zäthbath*
thd=en kar za\kor/ath zbär
middle=LOC village 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\become night
zä\thb/ath
2|3PL:PST:PFV\enter
'They surrounded the village and came in at night'

(42) *zan thefafath*
zan thä\faf/ath
fight 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hold
'and killed them.'

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(43) *srank a nafangth mane yara*
srank a nafa-ngth mane ya\r/a
PN and 3.POSS-younger_sibling which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'As for Srank and his little brother,'

(44) *srank sakwrath zätra*
srank sa\kwr/ath zä\tr/a
PN 2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\hit SG:PST:PFV\fall
'they struck him down.'

(45) *fi keke kwosirwä sakwrath*
fi keke kwosi=r=wä sa\kwr/ath
but NEG dead=PURP=EMPH 2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\hit
'But they did not kill him.'

(46) *watik, thogr thwarenzrm mr rtmaksir*
wati thog=r thwa\re/nzrm mr rtmak-si=r
then bamboo_species=PURP 2|3PL:PST:DUR\look neck cut-NMLZ=PURP
'They looked around for the small bamboo with which they wanted to cut his neck.'

(47) *z zäbrimakoth thogr thwarenzrm srank fthé mane yara yakä*
z zä\brim/akoth thog=r thwa\re/nzrm
IAM PL:PST:PFV:AND\return bamboo_species=PURP 2|3PL:PST:DUR\look
srank fthé mane ya\r/a yak=ä
PN when which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be run=ASSOC
'When they returned to look for the bamboo knife, Srank ran off.'

(48) *nafangth fi z kwosirwä sakwrath*
nafa-ngth fi z kwosi=r=wä
3.POSS-younger_sibling 3.ABS IAM dead=PURP=EMPH
sa\kwr/ath
2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\hit
'They had already killed his little brother.'

(49) *watik, srank näbi yasi fam sanra yasi ynbragwa masu*
wati srank näbi yasi fam san\r/a yasi
then PN one PN thought SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:PFV:VENT\do PN
yn\brag/wa masu
SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\follow PLN
'Srank thought only of Yasi. He followed Yasi to Masu.'

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(50) *naf fof zätrifa fobo nima "firran z thäkwrth"*
naf fof zä\trif/a fobo nima firra=en z
3SG.ERG EMPH SG:PST:PFV\tell DIST:ALL like_this PLN=LOC IAM
thä\kwr/th
2|3PL>2|3PL:RPST:PFV\hit
'(On the way) he told everyone: "They have already killed them in Firra."'

(51) *fthé kwan swanorm ŋarsen masun neba wozifa*
fthé kwan swa\nor/m ŋars=en masu=en neba wazi=fa
when shout 3SG.M:PST:DUR\shout river=LOC PLN=LOC opposite side=ABL
'Then he shouted at the river in Masu from the other side.'

(52) *yasif karbu sakora*
yasi=f karbu sa\kor/a
PN=ERG.SG PN SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\speak
'Yasi said to Karémbu'

(53) *srank byanor garda garda sarofäth!*
srank b=ya\nor/ garda sa\rofäth/
PN MED=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\shout canoe 2SG>3SG.M.IO:IMP:PFV\paddle
'"Srank is shouting there. Take the canoe for him!'

(54) *kayé kma fof fi sanmisé*
kayé kma fof fi san\mis/é
one_day_away POT EMPH 3.ABS 1SG>3SG.M:RPST:PFV:VENT\bring
'I tried to take him with me yesterday.'

(55) *kma né sräkwrmth zan wogané*
kma n srä\kwr/mth zan woga=é
POT IMN 2|3PL>3SG.M:IRR:PFV:DUR\hit fight man=ERG.NSG
'These headhunters nearly killed him."'

(56) *watik, srank trtha byara srank ngemäre*
wati srank trtha b=ya\r/a srank nge=mär
then PN life MED=3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be PN child=PRIV
'So Srank survived, but he didn't leave any children behind.'

(57) *ane efoth yföyfön fthé kwankwirmth foba kwanfarkwrmth*

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ane efoth yfö~yfö=en fthé kwan\kwi/rmth foba
DEM day REDUP~hole=LOC when 2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\run DIST:ABL
kwan\fark/wrmth
2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\set_off
'Back then, when they ran away and left,'

(58) *fobo nä karma thwamnzrm nima safsma*
fobo nä kar=ma thwa\m/nzrm nima safs=ma
DIST:ALL INDF village=CHAR 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit like_this PLN=CHAR
'other people had settled there, for example people from Safés.'

(59) *safsma woga nä fobo swamnzrm gfi yf*
safs=ma woga nä fobo swa\m/nzrm gfi yf
PLN=CHAR man INDF DIST:ALL 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit PN name
'There was a man from Safés by the name of Géfi.'

(60) *mafnemäwä bamu yé thbithé zena mafnemäwä erä*
mafane=ma=wä bamu \yé/ thbithé zena
who.POSS.NSG=CHAR=EMPH PN 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be PN today
mafane=ma=wä e\rä/
who.POSS.NSG=CHAR=EMPH 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'His father was Bamu, but they actually come from Thémbithé.'

(61) *fi z zenfara ane kayé nima*
fi z zen\far/a ane kayé nima
3.ABS IAM SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off DEM one_day_away like_this
'(Géfi) he had left already.'

(62) *kayé zan zrarä fi z zenfara fi anema trtha zena zf erä*
kayé zan zra\rä/ fi z zen\far/a
one_day_away fight 3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\be 3.ABS IAM SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off
fi ane=ma trtha zena zf e\rä/
3.ABS DEM=CHAR life today ABSC 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'He knew there would be an attack. So he left. That's why they (his children) are still alive.'

(63) *fi fthé nyamnzrm nafäsü kwa thräkwrmth*

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fi fthé n=ya\m/nzrm nafä=sü kwa
3.ABS when IPST=3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit 3PL.ASSOC=ETC FUT
thrä\kwr/mth
2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV:DUR\hit
'If he had stayed, he would have been killed along with others.'

(64) *kabe fobo nä firran mane erera*
kabe fobo nä firra=en mane e\rä/ra
people DIST:ALL INDF PLN=LOC which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be
'The other people in Firra,'

(65) *kabe karma mane ämnza fi z thäkwrath fobo nafä thäthfrath*
kabe kar=ma mane ä\m/nza fi z
people village=CHAR which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\sit 3.ABS IAM
thä\kwr/ath fobo nafä thä\thafr/ath
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit DIST:ALL 3PL.ASSOC 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\add
'people from other villages who had lived there, were also killed and mixed with them.'

(66) *fi anenzo trtha woga ferna srank yasi*
fi ane=nzo trtha woga f=e\rn/a srank yasi
3.ABS DEM=ONLY life man DIST=SG>2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be PN PN
'Only those two survived, Srank and Yasi.'

(67) *yasifa foba fof ni zane zewärake zena znrä*
yasi=fa foba fof ni zane zä\wär/ake zena
PN=ABL DIST:ABL EMPH 1NSG DEM:PROX 1PL:PST:PFV\happen today
z=n\rä/
PROX=1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'We go back to Yasi; from that time until today.'

(68) *nzenme ŋafyé berna nzone ŋafe kwozi maiti*
nzenme ŋafe=é b=e\rn/a nzone ŋafe kwozi
1NSG.POSS father=ABS.NSG MED=2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be 1SG.POSS father PN
maiti
PN
'Our fathers were Kwozi and Maiti.'

(69) *fi trtha berna. srank ngemäre zäbtha.*

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fi trtha b=e\rn/a srank nge=mär zä\bth/a
3.ABS life MED=2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be PN child=PRIV SG:PST:PFV\finish
'(This family line) survived, but Srank died later without leaving children.'

(70) *ŋare ffé zefafa fi ngemär bana yara*
ŋare fefe zä\faf/a fi nge=mär bana ya\r/a
wife really SG:PST:PFV\marry but child=PRIV pitiful 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'He did get married, but the poor chap had no children.'

(71) *ausi fäth mä rera ane zan mrmren nafane yf zafo*
ausi fäth mä \rä/ra ane zan mrmr=en nafane
old_woman DIM where 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be DEM fight inside=LOC 3SG.POSS
yf zafo
name PN
'There was another woman in that headhunting raid. Her name was Zafo.'

(72) *akrimogoma emoth zafo*
akrimogo=ma emoth zafo
PLN=CHAR sister PN
'Zafo was from Akrimongo.'

(73) *watik fi mane rera mathmath gamo zäzira nasi yfön zäthba*
wati fi mane \rä/ra mathmath gamo zä\zir/a
then 3.ABS which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be hiding_spell spell SG:PST:PFV\throw
nasi yfö=en zä\thb/a
long_yam hole=LOC SG:PST:PFV\enter
'She used magic and hid in the hole of a long yam.'

(74) *watik, zan wogané komnzo zfnagwrmth*
wati zan woga=é komnzo zf\nag/wrmth
then fight man=ERG.NSG only 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR\miss
'The headhunters simply missed her.'

(75) *watik zan woga fthé zäzinbrath*
wati zan woga fthé zä\zinbr/ath
then fight man when 2|3PL:PST:PFV\pass_by
'When the headhunters had passed,'

(76) *fi fthé fof zänmätra nasi yföfa akrimogo*

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fi fthé fof zän\mätr/a nasi yfö=fa akrimogo
3.ABS when EMPH SG:PST:PFV:VENT\exit long_yam hole=ABL PLN
'she came out of the long yam hole (and ran) to Akrimongo.'

(77) *akrimogo karnm naf thätrifa*
akrimogo kar=nm naf thä\trif/a
PLN village=DAT.NSG 3SG.ERG SG>2|3PL.IO:PST:PFV\tell
'She told the Akrimongo people'

(78) *mawoi z sakwrth*
mawoi z sa\kwr/th
PN IAM 2|3PL>3SG.M:RPST:PFV\hit
'"They've already killed Mawoi."'

(79) *kafar mane yara firrama kafar mawoi*
kafar mane ya\r/a firra=ma kafar mawoi
big which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be PLN=CHAR big PN
'Mawoi was an elder from Firra.'

(80) *mawoi z safafth*
mawoi z sa\faf/th
PN IAM 2|3PL>3SG.M:RPST:PFV\hold
'"They've already got Mawoi."'

(81) *watik, fobo fof miyatha zäkorath "oh, firran z thäkwrth"*
wati fobo fof miyatha zä\kor/ath oh firra=en z
then DIST:ALL EMPH knowledge 2|3PL:PST:PFV\become oh PLN=LOC IAM
thä\kwr/th
2|3PL>2|3PL:RPST:PFV\hit
'That's how they found out: "Oh, they killed them in Firra."'

(82) *nezä faw brigsir mane rera thrmawä eyaka*
nezä faw brig-si=r mane \rä/ra
in_return payment return-NMLZ=PURP which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be
thrma=wä e\yak/a
later=EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\walk
'As for their revenge, that came much later.'

(83) *ŋarsen kma thethräfath fi z zaföwä zäritakoth*

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ŋars=en kma thä\thräf/ath fi z zafe=wä
river=LOC POT 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\block but IAM early=EMPH
zä\rit/akoth
PL:PST:PFV:AND\cross
'They should have stopped the headhunters at the river, but they had already crossed the river.'

(84) *naf fof ŋariza yf fof*
naf fof ŋa\riz/a yf fof
3SG.ERG EMPH SG:PST:IPFV\hear name EMPH
'The woman had heard their names.'

(85) *wära zokwasime mane kwanafrmth fobo*
wära zokwasi=me mane kwa\naf/rmth fobo
PN speech=INS which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\talk DIST:ALL
'Some were talking in Wära language.'

(86) *wartha zokwasime kwanafrmth kanza zokwasime*
wartha zokwasi=me kwa\naf/rmth kanza zokwasi=me
PN speech=INS 2|3PL:PST:DUR\talk PN speech=INS
'Some talked in Wartha and Kánchá.'

(87) *wära zokwasi woga nä foba yariza*
wära zokwasi woga nä foba ya\riz/a
PN speech man INDF DIST:ABL SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\hear
'She heard one guy speaking Wära,'

(88) *woga mane ŋanafa emoth wäthräkwa*
woga mane ŋa\naf/a emoth wä\thräk/wa
man which SG:PST:IPFV\speak girl SG>3SG.F.IO:PST:IPFV\block
'a man who prevented the others from killing his sister (saying)'

(89) *"nzone ymoth fob rä mafo kmam zethfro"*

'"That's my sister over there. Don't mix her up with the others!"'[2]

[2]He speaks Wära. A translation to Komnzo would be: *nzone emoth fobo rä maf kmam zathafro.*

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(90) *nafadba ane ausi fäthdba miyatha zokwasi fof zathorath nima*
nafadba ane ausi fäth=dba miyatha zokwasi fof
3SG.ABL DEM old_woman DIM=ABL.ANIM.SG knowledge speech EMPH
za\thor/ath nima
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\carry like_this
'From this young woman the knowledge spread (and people said)'

(91) *"okay, keke zagr woga zanr thwaniyak. fi zba zrä. safsma woga thwaniyak, nzrarima."*
okay keke zagr woga zan=r thwan\yak/ fi
okay NEG far man fight=PURP 2|3PL:RPST:IPFV:VENT\come 3.ABS
zba z=\rä/ safs=ma woga
PROX:ABL PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN=CHAR man
thwan\yak/ nzrari=ma
2|3PL:RPST:IPFV:VENT\come PLN=CHAR
'"Okay, they did not come from far away to kill them. There are from close by, from Safés, from Nzrari."'

(92) *watik, nezä faw mane rera*
wati nezä faw mane \rä/ra
then in_return payment which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be
'Well, the revenge that took place'

(93) *ane firra zanane faw*
ane firra zan=ane faw
DEM PLN fight=POSS.SG payment
'was the payback for Firra.'

(94) *nezä faw z wbrigrnath nzenme aki*
nezä faw z w\brig/rnath nzenme
in_return payment IAM 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\return 1NSG.POSS
aki
grandparent
'Our grandfathers paid them back'

(95) *a ote*
a ote
and PN
'and also Ote'

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(96) *mafanemäwä zena kaunsl yé*
mafane=ma=wä zena kaunsl \yé/
who.POSS.NSG=CHAR=EMPH today councillor 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'whose (grandson) is now the councillor,'[3]

(97) *nane marua ane family bramöwä kadikafu*
nane marua ane family bramöwä kadikafu
elder_sibling PN DEM family all PN
'brother Marua, Kadikafu and the whole family.'[4]

(98) *okay, nafa nezä z faw wbrigrnath*
okay nafa nezä z faw w\brig/rnath
okay 3NSG.ERG in_return IAM payment 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\return
'Okay, they took revenge'

(99) *bänema nafanme mayawa kakafar z bramöwä thäkwrath firran*
bäne=ma nafanme mayawa ka~kafar z bramöwä
PH=CHAR 3NSG.POSS PN REDUP~big IAM all
thä\kwr/ath firra=en
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit PLN=LOC
'because all their Mayawa elders were killed at Firra.'

(100) *ane ebar mane rera fawkaräsü rera*
ane ebar mane \rä/ra faw=karä=sü
DEM head which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be payment=PROP=ETC
\rä/ra
3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be
'Those cut-off heads would be avenged.'

(101) *nezä mane erera zagr keke eyaka*
nezä mane e\rä/ra zagr keke e\yak/a
in_return which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be far NEG 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\walk
'They did not go far for their revenge.'

(102) *mane né merefo themiyarath nezä faw merema woga kma thräkwrmth*

[3]Ote's grandson, Abia Bai, from Masu was the ward member for Rouku at the time.
[4]Abia Bai's brothers Marua Bai and Kaumb Bai (Kadikafu).

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mane n mere=fo thä\miya/rath nezä faw
which IMN PLN=ALL 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\fetch in_return payment
mere=ma woga kma thrä\kwr/mth
PLN=CHAR man POT 2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV:DUR\hit
'They were about to go to Mere. They almost took revenge on the people from Mere.'

(103) *komnzo zäwthefath*
komnzo zä\wthef/ath
only 2|3PL:PST:PFV\change
'But they decided to turn around and'

(104) *safsma woga thäkwrath nzrarin*
safs=ma woga thä\kwr/ath nzrari=en
PLN=CHAR man 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit PLN=LOC
'kill the Safés people at Nzrari.'

(105) *krsi znen fobo fof thethräfath fobo fof thäkwrath*
kr-si zn=en fobo fof thä\thräf/ath
block-NMLZ place=LOC DIST:ALL EMPH 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\block
fobo fof thä\kwr/ath
DIST:ALL EMPH 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit
'They surrounded them there and killed them.'

(106) *watik, faw z ŋabrigwa.*
wati faw z ŋa\brig/wa
then payment IAM SG:PST:IPFV\return
'That was the revenge.'

(107) *ane ebar nimame firran fof rera ane*
ane ebar nima=me firra=en fof \rä/ra ane
DEM head like_this=INS PLN=LOC EMPH 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be DEM
'This is what happened during the Firra headhunt.'

(108) *fobafa mane rä fobo fof kerker kwanbthakrm ane fof*
foba=fa mane \rä/ fobo fof kerker
DIST:ABL=ABL which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be DIST:ALL EMPH tail
kwan\bthak/wrm ane fof
SG:PST:DUR:VENT\finish DEM EMPH
'From then on, the hunting raids came to an end.'

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(109) *monme zane ebarane zan zfrärm fof*
mon=me zane ebar=ane zan zf\rä/rm fof
how=INS DEM:PROX head=POSS.SG fight 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be EMPH
'What they did in the headhunt,'

(110) *woga thufnzrmth ebar thwärtmth thfzänzrmth karfo*
woga thu\fn/nzrmth ebar thwä\rtm/th
man 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit head 2|3PL>2|3PL:ITER\cut
thf\zä/nzrmth kar=fo
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\carry village=ALL
'they killed the people, cut off their heads and carried them back home.'

(111) *ane mane rera edaŋane ane fof rera*
ane mane \rä/ra eda=ane ane fof \rä/ra
DEM which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be two=POSS.SG DEM EMPH 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be
'This incident that was the second last headhunt.'

(112) *ane fof rera last fefe mä zermäna fethkakaren zbo mane thäkwrath*
ane fof \rä/ra last fefe mä zä\rmän/a fethka
DEM EMPH 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be last really where SG:PST:PFV\close PLN
kar=en zbo mane thä\kwr/ath
place=LOC PROX:ALL which 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit
'The very last one, where they killed people, took place at Fethka.'

(113) *fethkakar karen fthé thäkwrath näbi fthé fof zemathakoth*
fethka kar kar=en fthé thä\kwr/ath näbi fthé fof
PLN place place=LOC when 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit one when EMPH
zä\math/akoth
PL:PST:PFV:AND\run
'When they killed the people of Fethka, the (survivors) ran away forever.'

(114) *fobo fof zäkora ebar fobo fof zäbtha*
fobo fof zä\kor/a ebar fobo fof zä\bth/a
DIST:ALL EMPH SG:PST:PFV\become head DIST:ALL EMPH SG:PST:PFV\finish
'From this point on, headhunting was over.'

(115) *zanemr zena znrä*
zane=r zena z=n\rä/
DEM:PROX=PURP today PROX=1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'That is why we are alive today.'

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(116) *wati, zenafa ni tüfr nagayé kwakonzre*
wati zena=fa ni tüfr nagayé kwa\ko/nzre
then today=ABL 1NSG plenty children 1PL:RPST:IPFV\become
'We are many children now.'

(117) *fi ane ebarane zokwasi fthé z maf kratrikwro fi*
fi ane ebar=ane zokwasi fthé z maf
but DEM head=POSS.SG speech when IAM who.ERG.SG
kra\trik/wro
SG:IRR:IPFV:AND\tell
'But this headhunting story, whoever may tell it,'

(118) *zena mrmren fthé niné wbrigwre näbuné*
zena mrmr=en fthé niné w\brig/wre
today inside=LOC when 1NSG.EMPH 1PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\return
näbun=é
INDF=ERG.NSG
'when we or others retell it,'

(119) *fthé zmarwre zane nzenme kar mrmren thd moreheaden*
fthé z\mar/wre zane nzenme kar mrmr=en
when 2PL>3SG.F:IMP:IPFV\see DEM:PROX 1NSG.POSS village inside=LOC
thd morehead=en
middle PLN=LOC
'you just need to look inside our village, in the middle of Morehead.'

(120) *nimame krenafthmé thd moreheaden kar mane erä*
nima=me krä\nafthm/é thd morehead=en kar mane
like_this=INS 1SG:IRR:PFV\speak middle PLN=LOC village which
e\rä/
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'I can tell you, in the middle of Morehead, those are the villages (where people came from).'

(121) *ni woga tüfrmäre nrä*
ni woga tüfr=mär n\rä/
1NSG man plenty=PRIV 1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'We are not many people,'

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(122) *bänema nzenme thden ane fof kwakwirm woga finzo finzo kwafnzrmth*
bäne=ma nzenme thd=en ane fof kwa\kwir/m woga
PH=CHAR 1NSG.POSS middle=LOC DEM EMPH SG:PST:DUR\run man
fi=nzo fi=nzo kwa\fn/nzrmth
3.ABS=ONLY 3.ABS=ONLY 2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit
'because this happened in our midst. People killed each other.'

(123) *nä kar wogané nä kar thwemiyarth*
nä kar woga=é nä kar thwä\miyar/th
INDF village man=ERG.NSG INDF village 2|3PL>2|3PL:ITER\fetch
'One group of villagers attacked other villages,'

(124) *nä kar wogané nä kar woga thwemiyarth*
nä kar woga=é nä kar woga thwä\miyar/th
INDF village man=ERG.NSG INDF village man 2|3PL>2|3PL:ITER\fetch
'and again another group of villagers attacked other villagers.'

(125) *okay, ni nimame fof ŋafiyokwake*
okay ni nima=me fof ŋa\fiyok/wake
okay 1NSG like_this=INS EMPH 1PL:PST:IPFV\make
'Okay, that is what we have done.'

(126) *nzenme mrmren nima fof ŋakwira yam*
nzenme mrmr=en nima fof ŋa\kwir/a yam
1NSG.POSS inside=LOC like_this EMPH SG:PST:IPFV\run custom
'This custom was common with us.'

(127) *anema kabekaräsü ni nrera ni mrnmäwä nrera*
ane=ma kabe=karä=sü ni n\rä/ra ni
DEM=CHAR man=PROP=ETC 1NSG 1PL:PST:IPFV\be 1NSG
mrn=ma=wä n\rä/ra
family=CHAR=EMPH 1PL:PST:IPFV\be
'We were part of that. We come from that clan.'

(128) *firran mane thäkwrath woga fi fefe zäbthath*
firra=en mane thä\kwr/ath woga fi fefe
PLN=LOC which 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit man 3.ABS really
zä\bth/ath
2|3PL:PST:PFV\finish
'The Firra headhunt really finished off these other clans.'

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(129) *nafane story nimame firraŋane fof rä brä*
nafane story nima=me firra=ane fof \rä/
3SG.POSS story like_this=INS PLN=POSS.SG EMPH 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
b=\rä/
MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'This is the story about the Firra headhunt.'

(130) *nä keke mane fä sathfära ninzo fefe nznethfära*
nä keke mane fä sa\thfär/a ni=nzo fefe
INDF NEG which DIST 3SG.M:PST:PFV\jump 1NSG=ONLY really
nznä\thfär/a
1PL:PST:PFV\jump
'Nobody could escape there, only we could escape.'

(131) *yasiane family zena znrä*
yasi=ane family zena z=n\rä/
PN=POSS.SG family today PROX=1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'From Yasi's family to us today.'

(132) *ni yasiane mrnma*
ni yasi=ane mrn=ma
1NSG PN=POSS.SG family=CHAR
'We are from Yasi's family.'

(133) *nge nafane*
nge nafane
child 3SG.POSS
'(We are) his children.'

(134) *nima ni nafane ane badabadama fof nrä*
nima ni nafane badabada=ma fof n\rä/
like_this 1NSG 3SG.POSS ancestor=CHAR EMPH 1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'We go back to his ancestors.'

(135) *nzenme mrn mrmren z monme miyatha ŋakwir*
nzenme mrn mrmr=en z mon=me miyatha
1NSG.POSS family inside=LOC IAM how=INS knowledge
ŋa\kwir/
2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\run
'We know about this in our family.'

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(136) *gadmewä fi zbo komnzo ämrna karbu ote*
gadmöwä fi zbo komnzo ä\m/rna karbu ote
thanks 3.ABS PROX:ALL only 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\sit PN PN
'Fortunately, Ote and Karémbu had stayed here.'

(137) *firranzo bä bthrarärm mane fthé z thräkwrmth fobo fof*
firra=nzo bä b=thra\rä/rm mane fthé z
PLN=ONLY MED MED=2|3PL:IRR:DUR\be which when IAM
thrä\kwr/mth fobo fof
2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV:DUR\hit DIST:ALL EMPH
'If they had been there at Firra, they would have been killed too,'

(138) *keke kwa ni tüfr nzrarärm*
keke kwa ni tüfr nzra\rä/rm
NEG FUT 1NSG plenty 1PL:IRR:DUR\be
'and we would not be many people today.'

(139) *fi mon zbo ämrna yasif ane fof fam thnra*
fi mon zbo ä\m/rna yasi=f ane fof fam
3.ABS how PROX:ALL 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\sit PN=ERG.SG DEM EMPH thought
thn\r/a
SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\do
'Because those two were staying here, Yasi thought of them,'

(140) *nafanemäwä mrn fof*
nafane=ma=wä mrn fof
3SG.POSS=CHAR=EMPH family EMPH
'really his own clan,'

(141) *watik zänbrima fi zanmatha*
wati zän\brim/a fi zan\math/a
then SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return 3.ABS SG:PST:PFV:VENT\run
'he came back, he ran really.'

(142) *nzone ŋafe näbinzo finzo*
nzone ŋafe näbi=nzo fi=nzo
1SG.POSS father one=ONLY 3.ABS=ONLY
'My father was the only (son).'

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(143) *fobo fof wythik ane zokwasi fof firra ebarma*
fobo fof wa\ythk/ ane zokwasi fof firra
DIST:ALL EMPH 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\come_to_end DEM speech EMPH PLN
ebar=ma
head=CHAR
'The story of the Firra's headhunt ends here.'

(144) *keke zanfrme rä*
keke zanfr=me \rä/
NEG long=INS 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'It is not a long story.'

(145) *fobo komnzo zänbtha fof*
fobo komnzo zän\bth/a fof
DIST:ALL only 2|3SG:PST:PFV:VENT\finish EMPH
'At that time it ended'

(146) *nima kerkeren efothen zfwiyakm monwä z nznanafthmé*
nima kerker=en efoth=en zf\yak/m mon=wä z
like_this tail=LOC day=LOC 3SG.F:PST:DUR\walk how=EMPH IAM
nz=na\nafthm/é
IPST=1SG>2SG.IO:RPST:PFV\talk
'in the last days (of headhunting). Like I just told you.'

(147) *kerker efothen zfwiyakm*
kerker efoth=en zf\yak/m
tail day=LOC 3SG.F:PST:DUR\walk
'This happened in the last days (of headhunting).'

(148) *fthé fefe markai zänthba we mizi zänthbath*
fthé fefe markai zän\thb/a we mizi
when really outsider SG:PST:PFV:VENT\enter also pastor
zän\thb/ath
2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\enter
'This happened when the white man came and also when the missionaries arrived.'

(149) *fobo fof wythka*
fobo fof wa\ythk/a ebar zan
DIST:ALL EMPH 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\come_to_end head fight
'After that, the headhunting ended.'

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(150) *fthé dibura fathasi thethkäfath mafa ane woga thufnzrmth nimame*
fthé dibura fatha-si thä\thkäf/ath mafa ane
when prison hold-NMLZ 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\start who.ERG.NSG DEM
woga thu\fn/nzrmth nima=me
man 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit like_this=INS
'They started throwing people in prison who had killed someone.'

(151) *fobo fof zuwythk ane zokwasi*
fobo fof zwa\ythk/ ane zokwasi
DIST:ALL EMPH 3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\come_to_end DEM speech
'This story is now over.'

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# 7 *Faw brigsi* - The revenge attack

## 7.1 Introduction

*Faw brigsi* is narrative lasting roughly 10min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on November 19th 2011, in both audio and video formats.[1] The story teller is Abia Bai, and the recording took place outside his house at Rouku village. Abia proposed to tell this story prompted by the transcription of the story about the headhunting raid at Firra (cf. §6). The headhunters in the story come from the lineage of his grandfather and great-grandfather from the Masu-Mayawa clan.

## 7.2 Summary & background

The story is about a headhunt that took place in the village of *Téndöfi*. The raid was revenge for an earlier attack on the village of *Firra*, in which most of the inhabitants of *Firra* were killed. Some of the survivors of the Mayawa clan joined forces with the inhabitants of *Masu*, *Mongarkam* and *Fethkakar* and led the revenge campaign. The protagonists are Yasi and Ote.

The headhunters travel to *Tämnzüfi*, which is located on the opposite side of the Morehead River. They perform a ritual to ensure that their victims are unaware of the impending attack and go to sleep.

One of the headhunters has relatives in *Téndöfi*. He goes to the village and warns his exchange man and his family. After his return, the attackers wait until nightfall, then cross the river and surround the village. They enter the village and kill most of the inhabitants. Yasi and Ote fight with a young woman who is trying to free herself. Suddenly they realise that the other headhunters have finished their work and have already left the village. They leave the woman behind and follow the others.

On their return, the headhunters are welcomed back to their village by the women, who dance and sing for them. They celebrate the successful raid.

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20111119-01. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5801368

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## 7.3 Parallel text

*namä ezi. zane namä ezi mrmren nzä kwa trikasi ŋatrikwé. tdöfin mane thäkwrath kabe ebar mä ertmakwrath fof. faw wbrigwath firrane zanma fof.*

Good morning! In this nice morning, I will tell the story, how they killed them at *Téndöfi*, where they cut off peoples' heads, and how they took revenge for the attack on *Firra*.

*zanr fthé zathkäfath fam fthé wkurwath. nafa wäfiyoknath ote a yasi. bä ane fam wäfiyoknath tamnzüfi. tamnzüfi mane rä ŋars wazi bä rä forthr fren. fä fof fam wräznath faw brigsir bänema nafanme kabe zfth firran mane thäkwrath fof. srank mane sakwrath. watik, fthé wäfiyoknath nafa nima zr ŋarnath mogarkam. kabe zfth fobo nä thwamnzrm fof. nima wäfiyoknath fethka kar. nä zr fobo zarath fof. nä zbo zf nafanme kabe zfth fefe faremanemedbo. ane zr fthé ŋarnath. watik, kabe zba eyaka bobo bäne tämnzüfi. fä ŋamosinzath. wärzwänzath. monme kwa thräkwrmth fof tdöfin kabe. tdöfin kabe fäth bä mane thwamnzrm fof safsane kabe erera. mafa zr ŋarerath firra ebarr fof. watik, anema fobo fof faw brigsir zathkäfath fof.*

Before the revenge attack, they discussed their plans. Ote and Yasi did that. They planned it in *Tamnzüfi*. *Tamnzüfi* lies on the other side of the river in *Fothér* forest. They agreed on a plan to take revenge on them, to avenge their clan members, who were killed at *Firra*, against those who had killed Srank. They allied themselves with the people of *Mogarkam*. Some of their elders were living there. Likewise with *Fethkakar*, they also became allies. Some of their elders were from the *Farem* people. So they had formed an alliance at that time. All these headhunters gathered at whatchamacallit, at *Tämnzüfi*. They discussed how they would attack the people of *Téndöfi*. A few people living in *Téndöfi* were from *Safés*. It was them who had formed an alliance in the attack on *Firra*. That is reason why they took revenge at *Téndöfi*.

*kabe fä ŋamosinzath tämnzüfin. zäbthath watik zefarath. tämnzüfa zefarath sazäthi. sazäthifa foba zartmath trn zäre. trn zärefa eyaka käs. käsen fä fof ŋamosinzath fof. ŋamothwath kabe yf ane fof efathwath. fr thmthm egarwath wämne. wämne nima egarwath*

So they gathered over there in *Tämnzüfi*. They finished their discussions and got going. They went from *Tämnzüfi* to *Sazäthi*. From *Sazäthi*, they took a shortcut to *Térén Zäre*. From *Térén Zäre* they walked to *Käs*. They gathered in *Käs* and sat closely to-

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*fr. fr thmthm yfkarä. ane kabeane yf nä swägarnzth, ane kabeane yf nä swägarnzth. thäbthath rnzam fobo erera fof boba wazi tdöfin thwamnzrm ŋare ngenge kabe.*

gether collecting the names of their victims. They were breaking small twigs. They broke the twigs like this. They put a name to each twig. For this man's name they broke one twig, and for that man's name they broke another twig. They did this for as many people as lived on the other side of the river in *Téndöfi*, for every woman, for the children and the men.

*nä kabe yara nzenmema zane karma zf faremma. safskarä mafä thäritath fof fi bobo sfrärm tdöfin. wati, naf thärkora "nzone fäms fobo yamnzr. nzone fäms ŋare fobo fof rä. nzä zöbthé kwa wiyak. kwa srantrifé fof fämsn." ŋarsfa foba zabrmako. katan bobo bräro fof käsfa zzagrmär. watik fobo fof gardar sarna fof. gardar yannor. nafafämsf srenkaris "oh, kabe byannor gardar." watik nima yara fof z ŋaroyakwa ane fof tarazü. nabi dunzi fyara fof. nafafäms yanyak fobo fof sremar fof. sukufa srar zi nge fof. nafafämsf mane thwanathrm zba mane yakako fof. zanr mane yakako fof. watik sukufa ane rära zi nge. sukufa srar. sukufa krekar. keke naf nima zära: "sukufa zane zisé zwar. rma zisé zwar?" watik, thrma thamin yafrtha. nima yafrtha noku yam wfänza fof. watik nafafäms fam fthé fof zära nima "zan kabe yé zane."*

There was one man amongst the headhunters who was from our clan, from this village here, from the *Farem* people. He had exchanged wives with the people from *Safés*, and this family was also there in *Téndöfi*. So he told the others: "My exchange man is staying there. My exchange woman is there. I will go ahead. I will tell my exchange man what is going to happen." He followed the riverbank for a short distance. Not far from *Käs*, he called out for the canoe. His exchange man heard him and said "Oh, someone is calling for the canoe." Well, he was already dressed up wearing his headdress. He was carrying his bow and arrow. His exchange man came and he looked at him. He gave his exchange man tobacco, really strong tobacco. He was smoking it first, the one who went from here, the headhunter. It was really strong tobacco. He gave him the tobacco. He puffed it, but he did not understand the sign, and thought "He gave me this strong tobacco. Why did he give me the strong tobacco?" Later he was biting

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his tongue towards his exchange man. He bit on his tongue in an aggressive way. That's when his exchange man got the message "This is a headhunter."

*watik kraritth bern. sukufa ärithr nafathufthnm nafangom karnm ämnzr. watik, fämsf sräkor fäms "fof krarifthe. nzä fof ŋafarkwr fof." nä bana mane erera keke thätrifa nafafämsf. watik, fi nima zefara zyé. zärita. fi miyatha sfrärm nima zanr zane swanyak. kabe emarwr. nafaŋare zräkor "ni krafare!" watik nafafämsf sräkor "watik garda bana kwa srärité. nama we n kränbrimé fof." watik, krarifthth nafafäms zefarako. fi zärita yanyak kabe thrämosir. "oh nima rä, nima rä, nima rä, nima tüfr kabe erä, nima tüfr ŋare erä, nge nge. fäms z zefaro."*

They crossed the river together. He gave tobacco to his in-laws, to his brothers-in-law and they sat down. Then, his exchange told him, "Let's say goodbye. I have to get going now." As for those other poor guys, his exchange man did not tell them what he knew: this one had come for an attack, he came to spy on the people. So he told his wife "We are going to leave!" The exchange man told him: "You go ahead. I will take the old canoe across and I will come back the day after tomorrow." They said goodbye to each other. He went across to meet the other headhunters. He told them "It is like this and like this. There are lots of men, women and children. My exchange man is leaving now."

*watik kafar mane sfrärm. finzo sagathinzath mogarkamma. kabe naf fr thmthm mane erera we nima tätüme thänarnza fof. tätüme thrärnarnz. watik, fi fobo fof swamnzrm. tätü fof bänema tmod ane äfiyokwa fof. tmod ane zräkorth tmatm. keke kwa kräfänir. fof kabe gamokarä ane thänarnzath fof. tätü mä swamnzrm wämne tnz enthärkunzath aneme tätü zanarnzath fof.*

Okay, there was an old man from *Mogarkam*. They left him behind in the camp. He was the one who kept these small twigs and branches under the coconut shell. Someone had to hold down the coconut shell. So he stayed behind. He cast a spell on it called "tmod". The coconut shell must not be moved during this spell. It keeps the victims in check. They brought short pieces of wood and used them to hold the coconut shell in position.

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*fi bana mane thfrärm boba mane erera tdöfin. komnzo etfth etfthnzo thfrugrm. yoganai thfrärm. watik, fi ŋamonegwath, ŋamonegwath e zizi kräkor, z-zbär. srima kabe thräriftht. zöbthé thräriftht. zöbthé fi efrezrth. kar foba zumarwrmth: "oh fä erä, fä erä, fä erä." anemewä kwaritakwrmth. ŋaritakwath zan kabe bramöwä farem. zäbtha watik. kwot kar fthé wkrkwath, wkrkwath, wkrkwath. ktkt zäkora fof. fthé fof thränthor fof. tä tä tä tä thethkäfath. zan efnzath, efnzath, efnzath, efnzath.*

The poor people in *Téndöfi* were fast asleep. They were very tired. The headhunters waited until it was late, until dawn. Then they sent their spies ahead. They approached from the river and spied out the village. They were talking "Okay, these one are there and the other ones are over there." With this knowledge, they crossed the river. The whole group of *Farem* headhunters went across until everyone was there. They surrounded the village and sealed it off. Then the attack began. They shot their arrows and started fighting. They killed everyone of them.

*näbi fobo kafar emoth ausi bana rera fof. oroman ote, oroman yasi nafa zrakothmth, zrakothmth, zrafafth. "oh" kma thrakor "ze bane ŋari wr." "mh, né nzafäkuthe fof. zena zf mr nthkne!" zrafafth. kata bananzo thrafithwonzth. keke zkwrath. mr wthknth. kma zane garsir zfrnmth di kam fof. keke! ŋa kma bana emoth fäth fä nima kma kwafrnzgwrm. anemewä fi nä zan kabe mane erera zä efnzath kabe bramöwä. ritaksi zethkäfath. finzo fä fof. ane kafar emothf thwathofiknm. nima zfzänmth kma traksir n zfrnmth di kam garsir "awkt ngemäku, kabe matak erä! z nzngathinzth!" wgathiknath fobo fof. frknzo zwanorm. grr kwannzo fobo zwanorm zba mrfa fof. kramaththberna "ai!" waro kwan thrarn fof. foba thranyafth berä. gardakarä fobo fof eyan. ŋaritakwrth. "mon?" "zrkä komnzo zgathinze fof. zane bökwan z zrtme*

There was one young woman there. Old man Ote and Yasi chased her. They chased and grabbed her. She tried to tell them: "Oh, I am one of your sisters." They replied "Oh, we'll take good care of you! We'll break your neck now!" They held her tight and pulled out their bamboo knives. But they did not manage to kill her. They just cut the neck. They tried to break this neck bone here. They didn't succeed and the poor girl was struggling to free herself. Meanwhile, the other headhunters had killed all the other villagers. They started to cross the river again. Only that girl was still fighting with the two men. They threw her to the ground trying to break her neck, when one of them realized "Oh brother, everyone's gone! They've left us behind." They let go of the girl. She was bleeding badly and

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*katame. komnzo bŋatäriwr."*

gurgling from her throat. The two ran away. "Hey!" They gave a signal and the others answered them. They were on the other side of the river with the canoe. They came across asking "What happened?" They replied "We left her half dead. We cut her throat with the bamboo knife. She'll just die up there."

*ŋafsinzth "oh nima tüfr thänkwre. tüfrmär thfrä. nzenme tüfr thäkwrath." erugr, ewäkwr. buay, äniyak, äniyak sazäthi. äniyak mdüfi. fä fof wath thräntrifth, ebar wath. "eh" ausiausiyé badayé foba krekaristh "z thänkwrth. zännor!"*

Then they took stock: "Oh, we killed so and so many of them, not many. But they also killed some of us." They slept and woke up in the morning. They rushed off and came to *Sazäthi*. Next, they came to *Méndüfi*. This is where they started singing a head-hunting song. "Hey", the old women and the grandmothers heard them and said "They've already killed them. Now they're coming back singing."

*ausiausi ŋafyenwrth, kafarkafar nä. nafa krethkäfth. fthé kwamnzokwrmth zzarkarä. krethkäfth fi benrä ebarkarä. anemewä thränthor. watik ebar ane fof zzarfo threthkäfth bäne fof thorsi. ekarkwrth. thräbthth. watik ŋamsakwath. fof kwathwekwrmth. kafar brubru sufnzrmth. "oh" zba zf thwarizrmth "z thänkwrth. thäkwrth fof farem fethkar mogarkam." watik, nezä fobo fof zan wythka fof.*

The women and some old grannies stood in a row. They started jumping up and down. They held their fish nets. As the men approached the village, they held up the heads of their victims. They threw the heads into the fish nets. They took the fish nets to the old people and they finished the ritual. Then they sat down and enjoyed themselves. They were beating the big drums to let everyone know. When people heard this, they said "They've killed them already. The *Farem* people, the *Fethkakar* people and the *Mogarkam* people killed them." That was the end of the revenge.

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*watik, zanma trikasi tdöfin mane thäkwrath faremma, zbo zf zwythk. eso kafar benme namä yarizsima.*

Well, the headhunting story has come to an end now, about those people who were killed at *Téndöfi* by the *Farem*. Thank you very much for listening!

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## 7.4 Glossed text

(1) *namä ezi*
namä ezi
good morning
'Good morning!'

(2) *zane namä ezi mrmren nzä kwa trikasi ŋatrikwé*
zane namä ezi mrmr=en nzä kwa trikasi
DEM:PROX good morning inside=LOC 1SG.ABS FUT story
ŋa\trik/wé
1SG:NPST:IPFV\tell
'In this nice morning, I will tell the story,'

(3) *tdöfin mane thäkwrath kabe ebar mä ertmakwrath fof*
tdöfi=en mane thä\kwr/ath kabe ebar mä
PLN=LOC which 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit man head where
e\rtmak/wrath fof
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\cut EMPH
'how they killed them at Téndöfi, where they cut off peoples' heads,'

(4) *faw wbrigwath firrane zanma fof*
faw w\brig/wath firra=ane zan=ma fof
payment 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\return PLN=POSS.SG fight=CHAR EMPH
'and how they took revenge for the attack on Firra village.'

(5) *zanr fthé zathkäfath fam fthé wkurwath*
zan=r fthé za\thkäf/ath fam fthé
fight=PURP when 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\start thought when
w\kur/wath
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\split
'They discussed their plans before the revenge attack.'

(6) *nafa wäfiyoknath ote a yasi*
nafa wä\fiyok/nath ote a yasi
3NSG.ERG 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make PN and PN
'Ote and Yasi did that.'

(7) *bä ane fam wäfiyoknath tamnzüfi*

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bä ane fam wä\fiyok/nath tamnzüfi
MED DEM thought 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make PLN
'They planned it in Tamnzüfi.'

(8) *tamnzüfi mane rä ŋars wazi bä rä forthr fren*
tamnzüfi mane \rä/ ŋars wazi bä \rä/
PLN which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be river side MED 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
forthr fr=en
PLN stem=LOC
'Tamnzüfi lies on the other side of the river in the Fothér forest.'

(9) *fä fof fam wräznath faw brigsir bänema*
fä fof fam w\räz/nath faw
DIST EMPH thought 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\erect payment
brig-si=r bäne=ma
return-NMLZ=PURP PH=CHAR
'They agreed on a plan to take revenge on them,'

(10) *nafanme kabe zfth firran mane thäkwrath fof*
nafanme kabe zfth firra=en mane thä\kwr/ath fof
3NSG.POSS man tree_base PLN=LOC which 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit EMPH
'to revenge their clan people, who were killed at Firra,'

(11) *srank mane sakwrath.*
srank mane sa\kwr/ath
PN which 2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\hit
'against those who had killed Srank.'[2]

(12) *watik, fthé wäfiyoknath nafa nima zr ŋarnath mogarkam*
watik fthé wä\fiyok/nath nafa nima zr
then when 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make 3NSG.ERG like_this tooth
ŋa\rn/ath mogarkam
2|3DU:PST:IPFV\do PLN
'When they did so, they allied themselves with (the people of) Mogarkam.'[3]

[2]According to Maraga's headhunting story, Srank escaped the attack.
[3]zr ŋarär is a fixed expression meaning 'ally oneself with' (lit. 'do the teeth').

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(13) *kabe zfth fobo nä thwamnzrm fof*
kabe zfth fobo nä thwa\m/nzrm fof
man tree_base DIST:ALL INDF 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit EMPH
'Some of their elders were living there.'

(14) *nima wäfiyoknath fethka kar*
nima wä\fiyok/nath fethka kar
like_this 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make PLN village
'Likewise with Fethkakar,'

(15) *nä zr fobo zarath fof*
nä zr fobo za\r/ath fof
INDF tooth DIST:ALL 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\do EMPH
'they also allied themselves with them,'

(16) *nä zbo zf nafanme kabe zfth fefe faremanemedbo*
nä zbo zf nafanme kabe zfth fefe
INDF PROX:ALL ABSC 3NSG.POSS man tree_base really
farem=ane=medbo
PLN=POSS.SG=ALL.ANIM.NSG
'some came from here, some of their elders were from the Farem people.'

(17) *ane zr fthé ŋarnath*
ane zr fthé ŋa\rn/ath
DEM tooth when 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\do
'So they had formed an alliance at that time.'

(18) *watik, kabe zba eyaka bobo bäne tämnzüfi*
watik kabe zba e\yak/a bobo bäne tämnzüfi
then man PROX:ABL 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\walk MED:ALL PH.ABS PLN
'Next the headhunters walked from here to whatchamacallit, to Tämnzüfi.'

(19) *fä ŋamosinzath wärzwänzath*
fä ŋa\mosi/nzath wä\rzwä/nzath
DIST 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\gather 2|3PL>3SG.F.IO:PST:IPFV\discuss
'They gathered there and discussed things,'

(20) *monme kwa thräkwrmth fof tdöfin kabe*

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mon=me kwa thrä\kwr/mth fof tdöfi=en kabe
how=INS FUT 2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV:DUR\hit EMPH PLN=LOC people
'how they will attack the people of Téndöfi.'

(21) *tdöfin kabe fäth bä mane thwamnzrm fof safsane kabe erera*
tdöfi=en kabe fäth bä mane thwa\m/nzrm fof safs=ane
PLN=LOC man DIM MED which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit EMPH PLN=POSS.SG
kabe e\rä/ra
people 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be
'A few people living in Téndöfi were from Safés.'

(22) *mafa zr ŋarerath firra ebarr fof*
mafa zr ŋa\rä/rath firra ebar=r fof
who.ERG.NSG tooth 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\do PLN head=PURP EMPH
'They had formed an alliance in the attack on Firra.'

(23) *watik, anema fobo fof faw brigsir zathkäfath fof*
watik ane=ma fobo fof faw brig-si=r
then DEM=CHAR DIST:ALL EMPH payment return-NMLZ=PURP
za\thkäf/ath fof
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\start EMPH
'This is really why they started the revenge there (in Téndöfi).'

(24) *kabe fä ŋamosinzath tämnzüfin*
kabe fä ŋa\mosi/nzath tämnzüfi=en
man DIST 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\gather PLN=LOC
'So they gathered over there in Tämnzüfi.'

(25) *zäbthath watik zefarath*
zä\bth/ath watik ze\far/ath
2|3PL:PST:PFV\finish then 2|3PL:PST:PFV\set_off
'They finished (their discussions) and got going.'

(26) *tämnzüfa zefarath sazäthi*
tämnzüfi=fa ze\far/ath sazäthi
PLN=ABL 2|3PL:PST:PFV\set_off PLN
'They went from Tämnzüfi to Sazäthi.'

(27) *sazäthifa foba zartmath trn zäre*

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sazäthi=fa foba za\rtm/ath trn_zäre
PLN=ABL DIST:ABL 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\cut PLN
'From Sazäthi, they took a shortcut to Térén Zäre.'

(28) *trn zärefa eyaka käs*
trn_zäre=fa e\yak/a käs
PLN=ABL 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\walk PLN
'From Térén Zäre they walked to Käs.'

(29) *käsen fä fof ŋamosinzath fof*
käs=en fä fof ŋa\mosi/nzath fof
PLN=LOC DIST EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\gather EMPH
'They gathered in Käs'

(30) *ŋamothwath kabe yf ane fof efathwath*
ŋa\moth/wath kabe yf ane fof
2|3PL:PST:IPFV\sit_together people name DEM EMPH
e\fath/wath
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hold
'and sat closely together calling out the names (of their victims).'

(31) *fr thmthm egarwath wämne*
fr thm~thm e\gar/wath wämne
post REDUP~nose 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\break tree
'They were breaking small sticks,'

(32) *wämne nima egarwath fr*
wämne nima e\gar/wath fr
tree like_this 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\break post
'they broke the stick like this,'

(33) *fr thmthm yfkarä*
fr thm~thm yf=karä
post REDUP~nose name=PROP
'and they put a name to each little twig.'

(34) *ane kabeane yf nä swägarnzth ane kabeane yf nä swägarnzth*

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ane kabe=ane yf nä swä\gar/nzth ane
DEM man=POSS.SG name INDF 2|3PL>3SG.M.IO:NPST:IPFV\break DEM
kabe=ane yf nä swä\gar/nzth
man=POSS.SG name INDF 2|3PL>3SG.M.IO:NPST:IPFV\break
'For this man's name they broke one stick, and for that man's name they broke another stick.'

(35) *thäbthath rnzam fobo erera fof boba wazi tdöfin thwamnzrm ŋare ngenge kabe*
thä\bth/ath rnzam fobo e\rä/ra fof
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\finish how_many DIST:ALL 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be EMPH
boba wazi tdöfi=en thwa\m/nzrm ŋare nge~nge kabe
MED:ABL side PLN=LOC 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit woman REDUP~child man
'They did this for as many people as lived on the other side of the river in Téndöfi, for every woman, for the children and for the men.'

(36) *nä kabe yara nzenmema zane karma zf faremma*
nä kabe ya\r/a nzenme=ma zane kar=ma
INDF man 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be 1NSG.POSS=CHAR DEM:PROX village=CHAR
zf farem=ma
ABSC PLN=CHAR
'But there was one man (amongst the headhunters) who was from our clan, from this village here, from the Farem people.'

(37) *safskarä mafä thäritath fof fi bobo sfrärm tdöfin*
safs kar=ä mafä thä\rit/ath fof fi
PLN village=ASSOC who.ASSOC.PL 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\cross EMPH 3.ABS
bobo sf\rä/rm tdöfi=en
MED:ALL 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be PLN=LOC
'He had exchanged wives with the people from Safés, and (this family) was also there in Téndöfi.'

(38) *wati, naf thärkora "nzone fäms fobo yamnzr*
wati naf thär\kor/a nzone fäms fobo
then 3SG.ERG SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\speak 1SG.POSS exchange DIST:ALL
ya\m/nzr
3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\sit
'So he told the others: "My exchange man is staying there.'

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(39) *nzone fäms ŋare fobo fof rä*
nzone fäms ŋare fobo fof \rä/
1SG.POSS exchange woman DIST:ALL EMPH 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'My exchange woman is also there.'

(40) *nzä zöbthé kwa wiyak*
nzä zöbthé kwa w\yak/
1SG.ABS first FUT 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk
'I will go ahead.'

(41) *kwa srantrifé fof fämsn"*
kwa sran\trif/é fof fäms=n
FUT 1SG>3SG.M.IO:IRR:PFV:VENT\tell EMPH exchange=DAT.SG
'I will tell my exchange man (what's coming)."'

(42) *ŋarsfa foba zabrmako katan bobo bräro fof*
ŋars=fa foba za\bram/ako katan bobo
river=ABL DIST:ABL SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV:AND\follow small MED:ALL
b=\rä/ro fof
MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:AND\be EMPH
'He followed the riverbank for a short distance,'

(43) *käsfa zzagrmär*
käs=fa z~zagr=mär
PLN=ABL REDUP~far=PRIV
'not far from Käs.'

(44) *watik fobo fof gardar sarna fof*
watik fobo fof garda=r sa\rn/a fof
then DIST:ALL EMPH canoe=PURP 3SG.M:PST:PFV\shout EMPH
'Then he called out for the canoe.'

(45) *gardar yannor nafafämsf srenkaris "oh kabe byannor gardar"*
garda=r yan\nor/ nafa-fäms=f
canoe=PURP 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\shout 3.POSS-exchange=ERG.SG
sren\karis/ oh kabe
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV:VENT\hear oh man
b=yan\nor/ garda=r
MED=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\shout canoe=PURP
'As he was calling for the canoe, his exchange man heard him (and said) "Oh, someone is calling for the canoe."'

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(46) *watik nima yara fof*
watik nima ya\r/a fof
then like_this 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be EMPH
'Well, he looked like this,'

(47) *z ŋaroyakwa ane fof tarazü*
z ŋa\royak/wa ane fof tarazü
IAM SG:PST:IPFV\dress DEM EMPH headdress
'he was already dressed up wearing his headdress'

(48) *nabi dunzi fyara fof*
nabi dunzi f=ya\r/a fof
bow arrow DIST=3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be EMPH
'and he was carrying his bow and arrow.'

(49) *nafafäms yanyak fobo fof sremar fof*
nafa-fäms yan\yak/ fobo fof
3.POSS-exchange 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come DIST:ALL EMPH
sre\mar/ fof
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\see EMPH
'His exchange man came and he looked at him.'

(50) *sukufa srar zi nge fof*
sukufa sra\r/ zi nge fof
tobacco 2|3SG>3SG.M.IO:IRR:PFV\give pain child EMPH
'He gave him tobacco, really strong tobacco.'[4]

(51) *nafafämsf mane thwanathrm zba mane yakako fof*
nafa-fäms=f mane thwa\na/thrm zba mane
3.POSS-exchange=ERG.SG which SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\eat PROX:ABL which
\yak/ako fof
3SG.M:PST:IPFV:AND\walk EMPH
'His exchange man was smoking it first, the one who went from here,'

(52) *zanr mane yakako fof*
zan=r mane \yak/ako fof
fight=PURP which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:AND\walk EMPH
'the one who had come for killing them.'

[4] zi nge 'child of pain' is a metaphor for strong tobacco.

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(53) *watik sukufa ane rära zi nge*
watik sukufa ane \rä/ra zi nge
then tobacco DEM 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be pain child
'Anyway, it was really strong tobacco.'

(54) *sukufa srar sukufa krekar*
sukufa sra\r/ sukufa kre\kar/
tobacco 2|3SG>3SG.M.IO:IRR:PFV\give tobacco 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\pull
'He gave him the tobacco and he puffed it.'

(55) *keke naf nima zära "sukufa zane zisé zwar. rma zisé zwar?"*
keke naf nima zä\r/a sukufa zane zisé
NEG 3SG.ERG like_this SG:PST:PFV\do tobacco DEM:PROX painful
zwa\r/ rma zisé zwa\r/
2|3SG>1SG.IO:RPST:PFV\give why painful 2|3SG>1SG.IO:RPST:PFV\give
'But he did not understand (the sign), and (thought) "He gave me this strong tobacco. Why did he give me the strong tobacco?"'[5]

(56) *watik, thrma thamin yafrtha*
watik thrma thamin ya\fr/tha
then later tongue SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:IPFV\bite
'Later he was biting his tongue towards him.'[6]

(57) *nima yafrtha noku yam wfänza fof*
nima ya\fr/tha noku yam
like_this SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:IPFV\bite anger event
w\fä/nza fof
SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\present EMPH
'He bit (on his tongue) in an aggressive way.'

(58) *watik nafafäms fam fthé fof zära nima "zan kabe yé zane"*
watik nafa-fäms fam fthé fof zä\r/a nima zan
then 3.POSS-exchange thought when EMPH SG:PST:PFV\do like_this fight
kabe \yé/ zane
man 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be DEM:PROX
'That's when his exchange man understood the message and thought "This is a headhunter."'

[5]The strong tobacco was meant as a warning message.
[6]As another warning sign.

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(59) *watik kraritth bern*
watik kra\rit/th b=e\rn/
then 2|3DU:IRR:PFV\cross MED=2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\be
'They crossed the river there.'

(60) *sukufa ärithr nafathufthnm nafangom karnm ämnzr*
sukufa ä\ri/thr nafa-thufth=nm
tobacco 2|3SG>2|3PL.IO:NPST:IPFV\give 3.POSS-in_law=DAT.NSG
nafa-ngom kar=nm ä\m/nzr
3.POSS-brother_in_law place=DAT.NSG 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit
'He gave tobacco to his in-laws, to his brothers-in-law and they sat down.'

(61) *watik, fämsf sräkor fäms "fof krarifthe*
watik fäms=f srä\kor/ fäms fof
then exchange=ERG.SG 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\speak exchange EMPH
kra\rifth/e
1DU:IRR:IPFV\send
'Then, his exchange told him, "Let's say goodbye.'

(62) *nzä fof ŋafarkwr fof"*
nzä fof ŋa\fark/wé fof
1SG.ABS EMPH 1SG:NPST:IPFV\set_off EMPH
'I will set off now."'

(63) *nä bana mane erera keke thätrifa nafafämsf*
nä bana mane e\rä/ra keke thä\trif/a
INDF pitiful which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be NEG SG>2|3PL.IO:PST:PFV\tell
nafa-fäms=f
3.POSS-exchange=ERG.SG
'As for those other poor guys, his exchange man did not tell them.'

(64) *watik, fi nima zefara zyé*
watik fi nima ze\far/a z=\yé/
then 3.ABS like_this SG:PST:PFV\set_off PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'Then he left like this,'

(65) *zärita*
zä\rit/a
2|3SG:PST:PFV\cross
'he crossed the river.'

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(66) *fi miyatha sfrärm nima zanr zane swanyak*
fi miyatha sf\rä/rm nima zan=r zane
3.ABS knowledge 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be like_this fight=PURP DEM:PROX
swan\yak/
3SG.M:RPST:IPFV:VENT\come
'But he knew that this one had come for an attack.'

(67) *kabe emarwr*
kabe e\mar/wr
people 2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\see
'He was spying on the people.'

(68) *nafaŋare zräkor "ni krafare"*
nafa-ŋare zrä\kor/ ni kra\far/e
3.POSS-wife 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\speak 1NSG 1DU:IRR:PFV\set_off
'So he told his wife "We are going to leave!"'

(69) *watik nafafämsf sräkor watik garda bana kwa srärité*
watik nafa-fäms=f srä\kor/ watik garda
then 3.POSS-exchange=ERG.SG 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\speak then canoe
bana kwa srä\rit/é
pitiful FUT 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\cross
'The exchange man told him: "I will take the old canoe across and'

(70) *nama we n kränbrimé fof*
nama we n krän\brim/é fof
two_days_away also IMN 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\return EMPH
'I will come back the day after tomorrow."'

(71) *watik, krarifthth nafafäms zefarako*
watik kra\rifth/th nafa-fäms ze\far/ako
then 2|3DU:IRR:PFV\send 3.POSS-exchange SG:PST:PFV:AND\set_off
'They said goodbye to each other and his exchange man left.'

(72) *fi zärita yanyak kabe thrämosir*
fi zä\rit/a yan\yak/ kabe
3.ABS 2|3SG:PST:PFV\cross 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come people
thrä\mosi/r
2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\gather
'He went across and met the other headhunters.'

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(73) *“o nima rä nima rä nima rä nima tüfr kabe erä, nima tüfr ŋare erä nge nge*
o nima \rä/ nima \rä/ nima
or like_this 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be like_this 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be like_this
\rä/ nima tüfr kabe e\rä/ nima
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be like_this plenty man 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be like_this
tüfr ŋare e\rä/ nge~nge
plenty woman 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be REDUP~child
‘(He told tem) “It is like this and like this. There are lots of men, women and children.’

(74) *fäms z zefaro”*
fäms z ze\far/o
exchange IAM SG:RPST:PFV:AND\set_off
‘My exchange man left already.”’

(75) *watik kafar mane sfrärm finzo sagathinzath mogarkamma*
watik kafar mane sf\rä/rm fi=nzo
then big which 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be 3.ABS=ONLY
sa\gathinz/ath mogarkam=ma
2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\leave PLN=CHAR
‘Okay, there was an old man from Mongarkam. They left only him behind (in the camp).’

(76) *kabe naf fr thmthm mane erera we nima tätüme thänarnza fof*
kabe naf fr thm~thm mane e\rä/ra we nima
man 3SG.ERG post REDUP~nose which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be also like_this
tätü=me thä\nar/nza fof
coconut_shell=INS SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\press_down EMPH
‘He was the one who kept these small branches covered with a coconut shell.’[7]

(77) *tätüme thrärnarnz watik, fi fobo fof swamnzrm*
tätü=me thrär\nar/nz watik fi fobo
coconut_shell=INS SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\press_down then 3.ABS DIST:ALL
fof swa\m/nzrm
EMPH 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit
‘He had to push down the coconut shell. So he stayed behind.’

[7]This ensures that the victims remain in the dark about their impending fate.

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(78) *tätü fof bänema tmod ane äfiyokwa fof*
tätü fof bäne=ma tmod ane ä\fiyok/wa fof
coconut_shell EMPH PH=CHAR spell DEM SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\make EMPH
'Using a coconut shell, he bewitched them with this spell.'

(79) *tmod ane zräkorth tmatm*
tmod ane zrä\kor/th tmatm
spell DEM 2|3PL>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\speak action
'This action is called tmod.'

(80) *keke kwa kräfänir fof kabe gamokarä ane thänarnzath fof*
keke kwa krä\fänir/ fof kabe gamo=karä ane
NEG FUT 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\shift_place EMPH man spell=PROP DEM
thä\nar/nzath fof
2|3SG:PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\press_down EMPH
'One cannot move (the coconut shell). It keeps (the victims) suppressed with the spell.'

(81) *tätü mä swamnzrm wämne tnz enthärkunzath aneme tätü zanarnzath fof*
tätü mä swa\m/nzrm wämne tnz
coconut_shell where 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit tree short
en\thärku/nzath ane=me tätü
2|3PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\drag DEM=INS coconut_shell
za\nar/nzath fof
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\press_down EMPH
'They brought short sticks and used them to secure the coconut shell in place.'

(82) *fi bana mane thfrärm boba mane erera tdöfin*
fi bana mane thf\rä/rm boba mane e\rä/ra
3.ABS pitiful which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be MED:ABL which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be
tdöfi=en
PLN=LOC
'As for the poor people there, the ones in Téndöfi,'

(83) *komnzo etfth etfthnzo thfrugrm yoganai thfrärm*
komnzo etfth etfth=nzo thf\ru/grm yoganai thf\rä/rm
only sleep sleep=ONLY 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sleep tired 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'they simply slept soundly. They were very tired.'

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(84) *watik, fi ŋamonegwath ŋamonegwath e zizi kräkor zzbär*
watik fi ŋa\moneg/wath ŋa\moneg/wath e zizi
then 3.ABS 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\wait 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\wait until afternoon
krä\kor/ z~zbär
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\become REDUP~night
'So the (headhunters) waited and waited until it got late, until dawn.'

(85) *srima kabe thräriftht zöbthé thräriftht*
srima kabe thrä\rifth/th zöbthé thrä\rifth/th
spy man 2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\send first 2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\send
'They sent out their spies first.'

(86) *zöbthé fi efrezrth*
zöbthé fi e\frez/rth
first 3.ABS 2|3PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\come_up_from_river
'They approached from the river'

(87) *kar foba zumarwrmth*
kar foba zu\mar/wrmth
village DIST:ABL 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR\see
'and spied out the village from there.'

(88) *"o fä erä fä erä fä erä"*
o fä e\rä/ fä e\rä/ fä
or DIST 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be DIST 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be DIST
e\rä/
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'(They were talking:) "Oh, these ones are there and the other ones are there."'

(89) *anemewä kwaritakwrmth ŋaritakwath zan kabe bramöwä farem*
ane=me=wä kwa\ritak/wrmth ŋa\ritak/wath zan kabe
DEM=INS=EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR\cross 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\cross fight man
bramöwä farem
all PLN
'With this (knowledge) they crossed the river. The whole group of headhunters from the Farem crossed over.'

(90) *zäbtha watik*

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zä\bth/a watik
2|3SG:PST:PFV\finish then
'Until everyone was there there.'

(91) *kwot kar fthé wkrkwath wkrkwath wkrkwath ktkt zäkora fof*
kwot kar fthé w\krk/wath
properly village when 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\block
w\krk/wath w\krk/wath ktkt
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\block 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\block tightness
zä\kor/a fof
2|3SG:PST:PFV\become EMPH
'They blocked and blocked and blocked the village until they had sealed it off completely.'

(92) *fthé fof thränthor fof*
fthé fof thrän\thor/ fof
when EMPH 2|3PL:IRR:PFV:VENT\appear EMPH
'That was when the attack began.'

(93) *tä tä tä tä thethkäfath zan efnzath efnzath efnzath efnzath*
tä the\thkäf/ath zan e\fn/zath
banging_sound 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\start fight 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit
e\fn/zath e\fn/zath e\fn/zath
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit
'Bang Bang Bang Bang. They shot their arrows and began to fight. They killed them and killed them.'

(94) *näbi fobo kafar emoth ausi bana rera fof*
näbi fobo kafar emoth ausi bana \rä/ra fof
one DIST:ALL big girl old_woman pitiful 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be EMPH
'There was one older girl there.'

(95) *oroman ote oroman yasi nafa zrakothmth*
oroman ote yasi nafa zra\kothm/th
old_man PN PN 3NSG.ERG 2|3DU>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\chase
'Old man Ote and Yasi chased her.'

(96) *zrakothmth zrafafth*
zra\kothm/th zra\faf/th
2|3DU>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\chase 2|3DU>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\hold
'They chased her down and grabbed her.'

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(97) *"Oh" kma thrakor "ze bane ŋari wr"*
oh kma thra\kor/
oh POT 2|3SG>2|3DU:IRR:PFV\speak
'She tried to tell them: "Oh, I am one of your sisters."'[8]

(98) *"mh né nzafäkuthe fof*
mh n nza\fäkuth/e fof
yes IMN 1PL>2SG:IRR:PFV\take.care EMPH
'(They said) "Oh, we'll take good care of you.'

(99) *zena zf mr nthkne!"*
zena zf mr n\thkn/e
today ABSC neck 1DU>2SG:NPST:IPFV\cut_off
'We'll break your neck now!"'

(100) *zrafafth kata bananzo thrafithwonzth*
zra\faf/th kata bana=nzo
2|3DU>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\hold bamboo_knife pitiful=ONLY
thra\fithwonz/th
2|3DU>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\take_out
'They held her tight and pulled out their bamboo knives.'

(101) *keke zkwrath mr wthknth*
keke z\kwr/ath mr w\thkn/th
NEG 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\hit neck 2|3DU>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\cut_off
'But they did not manage to kill her. They just cut the neck.'

(102) *kma zane garsir zfrnmth di kam fof*
kma zane gar-si=r zf\rn/mth di kam
POT DEM:PROX break-NMLZ=PURP 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:DUR\do neck bone
fof
EMPH
'They tried to break this neck bone here.'

(103) *keke ŋa kma bana emoth fäth fä nima kma kwafrnzgwrm*
keke ŋa kma bana emoth fäth fä nima kma kwa\frnzg/wrm
NEG and POT pitiful girl DIM DIST like_this POT SG:PST:DUR\struggle
'They didn't succeed and the poor girl struggled to free herself.'

[8]She speaks in Wära. A translation to Komnzo would be: "nzä benme ŋare worä."

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(104) *anemewä fi nä zan kabe mane erera zä efnzath kabe bramöwä*
ane=me=wä fi nä zan kabe mane e\rä/ra zä
DEM=INS=EMPH 3.ABS INDF fight man which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be PROX
e\fn/zath kabe bramöwä
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\hit man all
'In the meantime, the other headhunters had killed all the other villagers'

(105) *ritaksi zethkäfath*
ritak-si ze\thkäf/ath
cross-NMLZ 2|3PL:PST:PFV\start
'and they started to cross the river again.'

(106) *finzo fä fof ane kafar emothf thwathofiknm*
fi=nzo fä fof ane kafar emoth=f
3.ABS=ONLY DIST EMPH DEM big girl=ERG.SG
thwa\thofik/nm
SG>2|3DU.IO:PST:DUR\disturb
'Only the big girl was still fighting (with the two men).'

(107) *nima zfzänmth kma traksir n zfrnmth di kam garsir*
nima zf\zä/nmth kma trak-si=r n
like_this 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:DUR\carry POT fall-NMLZ=PURP IMN
zf\rn/mth di kam gar-si=r
2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:DUR\do neck bone break-NMLZ=PURP
'They carried her away and threw her to the ground and tried to break her neck, (when one of them said)'

(108) *"awkt ngemäku, kabe matak erä! z nzngathinzth!"*
awkot ngemäku kabe matak e\rä/ z
oh_no adress_term people nothing 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be IAM
nz=n\gathinz/th
IMM=2|3PL>1DU:NPST:IPFV\leave
"'Oh brother, everyone is gone. They left us behind."'[9]

(109) *wgathiknath fobo fof. frknzo zwanorm. grr kwannzo fobo zwanorm zba mrfa fof*

[9]ngemäku is used as an address term between a biological parent and the person who has adopted a child. Such pairings are often siblings.

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w\gathik/nath fobo fof frk=nzo
2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\leave DIST:ALL EMPH blood=ONLY
zwa\nor/m grr kwan=nzo fobo
3SG.F:PST:DUR\shout gurgling_sound shout=ONLY DIST:ALL
zwa\nor/m zba mr=fa fof
3SG.F:PST:DUR\shout PROX:ABL neck=ABL EMPH
'They left the girl there. She was bleeding badly and gurgling from her throat.'

(110) *kramaththth berna "ai" waro kwan thrarn fof*
kra\math/th b=e\rn/a *** waro kwan
2|3DU:IRR:PFV\run MED=2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be *** fake shout
thra\rn/ fof
2|3DU:IRR:PFV\shout EMPH
'The two guys ran off. "Hey!" They gave a signal.'

(111) *foba thranyafth*
foba thran\yaf/th
DIST:ABL 2|3PL>2|3DU:IRR:PFV:VENT\answer
'The others answered them.'

(112) *berä gardakarä fobo fof eyan*
b=e\rä/ garda=karä fobo fof
MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be canoe=PROP DIST:ALL EMPH
e\yan/
2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\walk
'They were on the other side with the canoe.'

(113) *ŋaritakwrth "mon?"*
ŋa\ritak/wrth mon
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\cross how
'The others crossed the river (and asked) "What happened?"'

(114) *"zrkä komnzo zgathinze fof. zane bökwan z zrtme katame*
zrkä komnzo z\gathinz/e fof zane bökwan z
half only 1DU>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\leave EMPH DEM:PROX throat IAM
z\rtm/e kata=me
1DU>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\cut bamboo_knife=INS
'(They replied) "We left her half dead. We cut her throat with the bamboo knife.'

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(115) *komnzo bŋatäriwr"*
komnzo b=ŋa\täri/wr
only MED=2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\suffer
'She'll just die up there."'

(116) *ŋafsinzth "oh nima tüfr thänkwre tüfrmär thfrä nzenme tüfr thäkwrath"*
ŋa\fsi/nzth oh nima tüfr thän\kwr/e
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\count oh like_this plenty 1PL>2|3PL:RPST:PFV:VENT\hit
tüfr=mär thf\rä/ nzenme tüfr
plenty=PRIV 2|3PL:RPST:IPFV\be 1NSG.POSS plenty
thä\kwr/ath
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit
'Then they took stock: "Oh, we killed so and so many of them, not many. But they killed many of us."'

(117) *erugr ewäkwr*
e\ru/gr e\wäk/wr
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sleep 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\daybreak_on_sb
'They slept and woke up in the morning.'

(118) *buay äniyak äniyak sazäthi*
buay än\yak/ än\yak/
running_away 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come
sazäthi
PLN
'They rushed off and came to Sazäthi.'

(119) *äniyak mdüfi*
än\yak/ mdüfi
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come PLN
'Next, they came to Méndüfi.'

(120) *fä fof wath thräntrifth ebar wath*
fä fof wath thrän\trif/th ebar wath
DIST EMPH dance 2|3PL>2|3PL.IO:IRR:PFV:VENT\tell head dance
'This is where they would sing a headhunting song.'

(121) *"eh" ausiausiyé badayé foba krekaristh*

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eh ausi~ausi=é bada=é foba
hey REDUP~old_woman=ERG.NSG ancestor=ERG.NSG DIST:ABL
kre\karis/th
2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hear
"'Hey", the old women and the grandmothers heard them (and said)'

(122) *"z thänkwrth zännor"*
z thän\kwr/th z=än\nor/
IAM 2|3PL>2|3PL:RPST:PFV:VENT\hit PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\shout
"'They've already killed them. Now they're coming back singing."'

(123) *ausiausi ŋafyenwrth kafarkafar nä*
ausi~ausi ŋa\fyen/wrth kafar~kafar nä
REDUP~old_woman 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\line.up REDUP~big INDF
'The women and some older women stood in a row,'

(124) *nafa krethkäfth fthé kwamnzokwrmth zzarkarä*
nafa kre\thkäf/th fthé kwa\mnzok/wrmth zzar=karä
3NSG.ERG 2|3PL:IRR:PFV\start when 2|3PL:PST:DUR\bounce fish_net=PROP
'and they started jumping up and down holding their fishing nets.'

(125) *krethkäfth fi benrä ebarkarä anemewä thränthor*
kre\thkäf/th fi b=en\rä/ ebar=karä
2|3PL:IRR:PFV\start 3.ABS MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be head=PROP
ane=me=wä thrän\thor/
DEM=INS=EMPH 2|3PL:IRR:PFV:VENT\appear
'The (men) began to approach the village and held the heads'

(126) *watik ebar ane fof zzarfo threthkäfth bäne fof thorsi*
watik ebar ane fof zzar=fo thre\thkäf/th bäne
then head DEM EMPH fish_net=ALL 2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\start PH.ABS
fof thor-si
EMPH enter-NMLZ
'and they began to whats-that, to put the heads in the fishing nets.'

(127) *ekarkwrth thräbthth*
e\kark/wrth thrä\bth/th
2|3PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\take 2|3PL>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\finish
'They took them to the old people and finished (the ritual).'

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(128) *watik ŋamsakwath fof kwathwekwrmth kafar brubru sufnzrmth oh*
watik ŋa\msak/wath fof kwa\thwek/wrmth kafar brubru
then 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\sit EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR\rejoice big drum
su\fn/zrmth oh
2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:DUR\hit oh
'Then they sat down and enjoyed themselves. They beat the big drum (to let everyone know).'

(129) *zba zf thwarizrmth*
zba zf thwa\riz/rmth
PROX:ABL ABSC 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hear
'The people heard this (and said)'

(130) *"z thänkwrth*
z thän\kwr/th
IAM 2|3PL>2|3PL:RPST:PFV:VENT\hit
"'They've killed them already.'

(131) *thäkwrth fof farem fethkar mogarkam"*
thä\kwr/th fof farem fethkar mogarkam
2|3PL>2|3PL:RPST:PFV\hit EMPH PLN PLN PLN
'The Farem people, the Fethka people and the Mongarkam people killed them."'

(132) *watik, nezä fobo fof zan wythka fof*
watik nezä fobo fof zan w\ythk/a fof
then in_return DIST:ALL EMPH fight 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\come_to_end EMPH
'That was the end of the revenge.'

(133) *watik, zanma trikasi tdöfin mane thäkwrath faremma*
watik zan=ma trikasi tdöfi=en mane thä\kwr/ath
then fight=CHAR story PLN=LOC which 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hit
farem=ma
PLN=CHAR
'Well, the headhunting story about those who were killed at Téndöfi by the Farem,'

(134) *zbo zf zwythk*
zbo zf zw\ythk/
PROX:ALL ABSC 3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\come_to_end
'it has come to an end now.'

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(135) *eso kafar benme namä yarizsima*
eso kafar benme namä yariz-si=ma
thanks big 2NSG.POSS good hear-NMLZ=CHAR
'Thank you very much for listening!'

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# 8 *Nzürna trikasi watayan* - The Nzürna story at Wataya forest

## 8.1 Introduction

*Nzürna trikasi watayan* is a recording lasting roughly 6min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on November 19th 2011, in both audio and video.[1] The story teller is Marua Bai. The recording took place in a camp by the Morehead river the vicinity of Rouku village. This recording belongs to the wider genre of *nzürna trikasi* 'Nzürna stories' which are told publicly and can be considered common knowledge. During my fieldwork in Rouku, I was able to record three such stories, but I was told many more. In the following, I will give a kind of Gestalt description of the genre and introduce some of the recurring motifs.

The Nzürna character is a female forest being, often an older woman, with extraordinarily long fingernails and eyelashes, sometimes also earlobes. In many versions, she lives with a husband and with children, but these play only a minor role in the plot. Nzürna can change her appearance into a normal human being of any age and sex. She puts this skill to use in order to trick clueless villagers into deadly traps. The fate of her victims is often quite gruesome: She kills and eats them raw, she plucks out their eyeballs, she decapitates them and carries their heads home, with her long fingernails she rips out their intestines through the anus, and places them somewhere visible to mark the event. These chilling details add to the colourful retellings of Nzürna stories. In fact most stories contain some kind of a warning message: either the poor protagonist was warned not to go alone to these places in the forest, or the audience is directly addressed not to do such foolish things.

Nzürna stories are often imaginative and comical, and both the audience and narrator laugh a lot at certain passages that recur in the stories. For example, the doomed protagonist often tries to escape the Nzürna by hiding under a pile of yams in the storage house. But the Nzürna has the ability to command centipedes

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20111119-06. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189830

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and she sends them to give him painful bites. In another scene towards the end, the Nzürna realizes that the villagers have sealed her fate by setting her house on fire. Trapped inside, she tries in vain to put out the fire by urinating and defecating on the flames getting all burned in her attempts. These parts of the story are often acted out verbally, sometimes even physically, and they usually elicit hysteric laughter from the audience.

In all versions of Nzürna stories that I have heard, she and her family live in the hollow inside of a Wäsü tree (*Ficus elastica*). These 'strangler figs' or 'curtain figs' have a remarkable appearance when fully matured. They are parasitic plants whose seeds are usually carried by birds to a host tree, where they germinate in crevices and develop long arial roots downwards. Strangler figs grow until they fully envelop the host tree, which eventually dies. This creates the characteristic hollow central core, which is described as the entrance to the Nzürna's house. Although most of the stories locate the wäsü tree in a specific place, narrators can never point to the actual tree, because at the end of each story the wäsü tree is burned to the ground by revengeful villagers, thereby killing the Nzürna.

## 8.2 Summary & background

This nzürna story is set at Wataya forest, about 5km East of Rouku. In the plot of the story, a young girl is tricked by the Nzürna, who pretends to be one of her mothers. Realising what is going on, the young girl runs back to the village and meets her father. The father alarms the other villagers. They hide two girls in the yam house covering them with mats and yams. They try to protect them by dancing and drumming around the yam house. During the evening, the Nzürna sneaks around the yam house and makes everyone sleepy by throwing dust in their eyes. Once they sleep, she opens the yam house, kills and eats the girl. The next day, the villagers take revenge. Two sorcerers find the wäsü tree and block the entrance. They pile firewood on the door, set it on fire, and kill the Nzürna.

## 8.3 Parallel text

*okay kwa nathkärwé. nzürna trikasi kwa nathkärwé. kar ane fof rouku. fä fof thwamnzrm boba yabär. yabären watik erugwra, ewäkwa. ttfö nima rä dimsathak. ttfö rsrsir zefarath kabe ausi fäthä. kabe näbi sfrärm eda ŋare-*

Okay, I'll start talking to you now. I will start the Nzürna story for you. The place is *Rouku*. The people were living in *Yambär*. They slept in *Yambär*. There is a creek is at *Dimsathak*. The men and the women went off for

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*karä. nge kafarmär madma nafane zaneme nafaŋamayé berno zöbthé. watik nafaŋafe roukun bobo komnzo swamnzrm. nge thrma kwabragwrmo madma.*

poison root fishing. There was one man who had two wives. The child, a girl, was still young, maybe like this. Her mothers went ahead, while the father stayed in *Rouku*. The girl followed behind.

*fi nzürna ŋare foba wataya fz masun. zba mane rä kafar. foba nima zwanyakm zzarkarä ttfön. katan kofäkofä ŋarufay naf ane thfnfrzrm. wati emoth fäth zba katan zräro. watik fobo fof zamarath fof. foba wsza "awe, ah käntf! ah zanfr z zäkorth! ni zä zf namrn. zane zf kwa ŋafrzne." watik gaso zwathugwrm. kma nima nafaŋame kma zräkor "bobo gniyaké! oh, boba n thanmrinzé!" katan kofäkofä zzarkarä fof nzürna ŋare. watik naf thwanmrinzrm taba. nzürna ŋaref yakme ane thwanathrm. kwafyunzrm mthi. we bräro we nä kanzkanzfo we änmrinza we gwrr gwrr gwrr. naf emoth fäthf zremar "ŋame zane keke rä. nzürna ŋare rä!"*

The Nzürna lived in the big forest of *Wataya* on the *Masu* side. She came this way with her fish net catching fish at the creek, small fish, the ŋarufay fish. She was catching those ones. The small girl was walking past, when they saw each other. The Nzürna called out to her: "Come over! Come here! The others are already far ahead. Let's stay here. We will poison this creek right here." She was deceiving her badly, pretending to be one of her mothers. She said to her "You go over there! Try to chase the fish this way!" The Nzürna caught small fish with her net. She caught them until the fish net was full. The Nzürna ate them up quickly. She gulped down the whole fish. They walked to another bend in the creek. She caught them and again "nom nom nom" she swallowed them. The little girl looked at her and thought "This is not my mother. This is a Nzürna."

*nima zwamägwrmo fz zawe kafar fzfo watayafo. watik zräkor "bobo gniyaké! oh zagrwä." emoth fthé mane wyaka ane bobo nä kanzkanzfo. bad fä fof gwargwar zathkäfa tharisi emoth fäthf. no gabrinzo kwakwirm nzürna*

The Nzürna was leading her further into the forest at *Wataya*. Then she said "You go a bit further over there!" The girl went to another bend in the creek. The girl started digging up the mud in the water. The water that

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*ŋaredbo. watik emoth fäth mane rera ŋakwira. moth.*

flowed towards the Nzürna was completely muddy. The girl quickly ran off towards the road. She got there and ran away.

*zränthor ŋankwira zizi nafaŋafadbo. "ŋafe wonmarwr! nzürna wanmrinzr! nzürna ŋarer nŋafrzne." nafaŋafe ŋankwira. kabe bramöwä thämesako zizi "nima nima nima" ätrikwr a ferä. nafaŋamyé komnzo kwa thufogwrm ttföfo frzsi znfo.*

She arrived at her father's place late in the afternoon. "Father, look at me! The Nzürna is chasing me. I just caught fish together with the Nzürna." Her father brought all the people together. She told them "This happened and then this happened." and so on. Her mothers were still out at the creek, at the netting place.

*watik nafaŋamayé enthorakwa. nafaŋafaf nä ŋare zräkothm. kofä yaregwr nabi zan nabi zan wfnza. we nä zräkothm. nabi zan nabi zan wfnzr. "emoth fäth ane fof efoth bä sfrärm zizi." watik nima sizenzo emoth fäth thrathbth wawa mnzen. tbo mnz bäkfo. thäbu eraknath. watik erdiknath. watik nima ewäthath wawame enarnath yamekarä. zagathinzath.*

Well, when the mothers came back, the father got angry and chased one wife. She was still carrying the fish. He hit her with the bow. Then he chased the other wife, and he also hit her with the bow. He shouted "That little girl was all by herself. It was already getting late!" Then they put two girls of the same age at the back of the yam house. They told them to be very quiet. They twisted the girls' hair and tied them together. They wrapped in mats and covered them with more mats and put yams on top. That's how they left them.

*nzürna z renra. withen zämora. foba thumarwrm. kabe brubru nag ythama tarazü. mnz ane round wäfiyokwath, wath sfrnzürwrmth. "bru bru bru bru bru" nzürna thethkäfa dd wthme. kabe etfth thfmnzerakwrm. kwot zäbthath etfth bra. krenfar. mnz ane wrfunzr. kräthbo thramar "keke nä!" zräkor*

The Nzürna had already arrived. She was leaning against the banana tree. She was watching them from there. The people brought out their drums, grass skirts, and headdresses. They stood around the yam house while dancing and drumming "bru bru bru bru bru" The Nzürna started to throw

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*"zane zf!" erbärn thäbufa. zränthor mnz zrfö. si zramätr neba bök neba bök. fkfa wth yfön gaga thräsryofth. wth thrthr thränmätr. wänathr fä fof. kabe etfth bra. [borsi we fof ŋaborwr?] kabe etfth zäbthath wänatha. watik faren. watik faren wth thrämir. ebarnzo zathora wataya.*

dust at them to make them sleepy. Soon they were exhausted and fell asleep. She went and tore open the yam house. She went inside and looked at the two girls. "Not this one", she said, "but this is the one." She untied their hair and carried one of the girls to the door. As for the other girl, she plucked out one of her eyes and then the other eye. Next she pushed her hand into her arse and ripped out the intestines. Then she ate her intestines. This happened while the people were fast asleep. What are you laughing at? [to someone in the audience] While the people were sleeping, she ate her up. Then she hung the remaining guts on a post. Only the head, she took to back *Wataya*.

*wämne yf bäne wäsi. watik fä fof ŋasoga warfo, nafanemäwä mnzen. nafafisf zamara "oh bä zane kerere z nŋanfiyokwr? kabe z be nyanathr!" nafafis zamatha zba. nä fz bobo rä. tauri kufak fobo fof ŋafäniza wtrime.*

What's the name of that tree? She got to her Wäsi tree. She climbed inside her house. Her husband looked at her and said, "Oh, what trouble have you been in? You have eaten a human again!" The husband took off and ran away. There is another forest over there. He was scared and ran away to *Tauri Kufak*.

*erugr, ewäkr. nima n "matak, emoth ane matak!" wthnzo zemarath faren. kafar bthan kabe ŋawoknzath. zamiyarath müsa. "oh, zä zf wthkgr!" watik bthan kwathkwathme wäsi fur yrerath. mni ŋathomonwath. zbo zfthen zaföfath. ŋarsira, ŋarsira, ŋarsira, ŋarsira, ŋarsira. nima n zremar "eh mni!" yirme kma mni wfraza. keke. wthme*

The next morning, the people woke up and realized what had happened. "She's gone. The girl is gone!" They only saw the guts hanging from the post. They chose their best sorcerers. They went after her until they found the tree. "Oh, she's in here!" Then they wrapped up the wäsi tree with their magic spells. They piled fire-

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*kma wnrtuwonza. keke. kabe ebar ane fof kränzir. mni kma zfrazrm. keke. ŋarsira bra. kräbth wämnekaräsü krärzifth! watik ane kukakuka kma n zarna. watik zrefafth thngthng wrmrwath. bra zäbtha. zokwasi fof zäbth.*

wood at the base and set it on fire. It burned and burned. The Nzürna was looking outside "Oh, there is fire!" She tried to put out the fire by peeing on it, but that didn't work. She tried to spray the fire with her shit, but that didn't work either. She threw the girl's skull to extinguish the fire, but that didn't work. In the end, she burned with the tree and everything else. Eventually the tree fell over. Well, that Kukakuka bird was just about to call out and escape with her, but the sorcerers grabbed it and burned it too. They ground up the charcoal, the last remains of her, until everything was gone. The story is finished now.

*nzürna trikasi nimame fof rä. keke nzürna trikasi rä. kabe trikasi rä zane kabe fefe. watik nzürna trikasir z wkwthenzath. watik fof zäbth.*

That was the Nzürna story. In fact, it is not a Nzürna story, but it's a real story. They changed it into a Nzürna story. Okay, it is finished now.

CD: *z wkwthenzath?*

CD: They changed it?

*kabe zokwasi. aha, nzürna trikasi zarath. zakwthefath. nima bresanema monwä ane rä. emoth katan wänatha. bres monwä zba yanatha. zane kafar yara. ane katan rera, emoth fäth. wataya zba mane rä masu zawe. foba fof renra ane nzürna ŋare.*

A real story, yes, they made it into a Nzürna story. They changed it. It is like the Nzürna story about Bres. The Nzürna ate a small girl just like she ate Bres. That one was an adult, but she was a small child. It happened at *Wataya* here. That Nzürna came from the *Masu* side.

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## 8.4 Glossed text

(1) *okay kwa nathkärwé*
okay kwa na\thkär/wé
okay FUT 1SG>2SG.IO:NPST:IPFV\start
'Okay, I'll start talking to you now.'

(2) *nzürna trikasi kwa nathkärwé*
nzürna trikasi kwa na\thkär/wé
spirit_woman story FUT 1SG>2SG.IO:NPST:IPFV\start
'I will start the Nzürna story for you.'

(3) *kar ane fof rouku*
kar ane fof rouku
place DEM EMPH Rouku
'The place (is) Rouku.'

(4) *fä fof thwamnzrm boba yabär*
fä fof thwa\m/nzrm boba yabär
DIST EMPH 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit MED:ABL PLN
'The people were living in Yambär.'

(5) *yabären watik erugwra ewäkwa*
yabär=en watik e\ru/gwra e\wäk/wa
PLN=LOC then 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\sleep 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\daybreak_on_sb
'They slept in Yambär.'

(6) *ttfö nima rä dimsathak*
ttfö nima \rä/ dimsathak
creek like_this 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN
'There is a creek is at Dimsathak.'

(7) *ttfö rsrsir zefarath kabe ausi fäthä*
ttfö rsr-si=r ze\far/ath kabe
creek poison_root_fishing-NMLZ=PURP 2|3PL:PST:PFV\set_off man
ausi fäth=ä
old_woman DIM=ASSOC
'The men and the women went off for poison root fishing.'

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(8) *kabe näbi sfrärm eda ŋarekarä*
kabe näbi sf\rä/rm eda ŋare=karä
man one 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be two wife=PROP
'There was one man who had two wives.'

(9) *nge kafarmär madma nafane zaneme*
nge kafar=mär madma nafane zane=me
child big=PRIV female 3SG.POSS DEM:PROX=INS
'The child, a girl, was still young, maybe like this.'[2]

(10) *nafaŋamayé berno zöbthé*
nafa-ŋama=é b=e\rn/o zöbthé
3.POSS-mother=ABS.NSG MED=2|3DU:NPST:IPFV:AND\be first
'Her mothers went ahead,'

(11) *watik nafaŋafe roukun bobo komnzo swamnzrm*
watik nafa-ŋafe rouku=en bobo komnzo swa\m/nzrm
then 3.POSS-father PLN=LOC MED:ALL only 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit
'while the father stayed in Rouku.'

(12) *nge thrma kwabragwrmo madma*
nge thrma kwa\brag/wrmo madma
child later SG:PST:DUR:AND\follow female
'The girl followed behind.'

(13) *fi nzürna ŋare foba wataya fz masun zba mane rä kafar*
fi nzürna ŋare foba wataya fz masu=en zba
but spirit_woman woman DIST:ABL PLN forest PLN=LOC PROX:ABL
mane \rä/ kafar
which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be big
'The Nzürna lived in the big forest of Wataya on the Masu side.'

(14) *foba nima zwanyakm zzarkarä ttfön*
foba nima zwan\yak/m zzar=karä=en
DIST:ABL like_this 3SG.F:PST:DUR:VENT\come fish_net=PROP=LOC
'She came this way with her fish net catching fish at the creek,'

[2]He indicates the size of girl with a gesture.

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(15) *katan kofäkofä ŋarufay*
katan kofä~kofä ŋarufay
small REDUP~fish fish_species
'small fish, the ŋarufay fish.'[3]

(16) *naf ane thfnfrzrm*
naf ane thfn\frz/rm
3SG.ERG DEM SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\catch_with_net
'She was catching those ones.'

(17) *wati emoth fäth zba katan zräro*
wati emoth fäth zba katan z=\rä/ro
then girl DIM PROX:ABL small PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'The small girl was walking past,'

(18) *watik fobo fof zamarath fof*
watik fobo fof za\mar/ath fof
then DIST:ALL EMPH 2|3DU:PST:PFV\see EMPH
'when they saw each other.'

(19) *foba wsza "awe ah*
foba w\sz/a awe ah
DIST:ABL SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\call come ah
'The Nzürna called out to her: "Come over!'

(20) *käntf ah zanfr z zäkorth!*
kän\tf/ ah zanfr z zä\kor/th
2SG:IMP:PFV:VENT\walk ah long IAM 2|3PL:RPST:PFV\become
'Come here! The others are already far ahead.'

(21) *ni zä zf namrn*
ni zä zf na\m/rn
1NSG PROX IMM 1DU:NPST:IPFV\sit
'Let's stay here.'

(22) *"zane zf kwa ŋafrzne"*
zane zf kwa ŋa\frz/ne
DEM:PROX IMM FUT 1DU:NPST:IPFV\catch_with_net
'We will poison this (creek) right here."'

[3] ŋarufay "northern purple-spotted gudgeon" (Morgunda Morgunda)

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(23) *watik gaso zwathugwrm*
watik gaso zwa\thug/wrm
then badly SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\trick
'She was deceiving her badly,'

(24) *kma nima nafaŋame kma*
kma nima nafa-ŋame kma
POT like_this 3.POSS-mother POT
'pretending to be one of her mothers.'

(25) *zräkor "bobo gniyaké oh"*
zrä\kor/ bobo gn\yak/é oh
2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\speak MED:ALL 2SG:IMP:IPFV\walk oh
'She said to her "You go over there!'

(26) *"boba n thanmrinzé"*
boba n than\mri/nzé
MED:ABL IMN 2SG>2|3PL:IMP:IPFV:VENT\chase
'Try to chase (the fish) this way!"'

(27) *katan kofäkofä zzarkarä fof nzürna ŋare*
katan kofä~kofä zzar=karä fof nzürna ŋare
small REDUP~fish fish_net=PROP EMPH spirit_woman woman
'The Nzürna caught small fish with her net.'

(28) *watik naf thwanmrinzrm taba*
watik naf thwan\mri/nzrm taba
then 3SG.ERG SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\chase plenty
'She caught them until (the fish net) was full.'

(29) *nzürna ŋaref yakme ane thwanathrm kwafyunzrm mthi*
nzürna ŋare=f yakme ane thwa\na/thrm
spirit_woman woman=ERG.SG quickly DEM SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\eat
kwa\fyu/nzrm mthi
SG:PST:DUR\swallow whole
'The Nzürna ate them up quickly. She gulped down the whole fish.'

(30) *we bräro we nä kanzkanzfo*
we b=\rä/ro we nä kanzkanz=fo
also MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:AND\be also INDF crookedness=ALL
'They walked to another bend in the creek.'

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(31) *we änmrinza we gwrr gwrr gwrr*
we än\mri/nza we gwrr
also SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\chase also sound_of_swallowing
gwrr gwrr
sound_of_swallowing sound_of_swallowing
'She caught them and again "nom nom nom" (she swallowed them).'[4]

(32) *naf emoth fäthf zremar "ŋame zane keke rä*
naf emoth fäth=f zre\mar/ ŋame zane
3SG.ERG girl DIM=ERG.SG 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\see mother DEM:PROX
keke \rä/
NEG 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'The little girl looked at her (and thought) "This is not my mother.'

(33) *nzürna ŋare rä"*
nzürna ŋare \rä/
spirit_woman woman 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'This is a Nzürna"'

(34) *nima zwamägwrmo fz zawe kafar fzfo watayafo*
nima zwa\mäg/wrmo fz zawe kafar fz=fo
like_this SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR:AND\lead forest right big forest=ALL
wataya=fo
PLN=ALL
'The Nzürna was leading her further into the forest at Wataya.'

(35) *watik zräkor "bobo gniyaké oh zagrwä"*
watik zrä\kor/ bobo gn\yak/é oh
then 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\speak MED:ALL 2SG:IMP:IPFV\walk oh
zagr=wä
far=EMPH
'Then she said "You go a bit further over there!"'

(36) *emoth fthé mane wyaka ane bobo nä kanzkanzfo*
emoth fthé mane w\yak/a ane bobo nä
girl when which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\walk DEM MED:ALL INDF
kanzkanz=fo
crookedness=ALL
'The girl went to another bend (in the creek).'

[4] gwrr kwan "sound of swallowing something down"

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(37) *bad fä fof gwargwar zathkäfa tharisi emoth fäthf*
bad fä fof gwargwar za\thkäf/a thari-si emoth
ground DIST EMPH mud SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\start dig-NMLZ girl
fäth=f
DIM=ERG.SG
'The girl started digging up the mud in the water.'

(38) *no gabrinzo kwakwirm nzürna ŋaredbo*
no gabri=nzo kwa\kwir/m nzürna
water muddyness=ONLY SG:PST:DUR\run spirit_woman
ŋare=dbo
woman=ALL.ANIM.SG
'The water that flowed towards the Nzürna was completely muddy.'

(39) *watik emoth fäth mane rera ŋakwira moth*
watik emoth fäth mane \rä/ra ŋa\kwir/a moth
then girl DIM which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be SG:PST:IPFV\run path
'The girl quickly ran off towards the road.'

(40) *zränthor ŋankwira*
zrän\thor/ ŋan\kwir/a
3SG.F:IRR:PFV:VENT\appear 2|3SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\run
'She got there and ran away.'

(41) *zizi nafaŋafadbo*
zizi nafa-ŋafa=dbo
afternoon 3.POSS-father=ALL.ANIM.SG
'She arrived at her father's place in the afternoon.'

(42) *"ŋafe wonmarwr*
ŋafe won\mar/wr
father 2|3SG>1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\see
'"Father, look at me!'

(43) *nzürna wanmrinzr nzürna ŋarer nŋafrzne*
nzürna wan\mri/nzr nzürna
spirit_woman 2|3SG>1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\chase spirit_woman
ŋare=r n=ŋa\frz/ne
woman=ASSOC.DU IPST=1DU:NPST:IPFV\catch_with_net
'The Nzürna is chasing me. I just caught fish together with the Nzürna."'

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(44) *nafaŋafe ŋankwira*
nafa-ŋafe ŋan\kwir/a
3.POSS-father 2|3SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\run
'Her father ran off and'

(45) *kabe bramöwä thämesako zizi*
kabe bramöwä thä\mes/ako zizi
man all SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV:AND\bring afternoon
'brought all the people together in the afternoon.'

(46) *"nima nima nima"*
nima nima nima
like_this like_this like_this
'"This happened and then this happened."'

(47) *ätrikwr a ferä*
ä\trik/wr a f=e\rä/
2|3SG>2|3PL.IO:NPST:IPFV\tell and DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'She told them.'

(48) *nafaŋamyé komnzo kwa thufogwrm ttföfo*
nafa-ŋamy=é komnzo kwa thu\fog/wrm ttfö=fo
3.POSS-mother=ERG.NSG only FUT 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be_away creek=ALL
'Her mothers were still out at the creek,'

(49) *frzsi znfo*
frz-si zn=fo
catch_with_net-NMLZ place=ALL
'at the netting place.'

(50) *watik nafaŋamayé enthorakwa*
watik nafa-ŋama=é en\thorak/wa
then 3.POSS-mother=ERG.NSG 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\appear
'Well, when the mothers came back,'

(51) *nafaŋafaf nä ŋare zräkothm kofä yaregwr nabi zan nabi zan wfnza*
nafa-ŋafa=f nä ŋare zrä\kothm/ kofä
3.POSS-father=ERG.SG INDF wife 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\chase fish
ya\reg/wr nabi zan nabi zan w\fn/za
2SG:NPST:STAT\be_on_sb bow fight bow fight SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\hit
'the father chased one wife. She was still carrying the fish. He hit her with the bow.'

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(52) *we nä zräkothm nabi zan nabi zan wfnzr*
we nä zrä\kothm/ nabi zan nabi zan
also INDF 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\chase bow fight bow fight
w\fn/zr
2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\hit
'Then he chased the other wife, and he also hit her with the bow.'

(53) *"emoth fäth ane fof efoth bä sfrärm zizi"*
emoth fäth ane fof efoth bä sf\rä/rm zizi
girl DIM DEM EMPH sun MED 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be afternoon
'"That little girl (was out alone). It was already getting late in the day."'

(54) *watik nima sizenzo emoth fäth thrathbth wawa mnzen*
watik nima size=nzo emoth fäth thra\thb/th
then like_this size=ONLY girl DIM 2|3PL>2|3DU:IRR:PFV\enter
wawa mnz=en
round_yam house=LOC
'Then they put two girls of the same age in the yam house'

(55) *tbo mnz bäkfo*
tbo mnz bäk=fo
sudden_silence house behind=ALL
'(and told them to be) very quiet at the back of the house.'

(56) *thäbu eraknath watik erdiknath watik nima*
thäbu e\rak/nath watik
hair 2|3DU>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\twist then
e\rdikn/ath watik nima
2|3DU>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\tie_together then like_this
'They twisted the (girls') hair and tied them together.'

(57) *ewäthath*
e\wäth/ath
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\tie_around
'They wrapped them up'

(58) *wawame enarnath yamekarä*
wawa=me e\nar/nath yame=karä
round_yam=INS 2|3PL>2|3DU:PST:IPFV\press_down mat=PROP
'and covered them with mats and put yams on top.'

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(59) *zagathinzath*
za\gathinz/ath
2|3DU:PST:PFV\leave
'That's how they left them.'

(60) *nzürna z renra withen zämora*
nzürna z \rä/nra with=en zä\mor/a
spirit_woman IAM 3SG.F:PST:IPFV:VENT\be banana=LOC SG:PST:PFV\lean
'The Nzürna had already arrived. She leaned against the banana tree.'

(61) *foba thumarwrm*
foba thu\mar/wrm
DIST:ABL SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\see
'She was watching them from there.'

(62) *kabe brubru nag ythama tarazü*
kabe brubru nag ythama tarazü
man drum grassskirt bird_of_paradise headdress
'The people (brought out) their drums, grassskirts, headdresses, etc.'

(63) *mnz ane round wäfiyokwath*
mnz ane round wä\fiyok/wath
house DEM surround 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make
'They surrounded the house'

(64) *wath sfrnzürwrmth*
wath sf\rnzür/wrmth
dance 2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:DUR\dance
'while they were dancing:'

(65) *"bru bru bru bru bru"*
bru bru bru bru
sound_of_drum sound_of_drum sound_of_drum sound_of_drum
bru
sound_of_drum
'"bang bang bang bang bang"'

(66) *nzürna thethkäfa dd wthme*

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nzürna the\thkäf/a dd wth=me
spirit_woman SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\start worm faeces=INS
'The Nzürna began to throw fine soil at them.'[5]

(67) *kabe etfth thfmnzerakwrm*
kabe etfth thf\mnzerak/wrm
man sleep SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\fall_asleep
'She made people sleepy.'

(68) *kwot zäbthath etfth bra*
kwot zä\bth/ath etfth bra
properly 2|3PL:PST:PFV\finish sleep sth_finished
'Until they were done. They fell asleep.'

(69) *krenfar mnz ane wrfunzr*
kren\far/ mnz ane w\rfu/nzr
2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off house DEM 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\pull_off
'She went and tore open the house.'

(70) *kräthbo thramar*
krä\thb/o thra\mar/
SG:IRR:PFV:AND\enter 2|3SG>2|3DU:IRR:PFV\see
'She went inside and looked at the (two girls).'

(71) *"keke nä" zräkor "zane zf"*
keke nä zrä\kor/ zane zf
NEG INDF 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\speak DEM:PROX IMM
'"Not this one", she said, "but this is the one."'

(72) *erbärn thäbufa*
e\rbä/rn thäbu=fa
2|3SG>2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\untie hair=ABL
'She untied their hair and'

(73) *zränthor mnz zrfö*
zrän\thor/ mnz zrfö
2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV:VENT\carry house door
'carried one (of the girls) to the door.'

[5] dd wth 'worm faeces' is the soil thrown up by worms digging in the ground.

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(74) *si zramätr neba bök neba bök*
si zra\mätr/ neba bök neba bök
eyes 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\exit opposite smacking_sound opposite smacking_sound
'(As for the other girl,) she first pulled out one eye and then the other.'

(75) *fkfa wth yfön gaga thräsryofth*
fk=fa wth yfö=en gaga thrä\sryofth/
buttocks=ABL faeces hole=LOC hand 2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\send
'Then she pushed her hand in her arse and'

(76) *wth thrthr thränmätr*
wth thrthr thrän\mätr/
faeces intestines 2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV:VENT\exit
'pulled out the intestines.'

(77) *wänathr fä fof*
wä\na/thr fä fof
2|3SG>3SG.F.IO:NPST:IPFV\eat DIST EMPH
'Then she ate her (intestines).'

(78) *kabe etfth bra*
kabe etfth bra
man sleep sth_finished
'The people were fast asleep.'

(79) *borsi we fof ŋaborwr*
bor-si we fof ŋa\bor/wr
laugh-NMLZ also EMPH 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\laugh
'What are you laughing at?'[6]

(80) *kabe etfth zäbthath wänatha watik faren*
kabe etfth zä\bth/ath wä\na/tha
man sleep 2|3PL:PST:PFV\finish SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\eat
'While the people were sleeping, she ate her up.'

[6]Marua is talking to a boy in the audience.

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(81) *watik faren wth thrämir*
watik far=en wth thrä\mir/
then stem=LOC faeces 2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hang
'Then she hung the (remaining) guts on a post.'

(82) *ebarnzo zathora wataya*
ebar=nzo za\thor/a wataya
head=ONLY SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\carry PLN
'She only took her head to Wataya.'

(83) *wämne yf bäne wäsi*
wämne yf bäne wäsi
tree name PH.ABS tree_species
'What's the name of that tree? To (her) Wäsi tree.'[7]

(84) *watik fä fof ŋasoga warfo nafanemäwä mnzen*
watik fä fof ŋa\sog/a warfo nafane=ma=wä
then DIST EMPH SG:PST:IPFV\ascend above 3SG.POSS=CHAR=EMPH
mnz=en
house=LOC
'Then she climbed inside her own house.'

(85) *nafafisf zamara "oh bä zane kerere z nŋanfiyokwr?"*
nafa-fis=f za\mar/a oh bä zane kerere
3.POSS-husband=ERG.SG SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\see oh 2.ABS DEM:PROX trouble
z n=ŋan\fiyok/wr
IAM IPST=2|3SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\make
'Her husband looked at her (and said), "Oh, what trouble have you been in?'

(86) *kabe z be nyanathr!"*
kabe z be n=ya\na/thr
man IAM 2SG.ERG IPST=2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat
'You have eaten a human!"'

(87) *nafafis zamatha zba*
nafa-fis za\math/a zba
3.POSS-husband SG:PST:PFV\run PROX:ABL
'The husband took off and ran this way.'

[7] wäsi "strangler fig" (Ficus elastica)

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(88) *nä fz bobo rä*
nä fz bobo \rä/
INDF forest MED:ALL 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'There is another forest over there.'

(89) *tauri kufak fobo fof ŋafäniza wtrime*
tauri_kufak fobo fof ŋa\fäniz/a wtri=me
PLN DIST:ALL EMPH SG:PST:IPFV\shift_place fear=INS
'He was scared and moved away to Tauri Kufak.'

(90) *erugr ewäkr nima n "matak*
e\ru/gr e\wäk/r nima n
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sleep 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\daybreak_on_sb like_this IMN
matak
nothing
'The people woke up (and realized) "They are gone!'

(91) *emoth ane matak"*
emoth ane matak
girl DEM nothing
'that girl is gone!"'

(92) *wthnzo zemarath faren*
wth=nzo ze\mar/ath far=en
faeces=ONLY 2|3PL:PST:PFV\see stem=LOC
'They only saw the guts hanging from the post.'

(93) *kafar bthan kabe ŋawoknzath*
kafar bthan kabe ŋa\wok/nzath
big magic man 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\choose
'They choose their best sorcerers.'

(94) *zamiyarath müsa "oh zä zf wthkgr"*
za\miyar/ath müsa oh zä zf
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\fetch restlessness oh PROX IMM
w\th/kgr
3SG.F:NPST:STAT\be_inside
'They went after her (until they found the tree). "Oh, she's in here!"'

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(95) *watik bthan kwathkwathme wäsi fur yrerath*
watik bthan kwathkwath=me wäsi fur
then magic intention=INS tree_species bundle
y\rä/rath
2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\do
'Then they wrapped up the wäsi tree with their magic spells.'

(96) *mni ŋathomonwath zbo zfthen zaföfath*
mni ŋa\thomon/wath zbo zfth=en
firewood 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\make_fire PROX:ALL tree_base=LOC
za\föf/ath
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\burn
'They piled firewood at the base and burned it.'

(97) *ŋarsira ŋarsira ŋarsira*
ŋa\rsir/a ŋa\rsir/a ŋa\rsir/a
SG:PST:IPFV\burn SG:PST:IPFV\burn SG:PST:IPFV\burn
'It burned and burned'

(98) *ŋarsira ŋarsira*
ŋa\rsir/a ŋa\rsir/a
SG:PST:IPFV\burn SG:PST:IPFV\burn
'and burned and burned.'

(99) *nima n zremar "eh mni"*
nima n zre\mar/ eh mni
like_this IMN 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\see hey fire
'The Nzürna was looking outside "Oh, there is fire!"'

(100) *yirme kma mni wfraza keke*
yir=me kma mni w\fra/za keke
urine=INS POT fire SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\extinguish NEG
'She tried to put out the fire by peeing on it, but that didn't work.'

(101) *wthme kma wnrtuwonza keke*
wth=me kma wn\rtuwo/nza keke
faeces=INS POT SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV:VENT\spray NEG
'She tried to spray the fire with her shit, but that didn't work either.'

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(102) *kabe ebar ane fof kränzir mni kma zfrazrm keke*
kabe ebar ane fof kräⁿ\zir/ mni kma
man head DEM EMPH 2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\throw fire POT
z\fraz/rm keke
SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\extinguish NEG
'She threw the human skull at the fire to extinguish it, but that didn't work.'

(103) *ŋarsira bra*
ŋa\rsir/a bra
SG:PST:IPFV\burn sth_finished
'She burned completely'

(104) *kräbth wämnekaräsü krärzifth*
krä\bth/ wämne=karä=sü krä\rzif/th
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\finish tree=PROP=ETC 2|3PL:IRR:PFV\push_over
'with the tree and everything else. Eventually the tree fell.'

(105) *watik ane kukakuka kma n zarna*
watik ane kukakuka kma n za\rn/a
then DEM bird_species POT IMN 3SG.F:PST:PFV\shout
'Well, that kukakuka bird was just about to call out,'[8]

(106) *watik zrefafth thngthng wrmrwath*
watik zre\faf/th thngthng w\rmr/wath
then 2|3PL>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\hold charcoal 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\grind
'when the (sorcerers) grabbed (and burned) it. They ground up the charcoal remains (of her)'[9]

(107) *bra zäbtha*
bra zä\bth/a
sth_finished 2|3SG:PST:PFV\finish
'until everything was gone.'

(108) *zokwasi fof zäbth nzürna trikasi nimame fof rä*

[8]si kukakuka is an unidentified bird species; the bird is said be always present when there is bushfire.
[9]The spirit of the Nzürna was trying to escape by shapeshifting into the bird.

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zokwasi fof zä\bth/ nzürna trikasi nima=me
speech EMPH 2|3SG:RPST:PFV\finish spirit_woman story like_this=INS
fof \rä/
EMPH 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'The story is finished now. That was the Nzürna story.'

(109) *keke nzürna trikasi rä kabe trikasi rä zane kabe fefe*
keke nzürna trikasi \rä/ kabe trikasi
NEG spirit_woman story 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be man story
\rä/ zane kabe fefe
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be DEM:PROX man really
'Infact, it is not a Nzürna story, but a real story.'

(110) *watik nzürna trikasir z wkwthenzath*
watik nzürna trikasi=r z w\kwthe/nzath
then spirit_woman story=PURP IAM 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\change
'They later changed it into a Nzürna story.'

(111) *watik fof zäbth*
watik fof zä\bth/
then EMPH 2|3SG:RPST:PFV\finish
'Okay, it is finished now.'[10]

(112) *kabe zokwasi aha nzürna trikasi zarath zakwthefath*
kabe zokwasi ah nzürna trikasi za\r/ath
man speech ah spirit_woman story 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\do
za\kwthef/ath
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\change
'A real story, yes, they made it into a Nzürna story, they changed it.'

(113) *nima bresanema monwä ane rä*
nima bres=ane=ma mon=wä ane \rä/
like_this Bres=POSS.SG=CHAR how=EMPH DEM 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'It is like the (Nzürna story) about Bres.'

(114) *emoth katan wänatha*
emoth katan wä\na/tha
girl small SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\eat
'The Nzürna ate a small girl (just like)'

[10]CD asks about his statement.

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(115) *bres monwä bres monwä zba yanatha*
bres mon=wä bres mon=wä zba ya\na/tha
Bres how=EMPH Bres how=EMPH PROX:ABL SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat
'she ate Bres.'

(116) *zane kafar yara ane katan rera emoth fäth*
zane kafar ya\r/a ane katan \rä/ra emoth
DEM:PROX big 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be DEM small 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be girl
fäth
DIM
'This one was an adult, but she was a small child.'

(117) *wataya zba mane rä masu zawe foba fof renra ane nzürna ŋare*
wataya zba mane \rä/ masu zawe foba fof
PLN PROX:ABL which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PLN right DIST:ABL EMPH
\rä/nra ane nzürna ŋare
3SG.F:PST:IPFV:VENT\be DEM spirit_woman woman
'(It happened) at Wataya here. That Nzürna came from the Masu side.'

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# 9 *Nzürna trikasi firran* - The Nzürna story at Firra

## 9.1 Introduction

*Nzürna trikasi firran* is narrative lasting roughly 10min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on September 1st 2012, in both audio and video formats.[1] The story teller is Maraga Kwozi, and the recording took place in the garden of his house at Morehead Station.

## 9.2 Summary & background

In this story, the Nzürna was on good terms with the people of Firra. During the day, when people were out in their gardens, she would come to the village looking after the houses. One day, a stranger comes to the village. The Nzürna welcomes him pretending to be a friendly host. She realizes that the man is not from Firra, and seizes the opportunity. During the night, she kills and eats him. Then she returns to her Wäsü tree. When the villagers realise what has happened, they go after her and kill her. Again she is burned in her Wäsü tree.

## 9.3 Parallel text

| | |
|---|---|
| *zokwasi fefeme natrikwé o markai zokwasime?* | Should I tell you the story in Komnzo or in English? |
| CD: *keke, zokwasi fefeme!* | No, in Komnzo! |
| *zokwasi fefeme natrikwé. watikthmenzo! zaföwä, fthé kabe keke kwot tüfr thfrärm. thwamnzrm zane kafar baden* | I will tell it in Komnzo. Okay then. A long time ago, there were not many people. No matter how many people |

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20120901-01. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189847

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*thzé kabe enrera. nä kabe thfamnzrm mogarkamen. kar nima rä mogarkam. okay, nä thfamnzrm firran. okay, nä fä fefe thwamnzrm mänwä kar bramöwä erä.*

there were on earth, people came here then. Some people were living in *Mogarkam*. *Mogarkam* is a village. Okay, others lived in *Firra*. Still others lived in the places where their respective villages were located.

*firra mrmren mane zfrärm nzürna ŋare bobo zwamnzrm. nzürna ŋare nafafisrwä thfrnm. nafafis yf nagawa. tnztnz kabe sfrärm. nafane ŋare nzürna ŋare fof yf mane zfrärm zafo. nafrr thwamrnm. wati, mä fefe thwamrnm wäsü. nafanme mnz zfrärm. wäsü kafar sukogrm. ane yfön thuthkrnm. boba mnz nafanme zfrärm mä thwamrnm.*

Inside *Firra*, there once lived a Nzürna. The Nzürna lived together with her husband. Her husband's name was Nangawa. He was a smallish guy. As for his wife, that Nzürna's name was Zafo. They were living together in a Wäsü tree. Their house was inside a big Wäsü tree. There was a hole at the bottom of the tree. That was their house.

*firra kar mrmren kabe thwamnzrm fobo. kabe fthé kwarfakunzrmth. fthé thfiyakm. nima ŋarake znfo o fiyafr o nima efothen etfthmöwä fthé thfiyakm. ane nzürna ŋare ausi fof kwänzinzr. fi zwaniyakm. gatha kar fthé thumarwrm. gathagathame thfnakwrmth mnz gatha kar. dödö thfefaf. ane zurenwrmo. mnz fath thwafiyokwrm. kakauna monme gathagathame thfnakwrmth. kwot namäme thfanakwrm. mnzen thwarakthkwramo. mni tnz rä kwanbrigwrm nafanemäwä mnzfo. fthé we thwaniyakm thwänthor. ane mnz woga fthé swänthor "oh, zane ŋare z nzüwäniyak. mnz fath zf nzürenwro, zrä." zafe kabe miyatha thfrärm. nafanme rzarsi monme zfrärm. ane kar woganzo nafä fi monme nzürna ŋareyä kwarzarwrmth. keke thufnzrm ane karma kabe naf. bänema fi nar*

Plenty people lived in *Firra*. When the villagers left the village to attend their gardens or to go hunting, or when they stayed overnight somewhere, that Nzürna took over their place. She came to the village. When she saw rubbish lying around, when the people had left their belongings scattered around and there was rubbish everywhere, that's when she would grab the broom and sweep the place. She cleared their house yards. She put everything back in the right order. She put those things back in the house for them, for example small pieces of firewood. Then she returned to her own place. When they returned, the house owners said: "Oh, this woman was here. She has swept the house yard here." Back then, the villagers were aware of their ties to the Nzürna. Only

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*wogathatha bäne thfrärm nima miyatha thfrärm. nafane nagayé thfrärm. naf thwamonegwrm kabe fefe.*

the people of that particular village were on good terms with the Nzürna. She did not attack them, because they were her friends. They knew about each other. They were like her children. She looked after them.

*wati nä kayé mogarkamma kabe nima sfiyakm firrafo. wati, fi mane yara nama zokwasi woga yara. firran mane thwamnzrm mema zokwasi woga yara. fthé thwamnzrm kabe. wati, fi mane yaka e "krara krara krara" firra sathora fof with fren fof "krara krara krara" fi zära. yakme we sänis zära. kabe wokuthé zäkora nima kabe. ane si thäbu zanfr ra zane thfrärm. ofe ŋarerath. zäwthefa. kabe zäkora.*

One day, there was a man from *Mogarkam*, who came for a visit to *Firra*. He spoke Nama language. The people living in *Firra* were speakers of Mema. As he approached the village, a parrot called out "krara krara krara". Then he arrived in *Firra* and went inside the banana grove "krara krara krara". He quickly changed his appearance. He changed into a human being. Those long eyebrows and whatever else disappeared. He changed his appearance and became a human being.

*watik ŋare nima zräzigrm "awe! nzone moba nzraniyak?" naf we komnzo zära nima "oh, zane ausinzo zf zagathifth." "kabe matak erä nima z bramöwä kwafarkwrth nima erä ŋarsfo." "awow" yamenzo srathams. kramath. with tayo yanrkunzr, yarithr. kafar famä zäkora nima "nzone dagonma zane zf yé. z nziyanyak." bänema yrgfakwa nima zane karma keke yé. "moba z nm nziyanyak?" garam-garam srethkäf "kwa ŋabrigwr? efoth byé!" "keke zä zf kwa worugr. kwa fof thrämonesé kayé fthé thräthor."*

The Nzürna saw him and said: "Come closer, my dear friend! Where did you just come from?" He was thinking like this: "Oh, they must have left that old woman behind. No one else is here. They've all gone away. They must have gone down to the river." He said: "Okay then!" She spread out a mat for him and went and knocked down some bananas for him. She gave him the bananas. Bad thoughts arose in her mind: "This guy will be my meal now that he's here." She realised that the man was not from this village. "Where might he have come from?" She began to woo him. "You're not going back today? It's already late. The

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sun is almost setting." He replied "No, I will sleep here. I'll wait until the people come back tomorrow."

*zbär faf ŋathamsakrnth. etfth kramnzerth. etfth kwosi krämnzer. ausi nzürna ŋare krebnaf "züm züm züm züm!" subnazrm fof. sain swarithrm wati. keke zethäkna ane. yaka zanrnzo srewakuth . di fof safrnza kwosi. kwot yanatha fä fof. bramöwä sabtha. wthnzo ezänzr. füni komnzo bikogr firran. wämne yf füni yé. firran bä ykogr. nä kayé fthé boba gnyako nima kwa ymarwr ane kafar wämne. z niyakako? zba mothfa mane ykogr füni. ane bafen yakan dganzo saräsa. wth fobo fof thämira. ane kabeane wth. fi zäbrimako.*

In the evening, they spread their sleeping mats and went to sleep. The man was fast asleep. But the Nzürna woke up and called out "züm züm züm züm!" She was trying to wake him up, to give him a sign. He slept soundly and didn't move. She took the digging stick, struck him on the head and killed him. Then she ate him right there. She ate everything. Only the intestines, she carried to the Füni tree that stands in *Firra*. The name of the tree is Füni. It's there in *Firra*. If you walk there day, you will see that big tree. Ah, you've already been there? It is right by the road. She rammed the digging stick in the ground and hung the intestines from it, that man's intestines.

*zäthbako mnzen. nafafis oromanf zräses fof "be ranzo änfiyokwr, ah? bä moba nrä? mä nznrugr?" "mä kwa? bä fof zämnzeré zbärma. nagayanme znzän zwäfonz. ane gathagathame kakauna mane egathikwroth." nafafis miyamr.*

Then she returned and went inside her house. Her husband asked: "What have you been up to? Where do you come from? Where did you stay?" She replied "Nowhere! I slept there during the night. Nightfall caught me during work. The villagers had left their belongings lying around." Her husband was unsuspecting.

*fi fthé enthorakwa mnz kabe fof. nima thäzigrma. "nä tmatm ffé nzŋawänzr. manema kabe zä naf nziyanathr?" änyaka. zbär zf zukwinzrmth. zfkonzrmth. zäbrimath "mon kwa wäfiyok-*

When the villagers arrived, they looked around and said "Something bad has happened. Where did the man she ate come from?" In the evening, they went to her house. They argued

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*wre? bänema kabe z nzirärkwr? z nziyanathr." wati, bthan kabe thfrärm ane kabe firran mane thwamnzrm. wati, tmatm äfiyokwrth. ttmatm zwafiyokwrmth. fam wäfiyokwrth näbinzo. "mnime né zräföfe." nima tmatmr rä.*

with her and talked to her. As they returned to the village they were saying, "What should we do with her? Has she finished that man? She just ate him." There were some sorcerers who lived in *Firra*. They came up with a plan, "We will burn her in the fire."

*wati, bthan tmatmme nafane fam zwarmänwrmth. wärmänwath e ane bafen keke kwamätrakwrm. bänema fam z zürmänth. wtri we z zära nima "z zwemarth ane yam fiyoksin." mni wthomonwrth yfö mä zfrärm. mni wthomonwath a zräföfth. fi yame yrsifnzo zukonzrm boba wämne yfön fof. nafafis bana krebnaf. krekaris "u" mni u kwan fof. kafar wäsü sukogrm mrab fren waisamen. waisam ane kar yf rä. mobo zwamnzrm mrab fr thden. krär nafafis zräs "be ranzo kayé thwanfiyokwr?" "ra kwa thanfiyokwé?" "ra kwan we rä? ah, nzukar banafa borbor bana sathor." kma borbor ukwan zfrärm. zufsgwrm fof. "füsfüs ukwan bana nzukar banafa wnrä." mni kwarsirm. mni komnzo kwa zöfthé zethkäfa.*

They began to block her thoughts with their own magic. They blocked her mind until she did not dare come out of her house because they had intimidated her. She was scared thinking "They already know what I've done." They piled up firewood by the entrance to her house. They piled up wood and set it on fire. Meanwhile, she was busy weaving a mat in her tree. Her poor husband woke up and heard the sound of the fire "uh" That big Wäsü tree stood in a bamboo grove at *Waisam*. That's the name of the place, *Waisam*, where she lived. It is located in the middle of a bamboo grove. Her husband got up and asked her: "What have you done yesterday?" She replied "What do you mean, what did I do?" "What's this sound? Oh no!" She realized "The wind is blowing from my dear place." It was the sound of the burning bamboos. "It's the sound of the wind coming from my village." It was the fire that started growing.

*nima sräzigrm. nafafis bana fof zänmätra fof. mni zbo z zamara. rürä fthé zagathifa. nima sathfärako. nima fi fthé sathfärako yakäsü. trtha zutho-*

The poor husband was looking for an escape. He got out, while the fire was closing in. He left her alone. He jumped out like this. He jumped and

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*rakwrm. foba näbi fthé zanmatha fof emoth fäth nima ämnzr oten. komnzo zena bobo rä. ane kar we nä fof rä trikasi kar fof. dödö fr rä. kafar dödö fr zbo thden rä. näbüwä fthé zanmatha ote. emoth fäthnm thrätrif "beŋame ausi bzaföfth. nafanemäwä. kafar yam zwafiyokwr. kabe nä z swanathr." fi nimanzo ffé yarako.*

took off. He was running for his life. He ran away for good. Their daughters were staying in *Ote* at the time. That place still exists. It's place with a story of its own. That place is in the middle of some Dödö trees. So he escaped to *Ote* and informed the daughters, "Your mother burned in the flames there. It was all her fault! She did a big crime. She ate a man." He went away for good.

*fi nima mni zewaräfa. ŋarsira, ŋasira. kma zräzigrm "moba kwa krämätré? moba?" näbi ffé zaföfath. ŋarsira e kwot zäbtha. brbrnzo fof né zäthaba bafen ymden fof. "kuka kuka" fä mane wänor. krärth ane bthan woga ane kuka kuka zrämgth. krätr. wati, ffé zaföfath. ane fobo fä zäbtha. ane thrma mni fthé zäbtha.*

The fire was still burning. It burned and burned. She tried to find a way, "Where will I get out? Where?" Everything burned to the ground. Only her spirit tried to escape by turning into a bird. The one that is calling out "kuka kuka" over there. But the sorcerers shot the Kukakuka bird. It fell to the ground and they burned it. They managed to kill her. Then the fire went out.

*wati nagawa ŋabrigwa sir. "komnzo rä o z kwarsir mnin?" ŋabrigwa bobomr we waisam wäsü fthé sanmara. "watik fi nafazfthenwä" yanzo bobo yanora nafaŋareanema. wati, fi näbi zäbrima. zbo yamnzr. ane woga oten emoth fäthä ämnzr. kabeyé komnzo fä nomai sumarwre. ymarwre. fthé fä ŋaritakwr nima firrafo yak we nima ŋabrigwr. tnz fäth ane kabe yé.*

Nangawa returned to check on things. "Is she still alive or did she burn in the fire?" He returned to *Waisam* where he saw the Wäsü tree. He stood thinking "Well, it was all her fault." There he wept bitterly for his wife. Then he returned for good. This man lives now in *Ote* together with his daughters. From time to time, we see him when he crosses the river on his way to *Firra*. He is a small man.

*ane nzürna ŋareane zokwasi nimame fof rä fof. mane bobo firran zwamnzrm. tüfr yam nä ffé thwafiyokwrm. fi fathfa*

That was the Nzürna's story, the one who lived in *Firra*. She had done many other things, but this one thing she

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*ane fof wäfiyokwa. nä karma kabe mane yanatha mogarkamma. ane trikasi fobonzo wythk fof brä ane nzürna ŋareanema. watik, fobo fof zräkoré. nä karen nima näbuné bänema nä nzürna ŋare zokwasi trikasi bä räro. fi ane kar woga mane erä. fi ane miyatha erä. nzefé nzüwäbragwé nima ni miyatha nrä. nzekaren ane yam kwafiyokwrm nzenme ŋafyé mä thwamnzrm. ŋafyé we nzenm natrikwath. nima zbo zf zakoré. fof zäbthé.*

did in public. She ate a man from another village, a man from *Mogarkam*. This is the end of the story about that Nzürna. I have told it now. There are other stories at other places. There are other Nzürna stories, but the villagers there would know them. I followed this story because we know it. This happened in our village, where our fathers once lived. And the fathers told us about it. I have finished the story now. I am done.

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## 9.4 Glossed text

(1) *zokwasi fefeme natrikwé o markai zokwasime?*
zokwasi fefe=me na\trik/wé o markai zokwasi=me
speech really=INS 1SG>2SG.IO:NPST:IPFV\tell or outsider speech=INS
'Should I tell you the story in Komnzo or in English?'[2]

(2) *zokwasi fefeme natrikwé*
zokwasi fefe=me na\trik/wé
speech real=INS 1SG>2SG.IO:NPST:IPFV\tell
'I will tell it in Komnzo.'

(3) *watikthmenzo*
watik-thé=me=nzo
then-ADLZR=INS=ONLY
'Okay then.'

(4) *zaföwä*
zafö=wä
old=EMPH
'A long time ago,'

(5) *fthé kabe keke kwot tüfr thfrärm*
fthé kabe keke kwot tüfr thf\rä/rm
when people NEG properly plenty 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'there were not many people.'

(6) *thwamnzrm zane kafar baden thzé kabe enrera*
thwa\m/nzrm zane kafar bad=en thzé kabe
2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit DEM:PROX big ground=LOC whatever people
en\rä/ra
2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'No matter how many people there were on earth, people came here then.'

(7) *nä kabe thfamnzrm mogarkamen*
nä kabe thfa\m/nzrm mogarkam=en
INDF people 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit PLN=LOC
'Some people were living in Mogarkam.'

[2] I reply: *keke, zokwasi fefeme.* "No, in Komnzo."

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(8) *kar nima rä mogarkam*
kar nima \rä/ mogarkam
village like_this 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be Mogarkam
'Mongarkam is a village.'

(9) *okay, nä thfamnzrm firran*
okay nä thfa\m/nzrm firra=en
okay INDF 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit firra=LOC
'Okay, others lived in Firra.'

(10) *okay, nä fä fefe thwamnzrm mänwä kar bramöwä erä*
okay nä fä fefe thwa\m/nzrm mänwä kar bramöwä
okay INDF DIST really 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit where.EMPH village all
e\rä/
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'Still others lived in the places where their respective villages were located.'

(11) *firra mrmren mane zfrärm nzürna ŋare bobo zwamnzrm*
firra mrmr=en mane zf\rä/rm nzürna ŋare bobo
firra inside=LOC which 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be spirit_woman woman MED:ALL
zwa\m/nzrm
3SG.F:PST:DUR\sit
'Inside Firra, there was a Nzürna, who lived there.'

(12) *nzürna ŋare nafafisrwä thfrnm*
nzürna ŋare nafa-fis=r=wä
spirit_woman woman 3.POSS-husband=ASSOC.DU=EMPH
thf\rn/m
2|3DU:PST:DUR\be
'The Nzürna lived together with her husband.'

(13) *nafafis yf nagawa*
nafa-fis yf nagawa
3.POSS-husband name PN
'Her husband's name was Nangawa.'

(14) *tnztnz kabe sfrärm*
tnz~tnz kabe sf\rä/rm
REDUP~short man 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'He was a bit of a small guy.'

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(15) *nafane ŋare nzürna ŋare fof yf mane zfrärm zafo*
nafane ŋare nzürna ŋare fof yf mane zf\rä/rm
3SG.POSS wife spirit_woman woman EMPH name which 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
zafo
PN
'As for his wife, that Nzürna's name was Zafo.'

(16) *nafrr thwamrnm*
nafrr thwa\m/rnm
3DU.ASSOC 2|3DU:PST:DUR\sit
'They lived together.'

(17) *wati, mä fefe thwamrnm wäsü*
wati mä fefe thwa\m/rnm wäsü
then where really 2|3DU:PST:DUR\sit tree_species
'Where they really lived was in a Wäsü tree.'[3]

(18) *nafanme mnz zfrärm wäsü kafar sukogrm*
nafanme mnz zf\rä/rm wäsü kafar
3NSG.POSS house 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be tree_species big
su\ko/grm
3SG.M:PST:DUR:STAT\be_standing
'Their house was inside the big Wäsü tree.'

(19) *ane yfön thuthkrnm*
ane yfö=en thu\th/krnm
DEM hole=LOC 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be_inside
'They were inside the hole (at the bottom of the tree).'

(20) *boba mnz nafanme zfrärm mä thwamrnm*
boba mnz nafanme zf\rä/rm mä thwa\m/rnm
MED:ABL house 3NSG.POSS 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be where 2|3DU:PST:DUR\sit
'That was their house where they lived.'

(21) *firra kar mrmren kabe thwamnzrm fobo*
firra kar mrmr=en kabe thwa\m/nzrm fobo
PLN village inside=LOC people 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit DIST:ALL
'Many other people lived in Firra.'

[3] *wäsü* (sometimes) *wäsi* 'strangler fig' (*Ficus elastica*)

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(22) *kabe fthé kwarfakunzrmth fthé thfiyakm*
kabe fthé kwa\rfaku/nzrmth fthé thf\yak/m
man when 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sprinkle when 2|3PL:PST:DUR\walk
'When the people spread out, when they left the village,'

(23) *nima ŋarake znfo o fiyafr o*
nima ŋarake zn=fo o fiyaf=r o
like_this garden place=ALL or hunt=PURP or
'to attend their gardens, or to go hunting,'

(24) *nima efothen etfthmöwä thé thfwiyakm*
nima efoth=en etfth=me=wä fthé thf\yak/m
like_this day=LOC sleep=INS=EMPH when 2|3PL:PST:DUR\walk
'or when they stayed overnight somewhere,'

(25) *ane nzürna ŋare ausi fof kwänzinzr*
ane nzürna ŋare ausi fof kwän\zinzr/
DEM spirit_woman woman old_woman EMPH 2|3SG:ITER:VENT\replace
'that Nzürna took over their place.'

(26) *fi zwaniyakm gatha kar fthé thumarwrm*
fi zwan\yak/m gatha kar fthé thu\mar/wrm
3.ABS 3SG.F:PST:DUR:VENT\come bad place when SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\see
'She came (to the village). When she saw rubbish lying around,'

(27) *gathagathame thfnakwrmth mnz gatha kar*
gathagatha=me thf\nak/wrmth mnz gatha kar
bad=INS 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\put_down house bad place
'when the people had left their belongings scattered around and there was rubbish everywhere,'

(28) *dödö thfefaf ane zurenwrmo*
dödö thfe\faf/ ane
melaleuca_species 2|3SG>2|3PL:ITER\hold DEM
zu\ren/wrmo
SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR:AND\sweep
'she would grab the broom and sweep the place.'

(29) *mnz fath thwafiyokwrm*

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mnz fath thwa\fiyok/wrm
house clear_place SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\make
'She cleared their house yards.'

(30) *kakauna monme gathagathame thfnakwrmth*
nafanme kakauna mon=me gathagatha=me
3NSG.POSS thing how=INS bad=INS
thf\nak/wrmth
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\put_down
'Sometimes their things were scattered around'

(31) *kwot namäme thfanakwrm*
kwot namä=me thfa\nak/wrm
properly good=INS SG>2|3PL.IO:PST:DUR\put_down
'and she put everything back in the right order.'

(32) *mnzen thwarakthkwramo*
mnz=en thwa\rakthk/wramo
house=LOC SG>2|3PL.IO:PST:DUR:AND\put_on_top
'She put those things back in the house for them,'

(33) *mni tnz rä*
mni tnz \rä/
fire short 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'(for example) small pieces of firewood.'

(34) *kwanbrigwrm nafanemäwä mnzfo*
kwan\brig/wrm nafane=ma=wä mnz=fo
SG:PST:DUR:VENT\return 3SG.POSS=CHAR=EMPH house=ALL
'Then she returned to her own house.'

(35) *fthé we thwaniyakm thwänthor*
fthé we thwan\yak/m thwän\thor/
when also 2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\come 2|3PL:ITER:VENT\appear
'When the people came back again,'

(36) *ane mnz woga fthé swänthor*
ane mnz woga fthé swän\thor/
DEM house man when 3SG.M:ITER:VENT\appear
'the house owners said:'

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(37) *"oh zane ŋare z nzüwäniyak mnz fath zf nzürenwro zrä."*
oh zane ŋare z nz=wän\yak/ mnz
oh DEM:PROX woman IAM IPST=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come house
fath zf nz=w\ren/wro
clear_place IMM IPST=SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:AND\sweep
z=\rä/
PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'"Oh, this woman was here. She has swept the house yard here."'

(38) *zafe kabe miyatha thfrärm nafanme rzarsi monme zfrärm*
zafe kabe miyatha thf\rä/rm nafanme rzar-si mon=me
old man knowledge 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be 3NSG.POSS tie-NMLZ how=INS
zf\rä/rm
3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
'At that time, they knew about their connections to her,'

(39) *ane kar woganzo*
ane kar woga=nzo
DEM village man=ONLY
'but only the people from this particular village.'

(40) *nafä fi monme nzürna ŋareyä kwarzarwrmth*
nafä fi mon=me nzürna ŋare=ä kwa\rzar/wrmth
3PL.ASSOC 3.ABS how=INS spirit_woman woman=ASSOC 2|3PL:PST:DUR\tie
'They were on good terms with the Nzürna.'

(41) *keke thufnzrm ane karma kabe naf*
keke thu\fn/zrm ane kar=ma kabe naf
NEG SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit DEM village=CHAR man 3SG.ERG
'She did not attack the people from the village,'

(42) *bänema fi nar wogathatha bäne thfrärm nima*
bäne=ma fi nar woga=thatha bäne thf\rä/rm nima
PH=CHAR 3.ABS friend man=SIMIL PH.ABS 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be like_this
'because they were her friends.'

(43) *miyatha thfrärm*
miyatha thf\rä/rm
knowledge 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'They knew about her.'

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(44) *nafane nagayé thfrärm naf thwamonegwrm kabe fefe*
nafane nagayé thf\rä/rm naf thwa\moneg/wrm kabe
3SG.POSS children 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be 3SG.ERG SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\wait man
fefe
really
'They were like her children and she looked after them.'

(45) *wati nä kayé mogarkamma kabe*
wati nä kayé mogarkam=ma kabe
then INDF one_day_away Mogarkam=CHAR man
'One day, there was a man from Mongarkam,'

(46) *nima sfiyakm firrafo*
nima sf\yak/m firra=fo
like_this 3SG.M:PST:DUR\walk firra=ALL
'who came for a visit to Firra.'

(47) *wati, fi mane yara nama zokwasi woga yara*
wati fi mane ya\r/a nama zokwasi woga
then 3.ABS which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be two_days_away speech man
ya\r/a
3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'He spoke Nama language.'

(48) *firran mane thwamnzrm*
firra=en mane thwa\m/nzrm
firra=LOC which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'The people living in Firra'

(49) *mema zokwasi woga yara*
mema zokwasi woga ya\r/a
Mema speech man 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'were speakers of Mema.'

(50) *fthé thwamnzrm kabe*
fthé thwa\m/nzrm kabe
when 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit man
'In those times, when people still lived (at Firra).'[4]

[4]Firra is only used as a garden place today.

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(51) *wati, fi mane yaka e*
wati fi mane \yak/a e
then 3.ABS which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\walk until
'Okay, as he came (to Firra)'

(52) *"krara krara krara"*
krara krara krara
eclectus_parrot eclectus_parrot eclectus_parrot
'the parrot was calling out "krara krara krara".'[5]

(53) *firra sathora fof*
firra sa\thor/a fof
firra 3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear EMPH
'He arrived in Firra'

(54) *with fren fof*
with fr=en fof
banana post=LOC EMPH
'inside the banana grove'

(55) *"krara krara krara"*
krara krara krara
eclectus_parrot eclectus_parrot eclectus_parrot
'"krara krara krara".'

(56) *fi zära yakme we sänis zära*
fi zä\r/a yakme we sänis zä\r/a
3.ABS SG:PST:PFV\do quickly also change SG:PST:PFV\do
'He quickly changed his appearance.'

(57) *kabe wokuthé zäkora nima kabe*
kabe woku-thé zä\kor/a nima kabe
man skin-ADLZR SG:PST:PFV\become like_this man
'He changed into a human being.'

(58) *ane si thäbu zanfr ra zane thfrärm ofe ŋarerath*

[5] *krara* 'eclectus parrot' (*Eclectus polychloros*)

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ane si thäbu zanfr ra zane thf\rä/rm
DEM eyes hair long what.ABS DEM:PROX 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
ofe ŋa\rä/rath
disappearance 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\do
'Those long eyebrows and whatever else was there disappeared.'

(59) *zäwthefa kabe zäkora*
zä\wthef/a kabe zä\kor/a
SG:PST:PFV\change man SG:PST:PFV\become
'He changed his appearance and became a human being.'

(60) *watik ŋare nima zräzigrm "awe nzone moba nzraniyak?"*
watik ŋare nima zrä\zigrm/ awe nzone moba
then woman like_this 3SG.F:IRR:PFV\look come 1SG.POSS where.ABL
nzran\yak/
2SG:IRR:IPFV:VENT\come
'Then the Nzürna saw him and said: "Come closer, my dear friend! Where did you just come from?"'

(61) *naf we komnzo zära nima*
naf we komnzo zä\r/a nima
3SG.ERG also only SG:PST:PFV\do like_this
'He was thinking like this:'

(62) *"oh zane ausinzo zf zagathifth."*
oh zane ausi=nzo zf za\gathif/th
oh DEM:PROX old_woman=ONLY IMM 2|3PL>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\leave
'"Oh, they must have left this old woman behind.'

(63) *"kabe matak erä nima z bramöwä kwafarkwrth*
kabe matak e\rä/ nima z bramöwä
man nothing 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be like_this IAM all
kwa\fark/wrth
2|3PL:RPST:IPFV\set_off
'Nobody else is here. They have all gone out.'

(64) *nima erä ŋarsfo."*
nima e\rä/ ŋars=fo
like_this 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be river=ALL
'They must have gone down to the river."'

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(65) *"awow"*
awow
okay
'"Okay then!"'

(66) *yamenzo srathams*
yame=nzo sra\thams/
mat=ONLY 2|3SG>3SG.M.IO:IRR:PFV\spread
'She spread out a mat for him'

(67) *kramath with tayo yanrkunzr*
kra\math/ with tayo yan\rku/nzr
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\run banana ripe 2|3SG>3SG.F.IO:NPST:IPFV:VENT\knock_off
'and went and knocked down some bananas for him.'

(68) *yarithr*
ya\ri/thr
2|3SG>3SG.M.IO:NPST:IPFV\give
'She gave him (the bananas).'

(69) *kafar famä zäkora nima*
kafar fam=ä zä\kor/a nima
big thought=ASSOC SG:PST:PFV\become like_this
'Bad thoughts arose in her mind:'

(70) *"nzone dagonma zane zf yé"*
nzone dagon=ma zane zf \yé/
1SG.POSS food=CHAR DEM:PROX IMM 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'"This guy will be my meal.'

(71) *z nziyaniyak.*
z nz=yan\yak/
IAM IPST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come
'He's here already."'

(72) *bänema yrgfakwa nima zane karma keke yé.*
bäne=ma y\rgfak/wa nima zane
PH=CHAR SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\recognize like_this DEM:PROX
kar=ma keke \yé/
village=CHAR NEG 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'She realised that the man was not from this village.'

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(73) *moba z nm nziyaniyak*
moba z nm nz=yan\yak/
where.ABL IAM maybe IPST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come
'"Where might he have come from?"'

(74) *garamgaram srethkäf*
garamgaram sre\thkäf/
sweet_talk 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\start
'She began to woo him.'

(75) *"kwa ŋabrigwr? efoth byé!"*
kwa ŋa\brig/wr efoth b=\yé/
FUT 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\return sun MED=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'"You're not going back today? The sun has almost set there."'

(76) *"keke zä zf kwa worugr"*
keke zä zf kwa wo\ru/gr
NEG PROX IMM FUT 1SG:NPST:IPFV\sleep
'He replied "No, I will sleep here.'

(77) *"kwa fof thrämonesé kayé fthé thräthor."*
kwa fof thrä\mones/é kayé fthé
FUT EMPH 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\wait one_day_away when
thrä\thor/
2|3PL:IRR:PFV\appear
'I'll wait until the people come back tomorrow."'

(78) *zbär faf ŋathamsakrnth*
zbär faf ŋa\thamsak/rnth
night place 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\spread
'In the evening, they spread their sleeping mats'

(79) *etfth kramnzerth*
etfth kra\mnzer/th
sleep 2|3DU:IRR:PFV\fall_asleep
'and went to sleep.'

(80) *etfth kwosi krämnzer*
etfth kwosi krä\mnzer/
sleep dead 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\fall.asleep
'The man was fast asleep.'

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(81) *ausi nzürna ŋare krebnaf*
ausi nzürna ŋare kre\bnaf/
old_woman spirit_woman woman 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\wake_up
'But the Nzürna woke up (and called out)'

(82) *züm züm züm züm*
züm züm züm züm
centipede centipede centipede centipede
'"züm züm züm züm"'[6]

(83) *subnazrm fof ... sain swarithrm wati*
su\bnaz/rm fof sain swa\ri/thrm
SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\wake_up EMPH sign SG>3SG.M.IO:PST:DUR\give
'She was trying to wake him up, to give him a sign.'

(84) *keke zethäkna ane*
keke ze\thäkn/a ane
NEG SG:PST:PFV\shake DEM
'He slept soundly and didn't move.'

(85) *yaka zanrnzo srewakuth*
yaka zan=r=nzo sre\wakuth/
digging_stick fight=PURP=ONLY 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\pick_up
'She took the digging stick,'

(86) *di fof safrnza kwosi*
di fof sa\fr/nza kwosi
neck EMPH SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\bite dead
'struck him on the head and killed him.'

(87) *kwot yanatha fä fof*
kwot ya\na/tha fä fof
properly SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat DIST EMPH
'Then she ate him right there.'

(88) *bramöwä sabtha*
bramöwä sa\bth/a
all SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\finish
'(She ate) everything.'

[6]She can command the centipedes *züm*.

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(89) *wthnzo ezänzr*
wth=nzo e\zä/nzr
faeces=ONLY 2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\carry
'Only the intestines, she carried'

(90) *füni komnzo bikogr firran*
füni komnzo b=y\ko/gr firra=en
tree_species only MED=3SG.M:NPST:STAT\be_standing PLN=LOC
'to the Füni tree that stands in Firra.'

(91) *wämne yf füni yé*
wämne yf füni \yé/
tree name tree_species 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'The name of the tree is Füni.'

(92) *firran bä ykogr*
firra=en bä y\ko/gr
firra=LOC MED 3SG.M:NPST:STAT\be_standing
'It's there in Firra.'

(93) *nä kayé fthé boba gnyako nima kwa ymarwr ane kafar wämne*
nä kayé fthé boba gn\yak/o nima
INDF one_day_away when MED:ABL 2SG:IMP:IPFV:AND\walk like_this
kwa y\mar/wr ane kafar wämne
FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\see DEM big tree
'If you walk there day, you will see that big tree.'

(94) *z niyakako*
z n\yak/ako
IAM 2SG:PST:IPFV:AND\walk
'Ah, you've already been there?'[7]

(95) *zba mothfa mane ykogr füni*
zba moth=fa mane y\ko/gr füni
PROX:ABL path=ABL which 3SG.M:NPST:STAT\be_standing tree_species
'It is right by the road.'

[7]Maraga's wife pointed out that I had been there the year before.

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(96) *ane bafen yakan dganzo saräsa*
ane baf=en yaka=en dganzo sa\räs/a
DEM PH=LOC digging_stick=LOC bifurcation SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\erect
'She rammed the digging stick in the ground'

(97) *wth fobo fof thämira*
wth fobo fof thä\mir/a
faeces DIST:ALL EMPH SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hang
'and hung the intestines from it,'

(98) *ane kabeane wth*
ane kabe=ane wth
DEM man=POSS.SG faeces
'that man's intestines.'

(99) *fi zäbrimako zäthbako mnzen*
fi zä\brim/ako zä\thb/ako mnz=en
3.ABS SG:PST:PFV:AND\return SG:PST:PFV:AND\enter house=LOC
'Then she returned and went inside her house.'

(100) *nafafis oromanf zräses fof*
nafa-fis oroman=f zrä\s/ fof
3.POSS-husband old_man=ERG.SG 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\ask EMPH
'Her husband asked her:'

(101) *"be ranzo änfiyokwr, ah?*
be ra=nzo än\fiyok/wr ah
2SG.ERG what.ABS=ONLY 2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\make ah
'"'What have you been up to?'

(102) *bä moba nrä?*
bä moba n\rä/
2.ABS where.ABL 2SG:NPST:IPFV\be
'Where do you come from?'

(103) *mä nznrugr?"*
mä nz=n\ru/gr
where IPST=2SG:NPST:IPFV\sleep
'Where did you stay?"'

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(104) *mä kwa bä fof zämnzeré zbärma*
mä kwa bä fof zä\mnzer/é zbär=ma
where FUT MED EMPH 1SG:RPST:PFV\fall.asleep night=CHAR
'(She replied) "Nowhere! I slept there during the night.'

(105) *nagayanme znzän zwäfonz*
nagayé=aneme znzä=en zwä\fonz/
children=POSS.NSG work=LOC 1SG:RPST:PFV\dawn_on_sb
'Nightfall caught me during work for the children.'

(106) *ane gathagathame kakauna mane egathikwroth*
ane gatha=me kakauna mane e\gathik/wroth
DEM bad=INS thing which PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:AND\leave
'They had left their things lying around."'

(107) *nafafis miyamr*
nafa-fis miyamr
3.POSS-husband ignorance
'Her husband was unsuspecting.'

(108) *fi fthé enthorakwa mnz kabe fof*
fi fthé en\thorak/wa mnz kabe fof
3.ABS when 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\appear house man EMPH
'When the villagers arrived'

(109) *nima thäzigrma*
nima thä\zigrm/a
like_this 2|3PL:PST:PFV\look
'they looked around (and said)'

(110) *nä tmatm ffé nzŋawänzr*
nä tmatm fefe nz=ŋa\wä/nzr
INDF action really IPST=2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\happen
'"Something bad has happened.'

(111) *manema kabe zä naf nziyanathr*
mane=ma kabe zä naf nz=ya\na/thr
which=CHAR man PROX 3SG.ERG IPST=2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat
'Where did the man she ate come from?"'

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(112) *äniyaka zbär zf zukwinzrmth zfkonzrmth*
än\yak/a zbär zf zu\kwi/nzrmth
2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come night IMM 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR\argue
zf\ko/nzrmth
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR\speak
'In the evening, they went to her house. They argued with her and talked to her.'

(113) *zäbrimath mon kwa wäfiyokwre bänema kabe z nzirärkwr*
zä\brim/ath mon kwa wä\fiyok/wre bäne=ma
2|3PL:PST:PFV\return how FUT 1PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\make PH=CHAR
kabe z nz=y\rärk/wr
man IAM IPST=2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\mess_up
'As they returned to the village they were saying, "'What should we do with her? Has she already finished the man?'

(114) *z nziyanathr*
z nz=ya\na/thr
IAM IPST=2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat
'She just ate him."'

(115) *wati, bthan kabe thfrärm ane kabe firran mane thwamnzrm*
wati bthan kabe thf\rä/rm ane kabe firra=en mane
then magic man 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be DEM man PLN=LOC which
thwa\m/nzrm
2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'There were some sorcerers who lived in Firra.'

(116) *wati, tmatm äfiyokwrth*
wati tmatm ä\fiyok/wrth
then action 2|3PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\make
'There were getting prepared.'

(117) *ttmatm zwafiyokwrmth*
t~tmatm zwa\fiyok/wrmth
REDUP~action 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR\make
'They were getting prepared for her'

(118) *fam wäfiyokwrth näbinzo*

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fam wä\fiyok/wrth näbi=nzo
thought 2|3PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\make one=ONLY
'and they came up with a plan,'

(119) *"mnime né zräföfe"*
mni=me né zrä\föf/e
fire=INS IMN 1PL>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\burn
'"We will burn her in the fire."'

(120) *nima tmatmr rä*
nima tmatm=r \rä/
like_this action=PURP 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'This was the plan.'

(121) *wati, bthan tmatmme nafane fam zwarmänwrmth*
wati bthan tmatm=me nafane fam zwa\rmän/wrmth
then magic action=INS 3SG.POSS thought 2|3PL>3SG.F.IO:PST:DUR\close
'They began to block their thoughts with their magic.'

(122) *wärmänwath e*
wä\rmän/wath e
2|3PL>3SG.F.IO:PST:IPFV\close until
'They blocked her mind until'

(123) *ane bafen keke kwamätrakwrm bänema*
ane baf=en keke kwa\mätrak/wrm bäne=ma
DEM PH=LOC NEG SG:PST:DUR\exit PH=CHAR
'she did not dare come out of her house because'

(124) *fam z zürmänth*
fam z zü\rmän/th
thought IAM 2|3PL>3SG.M.IO:ITER\close
'they had intimidated her.'

(125) *wtri we z zära nima*
wtri we z zä\r/a nima
fear also IAM SG:PST:PFV\do like_this
'She was scared (thinking),'

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(126) *“z zwemarth ane yam fiyoksin”*
z zwe\mar/th ane yam fiyok-si=en
IAM 2|3SG>1SG:RPST:PFV\see DEM event make-NMLZ=LOC
‘“They already know what I’ve done.”’

(127) *mni wthomonwrth yfö mä zfrärm*
mni w\thomon/wrth yfö mä zf\rä/rm
firewood 2|3PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\make_fire hole where 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
‘They piled up firewood by the entrance (to her house).’

(128) *mni wthomonwath a zräföfth*
mni w\thomon/wath a zrä\föf/th
firewood 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFVmakepile_fire and 2|3PL:IRR:PFV\burn
‘They piled up wood and set it on fire.’

(129) *fi yame yrsifnzo zukonzrm boba wämne yfön fof*
fi yame yr-si=f=nzo zu\ko/nzrm boba
but mat build-NMLZ=ERG.SG=ONLY SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\become MED:ABL
wämne yfö=en fof
tree hole=LOC EMPH
‘Meanwhile, she was busy weaving a mat in her tree.’

(130) *nafafis bana krebnaf krekaris “u” mni u kwan fof*
nafa-fis bana kre\bnaf/ kre\karis/
3.POSS-husband pitiful 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\wake_up 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\hear
u mni u_kwan fof
sound_of_wind fire sound_of_wind EMPH
‘Her poor husband woke up and hear the sound of the fire “uh”’

(131) *kafar wäsü sukogrm mrab fren waisamen*
kafar wäsü su\ko/grm mrrab
big tree_species 3SG.M:PST:DUR:STAT\be_standing small_bamboo
fr=en waisam=en
post=LOC PLN=LOC
‘The big Wäsü tree stood in a bamboo grove at Waisam.’

(132) *waisam ane kar yf rä*
waisam ane kar yf \rä/
Waisam DEM place name 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
‘That’s the name of the place, Waisam,’

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(133) *mobo zwamnzrm*
mobo zwa\m/nzrm
where.ALL 3SG.F:PST:DUR\sit
'where she lived.'

(134) *mrab fr thden*
mrrab fr thd=en
small_bamboo post middle=LOC
'It is located in the middle of a bamboo grove.'

(135) *krär nafafis zräs "be ranzo kayé thwanfiyokwr?"*
krä\r/ nafa-fis zrä\s/ be
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\do 3.POSS-husband 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\ask 2SG.ERG
ra=nzo kayé thwan\fiyok/wr
what.ABS=ONLY one_day_away 2|3SG>2|3PL:RPST:IPFV:VENT\make
'Her husband got up asked her: "What have you done yesterday?"'

(136) *"ra kwa thanfiyokwé?"*
ra kwa than\fiyok/wé
what.ABS FUT 2SG>2|3PL:IMP:IPFV:VENT\make
'(She replied) "What do you mean, what did I do?"'

(137) *"ra kwan we rä? ah"*
ra kwan we \rä/ ah
what.ABS shout also 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be ah
'"and what's this sound? Oh no!"'

(138) *"nzukar banafa borbor bana sathor kma borbor ukwan zfrärm zufsgwrm fof"*
nzu-kar bana=fa borbor bana sa\thor/
1SG.POSS-place pitiful=ABL strong_wind pitiful 3SG.M:RPST:PFV\appear
kma borbor u_kwan zf\rä/rm
POT strong_wind sound_of_wind 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
zu\fsg/wrm fof
SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\blow EMPH
'(She realized) "My poor place, the wind is blowing. This is the sound of the fire (in the bamboos).'

(139) *füsfüs ukwan bana nzukar banafa wnrä*

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füsfüs u_kwan bana nzu-kar bana=fa
wind sound_of_wind pitiful 1SG.POSS-place pitiful=ABL
wn\rä/
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be
'It's the sound of the wind. It's coming from my village."'

(140) *mni kwarsirm mni komnzo kwa zöfthé zethkäfa*
mni kwa\rsir/m mni komnzo kwa zöfthé ze\thkäf/a
fire SG:PST:DUR\burn fire only FUT earlier SG:PST:PFV\start
'It was the fire that started burning earlier.'

(141) *nima srä̈zigrm nafafis bana fof zänmätra fof*
nima srä\zigrm/ nafa-fis bana fof
like_this 3SG.M:IRR:PFV\look 3.POSS-husband pitiful EMPH
zän\mätr/a fof
SG:PST:PFV:VENT\exit EMPH
'The poor husband was looking for an escape. He got out.'

(142) *mni zbo z zamara*
mni zbo z za\mar/a
fire PROX:ALL IAM SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\see
'The fire was very close.'

(143) *rürä fthé zagathifa*
rürä fthé za\gathif/a
alone when SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\leave
'So he left her alone'

(144) *nima sathfärako*
nima sa\thfär/ako
like_this 3SG.M:PST:PFV:AND\jump
'and jumped out like this.'

(145) *nima fi fthé sathfärako yakäsü*
nima fi fthé sa\thfär/ako yak=ä=sü
like_this 3.ABS when 3SG.M:PST:PFV:AND\jump run=ASSOC=ETC
'He jumped and took off.'

(146) *trtha zuthorakwrm*

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trtha zu\thorak/wrm
life SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\search
'He was running for his life.'

(147) *foba näbi fthé zanmatha fof*
foba näbi fthé zan\math/a fof
DIST:ABL one when 2|3SG:PST:PFV:VENT\run EMPH
'He ran away for good.'

(148) *emoth fäth nima ämnzr oten*
emoth fäth nima ä\m/nzr ote=en
girl DIM like_this 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit Ote=LOC
'Their daughters were staying in Ote at the time.'

(149) *komnzo zena bobo rä ane kar we nä fof rä trikasi kar fof*
komnzo zena bobo \rä/ ane kar we nä fof
only today MED:ALL 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be DEM village also INDF EMPH
\rä/ trikasi kar fof
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be story place EMPH
'That place still exists. It's place with a story of its own.'

(150) *dödö fr rä kafar dödö fr zbo thden rä*
dödö fr \rä/ kafar dödö
melaleuca_species post 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be big melaleuca_species
fr zbo thd=en \rä/
post PROX:ALL middle=LOC 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'That place is in the middle of some dödö trees.'[8]

(151) *näbüwä fthé zanmatha ote emoth fäthnm thrätrif*
näbi=wä fthé zan\math/a ote emoth fäth=nm
one=EMPH when SG:PST:PFV:VENT\run Ote girl DIM=DAT.NSG
thrä\trif/
2|3SG>2|3PL.IO:IRR:PFV\tell
'So he escaped to Ote and informed the daughters,'

(152) *"beŋame ausi bzaföfth nafanemäwä*

[8] *dödö* 'plant species' (*Melaleuca sp.*)

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be ŋame ausi b=za\föf/th
2NSG.POSS mother old_woman MED=2|3PL>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\burn
nafane=ma=wä
3SG.POSS=CHAR=EMPH
'"Your mother burned in the flames there. It was all her fault!'

(153) *kafar yam zwafiyokwr kabe nä z swanathr."*
kafar yam zwa\fiyok/wr kabe nä z
big event 2|3SG>3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\make man INDF IAM
swa\na/thr
2|3SG>3SG.M:RPST:IPFV\eat
'She did a big crime. She ate a man."'

(154) *fi nimanzo ffé yarako*
fi nima=nzo fefe ya\r/ako
3.ABS like_this=ONLY really 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:AND\be
'He went away for good.'

(155) *fi nima mni zewaräfa*
fi nima mni ze\waräf/a
but like_this fire SG:PST:PFV\burn
'The fire was still burning.'

(156) *ŋarsira ŋasira*
ŋa\rsir/a ŋa\rsir/a
SG:PST:IPFV\burn SG:PST:IPFV\burn
'It burned and burned.'

(157) *kma zräzigrm "moba kwa krämätré? moba?"*
kma zrä\zigrm/ moba kwa krä\mätr/é moba
POT 3SG.F:IRR:PFV\look where.ABL FUT 1SG:IRR:PFV\exit where.ABL
'She tried to find a way, "Where will I get out? Where?"'

(158) *näbi ffé zaföfath ŋarsira e kwot zäbtha*
näbi fefe za\föf/ath ŋa\rsir/a e kwot
one really 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\burn SG:PST:IPFV\burn until properly
zä\bth/a
SG:PST:PFV\finish
'Everything burned down. It burned until all was over.'

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(159) *brbrnzo fof né zäthaba bafen ymden fof*
brbr=nzo fof né zä\thb/a baf=en ymd=en fof
spirit=ONLY EMPH IMN SG:PST:PFV\enter PH=LOC bird=LOC EMPH
'Only her spirit tried to escaped by entering into a bird.'

(160) *"kuka kuka" fä mane wänor*
kuka kuka fä mane wä\nor/
bird_call bird_call DIST which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\shout
'The one that is calling out "kuka kuka" over there.'

(161) *krärth ane bthan woga ane kuka kuka zrämgth krätr*
krä\r/th ane bthan woga ane kukakuka
2|3PL:IRR:PFV\do DEM magic man DEM bird_species
zrä\mg/th krä\tr/
2|3SG:PL>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\shoot 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\fall
'But the sorcerers shot the kukakuka bird and it fell to the ground.'

(162) *wati, ffé zaföfath ane fobo fä zäbtha*
wati fefe za\föf/ath ane fobo fä
then really 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\burn DEM DIST:ALL DIST
zä\bth/a
SG:PST:PFV\finish
'They burned this bird and finished her off.'

(163) *ane thrma mni fthé zäbtha*
ane thrma mni fthé zä\bth/a
DEM later fire when SG:PST:PFV\finish
'The fire then went out.'

(164) *wati nagawa ŋabrigwa sir*
wati nagawa ŋa\brig/wa si=r
then Nangawa SG:PST:IPFV\return eyes=PURP
'Nangawa returned to check on things.'

(165) *"komnzo rä o z kwarsir mnin?"*
komnzo \rä/ o z kwa\rsir/ mni=en
only 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be or IAM 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\burn fire=LOC
'"Is she still alive or did she burn in the fire?"'

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(166) *ŋabrigwa bobomr we waisam wäsü fthé sanmara*
ŋa\brig/wa bobomr we waisam wäsü fthé
SG:PST:IPFV\return until also Waisam tree_species when
san\mar/a
SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV:VENT\see
'He returned to Waisam where he saw the Wäsü tree.'

(167) *"watik fi nafazfthenwä"*
watik fi nafa-zfth=en=wä
then 3.ABS 3.POSS-reason=LOC=EMPH
'He said: "Well, it was all her fault."'

(168) *yanzo bobo yanora nafaŋareanema*
ya=nzo bobo ya\nor/a nafa-ŋare=ane=ma
tear=ONLY MED:ALL 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\shout 3.POSS-wife=POSS.SG=CHAR
'He wept profusely for his wife there.'

(169) *wati, fi näbi zäbrima*
wati fi näbi zä\brim/a
then 3.ABS one SG:PST:PFV\return
'Then he returned for good.'

(170) *zbo yamnzr ane woga oten emoth fäthä ämnzr*
zbo ya\m/nzr ane woga ote=en emoth fäth=ä
PROX:ALL 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\sit DEM man Ote=LOC girl DIM=ASSOC
ä\m/nzr
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\sit
'This man lives now in Ote together with the daughters.'

(171) *kabeyé komnzo fä nomai sumarwre*
kabe=é komnzo fä nomai su\mar/wre
people=ERG.NSG only DIST HAB 1PL>3SG.M:RPST:IPFV\see
'You can still see him there from time to time.'

(172) *ymarwre fthé fä ŋaritakwr nima*
y\mar/wre fthé fä ŋa\ritak/wr nima
1PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\see when DIST 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\cross like_this
'We sometimes see him when he crosses the river'

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(173) *firrafo yak we nima ŋabrigwr*
firra=fo \yak/ we nima ŋa\brig/wr
firra=ALL 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\walk also like_this 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\return
'to go to Firra and when comes back again.'

(174) *tnz fäth ane kabe yé*
tnz fäth ane kabe \yé/
short DIM DEM man 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'He is a small man.'

(175) *ane nzürna ŋareane zokwasi nimame fof rä fof*
ane nzürna ŋare=ane zokwasi nima=me fof
DEM spirit_woman woman=POSS.SG speech like_this=INS EMPH
\rä/ fof
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be EMPH
'That was the Nzürna's story,'

(176) *mane bobo firran zwamnzrm*
mane bobo firra=en zwa\m/nzrm
which MED:ALL firra=LOC 3SG.F:PST:DUR\sit
'about the one who lived in Firra.'

(177) *tüfr yam nä ffé thwafiyokwrm fi fathfa ane fof wäfiyokwa*
tüfr yam nä fefe thwa\fiyok/wrm fi fath=fa
plenty event INDF really SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\make but clear_place=ABL
ane fof wä\fiyok/wa
DEM EMPH SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make
'She has done many other things, but this one thing she has done in public.'

(178) *nä karma kabe mane yanatha mogarkamma*
nä kar=ma kabe mane ya\na/tha
INDF village=CHAR man which SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat
mogarkam=ma
Mogarkam=CHAR
'She ate a man from another village, a man from Mongarkam.'

(179) *ane trikasi fobonzo wythk fof brä*

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ane trikasi fobo=nzo wa\ythk/ fof
DEM story DIST:ALL=ONLY 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\come_to_end EMPH
b=\rä/
MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'This is the end of the story'

(180) *ane nzürna ŋareanema*
ane nzürna ŋare=ane=ma
DEM spirit_woman woman=POSS.SG=CHAR
'about that Nzürna.'

(181) *watik, fobo fof zräkoré*
watik fobo fof zrä\kor/é
then DIST:ALL EMPH 1SG:IRR:PFV\speak
'I have told it now.'

(182) *nä karen nima näbuné bänema*
nä kar=en nima näbun=é bäne=ma
INDF place=LOC like_this INDF=ERG.NSG PH=CHAR
'There are other stories at other places.'

(183) *nä nzürna ŋare zokwasi trikasi bä räro fi ane kar woga mane erä fi ane miyatha erä*
nä nzürna ŋare zokwasi trikasi bä \rä/ro
INDF spirit_woman woman speech story MED 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
fi ane kar woga mane e\rä/ fi ane miyatha
3.ABS DEM village man which 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be 3.ABS DEM knowledge
e\rä/
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'There are other Nzürna stories, but the villagers there know them.'

(184) *nzefé nzüwäbragwé nima ni miyatha nrä*
nzefé nz=wä\brag/wé nima ni
1SG.ERG.EMPH IPST=1SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\follow like_this 1NSG
miyatha n\rä/
knowledge 1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'I followed this one because we know it.'

(185) *nzekaren ane yam kwafiyokwrm*

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nze-kar=en ane yam kwa\fiyok/wrm
1NSG:POSS-place=LOC DEM event SG:PST:DUR\make
'This happened in our village,'

(186) *nzenme ŋafyé mä thwamnzrm*
nzenme ŋaf=é mä thwa\m/nzrm
1NSG.POSS father=ABS.NSG where 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'where our fathers lived.'

(187) *ŋafyé we nzenm natrikwath*
ŋaf=é we nzenm na\trik/wath
father=ERG.NSG also 1NSG.DAT 2|3SG>1PL.IO:PST:IPFV\tell
'And the fathers told us about it.'

(188) *nima zbo zf zakoré*
nima zbo zf za\kor/é
like_this PROX:ALL IMM 1SG>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\speak
'I have finished it (the story) here in this way.'

(189) *fof zäbthé*
fof zä\bth/é
EMPH 1SG:RPST:PFV\finish
'I am done.'

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# 10 *Nzürna trikasi bresanema* - The Nzürna story about Bres

## 10.1 Introduction

*Nzürna trikasi bresanema* is narrative lasting roughly 10min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on August 27th 2012, in both audio and video formats.[1] The story teller is Kurai Tawéth, and the recording took place in front of the yam house of one of his brothers. Kurai grew up in a Wära speaking environment, and he feels embarassed about the fact that he speaks a different dialect. Consequently, this story has already been adapted to the Komnzo dialect in the transcription, i.e. it differs from the original recording.

## 10.2 Summary & background

A man named Bres is tricked by the Nzürna while he is out hunting. The Nzürna pretends to be one of his wives. He soon realizes who she really is, and he starts running back to the village, where he finds only his old mother. His two wives and all other villagers had left for a dance in another village. The mother hides Bres in the yam house under a pile of yams. When the Nzürna arrives at the scene, she starts to fight with the mother and defeats her. Next she sends centipedes into the yam house, who give Bres painful bites. The mother is then forced to open the yam house and the Nzürna kills and eats Bres. She leaves the place, while the mother is crying about the death of her son. At the same time, Bres' wives realise that something has happened. They return to the village only to find the remains of their husband. The mother reports what has happened, and the villagers make plans to take revenge. They burn the Wäsü tree and kill the Nzürna.

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20120827-03. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189856

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## 10.3 Parallel text

*nabon ezi. nä zokwasi we zathkäfé bresanema. okay, bres bä swamnzrm yirkon. edäwä ŋare swarärm nä kanfokma nä masuma. ane ŋare mane thfrnm nge matak. bres mane sfrärm fiyaf kabe yara. fara kabe yara. nima sfiyakm bäne kwonätrkr dbäwth. okay, nzürna ŋare fä fof zwamnzrm dbäwthen. nä kayé bäne swarärm kut ŋatr. ezi sfiyakm. ane thunfirakwrm taurir ruga yem. thunzänzrm bobo fof mnzfo. karome thurzathrmth edawä ŋariyé.*

Good morning! I'll begin another story about Bres. Okay, Bres was living in *Yirko*. He had two wives. One wife was from *Kanfok* and the other was from Masu. Neither of those two women had children. Bres was a hunter, a night hunter. He used to go this way, to *Kwonä Trkr* and to *Débäwéth*. Okay, there was a Nzürna living in *Débäwéth*. One day he had set a thingamajig, a trap with a bamboo string. He went early in the morning. He caught wallaby, pig and cassowary. He carried them back to the house. The two wives cooked them in the oven.

*nä kayé farem bramöwä zane thäkuka. wathr eyaka nima kanfok. nzürna wath yara. bresane ŋare mane erna ane wath znfo zabramath. thgathifath bres ausi. ŋariyé zafarath. ezi fi zefara ŋatr sir. efirakwa tauri rusa ruga. wati karo zathkäfath thomonsi fof. karo wäfiyokwr dbäwthen. fä sfrärm. wati thufränzrm. nzürna ŋare fthé zanthora. zanrna "nzone nge ranzo äfiyokwr?" nima bresf zamara "eh, ŋamyf zanema zf kwanafr. zanema fof nzürna ŋare zä ŋamränzr. "kwot kamonegwé!" zane kwakonzr zf."*

One day all the Farem people went for a dance at *Kanfok*. It was a nzürna dance. Bres' wives followed the others to that dancing place. They left Bres and the old woman behind. After they had left, Bres went and checked his traps. He took out a wallaby, a deer and a pig. He prepared the oven and piled up firewood. He made that oven in *Débäwéth*. He stayed over there. He burnt off the fur. That was when the Nzürna appeared. She called out to him "My child, what are you doing?" Bres saw her and thought "Hey, my mother told me about this one, about this Nzürna who is moving around here. "You be careful!" is what she told me."

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*zakora "wth ane thäthor! thänmayuf nofo!" fi mane ezänza. ane thefafa bramöwä no znfo. kma trutruf zukarkwrm. ane fof thwanathrm trtha. kwafyunzrm. foba wännora "bres kanmath trutruf nof zezänzr bäne." bres nima ŋankwir keke matak. fam zära "eh z nzänathr!" bres gatha fam. karo wrzöbnth. wrnth ŋarznth. tauri ane erzöbnath.*

He told her "You take the intestines and wash them in the water!" She carried them to the creek. The stream almost took them out of her hands. So she ate them intestines raw. She gulped them down. "Bres come quickly! The water current carries them away." Bres ran to her, but the intestines were gone. He thought "She just ate them." Bad thoughts arose in his mind. They closed up the oven. They threw out the little pieces of wood. They covered the wallaby meat.

*okay nzürna ŋare fi sakora "bänemr kwa nkasinzé yamr." yamr bres krämnzer. zä kwanfathwrm. si mätraksir né sfrärm. zanr sathkäfa nzürna ŋaref dagonr fof. "ah ausi nima rar ŋafiyokwr?" "keke yam zbo erä sin." watik zakora "nima käthf! no kwanrin dbäwth! mrrab fafä satrakumth!" "okay, nzefé kwa kräré." fi mane wiyaka wämnen zärbetha. zämora. yir yarinakwr. yir no yanzänzr fobo "zrä" nima zakumtha "keke, ausi yir befé zane nzürinakwr. kwot gniyaké! bobo mrrab bä zatrakumth!" wati ausi zefara. mrrab bä fof zatrakumtha ebaren.*

Okay, the Nzürna said, "I'll pick your lice out." Bres laid down. She was holding his head like this, and tried to pull out his eyeballs. She was trying to kill him, to eat him really. He said "Old woman, why are you doing this?" She replied "No, here are lice in your eyes." Then he told her: "You go and fetch some water for me from *Débäwéth*. Break some bamboos after that!" "Okay, I will do that." She pretended to walk away, but she hid behind a tree. She leaned against the tree and pissed in the container. She brought back the urine for him and said "Here you go." He smelled it and said "No, you just pissed into it. Go again and smash the bamboos too." She walked away and this time she really smashed the bamboo against her head.

*bresf bäne karo zathkäfa thasi fof. tauri thefafa. näbun kma yakme ewäthwa. nä ane thägathifa. fi zamatha mnzfo*

Meanwhile, Bres began to open up the oven. He grabbed some of the wallaby meat and quickly wrapped it up. He

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*yirko. ausi nafaŋame ausi bana fam wrera. mane wiyaka zefara fi. nzürna ŋare zanthora. ra karesa erera karo ane kwafyunzrm. nzürna ŋaref ŋafyunza. thäbtha. tauri ane ŋafyunza wämne ssaböm bres mänwä swamnzrm. wämne ssaböm berä. ane ŋafyünza. sathkäfa bragsi. "bres" foba zwanorm "bres tauri nä kwarafinzo!" bresf nä thabr zwarafinzm wämnen. ane kwäfyurmo. erna mnz ththora.*

left some of the meat and ran back to the house at *Yirko*. He was thinking of his mother, the poor, old woman. Then the Nzürna arrived back at the oven. Whatever barks or stones were lying around, she swallowed them down. The Nzürna gulped it all down. She finished it all. She swallowed the wallaby meat and the fresh leaves in the oven and the leaves that Bres was sitting on before. Then she began to follow him calling out 'Bres, put down some wallaby meat for me!' Bres put one wallaby leg up on the branch for her and she gulped it down. She shouted again, and they kept doing this until they approached the house.

*okay, ausi zakora "ŋame, nzürna ŋaryf wanmrinzr." ausif sakora "anema fof gukonzé nima kmam foba gniyaké!" ausi bäne wäfiyokwa. wawa ane yabun yawi e eriknwa. fobo sakora "kämnzer!" aneme ythäfa. ynarwa. sabtha. mnz wwäthwa kwot ŋadme. sagathifa. ausi zwamnzrm mni thaken. mnzen fof zrfön nima bafen. fobo mane zanthora "oh ngemäku" watik ausi a nzürna ŋare zan zathkäfath. ausi bäneme kwafasinzrm yaka zanme. "ra zisé wofnzr? nzone ane nge sanmätr! zbo ythkgr." "keke, nzä ngemäre worä." zathkäfath zan. ane kwafnmth e nzürna ŋare bäne sasryoftha züm. bres zbo yfrtha kamen. "ara" ŋawarkwa. nzürna ŋaref bäne ŋad yrtmakwa. zäthba. watik "kwamänz!" bres zänmätra. watik, wth grigrinzo sanmätra. watik, fobo yanatha. watik fi zänbrima nrkarä. ausi*

Okay, Bres said to the old woman: "Mother, the Nzürna is after me." The old woman said to him: "That's why I told you not to go to that side." The old woman quickly pulled apart a big pile of yams. She said to him: "You lie down here!" She covered him up and finished this. She closed the door properly with a string and left him there. She sat down by the fire at the house door. Then the Nzürna arrived and said "Oh dear friend!" The old woman and the Nzürna began to fight. The old woman smacked her with the digging stick "What pain are you giving me? Bring out my child! He is in here." The old woman replied "I don't have any children." They fought and fought, until the Nzürna sent a centipede into the house. It bit Bres on the back and he yelled "aaah". The

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*ya zagathif ya kwosi. okay, nafane bzäbth.*

Nzürna cut the string and went inside. She said, "You lead the way!" Bres came out. First, she pulled out his guts. Then she ate him. She returned back home with a full stomach. She left the old woman in tears. She was crying badly. Okay, this part of the story is finished.

*ŋareyé bä wath znen kanfoken. erna bäne erna zargfath fi yiryir thatrakumtha. "nzenme kabe nabonzo bä yé, o?" zasath "bä namänzo nrä?" "keke, nzä nimäwä worä. nzä yiryir z zwatrakumth." "krafare!" zbären zanfarath. mät kar äniyana. thrathor. ausi zranmarth. ya zwanoro. thrakor "benme kabe z ythkagr. zyamnzr! nzürna ŋare z nziyanathr."*

The two women were at the dancing place at *Kanfok*. While they were there, they realized something had happened. They suddenly had to pee. "Is our husband okay or not?" They asked each other "Are you okay?" "No, I am the same like you. I've already wet myself." "We have to get going." They left during the night. They came to *Mät Kar*. They arrived at the place and found the old woman in tears. She said "Your husband is inside. He is sitting here. The Nzürna has just eaten him."

*foba mane rera yak kabe ane kwamosinzrmth. bthan kabe zerä bthan kabe fof. ane tmatm wäfiyokwrath bafen yirkon. fafä zanmänzath bobo fof nzürna ŋare mobo zfrärm. kabe berä. ausi fäth mni wthosinzrath ane wäsi bafen. wäsi mnzen zwamnzrm. wati wthosinzath. zaföfth. wati, ane u kwan boba zekarisa. watik fthé fof zethkäfa "nzukarfa bäne sathor borbor fof." fthé fof zwanorm "ŋokä". ane zokwasi kwanafrm. nafan nima zwarärm. kma sfrärm borbor fi mni zürnane u kwan zethkäfako. mni ane zäföfa wäsi. zbofä wärsokwa ane mni thamin fof.*

They informed the other villagers. They came together. There were sorcerers amongst them. They practiced their magic in *Yirko* and led the others to the place where the Nzürna lived. Men and women came and piled firewood by the Wäsi tree. Then they set it on fire. She heard the sound of the fire saying "The wind is coming from my place." She shouted "ŋokä". She was saying those magic words. She thought it must be the wind, but it was the sound of the smoke rising. The fire was burning this Wäsi tree. The flames shocked her up there in

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*thm mane zathor. yame kma kränzir. nge nä kränzir. yirme kma wnkunzr. keke! nge ane bramöwä nafane mane erera mnifo kwanrzrm. nima okay nafafis oroman mane yara zäfänira. nrkarä fafä zathorako ane nzürna ŋare "bä namänzo nnrä? ra nr nrä? kabe zä yak. befä msfnzé!" nimawä sakora "ra befä nä z yase änthorakwr? komnzo fof nrugwr!" wati, mnifo ane fof zänfüsa. bthan kabeyé mitafo wfathwath. fam wärtmakwath.*

the tree. The flames reached her and she threw out the mat. She threw out the children. She tried in vain to piss on the fire. She threw all her children into the fire. Nzürna's husband, the old man, had already fled. Earlier when she had arrived with a full stomach, he had asked: "Are you okay? What is with your stomach? There was a man walking along here. You might have killed him!" She replied "What? Did you get any meat for the children? You just go to sleep!" Okay, she finally threw herself into the fire and burned to death. The sorcerers caught her spirit. They had blocked her mind also.

*wati, zena znamnzr ni znrä. nzenme nge nabonzo fzen eyak. zöbthé mane zfrärm keke nima kwamränzrmth. gathagatha kar zfrärm. ane wäsi zfthen kabe kam ane thfthnm kabe tüfr. kabe tüfr naf z änatha. ruga kam, yem kam, tauri kam, kabe kam. dmädrma faremma nä z änatha ane nzürna ŋare. okay, bobo zäbth ane zokwasi. eso bana. eso kafar.*

Today we live here in this place. Our children are safe when they walk through the forest. In the past, the children didn't move around. It was a dangerous place. Human bones were lying around that Wäsi tree. She had eaten many people. There were pig bones, cassowary bones, wallaby bones and also human bones. She had eaten some people from *Démändér* and from *Farem*, that Nzürna woman. Okay, the story ends here. Thank you my friend. Thank you very much.

*nabon trikasi rä. näbunf fafä maf kratrikwr, keke ane! nzone mane yara bres nzone kabe zfth nzone yara. nzone bada yara. ane festhfa rera ane yam. nafane msaksi zn mane rera yirkon swamnzrm. bäne fafä yrko zamar nzone bad fä fof ŋabrigwr nimame. eso kafar.*

It is a good story. Others should not tell this story. It is mine. Bres was my ancestor. He was my greatgrandfather. This was a true thing that happened. As for Bres' home, he was living in *Yirko*. You can see my land at *Yirko*. Thank you!

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## 10.4 Glossed text

(1) *nabon ezi*
nabon ezi
good morning
'Good morning!'

(2) *nä zokwasi we zathkäfé bresanema*
nä zokwasi we za\thkäf/é bres=ane=ma
INDF speech also 1SG>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\start PN=POSS.SG=CHAR
'I'll begin another story about Bres.'

(3) *okay, bres bä swamnzrm yirkon*
okay bres bä swa\m/nzrm yirko=en
okay PN MED 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit PLN=LOC
'Okay, Bres was living in Yirko.'

(4) *edäwä ŋare swarärm*
eda=wä ŋare swa\rä/rm
two=EMPH woman 3SG.M.IO:PST:DUR\be
'He had two wives.'

(5) *nä kanfokma nä masuma*
nä kanfok=ma nä masu=ma
INDF PLN=CHAR INDF PLN=CHAR
'One wife was from Kanfok and the other was from Masu.'

(6) *ane ŋare mane thfrnm nge matak*
ane ŋare mane thf\rn/m nge matak
DEM woman which 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be child nothing
'Neither of those two women had children.'

(7) *bres mane sfrärm fiyaf kabe yara*
bres mane sf\rä/rm fiyaf kabe ya\r/a
PN which 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be hunt man 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'Bres was a hunter,'

(8) *fara kabe yara*
fara kabe ya\r/a
night_hunting man 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'a night hunter.'

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(9) *nima sfiyakm bäne kwonätrkr dbäwth*
nima sf\yak/m bäne kwonätrkr dbäwth
like_this 3SG.M:PST:DUR\walk PH.ABS PLN PLN
'He used to go this way, to Kwonä Trkr and to Débäwéth.'

(10) *okay, nzürna ŋare fä fof zwamnzrm dbäwthen*
okay nzürna ŋare fä fof zwa\m/nzrm dbäwth=en
okay spirit_woman woman DIST EMPH 3SG.F:PST:DUR\sit PLN=LOC
'Okay, there was a Nzürna living in Débäwéth.'

(11) *nä kayé bäne swarärm kut ŋatr*
nä kayé bäne swa\rä/rm kut ŋatr
INDF one_day_away PH.ABS 3SG.M.IO:PST:DUR\be trap string
'One day he had set a whatchmacallit, a trap with a bamboo string.'

(12) *ezi sfiyakm ane thunfirakwrm taurir ruga yem*
ezi sf\yak/m ane
morning 3SG.M:PST:DUR\walk DEM
thun\firak/wrm tauri=r ruga yem
SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\take_from_net wallaby=PURP pig cassowary
'He went early in the morning. He caught wallaby, pig and cassowary.'

(13) *thunzänzrm bobo fof mnzfo*
thun\zä/nzrm bobo fof mnz=fo
SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\carry MED:ALL EMPH house=ALL
'He carried them back to the house.'

(14) *karome thurzathrmth edawä ŋariyé*
karo=me thu\rza/thrmth eda=wä ŋare=é
ground_oven=INS 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\bake two=EMPH woman=ERG.NSG
'The two wives cooked them in the oven.'

(15) *nä kayé farem bramöwä zane thäkuka. wathr eyaka nima kanfok*
nä kayé farem bramöwä zane thä\kuk/a
INDF one_day_away Farem all DEM:PROX 2|3PL:PST:PFV\stand
wath=r e\yak/a nima kanfok
dance=PURP 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\walk like_this Kanfok
'One day all the Farem people went for a dance at Kanfok.'

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(16) *nzürna wath yara*
nzürna wath ya\r/a
spirit_woman dance 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'It was a nzürna dance.'[2]

(17) *bresane ŋare mane erna ane wath znfo zabramath*
bres=ane ŋare mane e\rn/a ane wath zn=fo
Bres=POSS.SG woman which 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be DEM dance place=ALL
za\bram/ath
2|3DU:PST:PFV\follow
'Bres' wives followed the others to that dancing place.'

(18) *thgathifath bres ausi*
th\gathif/ath bres ausi
2|3PL>2|3DU:PST:PFV\leave Bres old_woman
'They left Bres and the old woman behind.'

(19) *ŋariyé zafarath ezi fi zefara ŋatr sir*
ŋare=é za\far/ath ezi fi ze\far/a
woman=ABS.NSG 2|3DU:PST:PFV\set_off morning 3.ABS SG:PST:PFV\set_off
ŋatr si=r
string eyes=PURP
'After the women had left, (Bres) went off to check his traps in the morning.'

(20) *efirakwa tauri rusa ruga*
e\firak/wa tauri rusa ruga
SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\take_from_net wallaby deer pig
'He took out a wallaby, a deer and a pig.'

(21) *wati karo zathkäfath thomonsi fof*
wati karo za\thkäf/ath thomon-si fof
then ground_oven 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV\start make_fire-NMLZ EMPH
'He prepared the oven and piled up firewood.'

(22) *karo wäfiyokwr dbäwthen*
karo wä\fiyok/wr dbäwth=en
ground_oven 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\make PLN=LOC
'He made that oven in Débäwéth.'

[2]This is the traditional dance style of the Farem people.

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(23) *fä sfrärm*
fä sf\rä/rm
DIST 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'He stayed over there.'

(24) *wati thufränzrm*
wati thu\frä/nzrm
then SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\singe_off
'He burnt off the fur.'

(25) *nzürna ŋare fthé zanthora*
nzürna ŋare fthé zan\thor/a
spirit_woman woman when 3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\appear
'That was when the Nzürna appeared.'

(26) *zanrna "nzone nge ranzo äfiyokwr?"*
zan\rn/a nzone nge ra=nzo
3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\shout 1SG.POSS child what.ABS=ONLY
ä\fiyok/wr
2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\make
'She called out to him "My child, what are you doing?"'

(27) *nima bresf zamara "eh*
nima bres=f za\mar/a eh
like_this Bres=ERG.SG SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\see hey
'Bres saw her (and thought) "Hey,'

(28) *ŋamyf zanema zf kwanafr*
ŋame=f zane=ma zf kwa\naf/r
mother=ERG.SG DEM:PROX=CHAR ABSC 2|3SG:RPST:IPFV:VENT\talk
'my mother told me about this one.'

(29) *zanema fof nzürna ŋare zä ŋamränzr*
zane=ma fof nzürna ŋare zä ŋa\mrä/nzr
DEM:PROX=CHAR EMPH spirit_woman woman PROX 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\stroll
'about this nzürna who is moving around here.'

(30) *"kwot kamonegwé" zane kwakonzr zf"*
kwot ka\moneg/wé zane kwa\ko/nzr zf
properly 2SG:IMP:IPFV\wait DEM:PROX 2|3SG>1SG:RPST:IPFV\speak ABSC
'"You be careful!" is what she told me."'

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(31) *zakora "wth ane thäthor*
za\kor/a wth ane thä\thor/
SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\speak faeces DEM 2SG>2|3PL:IMP:PFV\carry
'He told her "You take the intestines and'

(32) *thänmayuf nofo"*
thän\mayuf/ no=fo
2SG>2|3PL:IMP:PFV:VENT\wash water=ALL
'wash them in the water!"'

(33) *fi mane ezänza ane thefafa bramöwä no znfo*
fi mane e\zä/nza ane thä\faf/a
3.ABS which SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\carry DEM SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hold
bramöwä no zn=fo
all water place=ALL
'She carried all to the water.'

(34) *kma trutruf zukarkwrm ane fof thwanathrm trtha*
kma trutru=f zu\kark/wrm ane fof
POT stream=ERG.SG SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\pull DEM EMPH
thwa\na/thrm trtha
SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\eat life
'The stream of water almost tore them out of her hands. So she ate them (intestines) raw.'

(35) *kwafyunzrm*
kwa\fyu/nzrm
SG:PST:DUR\swallow
'She swallowed them down.'

(36) *foba wännora "bres kanmath*
foba wän\nor/a bres kan\math/
DIST:ABL 3SG.F:PST:IPFV:VENT\shout Bres 2SG:IMP:PFV:VENT\run
'She shouted "Bres come quickly!'

(37) *trutruf nof zezänzr bäne."*
trutru=f no=f z=e\zä/nzr bäne
stream=ERG.SG water=ERG.SG PROX=2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\carry PH.ABS
'The water current carries them away."'

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(38) *bres nima ŋankwir keke matak*
bres nima ŋan\kwir/ keke matak
Bres like_this 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\run NEG nothing
'Bres ran towards her, but the guts were gone.'

(39) *fam zära "eh z nzänathr"*
fam zä\r/a eh z nz=ä\na/thr
thought SG:PST:PFV\do hey IAM IPST=2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\eat
'He thought "She just ate them."'

(40) *bres gatha fam*
bres gatha fam
Bres bad thought
'Bad thoughts arose in his mind.'

(41) *karo wrzöbnth*
karo w\rzöb/nth
ground_oven 2|3DU>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\cover
'They closed up the oven.'

(42) *wrnth ŋarznth tauri ane erzöbnath*
w\rn/th ŋa\rz/nth tauri ane
2|3DU>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\do 2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\throw wallaby DEM
e\rzöb/nath
2|3DU>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\close_oven
'They threw out (the little pieces of wood). They covered the wallaby meat.'

(43) *okay nzürna ŋare fi sakora*
okay nzürna ŋare fi sa\kor/a
okay spirit_woman woman 3.ABS SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\speak
'Okay, the Nzürna said,'

(44) *"bänemr kwa nkasinzé yamr"*
bäne=r kwa n\kasi/nzé yam=r
PH=PURP FUT 1SG>2SG:NPST:IPFV\open_up louse=PURP
'"I'll pick your lice out."'

(45) *yamr bres krämnzer*

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yam=r bres krä\mnzer/
louse=PURP Bres 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\fall_asleep
'Bres laid down.'

(46) *zä kwanfathwrm. si mätraksir né sfrärm*
zä kwan\fath/wrm si mätrak-si=r n sf\rä/rm
PROX SG:PST:DUR:VENT\hold eyes exit-NMLZ=PURP IMN 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'She was holding his head like this, and tried to pull out his eyeballs.'

(47) *zanr sathkäfa nzürna ŋaref*
zan=r sa\thkäf/a nzürna ŋare=f
hit=PURP SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\start spirit_woman wife=ERG.SG
'The nzürna was trying to kill him,'

(48) *dagonr fof*
dagon=r fof
food=PURP EMPH
'to eat him really.'

(49) *"ah ausi nima rar ŋafiyokwr?" "keke yam zbo erä sin"*
ah ausi nima rar ŋa\fiyok/wr keke yam
ah old_woman like_this what.PURP 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\make NEG louse
zbo e\rä/ si=en
PROX:ALL 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be eyes=LOC
'He said "Old woman, why are you doing this?" She replied "No, here are lice in your eyes."'

(50) *watik zakora*
wati za\kor/a
then SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\speak
'Then he told her:'

(51) *"nima käthf no kwanrin dbäwth"*
nima kä\thf/ no kwan\rin/ dbäwth
like_this 2SG:IMP:PFV\walk water 2SG>1SG.IO:IMP:PFV:VENT\pour PLN
'"You go and fetch some water for me from Débäwéth.'

(52) *mrrab fafä satrakumth"*
mrrab fafä sa\trakumth/
small_bamboo after_that 2SG>3SG.M:IMP:PFV\smash
'Break some bamboos after that!"'

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(53) *"okay, nzefé kwa kräré."*
okay nzefé kwa krä\r/é
okay 1SG.ERG.EMPH FUT 1SG:IRR:PFV\do
'"Okay, I will do that."'

(54) *fi mane wiyaka wämnen zärbetha*
fi mane w\yak/a wämne=en zä\rbeth/a
3.ABS which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\walk tree=LOC SG:PST:PFV\protect
'She walked of, but she hid behind a tree.'

(55) *zämora yir yarinakwr*
zä\mor/a yir ya\rinak/wr
SG:PST:PFV\lean urine 2|3SG>3SG.M.IO:NPST:IPFV\pour
'She leaned (against the tree) and urinated in the container for him.'

(56) *yir no yanzänzr fobo "zrä"*
yir no yan\zä/nzr fobo
urine water 2|3SG>3SG.M.IO:NPST:IPFV:VENT\carry DIST:ALL
z=\rä/
PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'She brought the urine for him and said "Here you go."'

(57) *nima zakumtha "keke*
nima za\kumth/a keke
like_this SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\smell NEG
'He smelled it and said "No'

(58) *ausi yir befé zane nzürinakwr*
ausi yir befé zane
old_woman urine 2SG.ERG.EMPH DEM:PROX
nz=w\rinak/wr
IPST=2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\pour
'old woman, you pissed into it!'

(59) *kwot gniyaké bobo mrrab bä zatrakumth"*
kwot gn\yak/é bobo mrrab bä
properly 2SG:IMP:IPFV\walk MED:ALL small_bamboo MED
za\trakumth/
2SG>3SG.F:IMP:PFV\smash
'Go again! and smash the bamboos too."'

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(60) *wati ausi zefara mrrab bä fof zatrakumtha ebaren*
wati ausi ze\far/a mrrab bä fof
then old_woman SG:PST:PFV\set_off small_bamboo MED EMPH
za\trakumth/a ebar=en
2SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\smash head=LOC
'She walked away and really hit the bamboo on her head.'

(61) *bresf bäne karo zathkäfa thasi fof*
bres=f bäne karo za\thkäf/a
Bres=ERG.SG PH.ABS ground_oven SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\start
tha-si fof
open_oven-NMLZ EMPH
'Meanwhile, Bres began to open the oven.'

(62) *tauri thefafa näbun kma yakme ewäthwa*
tauri thä\faf/a näbun kma yakme
wallaby SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\hold INDF POT quickly
e\wäth/wa
SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\wrap
'He grabbed some of the wallaby meat and quickly wrapped them up.'

(63) *nä ane thägathifa*
nä ane thä\gathif/a
INDF DEM SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\leave
'He left some of the meat behind'

(64) *fi zamatha mnzfo yirko*
fi za\math/a mnz=fo yirko
3.ABS SG:PST:PFV\run house=ALL Yirko
'and he ran towards the house at Yirko.'

(65) *ausi nafaŋame ausi bana fam wrera*
ausi nafa-ŋame ausi bana fam
old_woman 3.POSS-mother old_woman pitiful thought
w\rä/ra
SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\do
'He thought of his mother, the poor, old woman.'

(66) *mane wiyaka zefara fi. nzürna ŋari zanthora*

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mane w\yak/a ze\far/a fi nzürna
which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\walk SG:PST:PFV\set_off 3.ABS spirit_woman
ŋare zan\thor/a
woman 3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\appear
'As he ran off, the Nzürna arrived (back at the oven).'

(67) *ra karesa erera karo ane kwafyunzrm*
ra karesa e\rä/ra karo ane
what.ABS paperbark 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be ground_oven DEM
kwa\fyu/nzrm
SG:PST:DUR\swallow
'Whatever bark and stones were lying around, she swallowed them.'

(68) *nzürna ŋaref ŋafyunza thäbtha*
nzürna ŋare=f ŋa\fyu/nza thä\bth/a
spirit_woman wife=ERG.SG SG:PST:IPFV\swallow SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\finish
'The Nzürna swallowed it all down. She finished it all.'

(69) *tauri ane ŋafyunza wämne ssaböm bres mänwä swamnzrm wämne ssaböm berä*
tauri ane ŋa\fyu/nza wämne ssaböm bres mänwä
wallaby DEM SG:PST:IPFV\swallow tree fresh_leaves Bres where.EMPH
swa\m/nzrm wämne ssaböm b=e\rä/
3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit tree fresh_leaves MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'She swallowed the wallaby meat and the fresh leaves (in the oven) and the leaves that bres was sitting on.'

(70) *ane ŋafyünza*
ane ŋa\fyu/nza
DEM SG:PST:IPFV\swallow
'She swallowed these.'

(71) *sathkäfa bragsi*
sa\thkäf/a brag-si
SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\start follow-NMLZ
'She began to follow him.'

(72) *"bres" foba zwanorm "bres tauri nä kwarafinzo"*

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bres foba zwa\nor/m bres tauri nä
Bres DIST:ABL 3SG.F:PST:DUR\shout Bres wallaby INDF
kwa\rafinz/o
2SG>1SG.IO:IMP:PFV:AND\put_on_top
'She called out, 'Bres, put down some wallaby meat for me!''

(73) *bresf nä thabr zwarafinzm wämnen*
bres=f nä thabr zwa\rafi/nzm wämne=en
Bres=ERG.SG INDF hand SG>3SG.F.IO:PST:DUR\put_on_top tree=LOC
'Bres put one wallby leg up on the branch for her'

(74) *ane kwäfyurmo*
ane kwä\fyur/mo
DEM SG:ITER:DUR:AND\swallow
'and she gulped it down.'

(75) *erna mnz ththora*
e\rn/a mnz th\thor/a
2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be house 2|3DU:PST:PFV\appear
'They kept doing this until they approached the house.'

(76) *okay, ausi zakora "ŋame, nzürna ŋaryf wanmrinzr"*
okay ausi za\kor/a ŋame nzürna
okay old_woman SG>3SG.F:PST:PFV\speak mother spirit_woman
ŋare=f wan\mrinz/r
woman=ERG.SG 2|3SG>1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\chase
'Okay, Bres said to the old woman: "Mother, the Nzürna is after me."'

(77) *ausif sakora "anema fof gukonzé nima kmam foba gniyaké"*
ausi=f sa\kor/a ane=ma fof
old_woman=ERG.SG SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\speak DEM=CHAR EMPH
gu\ko/nzé nima kma=m foba gn\yak/é
1SG>2SG:RPST:IPFV\speak like_this POT=APPR DIST:ABL 2SG:IMP:IPFV\walk
'The old woman said to him: "That's why I told you not to go to this side."'

(78) *ausi bäne wäfiyokwa*
ausi bäne wä\fiyok/wa
old_woman PH.ABS SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make
'The old woman was doing this,'

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(79) *wawa ane yabun yawi e eriknwa*
wawa ane yabun yawi e e\rikn/wa
round_yam DEM big round_object until SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\destroy
'she pulled apart a big pile of yams.'

(80) *fobo sakora "kämnzer"*
fobo sa\kor/a kä\mnzer/
DIST:ALL SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\speak 2SG:IMP:PFV\fall_asleep
'She said to him: "You lie down here!"'

(81) *aneme ythäfa ynarwa sabtha*
ane=me y\thäf/a y\nar/wa
DEM=INS SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\cover SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\press_down
sa\bth/a
SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\finish
'She covered him up and finshed this.'

(82) *mnz wwäthwa kwot ŋadme sagathifa*
mnz w\wäth/wa kwot ŋad=me sa\gathif/a
house SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\wrap properly rope=INS SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\leave
'She closed the door properly with a string and left him there.'

(83) *ausi zwamnzrm mni thaken*
ausi zwa\m/nzrm mni thak=en
old_woman 3SG.F:PST:DUR\sit fire fire_place=LOC
'She sat down by the fire.'

(84) *mnzen fof zrfön nima bafen*
mnz=en fof zrfö=en nima bafen
house=LOC EMPH door=LOC like_this PH.LOC
'at the house door really.'

(85) *fobo mane zanthora "oh ngemäku"*
fobo mane zan\thor/a oh ngemäku
DIST:ALL which 3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\appear oh address_term
'Then (the Nzürna) arrived and said "Oh dear friend!"'

(86) *watik ausi a nzürna ŋare zan zathkäfath*
wati ausi a nzürna ŋare zan za\thkäf/ath
then old_woman and spirit_woman woman fight 2|3DU:PST:PFV\start
'The old woman and the Nzürna began to fight.'

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(87) *ausi bäneme kwafasinzrm yaka zanme*
ausi bäne=me kwa\fasi/nzrm yaka zan=me
old_woman PH=INS SG:PST:DUR\make_noise digging_stick hit=INS
'She hit her with the digging stick'

(88) *"ra zisé wofnzr?*
ra zisé wo\fn/zr
what.ABS painful 2|3SG>1SG:NPST:IPFV\hit
'"What pain are you giving me?'

(89) *nzone ane nge sanmätr*
nzone ane nge san\mätr/
1SG.POSS DEM child 2SG>3SG.M:IMP:PFV:VENT\exit
'Bring out my child!'

(90) *zbo ythkgr"*
zbo y\th/kgr
PROX:ALL 3SG.M:NPST:STAT\be_inside
'He is in here."'

(91) *"keke nzä ngemäre worä"*
keke nzä nge=mär wo\rä/
NEG 1SG.ABS child=PRIV 1SG:NPST:IPFV\be
'The old woman replied "No, I don't have any children."'

(92) *zathkäfath zan*
za\thkäf/ath zan
2|3DU:PST:PFV\start fight
'They began to fight and'

(93) *ane kwafnmth e*
ane kwa\fn/nmth e
DEM 2|3DU:PST:DUR\fight until
'kept on fighting until'

(94) *nzürna ŋare bäne sasryoftha züm*
nzürna ŋare bäne sa\sryofth/a züm
spirit_woman woman PH.ABS SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\send centipede
'the Nzürna send in a centipede.'

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(95) *bres zbo yfrtha kamen "ara" ŋawarkwa*
bres zbo y\fr/tha kam=en ara ŋa\wark/wa
Bres PROX:ALL SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\bite back=LOC ouch SG:PST:IPFV\howl
'It bit Bres on the back and he yelled "aaah".'

(96) *nzürna ŋaref bäne ŋad yrtmakwa zäthba*
nzürna ŋare=f ŋad y\rtmak/wa zä\thb/a
spirit_woman wife=ERG.SG rope SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\cut SG:PST:PFV\enter
'The Nzürna cut the string and went inside.'

(97) *watik "kwamänz"*
wati kwa\mänz/
then 2SG>1SG:IMP:PFV\lead
'She said, "You lead the way!"'

(98) *bres zänmätra*
bres zän\mätr/a
Bres SG:PST:PFV:VENT\exit
'Bres came out.'

(99) *watik, wth grigrinzo sanmätra*
wati wth grigri=nzo san\mätr/a
then faeces maggot=ONLY SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV:VENT\exit
'She pulled out the worm (from his guts) and'

(100) *watik, fobo yanatha*
wati fobo ya\na/tha
then DIST:ALL SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat
'then, she ate him.'

(101) *watik fi zänbrima nrkarä*
wati fi zän\brim/a nr=karä
then 3.ABS SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return belly=PROP
'She returned back home with a full stomach'

(102) *ausi ya zagathif ya kwosi*
ausi ya za\gathif/ ya kwosi
old_woman tear 2|3SG>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\leave tear dead
'and left the old woman in tears. She was crying badly.'

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(103) *okay, nafane bzäbth*
okay nafane b=zä\bth/
okay 3SG.POSS MED=2|3SG:RPST:PFV\finish
'Okay, this (part of the story) is finished.'

(104) *ŋariyé bä wath znen kanfoken*
ŋare=é bä wath zn=en kanfok=en
woman=ABS.NSG MED dance place=LOC Kanfok=LOC
'The two women were at the dancing place at Kanfok.'

(105) *erna bäne erna*
e\rn/a bäne e\rn/a
2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be PH.ABS 2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be
'While they were there,'

(106) *zargfath fi yiryir thatrakumtha*
za\rgf/ath fi yir~yir tha\trakumth/a
2|3DU:PST:PFV\recognize 3.ABS REDUP~urine SG>2|3DU:PST:PFV\smash
'they realized something had happened. They suddenly had to pee.'[3]

(107) *nzenme kabe nabonzo bä yé o*
nzenme kabe nabon=nzo bä \yé/ o
1NSG.POSS man good=ONLY MED 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be or
'"Is our husband okay or not?"'

(108) *zasath "bä namänzo nrä?" "keke nzä nimäwä worä*
za\s/ath bä namä=nzo n\rä/ keke nzä
2|3DU:PST:PFV\ask 2.ABS good=ONLY 2SG:NPST:IPFV\be NEG 1SG.ABS
nima=wä wo\rä/
like_this=EMPH 1SG:NPST:IPFV\be
'They asked each other "Are you okay?" "No, I am the same (like you).'

(109) *nzä yiryir z zwatrakumth"*
nzä yir~yir z zwa\trakumth/
1SG.ABS REDUP~urine IAM 2|3SG>1SG:RPST:PFV\smash
'I've already wet myself."'

[3]A sudden urge of peeing is a sign that something bad has happened.

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(110) *"krafare" zbären zanfarath*
kra\far/e zbär=en zan\far/ath
1DU:IRR:PFV\set_off night=LOC 2|3DU:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off
'"We'll get going." They left during the night.'

(111) *mät kar äniyana*
mät kar än\yan/a
Mät place 2|3DU:PST:IPFV:VENT\come
'They came to Mät Kar.'

(112) *thrathor*
thra\thor/
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\appear
'They arrived at the place there'

(113) *ausi zranmarth ya zwanoro*
ausi zran\mar/th ya
old_woman 2|3DU>3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\see tear
zwa\nor/o
3SG.F:RPST:IPFV:AND\shout
'and found old woman in tears.'

(114) *thrakor "benme kabe z ythkagr*
thra\kor/ benme kabe z
2|3SG>2|3DU:IRR:PFV\speak 2NSG:POSS man IAM
y\th/kagr
3SG.M:NPST:STAT\be_inside
'She said "Your husband is inside.'

(115) *zyamnzr*
z=ya\m/nzr
PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\sit
'He is sitting here.'

(116) *nzürna ŋare z nziyanathr*
nzürna ŋare z nz=ya\na/thr
spirit_woman woman IAM IPST=2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\eat
'The Nzürna has just eaten him."'

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(117) *foba mane rera yak kabe ane kwamosinzrmth*
foba mane \rä/ra yak kabe ane kwa\mosi/nzrmth
DIST:ABL which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be run man DEM 2|3PL:PST:DUR\gather
'They went (to inform) the people. They came together.'

(118) *bthan kabe zerä bthan kabe fof*
bthan kabe z=e\rä/ bthan kabe fof
magic man PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be magic man EMPH
'There were sorcerers here.'

(119) *ane tmatm wäfiyokwrath bafen yrkon*
ane tmatm wä\fiyok/wath bafen yirko=en
DEM action 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make PH.LOC Yirko=LOC
'They practiced their magic in Yirko.'

(120) *fafä zanmänzath bobo fof nzürna ŋare mobo zfrärm*
fafä zan\mänz/ath bobo fof nzürna ŋare
after_that 2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\lead MED:ALL EMPH spirit_woman woman
mobo zf\rä/rm
where.ALL 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
'Then they led the others to the place where the Nzürna lived.'

(121) *kabe berä ausi fäth*
kabe b=e\rä/ ausi fäth
man MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be old_woman DIM
'Men and women came along.'

(122) *mni wthosinzrath ane wäsi bafen*
mni w\thosi/nzrath ane wäsi bafen
firewood 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make_fire DEM tree_species PH.LOC
'They stacked firewood by the Wäsi tree.'

(123) *wäsi mnzen zwamnzrm*
wäsi mnz=en zwa\m/nzrm
tree_species house=LOC 3SG.F:PST:DUR\sit
'While she stayed in house in the tree.'

(124) *wati wthosinzath zaföfth*
wati w\thosi/nzrath za\föf/th
then 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make_fire 2|3PL>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\burn
'Then they set it on fire.'

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(125) *wati, ane u kwan boba zekarisa*
wati ane u_kwan boba ze\karis/a
then DEM sound_of_fire MED:ABL SG:PST:PFV\hear
'She heard the sound of the fire.'

(126) *watik fthé fof zethkäfa "nzukarfa bäne sathor borbor fof"*
wati fthé fof ze\thkäf/a nzu-kar=fa bäne
then when EMPH SG:PST:PFV\start 1SG.POSS-place=ABL PH.ABS
sa\thor/ borbor fof
3SG.M:RPST:PFV\appear strong_wind EMPH
'She was saying "The wind is coming from my place."'

(127) *fthé fof zwanorm "ŋokä" ane zokwasi kwanafrm*
fthé fof zwa\nor/m ŋokä ane zokwasi kwa\naf/rm
when EMPH 3SG.F:PST:DUR\shout *** DEM speech SG:PST:DUR\talk
'She shouted "ŋokä". She was saying those (magic) words.'

(128) *nafan nima zwarärm kma sfrärm borbor*
nafan nima zwa\rä/rm kma sf\rä/rm
3SG.DAT like_this 3SG.F.IO:PST:DUR\be POT 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
borbor
strong_wind
'She thought it must be the wind,'

(129) *fi mni zürnane u kwan zethkäfako*
fi mni zürn=ane u_kwan ze\thkäf/ako
but fire smoke=POSS.SG sound_of_fire SG:PST:PFV:AND\start
'but, it was the sound of the smoke rising.'

(130) *mni ane zäföfa wäsi*
mni ane zä\föf/a wäsi
fire DEM SG:PST:PFV\burn tree_species
'The fire was burning on this Wäsi tree.'

(131) *zbofä wärsokwa ane mni thamin fof*
zbo=fa wä\rsok/wa ane mni thamin fof
PROX:ALL=ABL SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\disturb DEM fire tongue EMPH
'The flames shocked her up there (in the tree).'

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(132) *thm mane zathor*
thm mane za\thor/
nose which 3SG.F:RPST:PFV\appear
'The flames reached her and'

(133) *yame kma kränzir*
yame kma krän\zir/
mat POT 2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\throw
'she threw out the mat.'

(134) *nge nä kränzir*
nge nä krän\zir/
child INDF 2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\throw
'She threw out the children.'

(135) *yirme kma wnkunzr keke*
yir=me kma wn\ku/nzr keke
urine=INS POT 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\put_off NEG
'She tried in vain to urinate on the fire.'

(136) *nge ane bramöwä nafane mane erera mnifo kwanrzrm*
nge ane bramöwä nafane mane e\rä/ra mni=fo
child DEM all 3SG.POSS which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be fire=ALL
kwan\rz/rm
SG:PST:DUR:VENT\throw
'She threw all her children into the fire.'

(137) *nima okay nafafis oroman mane yara zäfänira*
nima okay nafa-fis oroman mane ya\r/a
like_this okay 3.POSS-husband old_man which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
zä\fänir/a
SG:PST:PFV\shift_place
'Nzürna's husband, the old man, had already fled.'

(138) *nrkarä fafä zathorako ane nzürna ŋare*
nr=karä fafä za\thor/ako ane nzürna
belly=PROP after_that 3SG.F:PST:PFV:AND\appear DEM spirit_woman
ŋare
woman
'Earlier when she had arrived with a full stomach, he asked:'

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(139) *"bä namänzo nnrä ra nr nrä?"*
bä namä=nzo nn\rä/ ra nr
2.ABS good=ONLY 2SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be what.ABS belly
n\rä/
2SG:NPST:IPFV\be
'"Are you okay? What is with you stomach?'

(140) *kabe zä yak*
kabe zä \yak/
man PROX 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\walk
'There was a man is walking along here.'

(141) *befä msfnzé*
befé m=s\fn/zé
2SG.ERG.EMPH APPR=1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\hit
'You might have killed him!"'

(142) *nimawä sakora*
nima=wä sa\kor/a
like_this=EMPH SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\speak
'She replied'

(143) *ra befä nä z yase änthorakwr*
ra befé nä z yase
what.ABS 2SG.ERG.EMPH INDF IAM game
än\thorak/wr
2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\search
'"What? Did you get any meat for the children?'

(144) *komnzo fof nrugwr*
komnzo fof n\ru/gr
only EMPH 2SG:NPST:IPFV\sleep
'You just go to sleep!"'

(145) *wati, mnifo ane fof zänfüsa*
wati mni=fo ane fof zän\füs/a
then fire=ALL DEM EMPH SG:PST:PFV:VENT\burn_down
'Okay, she finally threw herself into the fire and burned to death.'

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(146) *bthan kabeyé mitafo wfathwath*
bthan kabe=é mitafo w\fath/wath
magic people=ERG.NSG ghost 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\hold
'The sorcerers caught her spirit.'

(147) *fam wärtmakwath*
fam wä\rtmak/wath
thought 2|3PL>3SG.F.IO:PST:IPFV\cut
'They blocked her mind also.'

(148) *wati, zena znamnzr ni znrä*
wati zena z=na\m/nzr ni z=n\rä/
then today PROX=1PL:NPST:IPFV\sit 1NSG PROX=1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'Today we are here.'

(149) *nzenme nge nabonzo fzen eyak*
nzenme nge nabon=nzo fz=en e\yak/
1NSG.POSS child good=ONLY forest=LOC 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\walk
'Our children are safe when they walk through the forest.'

(150) *zöbthé mane zfrärm keke nima kwamränzrmth*
zöbthé mane zf\rä/rm keke nima kwa\mrä/nzrmth
first which 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be NEG like_this 2|3PL:PST:DUR\stroll
'In the past, the children didn't move around.'

(151) *gathagatha kar zfrärm*
gatha kar zf\rä/rm
bad place 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
'It was a dangerous place.'

(152) *ane wäsi zfthen kabe kam ane thfthnm kabe tüfr*
ane wäsi zfth=en kabe kam ane thf\thn/m
DEM tree_species tree_base=LOC man bone DEM 2|3PL:PST:DUR\lie_down
'Human bones were lying around on the base of that Wäsi tree.'

(153) *kabe tüfr naf z änatha*
kabe tüfr naf z ä\na/tha
people many 3SG.ERG IAM SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\eat
'She had eaten many people.'

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(154) *ruga kam yem kam tauri kam kabe kam*
ruga kam yem kam tauri kam kabe kam
pig bone cassowary bone wallaby bone man bone
'There were pig bones, cassowary bones, wallaby bones and also human bones.'

(155) *dmädrma faremma nä z änatha*
dmädr=ma farem=ma nä z ä\na/tha
Dmädr=CHAR Farem=CHAR INDF IAM SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\eat
'He had eaten some people from Démändér and from Farem,'

(156) *ane nzürna ŋare*
ane nzürna ŋare
DEM spirit_woman woman
'that Nzürna woman.'

(157) *okay, bobo zäbth ane zokwasi eso bana*
okay bobo zä\bth/ ane zokwasi eso bana
okay MED:ALL 2|3SG:RPST:PFV\finish DEM speech thanks pitiful
'Okay, the story ends here. Thank you my friend.'

(158) *eso kafar*
eso kafar
thanks big
'Thank you very much.'

(159) *nabon trikasi rä*
nabon trikasi \rä/
good story 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'It is a good story.'

(160) *näbunf fafä maf kratrikwr keke ane*
näbun=f fafä maf kra\trik/wr keke ane
INDF=ERG.SG after_that who.ERG.SG 2|3SG:IRR:IPFV\tell NEG DEM
'Others should not tell this story.'

(161) *nzone mane yara bres nzone kabe zfth nzone yara*
nzone mane ya\r/a bres nzone kabe zfth nzone
1SG.POSS which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be Bres 1SG.POSS man base 1SG.POSS
ya\r/a
3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'It is mine. Bres was my ancestor.'

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(162) *nzone bada yara*
nzone bada ya\r/a
1SG.POSS ancestor 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be
'He was my greatgrandfather.'

(163) *ane festhfa rera ane yam*
ane festh=fa \rä/ra ane yam
DEM body=ABL 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be DEM event
'This was a true thing (that happened).'

(164) *nafane msaksi zn mane rera yirkon swamnzrm*
nafane msak-si zn mane \rä/ra yirko=en
3SG.POSS sit-NMLZ place which 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be Yirko=LOC
swa\m/nzrm
3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit
'As for Bres' home, he was living in Yirko.'

(165) *bäne fafä yrko zamar nzone bad fä fof ŋabrigwr nimame*
bäne fafä yirko za\mar/ nzone bad fä
PH.ABS after_that Yirko 2SG>3SG.F:IMP:PFV\see 1SG.POSS ground DIST
fof ŋa\brig/wr nima=me
EMPH 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\return like_this=INS
'You can see my land at Yirko, which extends like that.'

(166) *eso kafar*
eso kafar
thanks big
'Thank you!'

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# 11 *Kukufia* - The short man Kukufia

## 11.1 Introduction

*Kukufia* is a narrative lasting roughly 6min. It was the first recording made during the documentation project. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on September 5th 2010, in audio format.[1] The speaker is Abia Bai, and the recording took place inside his house at Rouku.

## 11.2 Summary & background

The story tells about a man from Masu whose name is Kukufia and two children. Kukufia forces the two children to come with him on his canoe to go fishing. One day, the children's father finds out about this and hides underneath the house. When Kukufia returns to take the children, the father shoots at him and chases him to Masu, where he kills Kukufia and his two wives.

## 11.3 Parallel text

*nzone yf rä abia. nzä worä rokuma. nzone ŋafe bäi. trikasi bänema kwa natrikwé kabe tnz. yf sfrärm kukufia. kukufia mane yara masun swamnzrm. nafane ŋare edawä. nä kayé kabe zä swamnzrm we rokun. näbi ŋarekarä fi sfrärm. fi zefara bi farsir. karesa zfth kar yf rä. watik karesa zfthen fi bä bsfrärm. nagayé zbo thgathinzako. madma kafarwä a srak nge katanwä.*

My name is Abia. I am from *Rouku*. My father was Bäi. I'm going to tell you a story about what's-his-name. The short man's name was Kukufia. Kukufia lived in *Masu*. He had two wives. There was another man who lived here in *Rouku*. He had one wife. He set off to cut down a sago palm. The name of that place is *Karesa Zfth*. While he was there at *Karesa Zfth*, he left his two children here, the older girl and younger boy.

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20100905. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189889

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*nä kayé kukufia zenfara kofär. ŋarsfo zärsöfätha gardame rafisir kofä thoraksir. nafane gäw kofä rusima ane entharukwr. gardame krentharuf. krenfar. ŋanrafinzr e mnzärfr. kar yf rä ŋars rokurokun. wati garda fä sanzina foba krenfar. zänfrefa. sränrn. nafane yf zunbräknwrm "kukufia kukufia kukufia" wati katan nagayé fäthane ŋafe frükaren krakaristh. "ngth kabe yanor." fi mnzen boba thfrnm etfth mnzen kafar mnzen. watik kukufia yanyak. kräs "ey bä mane ethkgr mnzen? bä nä mane zbo nthkgr?" keke katakatané nä zayafath. yakasi keke. yanyak kwot we mnz zräkwr. neba zräkwr. nagayé fäth kranmätrth. madma kafarwä katan srak fäth.*

One day, Kukufia set off to go fishing. He went down to the river to paddle his canoe and look for fish. He had his harpoon to spear fish. He put the things in the canoe. He got into the canoe and set off. He paddled all the way to the *Mnzärfr*. This is a place on the riverbank. Then he left the canoe there and started to walk up here. When he came up, he shouted. He called his name "Kukufia Kukufia Kukufia". In the absence of their father, the little children heard this. "Little brother, there's a man shouting!" The two were there in the house, in the sleeping house, in the big house. Then Kukufia approached. He asked them, "Hey, who are you in the house? Who are you in there?" The little ones didn't answer. They gave no answer. He approached the house and knocked hard. He knocked on the other side. The little children came out. The big girl and the small boy.

*wati thmesa bobo ŋars rokurokufo. wati foba zetharufath. gardame katan emothf sfrafinzrm. nafangth thden sfrärm gardan. kukufia mane sfrärm kofär ane gäwkarä sukogrm. watik kwazür srämg. kwazür ysme nge fäth srärmir. etha ys kwazür ane mane yaththgr. ane ysme yrmigwr. we foba we krerafifth. thwä zrämg. nimamenzo ŋarafinzrth kaftfr we foba kränbrimth. nge kma kwawarkwrm zima. keke naf kukufia kwarizrm. watik foba ŋanrafinzrth e mnzärfr swäyé. watik foba*

He took them to the riverbank there. Then they got into the canoe. The little girl paddled the canoe. Her little brother sat in the centre of the canoe. Kukufia stood there with his harpoon, looking for fish. Then he speared a kwazür fish. With the kwazür spines, he pricked the little boy. With those three spines on the kwazür, he poked him with those. From there they paddled a little further and he shot a catfish. They paddled until *Kaftfr* and then returned from there. The boy

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*fof nagayé we thranbrim. nagayé fäth thnriftha. fi we kränbrim e masu gardamenzo. kräfref. ŋaremedbo kofä thräthayfth. etha efoth nima tmatm ŋafiyokwa fof.*

must have cried because of the pain. But Kukufia wasn't paying attention. They paddled back to the canoe place at *Mnzärfr*. From there, he brought them back. He sent the little children away and he returned to *Masu* by canoe. He came up from the river and showed his wives the fish. He continued this over the course of three days.

*nä kayé nafanme ŋafe karesa zfth foba nafaŋame yansriza. fafen nge zi swathizrm ekri zi kofä ysma. watik nafaŋafe mane yanra nagayé thrathorthm. nagayé fi wtrima ŋagathiknath mnz mrmr etfth mnzen. wati nagayé srarfitfth "ŋafe ni znrn katan nagayé." wati ŋafe kräntf thramar "oh, nimakarä ern. watik, moba kabe yanyak?" "keke, masufa yanyak. yf yé ane kukufia."*

One day the children's father came from *Karesa Zfth*. Their mother had sent him. In the meantime, the boy was in pain, physical pain from the fish spines. Their father came looking for them. The children stayed in fear in the house, inside the sleeping house. Then the children replied: "Father, we little children are here!" The father came and saw them. He said: "Oh, so that's what is going on! Where did that man come from?" "No, he came from *Masu*. His name is Kukufia."

*ane zizin kukufia we sathora fof. fänwä we garda sränzin mnzärfren zran. wati zänfrefa. yaniyak. nagayé kma né zirkn thrathkäf zirkn we kwot zirkn. keke. nafane ŋafe fi banbanen sfrugrm. with tagame z ŋathäfa. watik, nafaŋafe kräyuf. nagayé maneme thythy thfrnm. fobo samga fof. kukufia näbi zamatha dunzikarä. ŋakwir e masu. kräkwther. nafane ŋare mane zfrärm edama thrma ŋare. wati, mämen fobo zämira fof.*

Kukufia came back that afternoon. He left his canoe at the swamp near *Mnzärfr* and came up from river. He started to bully the children, over and over again. They did not react. The father was under the house. He had covered himself with banana leaves. Then the father stood up. While the children were distracting Kukufia, he shot him from there. Kukufia ran off with the arrow in his body. He ran all the way to *Masu*. He changed his appearance. Now he clung to the breast of the second woman as a baby.

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*wati nagayaneme ŋafyf zöfäthakfa zba zf frknzo yamrinza bänemr e masu. watik fobo fof nafaŋare thras "befis myé?" "keke zä yé. z zamath. mataknzo yé." watik zära. "mane kwa fof srarä? nge ane fof yé. katan nge fur fof yé." wati nagayaneme ŋafyf ane nge fr saferfa. ŋareyé efna edawä ane fof kwosirwä. wati fi zänbrima zöfäthak roku. wati ŋare fi wmiyanza. nafaŋare zränmes karesa zfthfa nagaynmedbo.*

The father followed the blood trail from *Zöfäthak* to *Masu*. There he asked the two wives: "Where is your husband?" "He's not here. He's run away. He's gone." Then he asked "Who's that supposed to be? It's this child! The little baby is him!" The father smashed the baby against a tree and beat both women to death. Then he returned to *Zöfäthak*, to *Rouku*. He fetched the wife from *Karesa Zfth* and brought her back to the children.

*wati trikasi fof zäbth. trikasi zfrä tnz. eso kafar.*

Well, that is the end story of the story. It was a short story. Thank you very much.

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## 11.4 Glossed text

(1) *nzone yf rä abia*
nzone yf \rä/ abia
1SG.POSS name 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PN
'My name is Abia.'

(2) *nzä worä rokuma*
nzä wo\rä/ roku=ma
1SG.ABS 1SG:NPST:IPFV\be PLN=CHAR
'I am from Rouku.'

(3) *nzone ŋafe bäi*
nzone ŋafe bäi
1SG.POSS father PN
'My father was Bäi.'

(4) *trikasi bänema kwa natrikwé*
trikasi bäne=ma kwa na\trik/wé
story PH=CHAR FUT 1SG>2SG.IO:NPST:IPFV\tell
'I'm going to tell you a story about what's-his-name.'

(5) *kabe tnz yf sfrärm kukufia*
kabe tnz yf sf\rä/rm kukufia
man short name 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be PN
'The short man's name was Kukufia.'

(6) *kukufia mane yara masun swamnzrm*
kukufia mane ya\r/a masu=en swa\m/nzrm
PN which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be PLN=LOC 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit
'Kukufia lived in Masu.'

(7) *nafane ŋare edawä*
nafane ŋare eda=wä
3SG.POSS wife two=EMPH
'He had two wives.'

(8) *nä kayé kabe zä swamnzrm we rokun*
nä kayé kabe zä swa\m/nzrm we roku=en
INDF one_day_away man PROX 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sit also PLN=LOC
'There was another man who lived here in Rouku.'

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(9) *näbi ŋarekarä fi sfrärm*
näbi ŋare=karä fi sf\rä/rm
one wife=PROP 3.ABS 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'He had one wife.'

(10) *fi zefara bi farsir*
fi ze\far/a bi far-si=r
3.ABS SG:PST:PFV\set_off sago fell-NMLZ=PURP
'He set off to cut down a sago palm.'

(11) *karesa zfth kar yf rä*
karesa_zfth kar yf \rä/
PLN place name 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'The name of that place is Karesa Zfth.'

(12) *watik karesa zfthen fi bä bsfrärm*
watik karesa_zfth=en fi bä b=sf\rä/rm
then PLN=LOC 3.ABS MED MED=3SG.M:PST:DUR\be
'While he was there at Karesa Zfth,'

(13) *nagayé zbo thgathinzako*
nagayé zbo th\gathinz/ako
children PROX:ALL SG>2|3DU:PST:PFV:AND\leave
'he left his two children here,'

(14) *madma kafarwä a srak nge katanwä*
madma kafar=wä a srak nge katan=wä
female big=EMPH and boy child small=EMPH
'the older girl and younger boy.'

(15) *nä kayé kukufia zenfara kofär*
nä kayé kukufia zen\far/a kofä=r
INDF one_day_away PN SG:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off fish=PURP
'One day, Kukufia set off to go fishing.'

(16) *ŋarsfo zärsöfätha gardame rafisir kofä thoraksir*
ŋars=fo zä\rsöfäth/a garda=me rafi-si=r kofä
river=ALL 2|3SG:PST:PFV\descend canoe=INS paddle-NMLZ=PURP fish
thorak-si=r
search-NMLZ=PURP
'He went down to the river to paddle his canoe and look for fish.'

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(17) *nafane gäw kofä rusima*
nafane gäw kofä ru-si=ma
3SG.POSS fish_spear fish shoot-NMLZ=CHAR
'He had his harpoon to spear fish.'

(18) *ane entharukwr gardame krentharuf krenfar*
ane en\tharuk/wr garda=me
DEM 2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\enter_open_cont canoe=INS
kren\tharuf/ kren\far/
2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\enter_open_cont 2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off
'He put the things in the canoe. He got into the canoe and set off.'

(19) *ŋanrafinzr e mnzärfr*
ŋan\rafi/nzr e mnzärfr
2|3SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\paddle until PLN
'He paddled all the way to the Mnzärfr.'

(20) *kar yf rä ŋars rokurokun*
kar yf \rä/ ŋars rokuroku=en
place name 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be river river_bank=LOC
'This is a place on the riverbank.'

(21) *wati garda fä sanzina foba krenfar*
wati garda fä san\zin/a foba
then canoe DIST SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV:VENT\put_down DIST:ABL
kren\far/
2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off
'Then he left the canoe there and started to walk up here.'

(22) *zänfrefa sränrn*
zän\fref/a srän\rn/
2|3SG:PST:PFV:VENT\come_up_from_river 3SG.M:IRR:PFV:VENT\shout
'When he came up, he shouted.'

(23) *nafane yf zunbräknwrm "kukufia kukufia kukufia"*
nafane yf zun\bräkn/wrm kukufia kukufia kukufia
3SG.POSS name SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR:VENT\call_out PN PN PN
'He called his name "Kukufia Kukufia Kukufia".'

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(24) *wati katan nagayé fäthane ŋafe frükaren krakaristh*
wati katan nagayé fäth=ane ŋafe frü kar=en
then small children DIM=POSS.SG father alone place=LOC
kra\karis/th
2|3DU:IRR:PFV\hear
'In the absence of their father, the little children heard this.'

(25) *"ngth kabe yanor"*
ngth kabe ya\nor/
younger_sibling man 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\shout
'"Little brother, there's a man shouting!"'

(26) *fi mnzen boba thfrnm*
fi mnz=en boba thf\rn/m
3.ABS house=LOC MED:ABL 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be
'The two were there in the house,'

(27) *etfth mnzen kafar mnzen*
etfth mnz=en kafar mnz=en
sleep house=LOC big house=LOC
'in the sleeping house, in the big house.'

(28) *watik kukufia yanyak*
watik kukufia yan\yak/
then PN 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come
'Then Kukufia approached.'

(29) *kräs "ey bä mane ethkgr mnzen?"*
krä\s/ ey bä mane e\th/kgr
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\ask hey 2SG.ABS which 2|3PL:NPST:STAT\be_inside
mnz=en
house=LOC
'He asked them, "Hey, who are you in the house?'

(30) *"bä nä mane zbo nthkgr?"*
bä nä mane zbo n\th/kgr
2SG.ABS INDF which PROX:ALL 2SG:NPST:STAT\be_inside
'Who are you in there?"'

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(31) *keke katakatané nä zayafath*
keke kata~katan=é nä za\yaf/ath
NEG REDUP~small=ERG.NSG INDF 2|3DU:PST:PFV\answer
'The little ones didn't reply.'

(32) *yakasi keke*
yaka-si keke
answer-NMLZ NEG
'They gave no answer.'

(33) *yanyak kwot we mnz zräkwr*
yan\yak/ kwot we mnz zrä\kwr/
3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come properly also house 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\hit
'He approached the house and knocked hard.'

(34) *neba zräkwr*
neba zrä\kwr/
opposite 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\hit
'He knocked on the other side.'

(35) *nagayé fäth kranmätrth*
nagayé fäth kran\mätr/th
children DIM 2|3DU:IRR:PFV:VENT\exit
'The little children came out.'

(36) *madma kafarwä katan srak fäth*
madma kafar=wä katan srak fäth
female big=EMPH small boy DIM
'The big girl and the small boy.'

(37) *wati thmesa bobo ŋars rokurokufo*
wati th\mes/a bobo ŋars rokuroku=fo
then SG>2|3DU:PST:PFV\bring MED:ALL river river_bank=ALL
'He took them to the riverbank there.'

(38) *wati foba zetharufath*
wati foba ze\tharuf/ath
then DIST:ABL 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\enter_open_cont
'Then they got into the canoe.'

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(39) *gardame katan emothf sfrafinzrm*
garda=me katan emoth=f sf\rafi/nzrm
canoe=INS small sister=ERG.SG SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\paddle
'The little girl paddled the canoe.'

(40) *nafangth thden sfrärm gardan*
nafa-ngth thd=en sf\rä/rm garda=en
3.POSS-younger_sibling middle=LOC 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be canoe=LOC
'Her little brother sat in the centre of the canoe.'

(41) *kukufia mane sfrärm kofär ane gäwkarä sukogrm*
kukufia mane sf\rä/rm kofä=r ane gäw=karä
PN which 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be fish=PURP DEM fish_spear=PROP
su\ko/grm
3SG.M:PST:DUR:STAT\be_standing
'Kukufia stood there at the front with his harpoon, looking for fish.'

(42) *watik kwazür srämg*
watik kwazür srä\mg/
then fish_species 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\shoot
'Then he speared a kwazür fish.'[2]

(43) *kwazür ysme nge fäth srärmir*
kwazür ys=me nge fäth srä\rmir/
fish_species spike=INS child DIM 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\pierce
'With the Kwazür spines, he pricked the little boy.'

(44) *etha ys kwazür ane mane yaththgr ane ysme yrmigwr*
etha ys kwazür ane mane ya\thth/gr
three spike fish_species DEM which 3SG.M.IO:NPST:STAT\be_sticking_on
ane ys=me y\rmig/wr
DEM spike=INS 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\pierce
'With those three spines on the kwazür, he poked him with those.'

(45) *we foba we krerafifth thwä zrämg*
we foba we kre\rafif/th thwä zrä\mg/
also DIST:ABL also 2|3PL:IRR:PFV\paddle catfish 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\shoot
'From there they paddled a little further and he shot a catfish.'[3]

[2]kwazür = narrow fronted tandan (Neosilurus ater)
[3]thwä = triangular shield catfish (Sciades leptaspis)

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(46) *nimamenzo ŋarafinzrth kaftfr we foba kränbrimth*
nima=me=nzo ŋa\rafi/nzrth kaftfr we foba
like_this=INS=ONLY 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\paddle PLN also DIST:ABL
krän\brim/th
2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\return
'They paddled until Kaftfr and then returned from there.'

(47) *nge kma kwawarkwrm zima*
nge kma kwa\wark/wrm zi=ma
child POT SG:PST:DUR\howl pain=CHAR
'The boy must have cried because of the pain.'

(48) *keke naf kukufia kwarizrm*
keke naf kukufia kwa\riz/rm
NEG 3SG.ERG PN 2|3SG:PST:DUR\hear
'But Kukufia wasn't paying attention.'

(49) *watik foba ŋanrafinzrth e mnzärfr swäyé*
watik foba ŋan\rafi/nzrth e mnzärfr swäyé
then DIST:ABL 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\paddle until PLN canoe_place
'They paddled back to the canoe place at Mnzärfr.'

(50) *watik foba fof nagayé we thranbrim*
watik foba fof nagayé we thran\brim/
then DIST:ABL EMPH children also 2|3SG>2|3DU:IRR:PFV:VENT\return
'From there, he brought them back.'

(51) *nagayé fäth thnriftha*
nagayé fäth thn\rifth/a
children DIM SG>2|3DU:PST:PFV:VENT\send
'He sent the little children away'

(52) *fi we kränbrim e masu gardamenzo*
fi we krän\brim/ e masu garda=me=nzo
3.ABS also 2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\return until PLN canoe=INS=ONLY
'and he returned to Masu by canoe.'

(53) *kräfref ŋaremedbo kofä thräthayfth*

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krä\fref/ ŋare=medbo kofä
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\come_up_from_river wife=ALL.ANIM.NSG fish
thrä\thayf/th
2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\present
'He came up from the river and showed his wives the fish.'

(54) *etha efoth nima tmatm ŋafiyokwa fof*
etha efoth nima tmatm ŋa\fiyok/wa fof
three day like_this action 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\make EMPH
'He continued this over the course of three days.'

(55) *nä kayé nafanme ŋafe karesa zfth foba*
nä kayé nafanme ŋafe karesa_zfth foba
INDF one_day_away 3NSG.POSS father PLN DIST:ABL
'One day the children's father came from Karesa Zfth.'

(56) *nafaŋame yansriza*
nafa-ŋame yan\sriz/a
3.POSS-mother SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\send
'Their mother had sent him.'

(57) *fafen nge zi swathizrm ekri zi kofä ysma*
fafen nge zi swa\thiz/rm ekri zi kofä ys=ma
meanwhile child pain 3SG.M:PST:DUR\die body pain fish spike=CHAR
'In the meantime, the boy was in pain, physical pain from the fish spines.'

(58) *watik nafaŋafe mane yanra nagayé thrathorthm*
wati nafa-ŋafe mane yan\r/a nagayé
then 3.POSS-father which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\be children
thra\thorthm/
2|3SG>2|3DU:IRR\search
'Their father came looking for them.'

(59) *nagayé fi wtrima ŋagathiknath mnz mrmr etfth mnzen*
nagayé fi wtri=ma ŋa\gathik/nath mnz mrmr etfth
children 3.ABS fear=CHAR 2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\leave house inside sleep
mnz=en
house=LOC
'The children stayed in fear in the house, inside the sleeping house.'

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(60) *wati nagayé srarfitfth "ŋafe ni znrn katan nagayé"*
wati nagayé sra\rfitf/th ŋafe ni
then children 2|3DU>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\answer father 1NSG
z=n\rn/ katan nagayé
PROX=1DU:NPST:IPFV\be small children
'Then the children replied: "Father, we little children are here!"'

(61) *wati ŋafe kräntf thramar "oh nimakarä ern"*
wati ŋafe krän\tf/ thra\mar/ oh
then father 2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\walk 2|3SG>2|3DU:IRR:PFV\see oh
nima=karä e\rn/
like_this=PROP 2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\be
'The father came and saw them. He said: "Oh, so that's what is going on!'

(62) *"watik, moba kabe yanyak?"*
watik moba kabe yan\yak/
then where.ABL man 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come
'Where did that man come from?"'

(63) *"keke, masufa yanyak. yf yé ane kukufia"*
keke masu=fa yan\yak/ yf \yé/
NEG PLN=ABL 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come name 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
ane kukufia
DEM PN
'"No, he came from Masu. His name is Kukufia."'

(64) *ane zizin Kukufia we sathora fof*
ane zizi=en kukufia we sa\thor/a fof
DEM afternoon=LOC PN also 3SG.M:PST:PFV\appear EMPH
'Kukufia came back that afternoon.'

(65) *fänwä we garda sränzin mnzärfren zran*
fän=wä we garda srän\zin/ mnzärfr=en
DIST=EMPH also canoe 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV:VENT\put_down PLN=LOC
zra=en
swamp=LOC
'He left his canoe at the swamp near Mnzärfr'

(66) *wati zänfrefa yaniyak*

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wati zän\fref/a
then 2|3SG:PST:PFV:VENT\come_up_from_river
yan\yak/
3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come
'and came up from river.'

(67) *nagayé kma né zirkn thrathkäf zirkn we kwot zirkn*
nagayé kma né zirkn thra\thkäf/ zirkn we
children POT IMN insistence 2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\start insistence also
kwot zirkn
properly insistence
'He started to bully the children, over and over again.'

(68) *keke. nafane ŋafe fi banbanen sfrugrm*
keke nafane ŋafe fi banban=en sf\ru/grm
NEG 3SG.POSS father 3.ABS underneath=LOC 3SG.M:PST:DUR\sleep
'They did not react. The father was under the house.'

(69) *with tagame z ŋathäfa*
with taga=me z ŋa\thäf/a
banana leaf=INS IAM 2|3SG:PST:IPFV\cover
'He had covered himself with banana leaves.'

(70) *watik, nafaŋafe kräyuf*
watik nafa-ŋafe krä\yuf/
then 3.POSS-father 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\stand
'Then the father stood up.'

(71) *nagayé maneme thythy thfrnm fobo samga fof*
nagayé mane=me thythy thf\rn/m fobo
children which=INS mucking_around 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be DIST:ALL
sa\mg/a fof
SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\shoot EMPH
'While the children were distracting Kukufia, he shot him from there.'

(72) *kukufia näbi zamatha dunzikarä*
kukufia näbi za\math/a dunzi=karä
PN one 2|3SG:PST:PFV\run arrow=PROP
'Kukufia ran off with the arrow in his body.'

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(73) *ŋakwir e Masu*
ŋa\kwir/ e masu
2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\run until PLN
'He ran all the way to Masu.'

(74) *kräkwther*
krä\kwther/
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\change
'He changed (his appearance).'

(75) *nafane ŋare mane zfrärm edama thrma ŋare.*
nafane ŋare mane zf\rä/rm eda=ma thrma ŋare
3SG.POSS wife which 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be two=CHAR later wife
'It was his wife, the second one, the latter wife,'

(76) *wati, mämen fobo zämira fof.*
wati mäm=en fobo zä\mir/a fof
then breast=LOC DIST:ALL 2|3SG:PST:PFV\hang EMPH
'on whose breast he clung (as a baby).'

(77) *wati nagayaneme ŋafyf zöfäthakfa zba zf frknzo yamrinza bänemr e masu*
wati nagayé=aneme ŋafe=f zöfäthak=fa zba zf
then children=POSS.NSG father=ERG.SG PLN=ABL PROX:ABL ABSC
frk=nzo ya\mri/nza bänemr masu
blood=ONLY SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\chase until PLN
'The father followed the blood trail from Zöfäthak to Masu.'

(78) *watik fobo fof nafaŋare thras "befis myé?"*
watik fobo fof nafa-ŋare thra\s/
then DIST:ALL EMPH 3.POSS-wife 2|3SG>2|3DU:IRR:PFV\ask
be-fis m=\yé/
2SG.POSS-husband IGNO=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'There he asked the two wives: "Where is your husband?"'

(79) *"keke zä yé. z zamath. mataknzo yé."*
keke zä \yé/ z za\math/ matak=nzo
NEG PROX 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be IAM 2|3SG:RPST:PFV\run nothing=ONLY
\yé/
3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'"He's not here. He's run away. He's gone."'

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(80) *watik zära*
watik zä\r/a
then SG:PST:PFV\do
'Then he asked'

(81) *"mane kwa fof srarä? nge ane fof yé."*
mane kwa fof sra\rä/ nge ane fof \yé/
which FUT EMPH 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\be child DEM EMPH 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'"Who's that supposed to be? It's this child!'

(82) *katan nge fur fof yé.*
katan nge fur for \yé/
small child bundle EMPH 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'The little baby is him!"'

(83) *wati nagayaneme ŋafyf ane nge fr saferfa*
wati nagayé=aneme ŋafe=f ane nge fr
then children=POSS.NSG father=ERG.SG DEM child post
sa\ferf/a
SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\whip_against_sth
'The father smashed the baby against a tree'

(84) *ŋareyé efna edawä ane fof kwosirwä*
ŋare=é e\fn/na eda=wä ane fof
woman=ABS.NSG SG>2|3DU:PST:IPFV\hit two=EMPH DEM EMPH
kwosi=r=wä
dead=PURP=EMPH
'and beat both women to death.'

(85) *wati fi zänbrima zöfäthak roku*
wati fi zän\brim/a zöfäthak roku
then 3.ABS 2|3SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return PLN PLN
'Then he returned to Zöfäthak, to Rouku.'

(86) *wati ŋare fi wmiyanza*
wati ŋare fi w\miya/nza
then wife 3.ABS SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\fetch
'He fetched the wife'

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(87) *nafaŋare zränmes karesa zfthfa nagaynmedbo*
nafa-ŋare zrän\mes/ karesa_zfth=fa
3.POSS-wife 2|3SG>3SG.F:RPST:PFV:VENT\bring PLN=ABL
nagayé=nmedbo
children=ALL.ANIM.NSG
'from Karesa Zfth and brought her back to the children.'

(88) *wati trikasi fof zäbth*
watik trikasi fof zä\bth/
then story EMPH 2|3SG:RPST:PFV\finish
'Well, that is the end story of the story.'

(89) *trikasi zfrä tnz*
trikasi zf\rä/ tnz
story 3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\be short
'It was a short story.'

(90) *eso kafar*
eso kafar
thanks big
'Thank you very much.'

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# 12 *Fenz yonasi* - Drinking body fluids

## 12.1 Introduction

*Fenz yonasi* is a narrative lasting roughly 5min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on September 3rd 2013, in both audio and video formats.[1] The story teller is Ruth Nakre Abia, and the recording took place at Abia Bai's house.

## 12.2 Summary & background

Nakre talks about sorcerers and their practice of visiting the grave of a recently deceased person. These sorcerers would extract body fluids from the corpse, sometimes also bones. They take their power from these body parts.

## 12.3 Parallel text

*bänema kwa ŋatrikwé nzefé. fenz ane mane ŋonathrth kwosifr kabeaneme, bthan kabeyé. trikasi zrethkäfé.*

I will talk about the body fluid from a dead man's corpse and how sorcerers are drinking this. I will start the story.

*bthan kabe fthé fenz yonasi. bänemr zrethkäfth mätraksir, kzi kwa yafiyokwrth. srafiyokwrth karesama. kzi srärzirth. watik kwa eyak nima kwosifr fthé kabe fthé ynänzüthzrth baden. fthé one week srakor, fthé fof krefar ane bthan kabe bobo fokam znfo. fokam mnzfo. sikwankwanme zbär thd kabef keke kwa sremar. süsübäthen kwa yak tosinmäre kwayanmäre. kwa yak. yfrsé gwonyamekarä kwa yé. keke kwa*

When these sorcerers want to drink bodily fluids, they first take out the bark tray they have made. They make it from the paperbark tree by bending the bark into shape. Next they go to the corpse. About a week after the funeral, the sorcerer makes his way to the grave, to the grave house. He creeps there in the middle of the night. Nobody will catch sight of him. He makes his way in the dark with-

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20130903-04. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189896

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*kwayanthé gwonyamekarä bänema kabeyé sremarth. fi fthé srayak e fokam. watik yfö katanr kwa yarenzr. katan yfö fthé zremar ebarfa, fä fof kwa bäne ythorthr mrrab. mrrab zbo zanfr byé. ane fof sräsryöfth bobo yfön. watik fobo fof srayak. kzi zräzin nabi tonze mrrab tonze. fenzane bäne mrrab bäne kwa wämneme yrthakunzr. watik fenz ane kwa ŋankarkwr naf fobo fof krayagunzr kzifo. nafa watikthmenzo. ke ka krärtf ane kzi. fthé zremar nima watikthmenzo zfrä. mrrab ane sräfum. watik kwot zrarmänwr yfö. watik krefar fof. bäne zrazänzr fenz kzikaf mä ke kwa kabef sremar ane yam fiyoksin. kwa wrifthzr.*

out a flashlight, without any light. He will wear black clothes. Not in white clothes, because someone might see him. Then he walks up to the grave and looks around for a small hole. When he finds a small hole at the head end, he inserts a small bamboo pipe. The pipe is about this long. He pushes it right into the hole. Next he puts the bark dish close to the bamboo pipe. He sucks up the fluid and pours it on the bark dish until he's got enough. He won't fill it right up. When he sees that there is enough there, he pulls out that bamboo pipe. Then he closes up the hole properly. Then he sets off. He will carry these bodily fluids with him in the bark dish, where nobody would see him. He will hide them.

*watik fi zöbthé zane bäne kramonziknwr zzarfa. bäne ferä ymd thäbu nzabu. watik ane thrma ane fof krefar fokamfo. ane fthé zrarinakwr. kzin sräbth. watik yonasir fof zräriftham. zöbthé bäneme kwa wrthakunzr zzarfame. bänema gatha miyosé rä. nafane miyo keke namä wärä. zrarthakunzr zräbth. wati bäne ane kwa yfethakwr ymd nzabu. srafethakwr keke kwa zane touch srarär ane fenzme. kwan krakurwr. zrarär kwanen bänema thafma gatha miyoma. zrarär zrafethakwr we zbo sranakwr krafigthkwr. we nimanzo kwot e zräbth ane fenz. fthé zräbth kzi ane kwa yfönzr mnime. fewama mnime sräföf. watik kräbrim nafane mnzfo.*

Before he starts anything, he will go and get whatchamacallit, ginger roots. Those things will be prepared and also the feather of a bird. Only then does he go to the grave, fills up the bark dish and hides to drink. First, he sprinkles the liquid with the ginger because it has a bad taste. Its taste is not good. He sprinkles it all over. Then he dips in the feather. He carefully dips it in because fluid should not touch his mouth. It would scratch his mouth. He puts it carefully into the mouth because it's bitter, because of its terrible taste. He does that and he dips it in. And he puts it down his throat and licks it. He continues doing this until he finishes up the fluid. When he's done, we will burn the bark

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tray in the fire because of the bad smell. He burns it in the fire and he returns to his house.

*kwa yrugr e baf fthé sräbth nima kabe zan miyof. okay fthé fof krefar. keke kwa mnzen ane tmatm zrafiyokwr ane yam. zagr kwa yak ksi karen. bä sramnzr. foba fof krefar kabe zanr. si kwa zöbthé ŋazübrakwr warfo kabedbo. warfo kabe kwa ykonzr "befé mitafo sabrim! nzun fefe kwagathif." watik ane kabe kwa yfänzr. kabe yf kwa ybräknwr nima "bäi! bäiane mitafo be sabrim! nzun fefe kwagathif!" watik fthé krefar kabef keke kwa sremar bänema mnzen fthé srarugr nagayé disturb or ŋare disturb srarär. watik anema fof krämätr outside nä karfo ksi karen fä sramnzr. fä ane tmatm kwa kabe yafiyokwr. btha zan yfnzr. foba fof krethfär. mobo fthzé. nima zba fthé roukuma nge srarä, zbär kwa yam zä wäfiyokwr zba krethfär safisfo. bä btha zan srafnzr. bthanme srafnzr. kränbrim we ane we zbär keke kwa bä srarugr o srawäkwr. zbär we kwa ŋanbrigwr keke kwa mothen fi srayak fi krathfänzr.*

He will sleep peacefully until the blood lust overcomes him. Okay, then he gets going. He doesn't do his magic in the house. He will go far somewhere in the bush. He has to go away in order to kill people. First, he will pray to god. He will say to god: "You take back the spirit but leave the flesh for me." He will point out a particular person and mention their name, for example "Bäi! Take Bäi's spirit back and leave his flesh behind for me!" Then he makes his way. He won't visit that person because his wife or his children will distract him. Therefore, he will go out to some place in the bush. He will perform this action there, but his magic power will strike that person. He can fly from there where ever he wishes, for example if a *Rouku* boy is the sorcerer, he will do this in the night and he will fly from here to *Safés*. He will strike the victim with a spell. Then he returns in the night. He doesn't stay there overnight. He will not walk on the road, but he will fly.

*nima ane wäfiyokwr. fthé sräbth kabe bthan zan srethkäf watik fä mane kwik erä fof. keke. taurifo tmatm zrafiyokwr o ŋathafo o faso rrokar berä. ane rrokarfo kwa tmatm yafiyokwr keke kwa nima nä kabedben. fi ane kabeane mitafo kwa wthorthr. nä faso rokarfo o*

He will do this: When he has finished drinking the fluids, he starts casting his spell. Next, someone will fall ill. He can also put the spell on a wallaby or on a dog, or on any other animal. He might do this to animal, and not to a human being. But the sorcerer's

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*fthzé ŋatha zräthb. ra fthzé srarä ymd. watik ane fof kwa tmatm yafiyokwr. ŋatha yafiyokwr nafane yfkaf. nezä kabe kwa kwosi yé. keke ŋatha kwa kwosi srarä yakme. mon tariäsi fthé kratariwr ŋatha, we kabe nimäwä kwa ŋatariwr. kwot e ŋatha fthé zä kwosi srarä, kabe bä kwa kwosi yé. bänema ŋatha ane nafane yfkaf sfrä. nimame ane fof bthan erä.*

spirit will go inside some animal or whatever. It could be a bird, or anything. For example, he performs these rituals on a dog and gives it the name of a man. This man will die, but he will not die quickly. While the dog dies slowly, the man will suffer in the same way. One day the dog will die. The man will also die because the dog has been marked with his name. That's how they do the spell.

*okay, ane fenz mane ŋonathrth. tmä naf fof ärithr. kwosifr kabeane tmäf fof ezänzr nä karfo. nä kayé kam kwa emätrakwrth, kabe kam kwosifr kam. watik, ane fof thfäsir fof. ane kamf kwa yzänzr bobo nä karfo. fi fenz ane bänemrnzo rä tmä yarisir. kamf fi ane kwa yzänzr bobo nima safs o wämnefr nima zagr kwa ŋathfänzr weam. fthzé bobomrwä arufe krathfänzr zagr karfo. ane tmäf kwa yzänzr kam a fenz.*

These sorcerers only become strong, when they drink these body fluids. The strength of the corpse carries them to another village. Sometimes they also take bones, human bones, from the corpse. That's really something to fly with. These bones allow them to go to other places. And these bodily fluids give them magic power. The bones will carry them, for example to *Safés* or to *Wämnefr*, or to far away to places such as *Weam*, or all the way to *Arufi*. This power can take them there. They use the bones and the body fluids.

*eso kafar. anenzo katan trikasi zfrä. trikasi nimanzo worä kabeyé mane watrikwrth. fi srakwä fthzé kwot kratrikwrth. gadmöwä.*

Thank you. That was the small story. I have told you this as I have heard it from others. The boys talk about this topic all the time. Thank you.

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## 12.4 Glossed text

(1) *bänema kwa ŋatrikwé nzefé*
bäne=ma kwa ŋa\trik/wé nzefé
PH=CHAR FUT 1SG:NPST:IPFV\tell 1SG.ERG.EMPH
'I will talk about'

(2) *fenz ane mane ŋonathrth kwosifr kabeaneme bthan kabeyé*
fenz mane ŋo\na/thrth kwosifr kabe=aneme bthan
pus which 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\drink corpse man=POSS.NSG magic
kabe=é
man=ERG.NSG
'the body liquids from a dead man's corpse that the sorcerers are drinking.'

(3) *trikasi zrethkäfé*
trikasi zre\thkäf/é
story 1SG:IRR:PFV\start
'I will start the story.'

(4) *bthan kabe fthé fenz yonasi*
bthan kabe fthé fenz yona-si
magic man when pus drink-NMLZ
'When the sorcerers go for drinking body fluids,'

(5) *bänemr zrethkäfth mätraksir*
bäne=mr zre\thkäf/th mätrak-si=r
PH=PURP 2|3PL:IRR:PFV\start exit-NMLZ=PURP
'they would start taking this out.'

(6) *kzi kwa yafiyokwrth*
kzi kwa ya\fiyok/wrth
bark_tray FUT 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\make
'First they make bark tray.'

(7) *srafiyokwrth karesama kzi srärzirth*
sra\fiyok/wrth karesa=ma kzi
2|3PL>3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\make paperbark=CHAR bark_tray
srä\rzir/th
2|3PL>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\bend
'They make it from the paperbark tree by bending the bark into shape.'

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(8) *watik kwa eyak nima kwosifr fthé*
watik kwa e\yak/ nima kwosifr fthé
then FUT 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\walk like_this corpse when
'Then they go to the corpse.'

(9) *kabe fthé ynänzüthzrth baden*
kabe fthé y\nänzüthz/rth bad=en
man when 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\bury ground=LOC
'People have buried the deceased in the grave'

(10) *fthé one week srakor*
fthé one week sra\kor/
when one week 2|3SG>3SG.M.IO:IRR:PFV\become
'and around a week after that,'

(11) *fthé fof krefar ane bthan kabe bobo fokam znfo*
fthé fof kre\far/ ane bthan kabe bobo fokam
when EMPH 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\set_off DEM magic man MED:ALL grave
zn=fo
place=ALL
'the sorcerer sets off to the grave,'

(12) *fokam mnzfo*
fokam mnz=fo
grave house=ALL
'to the grave house.'

(13) *sikwankwanme zbär thd*
sikwankwan=me zbär thd
quietness=INS night middle
'He sneaks there in the middle of the night.'

(14) *kabef keke kwa sremar*
kabe=f keke kwa sre\mar/
man=ERG.SG NEG FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\see
'Nobody can see him.'

(15) *süsübäthen kwa yak tosinmäre kwayanmäre*
süsübäth=en kwa \yak/ tosin=märe kwayan=märe
darkness=LOC FUT 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\walk flashlight=PRIV light=PRIV
'He goes there in the dark without a flashlight, without any light.'

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(16) *kwa yak yfrsé gwonyamekarä kwa yé*
kwa \yak/ yfrsé gwonyame=karä kwa
FUT 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\walk black clothing=PROP FUT
\yé/
3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'He is wearing black clothes.'

(17) *keke kwa kwayanthé gwonyamekarä bänema kabeyé sremarth*
keke kwa kwayan-thé gwonyame=karä kabe=é
NEG FUT light-ADLZR clothing=PROP people=ERG.NSG
sre\mar/th
2|3PL>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\see
'No bright clothing because someone might see him.'

(18) *fi fthé srayak e fokam*
fi fthé sra\yak/ e fokam
3.ABS when 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\walk until grave
'Then he walks up to the grave.'

(19) *watik yfö katanr kwa yarenzr*
watik yfö katan=r kwa ya\re/nzr
then hole small=PURP FUT 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\look
'He looks around for a small hole.'

(20) *katan yfö fthé zremar ebarfa*
katan yfö fthé zre\mar/ ebar=fa
small hole when 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\see head=ABL
'When he finds a small hole at the head end'

(21) *fä fof kwa bäne ythorthr mrrab*
fä fof kwa bäne y\thor/thr mrrab
DIST EMPH FUT PH.ABS 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\enter small_bamboo
'he inserts a small bamboo pipe.'

(22) *mrrab zbo zanfr byé*
mrrab zbo zanfr b=\yé/
small_bamboo PROX:ALL long MED=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'That bamboo pipe is about this long.'

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(23) *ane fof sräsryöfth bobo yfön*
ane fof srä\sryöfth/ bobo yfö=en
DEM EMPH 2|3PL>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\send MED:ALL hole=LOC
'He pushes it into the hole.'

(24) *watik fobo fof srayak*
watik fobo fof sra\yak/
then DIST:ALL EMPH 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\walk
'Then he goes'

(25) *kzi zräzin nabi tonze ... mrrab tonze*
kzi zrä\zin/ nabi tonze mrrab
bark_tray 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\put_down bamboo close small_bamboo
tonze
close
'and puts the barktray close to the bamboo pipe.'

(26) *fenzane bäne mrrab bäne kwa wämneme yrthakunzr*
fenz=ane bäne mrrab bäne kwa wämne=me
pus=POSS.SG PH.ABS small_bamboo PH.ABS FUT tree=INS
y\rthaku/nzr
2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\spray
'He will spray the body fluid with the bamboo stick.'

(27) *watik fenz ane kwa ŋankarkwr naf fobo fof krayagunzr kzifo*
watik fenz ane kwa ŋan\kark/wr naf fobo fof
then pus DEM FUT 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\pull 3SG.ERG DIST:ALL EMPH
kra\yagu/nzr kzi=fo
2|3SG:IRR:IPFV\pour bark_tray=ALL
'He sucks up the body fluid and pours it on the barktray.'

(28) *nafa watikthmenzo*
nafa watik-thé=me=nzo
3NSG.ERG enough-ADLZR=INS=ONLY
'Until he's got enough.'

(29) *ke ka krärtf ane kzi*
ke ka krä\rtf/ ane kzi
NEG FUT 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\fill_up DEM bark_tray
'He won't fill the barktray right up.'

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(30) *fthé zremar nima watikthmenzo zfrä*
fthé zre\mar/ nima watik-thé=me=nzo
when 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\see like_this enough-ADLZR=INS=ONLY
zf\rä/
3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\be
'When he sees that there is enough there,'

(31) *mrrab ane sräfum*
mrrab ane srä\fum/
small_bamboo DEM 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\pull_out
'he pulls out that bamboo pipe.'

(32) *watik kwot zrarmänwr yfö*
watik kwot zra\rmän/wr yfö
then properly 2|3PL>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\close hole
'Then closes up the hole properly.'

(33) *watik krefar fof*
watik kre\far/ fof
then 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\set_off EMPH
'Then he departs.'

(34) *bäne zrazänzr fenz kzikaf*
bäne zra\zä/nzr fenz kzi=kaf
PH.ABS 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\carry pus bark_tray=PROP
'He will carry these body fluids in the barktray,'

(35) *mä ke kwa kabef sremar ane yam fiyoksin*
mä ke kwa kabe=f sre\mar/ ane yam
where NEG FUT man=ERG.SG 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\see DEM event
fiyok-si=en
make-NMLZ=LOC
'where nobody would see him doing this.'

(36) *kwa wrifthzr*
kwa w\rifth/zr
FUT 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\hide
'He will hide it.'

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(37) *watik fi zöbthé zane bäne kramonziknwr ... zzarfa*
watik fi zöbthé zane bäne kra\monzikn/wr zzarfa
then 3.ABS first DEM:PROX PH.ABS 2|3SG:IRR:IPFV\get_ready ginger
'Before he starts anything, he will go and get whatchamacallit, the ginger.'

(38) *bäne ferä*
bäne f=e\rä/
PH.ABS DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'Those things will be ready.'

(39) *ymd thäbu nzabu*
ymd thäbu nzabu
bird hair wing
'and also a feather of a bird.'

(40) *watik ane thrma ane fof krefar fokamfo*
watik ane thrma ane fof kre\far/ fokam=fo
then DEM later DEM EMPH 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\set_off grave=ALL
'Only after that, he goes to the grave,'

(41) *ane fthé zrarinakwr kzin sräbth*
ane fthé zra\rinak/wr kzi=en
DEM when 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\pour bark_tray=LOC
srä\bth/
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\finish
'fills up the barktray,'

(42) *watik yonasir fof zräriftham*
watik yona-si=r fof zrä\rifthm/
then drink-NMLZ=PURP EMPH 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\hide
'and hides it for drinking.'

(43) *zöbthé bäneme kwa wrthakunzr*
zöbthé bäne=me kwa w\rthaku/nzr
first PH.ABS=INS FUT 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\spray
'First, he sprinkles the body liquid'

(44) *zzarfame bänema gatha miyosé rä*
zzarfa=me bäne=ma gatha miyosé \rä/
ginger=INS PH=CHAR bad taste 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'with the ginger because it has a bad taste.'

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(45) *nafane miyo keke namä wärä*
nafane miyo keke namä wä\rä/
3SG.POSS desire NEG good 3SG.F.IO:NPST:IPFV\be
'Its taste is not good.'

(46) *zrarthakunzr zräbth*
zra\rthaku/nzr zrä\bth/
2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\spray 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\finish
'He sprinkles it all over.'

(47) *wati bäne ane kwa yfethakwr ymd nzabu*
wati bäne ane kwa yfethakwr ymd nzabu
then PH.ABS DEM FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\dip_in bird wing
'Then he dips in the feather.'

(48) *srafethakwr keke kwa zane touch srarär ane fenzme*
srafethakwr keke kwa zane touch
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\dip_in NEG FUT DEM:PROX touch
sra\rä/r ane fenz=me
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\do DEM pus=INS
'He carefully dips it in since the body fluid should not touch (his mouth).'

(49) *kwan krakurwr*
kwan kra\kur/wr
throat 2|3SG:IRR:IPFV\split
'It would scratch his mouth.'

(50) *zrarär kwanen bänema thafma gatha miyoma*
zra\rä/r kwan=en bäne=ma thaf=ma gatha
2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\do throat=LOC PH=CHAR bitterness=CHAR bad
miyo=ma
taste=CHAR
'He puts it carefully into the mouth because it's bitter, because of its terrible taste.'

(51) *zrarär zrafethakwr we*
zra\rä/r zra\fethak/wr we
2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\do 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\dip_in also
'He does that and he dips it in.'

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(52) *zbo sranakwr krafigthkwr*
zbo sra\nak/wr kra\figthk/wr
PROX:ALL 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\put_down 2|3SG:IRR:IPFV\lick
'And he puts it down (his throat) and licks it.'

(53) *we nimanzo kwot e zräbth ane fenz*
we nima=nzo kwot e zrä\bth/ ane fenz
also like_this=ONLY properly until 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\finish DEM pus
'He continues doing this until he finishes up the fluid.'

(54) *fthé zräbth kzi ane kwa yfönzr mnime fewama*
fthé zrä\bth/ kzi ane kwa
when 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\finish bark_tray DEM FUT
y\fönz/r mni=me fewa=ma
2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\burn fire=INS smell=CHAR
'When he's done, we will burn the barktray in the fire because of the bad smell.'

(55) *mnime sräföf watik*
mni=me srä\föf/ watik
fire=INS 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\burn then
'He burns it in the fire'

(56) *kräbrim nafane mnzfo*
krä\brim/ nafane mnz=fo
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\return 3SG.POSS house=ALL
'(and) he returns to his house.'

(57) *kwa yrugr e*
kwa y\ru/gr e
FUT 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\sleep until
'He will sleep peacefully until'

(58) *baf fthé sräbth nima kabe zan miyof*
baf fthé srä\bth/ nima kabe zan
PH.ERG.SG when 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\finish like_this man fight
miyo=f
desire=ERG.SG
'the bloodlust overcomes him.'

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(59) *okay fthé fof krefar*
okay fthé fof kre\far/
okay when EMPH 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\set_off
'Okay, then he gets going.'

(60) *keke kwa mnzen ane tmatm zrafiyokwr ane yam*
keke kwa mnz=en ane tmatm zra\fiyok/wr ane yam
NEG FUT house=LOC DEM action 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\make DEM event
'He doesn't not do his magic in the house.'

(61) *zagr kwa yak ksi karen bä sramnzr*
zagr kwa \yak/ ksi kar=en bä
far FUT 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\walk grassland place=LOC MED
sra\m/nzr
3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\sit
'He will go far somewhere in the bush.'

(62) *foba fof krefar kabe zanr*
foba fof kre\far/ kabe zan=r
DIST:ABL EMPH 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\set_off people fight=PURP
'He has to go away to kill people.'

(63) *si kwa zöbthé ŋazübrakwr warfo kabedbo*
si kwa zöbthé ŋa\zübrak/wr warfo kabe=dbo
eyes FUT first 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\close_eyes above man=ALL.ANIM.SG
'First, he will pray to god.'

(64) *warfo kabe kwa ykonzr*
warfo kabe kwa y\ko/nzr
above man FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\speak
'He will say to god:'

(65) *"befé mitafo sabrim*
befé mitafo sa\brim/
2SG.ERG.EMPH ghost 2SG>3SG.M:IMP:PFV\return
'"You take back the spirit'

(66) *nzun fefe kwagathif"*
nzun fefe kwa\gathif/
1SG.DAT body 2SG>1SG.IO:IMP:PFV\leave
'leave the flesh for me."'

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(67) *watik ane kabe kwa yfänzr*
watik ane kabe kwa y\fä/nzr
then DEM man FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\present
'He will point out a particular person'

(68) *kabe yf kwa ybräknwr nima "bäi"*
kabe yf kwa y\bräkn/wr nima bäi
man name FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\call_out like_this Bäi
'and mention their name, for example "Mbäi!'

(69) *"bäiane mitafo be sabrim nzun fefe kwagathif"*
bäi=ane mitafo be sa\brim/ nzun fefe
Bäi=POSS.SG ghost 2SG.ERG 2SG>3SG.M:IMP:PFV\return 1SG.DAT body
kwa\gathif/
2SG>1SG.IO:IMP:PFV\leave
'Take Mbäi's spirit back and leave his flesh behind for me!"'

(70) *watik fthé krefar kabef keke kwa sremar bänema*
watik fthé kre\far/ kabe=f keke kwa
then when 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\set_off man=ERG.SG NEG FUT
sre\mar/ bäne=ma
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\see PH=CHAR
'Then he sets off. He won't visit the person because'

(71) *mnzen fthé srarugr nagayé disturb or ŋare disturb srarär*
mnz=en fthé sra\ru/gr nagayé disturb o ŋare
house=LOC when 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\sleep children disturbance or wife
disturb sra\rä/r
disturbance 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\do
'his wife or his children will distract him.'

(72) *watik anema fof krämätr outside nä karfo ksi karen fä sramnzr*
watik ane=ma fof krä\mätr/ outside nä kar=fo
then DEM=CHAR EMPH 2|3SG:IRR:IPFV\exit outside INDF place=ALL
ksi kar=en fä sra\m/nzr
grassland place=LOC DIST 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\sit
'Therefore, he will go out to some place in the savannah.'

(73) *fä ane tmatm kwa kabe yafiyokwr. btha zan yfnzr*

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fä ane tmatm kwa kabe ya\fiyok/wr btha zan
DIST DEM action FUT man 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\make magic fight
y\fn/zr
2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\hit
'He will perform this action there, but the magic will hit (that person).'

(74) *foba fof krethfär*
foba fof kre\thfä/r
DIST:ABL EMPH 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\fly
'He can fly from there'

(75) *mobo fthzé*
mobo fthzé
where.ALL INDF
'where ever (he wishes),'

(76) *nima*
nima
like_this
'for example'

(77) *zba fthé roukuma nge srarä*
zba fthé rouku=ma nge sra\rä/
PROX:ABL when PLN=CHAR child 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\be
'if a Rouku boy is the sorcerer,'

(78) *zbär kwa yam zä wäfiyokwr zba krethfär safisfo*
zbär kwa yam zä wä\fiyok/wr zba
night FUT event PROX 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\make PROX:ABL
kre\thfä/r safs=fo
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\fly PLN=ALL
'he will do this in night and fly from here to Safés.'

(79) *bä ... btha zan srafnzr bthanme srafnzr*
bä btha zan sra\fn/zr bthan=me
MED magic fight 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\hit magic=INS
sra\fn/zr
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\hit
'He will strike him with a spell. He will strike him with magic.'

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(80) *kränbrim we ane we zbär*
kränbrim we ane we zbär
2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\return also DEM also night
'Then he returns in the night.'

(81) *keke kwa bä srarugr o srawäkwr*
keke kwa bä sra\ru/gr o sra\wäk/wr
NEG FUT MED 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\sleep or 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\daybreak_on_sb
'He doesn't stay there overnight.'

(82) *zbär we kwa ŋanbrigwr keke kwa mothen fi srayak fi krathfänzr*
zbär we kwa ŋan\brig/wr keke kwa moth=en fi
night also FUT 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\return NEG FUT path=LOC 3.ABS
sra\yak/ fi kra\thfä/nzr
3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\walk 3.ABS 2|3SG:IRR:NPST\fly
'He goes back in the night. He will not walk on the road, but he will fly.'

(83) *nima ane wäfiyokwr*
nima ane wä\fiyok/wr
like_this DEM 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\make
'He will do like this:'

(84) *fthé sräbth kabe bthan zan srethkäf watik fä mane kwik erä fof*
fthé srä\bth/ kabe bthan zan
when 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\finish man magic fight
sre\thkäf/ watik fä mane kwik e\rä/
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\start then DIST which sickness 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
fof
EMPH
'When he has finished (drinking the bodily fluid), he starts casting spells. Next, some people there will fall ill.'

(85) *keke taurifo tmatm zrafiyokwr o ŋathafo*
keke tauri=fo tmatm zra\fiyok/wr o ŋatha=fo
NEG wallaby=ALL action 2|3SG>3SG.F:IRR:IPFV\make or dog=ALL
'He can put a spell on a wallaby or on a dog,'

(86) *o faso rrokar berä*
o faso r~rokar b=e\rä/
or meat REDUP~thing MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'or on any other (game) animals there.'

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(87) *ane rrokarfo kwa tmatm yafiyokwr keke kwa nima nä kabedben*
ane r~rokar=fo kwa tmatm ya\fiyok/wr keke
DEM REDUP~thing=ALL FUT action 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\make NEG
kwa nima nä kabe=dben
FUT like_this INDF man=LOC.ANIM.SG
'He will do this to animals, not to another man.'

(88) *fi ane kabeane mitafo kwa wthorthr*
fi ane kabe=ane mitafo kwa w\thor/thr
but DEM people=POSS.SG ghost FUT 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\enter
'But the sorcerer's spirit will go inside'

(89) *nä faso rokarfo o fthzé ŋatha zräthb*
nä faso rokar=fo o fthzé ŋatha zrä\thb/
INDF meat thing=ALL or INDF dog 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\enter
'some animal or whatever. I can go inside a dog.'

(90) *ra fthzé srarä ymd*
ra fthzé sra\rä/ ymd
what.ABS INDF 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\be bird
'It can be anything, for example a bird.'

(91) *watik ane fof kwa tmatm yafiyokwr ŋatha yafiyokwr nafane yfkaf*
watik ane fof kwa tmatm ya\fiyok/wr ŋatha
then DEM EMPH FUT action 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\make dog
ya\fiyok/wr nafane yf=kaf
2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\make 3SG.POSS name=PROP
'For example, he does these rituals to a dog and he puts some man's name to it.'

(92) *nezä kabe kwa kwosi yé keke ŋatha kwa kwosi srarä yakme*
nezä kabe kwa kwosi \yé/ keke ŋatha kwa kwosi
in_return man FUT dead 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be NEG dog FUT dead
sra\rä/ yakme
3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\be quickly
'The man will die, but the dog will not die quickly.'

(93) *mon tariäsi fthé kratariwr ŋatha*
mon tariä-si fthé kra\tari/wr ŋatha
how shrink-NMLZ when 2|3SG:IRR:IPFV\struggle dog
'As the dog slowly perishes,'

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(94) *we kabe nimäwä kwa ŋatariwr*
we kabe nimä=wä kwa ŋa\tari/wr
also man like_this=EMPH FUT 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\struggle
'the man will suffer in the same way.'

(95) *kwot e ŋatha fthé zä kwosi srarä kabe bä kwa kwosi yé*
kwot e ŋatha fthé zä kwosi sra\rä/ kabe bä kwa
properly until dog when PROX dead 3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\be man MED FUT
kwosi \yé/
dead 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'Some day the dog will die. The man will also die there,'

(96) *bänema ŋatha ane nafane yfkaf sfrä*
bäne=ma ŋatha ane nafane yf=kaf sf\rä/
PH=CHAR dog DEM 3SG.POSS name=PROP 3SG.M:RPST:IPFV\be
'because the dog was marked with his name.'

(97) *nimame ane fof bthan erä*
nima=me ane fof bthan e\rä/
like_this=INS DEM EMPH magic 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'This is how they are doing the magic.'[2]

(98) *okay, ane fenz mane ŋonathrth*
okay ane fenz mane ŋo\na/thrth
okay DEM pus which 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\drink
'It's when they drink these body fluids,'

(99) *tmä naf fof ärithr*
tmä naf fof ä\ri/thr
strength 3SG.ERG EMPH 2|3SG>2|3PL.IO:NPST:IPFV\give
'they become strong.'

(100) *kwosifr kabeane tmäf fof ezänzr nä karfo*
kwosifr kabe=ane tmä=f fof
corpse man=POSS.SG strength=ERG.SG EMPH
e\zä/nzr nä kar=fo
2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\carry INDF village=ALL
'The strength of the corpse carries them to another village.'

[2]CD asks *rma fi ngonathrth ane fenz* 'Why do they drink the body fluids?'

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(101) *nä kayé kam kwa emätrakwrth*
nä kayé kam kwa e\mätrak/wrth
INDF one_day_away bone FUT 2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\exit
'Sometimes, they will also extract bones,'

(102) *kabe kam kwosifr kam*
kabe kam kwosifr kam
man bone corpse bone
'human bones from the corpse.'

(103) *watik, ane fof thfäsir fof*
watik ane fof thfä-si=r fof
then DEM EMPH fly-NMLZ=PURP EMPH
'It is really for flying.'

(104) *ane kamf kwa yzänzr bobo nä karfo*
ane kam=f kwa y\zä/nzr bobo nä
DEM bone=ERG.SG FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\carry MED:ALL INDF
kar=fo
place=ALL
'These bones allow them to go to other places.'

(105) *fi fenz ane bänemrnzo rä tmä yarisir*
fi fenz ane bänemr=nzo \rä/ tmä
3.ABS pus DEM until=ONLY 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be strength
yari-si=r
give-NMLZ=PURP
'And these body fluids give them power.'

(106) *kamf fi ane kwa yzänzr bobo nima safs o wämnefr*
kam=f fi ane kwa y\zä/nzr bobo
bone=ERG.SG 3.ABS DEM FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\carry MED:ALL
nima safs o wämnefr
like_this PLN or PLN
'The bones will carry them, for example to Safés or to Wämnefr.'

(107) *o wämnefr nima zagr kwa ŋathfänzr weam*
nima zagr kwa ŋa\thfä/nzr weam
like_this far FUT 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\fly PLN
'They can fly far away (to places) such as Weam.'

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(108) *fthzé bobomrwä arufe krathfänzr*
fthzé bobomr=wä arufe kra\thfä/nzr
INDF until=EMPH PLN 2|3SG:IRR:NPST\fly
'Wherever they wish. They could fly all the way to Arufi,'

(109) *zagr karfo*
zagr kar=fo
far place=ALL
'to places far away.'

(110) *ane tmäf kwa yzänzr*
ane tmä=f kwa y\zä/nzr
DEM strength=ERG.SG FUT 2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\carry
'This power can take them there,'

(111) *kam a fenz*
kam a fenz
bone and pus
'it's the bones and the body fluid.'

(112) *eso kafar. anenzo katan trikasi zfrä*
eso kafar ane=nzo katan trikasi zf\rä/
thanks big DEM=ONLY small story 3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\be
'Thank you. That was the small story.'

(113) *trikasi nimanzo worä kabeyé mane watrikwrth*
trikasi nima=nzo wo\rä/ kabe=é mane
story like_this=ONLY 1SG:NPST:IPFV\be people=ERG.NSG which
wa\trik/wrth
2|3PL>1SG.IO:NPST:IPFV\tell
'I have told you as I have heard it from others.'

(114) *fi srakwä fthzé kwot kratrikwrth*
fi srak=wä fthzé kwot kra\trik/wrth
but boy=EMPH INDF properly 2|3PL:IRR:IPFV\tell
'The boys talk about this all the time.'

(115) *gadmöwä*
gadmöwä
thanks
'Thank you.'

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# 13 *Masis* - Matches

## 13.1 Introduction

*Masis* is a narrative lasting roughly 7min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on September 9th 2012, in video format.[1] The story teller is Kaumb Bai. The recording took place after the Sunday service in a shelter next to the church building in the village of Rouku. There was a large audience present, who burst out laughing at certain passages of the story.

## 13.2 Summary & background

The story takes place at a time when the inhabitants of Morehead had just been contacted by the colonial administrators and are exposed to "modern technology". More specifically, the story is about the introduction of the matchbox as a means of making fire.

In the story, a festival is held in the nearby village of Forzitho, with many people travelling from villages further west. The guests sing and dance all night long, interrupted only by breaks to sit down and take a rest. During this time, some respected elders stand up and give a speech. There is a special genre for these speeches called *se zokwasi* 'bark torch speech'. The story is about an argument between two men who have exchanged sisters, a man from Forzitho and a man from Koréth.

The man from Forzitho talks himself into a rage during his *se zokwasi*. In the midst of this rage, he pulls out a box of matches and announces to the crowd that he can make fire with this little thing. He claims that he can use it to light the so-called Kidn fire, which was the primordial fire that destroyed the mythical tree from which all humans descended. The crowd is shocked by his words. The people abandon everything and run away in fear. Finally, the man is pinned down and the matchbox is taken from him. They give him kava to drink to dampen his anger (and his physical movements). Finally, the dance continues until the early hours of the morning, when the people slaughter the pig and distribute the food.

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20120909-06. It is archived at: https://zenodo.org/records/1300792

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## 13.3 Parallel text

*nima fof. zane mane zafe zokwasi rä nzenme ŋafynme. ŋafyé nafanme zokwasi zrä. fthé fi miyamr thfrärm ra masis thfrärm. wati, anema masis mane thunrärm zba. torres strait islandfa thunrärm ane masis. wati, keke tüfrma yus thwafiyokwrmth o thufathwrmth. nä kabe näbikakmenzo finzo miyatha thfrärm fof.*

The story is like this. This story is an old story, our father's story. It's the fathers' story. It dates back to the time when people didn't yet know what matches were. When those matches first appeared here, they came from the *Torres Strait Islands*. There weren't many people who owned and used them. Only a few people really knew about them.

*ane efothen nä kayé z wath rera nima forzitho. wath rera. wati zba kabe äniyaka. thäwethath smärkifa. forzithoma kabe nä yara mafrr fäms erna. fi mon bänema yara korthma kabe. nä yf bäne mane wkonzrth mgte. wati fi fof äniyaka wathr fof. nzenme yam mane erä ruga emagthkwre. efnzre wati. nimamr fof. wati, mane äniyaka forzitho. wath sathayfath. ŋarnzürwäth zbär thd. zbär erära e wäksi tfotfo. wati, se fthé fof thäföfath fof. se fthé fof thäföfath. forzitho kabe fof nafafämsf thäföfa. se thäföfa. nokukarä kwanafrmth. nafafämsr kwanafnmth se zokwasi fof.*

At this time, there was a feast in *Forzitho*. There was a dance and people from here went there. They had also invited people from *Smärki*. There was one man from *Forzitho*. He had exchanged wives with those ones. He might have been from whatchamacallit, a man from *Koréth*. Another name for that place is *Méngte*. Well, so they came for the pig dance. It is customary to raise a pig and kill it for the dance. This is the way. As they came to *Forzitho*, they brought the dance into the village and they danced until midnight. The whole night passed and it was almost dawn. That was when they burned the bark. When they burned the bark it was the *Forzitho* man, his exchange man, who was talking. He burnt the torch. They were talking angrily. He got into an argument with his exchange man.

*wati naf z fafen masis z zbo thäthbako poketen, gwonyame bafen yaren. nokuyé fthé sabtha. ane kabe forzitho*

He had previously put a box of matches in his pocket, in his clothes, in the bag. As he talked himself into

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*kabe ane masis fthé thämätra fof. fthé thämätra fefe. näbi samätra masis foba fof. keke zane masis. zena zerä. striker zerä, keke ane! o lighter zerä. fi masis box fefe mane thfrärm fof. ane masis, stick masis. wati, näbi stick sanmätra ane kabe, forzithoma kabe. wati fof box ane neba zba thufathwrm neba. gagame neba gagame stick sufathwrm. kwanafrm nokume "nzefé fthé zänmätré. zfth mni zane zfrä kidn." zfth mni nä kayé zwäsmth kidn. wati kaböwä fthé samarath. wtri zärath. nima nafanme fam nima zfrärm: ah, kidn mane zfrärm a zafewä bad fthé ŋafiyokwa. ŋafyf fthé bad wäfiyokwa. kidn ane rifthzsime zfrärm. ymd nä zfrärm tütü. zena tütü mane wännor ymd fof. naf ane kidn zunarwrm mni.*

a rage, this man from *Forzitho*, he took out the matchbox. He pulled it out and got one match. It wasn't one of these lighters. Nowadays, there are cigarette lighters, not this type or lighter. These were real matches. These were match sticks. So the man from *Forzitho* took one match out. He held up the matchbox on one side with his hand. He held the match stick in his other hand. He was talking angrily "When I take this out, it will start the real fire, the Kidn fire!" They used to call the mythical fire sometimes Kidn. When people saw this, they got scared. They were thinking like this: This Kidn is from long time ago, when the earth was created, when god made the earth. This Kidn fire was hidden at the time. There was a bird named tütü. That tütü bird that was calling out today. She was hiding the Kidn fire.

*wati, anema kabeyé fthé zekarisath nima "nze kidn kwa zena zf yus wäfiyokwr. o znsän wnakwr. bänemr kwa ŋarsirwre ni bramöwä. ane masis fof thukonzrm masis box fof!" watik, fthé thänmätra ane masis fof. kabe mane erära zerfakuthath. wtri zärath ane katan masis boksmanzo fof. yaw kabe wathr mane enrära, kwakwirwrmth. ruga sagathifath. dagon ra bramöwä egathikwath. wtri zärath fof. "ane fthé kma zrärfusiré. zrewär. kabe bramöwä kwa ŋarsirwrth zane!" wtri thfrärm. wati krenafthth "sritüthe! sfafe! kidn mni mzärfusir! frthe bramöwä ŋar-*

The people heard him talk like this "Now I'm going to use them and we're all going to burn! I call these matches or matchbox." As he took out the matches, the people ran off in all directions. They were afraid of this small matchbox. All the people who had come to the dance ran away. They forgot about the pig, the food and everything else. They all were really scared. He continued "When I light this up, when it strikes, all the people will burn here." They were afraid and said: "Get him, hold him! He could start the fire and we'll all burn." A few men

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*sirwre." kabe nä änyaka zane gaga fur särath. ykarkwath ane mni masis fof. fthé fof zenaftha "miyatha käkoré! nima fof zräthor. anemr worfizrmth." näbuné manar thfgarwrmth. brubru thuwänzrmth. wtrime kwakwirwrmth ane masisma fof mni. wati, ykarkwrth. ymsakwrth. "be rar nima yam ŋafiyokwr? ni kwa nŋarsirwrame. nagayé fäth bramöwä berä. ausi kamkam berä. mane kwa né foba trtha niyarmo?" wati, ymsakwrth fof. yara krär yarinakwrth bänemr fof nafane noku frazsir. krärme srärirfth. wri kwosi sfthnm. watik, nafane noku fam aneme säbthath fof.*

came and tied up his hands. They took the fire from him, the matchbox really. He said: "Now you're feeling it! This is what will happen if you make fun of me." Others almost broke their feathers on their headdresses and smashed their drums. They ran away in fear because of these matches. Then they took the matchbox away from him and they sat him down. They said "Why are you doing this? We all could have burnt, all the little children and the old women. Who shall live from now on?" They sat him down properly. They poured him some kava to calm his anger. They bottled him with kava. He was lying there drunk out of his mind. They put an end to his angry thoughts.

*wati, wath srethkäfth. erära. threwäf. ruga yfnzrth. ykwathrth. dagon ŋarithath. ra bramöwä erära. bi ra erära. ŋarithath. wati, fi bana ŋabrigwath. smärki ŋabrigwath. forzitho karnzo thägathifath fof. ane kidn mni ane nafadben komnzo thfrärm.*

Then they started the dance again up until the morning hours. They killed the pig and slaughtered it. They distributed the meat, the sago and whatever else was there. Then the *Smärki* people went back. They left *Forzitho* village for good. That Kidn fire was just with that one guy.

*wati, namäwä kwot fthé masis ane fof thenthkäfath markai. fthé australian markaiyé fthé thenäthkäfath fof masis ane fof. kabe miyatha kwot fof kwakonzrmth. zane keke kidn rä. zane keke zfth mni rä. zane katan mninzo rä bänema sukufa o mni bänema fof. anema zane rä fof. fi zöbthé efothen mane thfrärm. siria wtri thfrärm. wtri kafar nima "bomb o kma bomb zfrärm?"*

These matchboxes were only recently introduced by the whites. The white people from *Autralia* brought these matches with them. People then found out that they call them matches. They have nothing do with the Kidn fire. This small fire is used for smoking tobacco or making a fire. It is for these things. But in the past, people were afraid. They were really scared

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*nimame fof. keke kafar kwark miyatha thfrärm nima ane rokar. ane timen bana nima, nzenme ŋafyé o nafanme ŋafyé mane erära. keke miyatha nä skul keke eyaka bobo. mobo ra nä keke aunege zanthorath o knowledge nä keke zanthorath. miyamr ane thfrärm fi fof zane mane wtri thfrärm. nafanme nabawan efoth ane fof rera. ane masi fthé nafa themarath fof.*

wondering "Is it a bomb or could it be a bomb?" That's how it was. The old people did not really know about those things at the time. Our fathers did not know and they did not go to school. There was no knowledge about this. Nothing was known about this. They did not know about it, so they were afraid of it. It was their first time to see matches.

*anema nä katan zokwasi nimamenzo fof zfrä, nzone katan masisma. ane mnima zöbthé mane zukonzrmth kidn o zfth mni. masis ane zöbthé zafe kabeyé thfkonzrmth fof. eso kafar. bramöwä yarizsima eso.*

That was the small story about these small matches. They used to call these Kidn fire or Zéféth fire. The old people used to call matches by those terms. Thank you all for listening. Thank you!

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## 13.4 Glossed text

(1) *nima fof*
nima fof
like_this EMPH
'(The story is) like this.'

(2) *zane mane zafe zokwasi rä*
zane mane zafe zokwasi \rä/
DEM:PROX which old speech 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'This story is an old story,'

(3) *nzenme ŋafynme*
nzenme ŋafe=aneme
1NSG.POSS father=POSS.NSG
'our father's (story).'

(4) *ŋafyé nafanme zokwasi zrä*
ŋafe=é nafanme zokwasi z=\rä/
father=ERG.NSG 3NSG.POSS speech PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'It's the fathers' story.'

(5) *fthé fi miyamr thfrärm ra masis thfrärm*
fthé fi miyamr thf\rä/rm ra masis
when 3.ABS ignorance 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be what.ABS matches
thf\rä/rm
2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'It dates back to the time when people didn't yet know what matches were.'

(6) *wati, anema masis mane thunrärm zba*
wati ane=ma masis mane thun\rä/rm zba
then DEM=CHAR matches which 2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\be PROX:ABL
'When those matches first appeared here,'

(7) *torres strait islandfa thunrärm ane masis*
torres_strait_island=fa thun\rä/rm ane masis
PLN=ABL 2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\be DEM matches
'they came from the Torres Strait Islands.'

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(8) *wati, keke tüfrma yus thwafiyokwrmth o thufathwrmth*
wati keke tüfr=ma yus thwa\fiyok/wrmth o
then NEG plenty=CHAR use 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\make or
thu\fath/wrmth
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hold
'There weren't many people who owned and used them.'

(9) *nä kabe näbikakmenzo finzo miyatha thfrärm fof*
nä kabe näbi-kak=me=nzo fi=nzo miyatha
INDF people one-DISTR=INS=ONLY 3.ABS=ONLY knowledge
thf\rä/rm fof
2|3PL:PST:DUR\be EMPH
'Only a few people really knew about them.'

(10) *ane efothen nä kayé z wath rera nima forzitho*
ane efoth=en nä kayé z wath \rä/ra nima
DEM day=LOC INDF one_day_away IAM dance 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be like_this
forzitho
PLN
'At this time, there was a feast in Forzitho.'

(11) *wath rera wati zba kabe äniyaka thäwethath smärkifa*
wath \rä/ra wati zba kabe än\yak/a
dance 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be then PROX:ABL people 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come
thä\weth/ath smärki=fa
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\invite PLN=ABL
'There was a dance and people from here went there. They had also invited people from Smärki.'[2]

(12) *forzithoma kabe nä yara mafrr fäms erna*
forzitho=ma kabe nä ya\r/a mafrr fäms
PLN=CHAR man INDF 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be who.ASSOC.DU exchange
e\rn/a
2|3DU:PST:IPFV\be
'There was one man from Forzitho. He had exchanged wives with those ones.'

[2]Smärki is a collective term for various peoples who live further west.

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(13) *fi mon bänema yara korthma kabe*
fi mon bäne=ma ya\r/a korth=ma kabe
3.ABS how PH.ABS=CHAR 3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be PLN=CHAR man
'He might have been from whatchamacallit, a man from Koréth.'

(14) *nä yf bäne mane wkonzrth mgte*
nä yf bäne mane w\ko/nzrth mgte
INDF name PH.ABS which 2|3PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\speak PLN
'Another name for that place is Méngte.'

(15) *wati fi fof äniyaka wathr fof*
wati fi fof än\yak/a wath=r fof
then 3.ABS EMPH 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come dance=PURP EMPH
'Well, so they came for the dance.'

(16) *nzenme yam mane erä ruga emagthkwre efnzre wati*
nzenme yam mane e\rä/ ruga
1NSG.POSS tradition which 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be pig
e\mgthk/wre e\fn/zre wati
1PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\feed 1PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\hit then
'It is customary to a pig and kill it (for the dance).'

(17) *nimamr fof*
nima=r fof
like_this=PURP EMPH
'This is the way.'

(18) *wati, mane äniyaka forzitho wath sathayfath*
wati mane än\yak/a forzitho wath
then which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come PLN dance
sa\thayf/ath
2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\present
'As they came to Forzitho, they brought the dance into the village'

(19) *ŋarnzürwäth zbär thd*
ŋa\rnzür/wath zbär thd
2|3PL:PST:IPFV\dance night middle
'and they danced until midnight.'

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(20) *zbär erära e wäksi tfotfo*
zbär e\rä/ra e wäk-si tfotfo
night 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be until daybreak_on_sb-NMLZ almost
'The whole night passed and it was almost dawn.'

(21) *wati, se fthé fof thäföfath fof*
wati se fthé fof thä\föf/ath fof
then barktorch when EMPH 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\burn EMPH
'That was when they burned the bark.'[3]

(22) *se fthé fof thäföfath*
se fthé fof thä\föf/ath
barktorch when EMPH 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\burn
'When they burned the bark'

(23) *forzitho kabe fof nafafämsf thäföfa*
forzitho kabe fof nafa-fäms=f thä\föf/a
PLN man EMPH 3.POSS-exchange=ERG.SG SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\burn
'it was the Forzitho man, his exchange man, who was talking.'

(24) *se thäföfa*
se thä\föf/a
barktorch SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\burn
'He burnt (the torch).'

(25) *nokukarä kwanafrmth*
noku=karä kwa\naf/rmth
anger=PROP 2|3PL:PST:DUR\talk
'They were talking angrily.'

(26) *nafafämsr kwanafnmth se zokwasi fof*
nafa-fäms=r kwa\naf/nmth se zokwasi fof
3.POSS-exchange=ASSOC.DU 2|3DU:RPST:DUR\talk barktorch speech EMPH
'He got into an argument with his exchange man.'

(27) *wati naf z fafen masis z zbo thäthbako poketen*

[3]'Burning the bark' alludes to a public speech genre called *se zokwasi* which is performed during feasts. The speaker carries a burning bark torch.

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wati naf z fafen masis z zbo
then 3SG.ERG IAM meanwhile matches IAM PROX:ALL
thä\thb/ako poket=en
SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV:AND\enter pocket=LOC
'He had previously put a box of matches in his pocket,'

(28) *gwonyame bafen yaren*
gwonyame bafen yare=en
clothing PH.LOC bag=LOC
'in his clothes, in the bag.'

(29) *nokuyé fthé sabtha*
noku=é fthé sa\bth/a
anger=ERG.NSG when SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\finish
'As he talked himself into a rage,'

(30) *ane kabe forzitho kabe*
ane kabe forzitho kabe
DEM man PLN man
'this man from Forzitho,'

(31) *ane masis fthé thämätra fof*
ane masis fthé thä\mätr/a fof
DEM matches when SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\exit EMPH
'he took out the matchbox.'

(32) *fthé thämätra fefe näbi samätra masis foba fof*
fthé thä\mätr/a fefe näbi sa\mätr/a masis
when SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\exit really one SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\exit matches
foba fof
DIST:ABL EMPH
'He pulled it out and got one match.'

(33) *keke zane masis*
keke zane masis
NEG DEM:PROX matches
'It wasn't one of these lighters.'

(34) *zena zerä striker zerä keke ane*

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zena z=e\rä/ striker z=e\rä/ keke
today PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be lighter PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be NEG
ane
DEM
'Nowadays, there are cigarette lighters, not this type'

(35) *o lighter zerä*
o lighter z=e\rä/
or lighter PROX=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'or lighter.'

(36) *fi masis box fefe mane thfrärm fof*
fi masis boks fefe mane thf\rä/rm fof
3.ABS matches box really which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be EMPH
'These were real matches.'

(37) *ane masis stick masis*
ane masis stick masis
DEM matches stick matches
'These were match sticks.'

(38) *wati, näbi stick sanmätra ane kabe forzithoma kabe*
wati näbi stick san\mätr/a ane kabe forzitho=ma kabe
then one stick SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV:VENT\exit DEM man PLN=CHAR man
'So the man from Forzitho took one match out.'

(39) *wati fof box ane neba zba thufathwrm neba*
wati fof boks ane neba zba thu\fath/wrm neba
then EMPH box DEM opposite PROX:ABL SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hold opposite
'He held up the matchbox on one side'

(40) *gagame neba gagame stick sufathwrm*
gaga=me neba gaga=me stick su\fath/wrm
hand=INS opposite hand=INS stick SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\hold
'with his hand. He held the match in his other hand.'

(41) *kwanafrm nokume*
kwa\naf/rm noku=me
SG:PST:DUR\talk anger=INS
'He was talking angrily'

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(42) *“nzefé fthé zänmätré*
nzefé fthé zän\mätr/é
1SG.ERG.EMPH when 1SG:PST:PFV:VENT\exit
‘“When I take this out’

(43) *zfth mni zane zfrä kidn”*
zfth mni zane zf\rä/ kidn
tree_base fire DEM:PROX 3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\be mythical_fire
‘it will start the real fire, the kidn fire!”’[4]

(44) *zfth mni nä kayé zwäsmth kidn*
zfth mni nä kayé zwä\s/mth
tree_base fire INDF one_day_away 2|3PL>3SG.F:ITER:DUR\call
kidn
mythical_fire
‘They used to call the mythical fire sometimes kidn.’

(45) *wati kaböwä fthé samarath wtri zärath*
wati kabe=wä fthé sa\mar/ath wtri zä\r/ath
then people=EMPH when 2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\see fear 2|3PL:PST:PFV\do
‘When people saw this, they got scared.’

(46) *nima nafanme fam nima zfrärm ah*
nima nafanme fam nima zf\rä/rm ah
like_this 3NSG.POSS thought like_this 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be ah
‘They were thinking like this:’

(47) *kidn mane zfrärm a zafewä*
kidn mane zf\rä/rm a zafe=wä
mythical_fire which 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be and old=EMPH
‘This kidn is from long time ago,’

(48) *bad fthé ŋafiyokwa*
bad fthé ŋa\fiyok/wa
ground when SG:PST:IPFV\make
‘when the earth was created,’

[4] *kidn* is a kind of mythical fire that has been burning in prehistoric times, when people still lives in the wäsi tree at *Kwafar* (cf. §3).

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(49) *ŋafyf fthé bad wäfiyokwa*
ŋafe=f fthé bad wä\fiyok/wa
father=ERG.SG when ground SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\make
'when god made the earth.'

(50) *kidn ane rifthzsime zfrärm*
kidn ane rifthz-si=me zf\rä/rm
mythical_fire DEM hide-NMLZ=INS 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
'This kidn fire was hidden at the time.'

(51) *ymd nä zfrärm tütü*
ymd nä zf\rä/rm tütü
bird INDF 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be bird_species
'There was a bird named tütü,'[5]

(52) *zena tütü mane wännor ymd fof*
zena tütü mane wän\nor/ ymd fof
today bird_species which 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\shout bird EMPH
'that tütü bird that was calling out today.'

(53) *naf ane kidn zunarwrm mni*
naf ane kidn zu\nar/wrm mni
3SG.ERG DEM mythical_fire SG>3SG.F:PST:DUR\press_down fire
'She was hiding the kidn fire.'

(54) *wati, anema kabeyé fthé zekarisath nima a*
wati ane=ma kabe=é fthé ze\karis/ath nima a
then DEM=CHAR people=ERG.NSG when 2|3PL:PST:PFV\hear like_this and
'The people heard him talk like this'

(55) *"nze kidn kwa zena zf yus wäfiyokwr o znsän wnakwr bänemr kwa ŋarsirwre ni bramöwä*
nze kidn kwa zena zf yus wä\fiyok/wr o
1SG.ERG mythical_fire FUT now ABSC use 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\make or
znsä=en w\nak/wr bäne=r kwa
work=LOC 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\put_down PH.ABS=PURP FUT
ŋa\rsir/wre ni bramöwä
1PL:NPST:IPFV\burn 1NSG all
'"Now I'm going to use them and we're all going to burn!'

[5] *tütü* 'pheasant coucal' (*Centropus phasianinus*)

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(56) *ane masis fof thukonzrm masis box fof"*
ane masis fof thu\ko/nzrm masis boks fof
DEM matches EMPH SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\speak matches box EMPH
'I call these matches or matchbox."'

(57) *watik, fthé thänmätra ane masis fof*
wati fthé thän\mätr/a ane masis fof
then when SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\exit DEM matches EMPH
'As he took out the matches,'

(58) *kabe mane erära zerfakuthath*
kabe mane e\rä/ra ze\rfakuth/ath
people which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be 2|3PL:PST:PFV\sprinkle
'the people ran off in all directions.'

(59) *wtri zärath ane katan masis boksmanzo fof*
wtri zä\r/ath ane katan masis boks=ma=nzo fof
fear 2|3PL:PST:PFV\do DEM small matches box=CHAR=ONLY EMPH
'They were afraid of this small matchbox.'

(60) *yaw kabe wathr mane enrära kwakwirwrmth*
yaw kabe wath=r mane en\rä/ra kwa\kwir/wrmth
all people dance=PURP which 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be 2|3PL:PST:DUR\run
'All the people who had come to the dance ran away.'

(61) *ruga sagathifath dagon ra bramöwä egathikwath*
ruga sa\gathif/ath dagon ra bramöwä
pig 2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\leave food what.ABS all
e\gathik/wath
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\leave
'They forgot about the pig, the food and everything else.'

(62) *wtri zärath fof*
wtri zä\r/ath fof
fear 2|3PL:PST:PFV\do EMPH
'They all were really scared.'

(63) *"ane fthé kma zrärfusiré zrewär*
ane fthé kma zrä\rfusir/é zre\wär/
DEM when POT 1SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\light_up 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\crack
'(He continued) "When I light this up, when it strikes,'

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(64) *kabe bramöwä kwa ŋarsirwrth zane"*
kabe bramöwä kwa ŋa\rsir/wrth zane
people all FUT 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\burn DEM:PROX
'all the people will burn here."'

(65) *wtri thfrärm*
wtri thf\rä/rm
fear 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'They were afraid.'

(66) *wati krenafthth "sritüthe sfafe kidn mni mzärfusir frthe bramöwä ŋarsirwre"*
wati kre\nafth/th s\ritüth/e s\faf/e
then 2|3PL:IRR:PFV\talk 2PL>3SG.M:IMP:PFV\grab 2PL>3SG.M:IMP:PFV\hold
kidn mni m=zä\rfusir/ fthé bramöwä
mythical_fire fire APPR=2SG>3SG.F:IMP:PFV\light_up when all
ŋa\rsir/wre
1PL:NPST:IPFV\burn
'So they said: "Get him, hold him! He could start the fire and we'll all burn."'

(67) *kabe nä äniyaka zane gaga fur särath*
kabe nä än\yak/a zane gaga fur
people INDF 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come DEM:PROX hand bundle
sä\r/ath
2|3PL>3SG.M.IO:PST:PFV\do
'A few men came and tied up his hands.'

(68) *ykarkwath ane mni masis fof*
y\kark/wath ane mni masis fof
2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\take DEM fire matches EMPH
'They took the fire from him, the matchbox really.'

(69) *fthé fof zenaftha "miyatha käkoré nima fof zräthor anemr worfizrmth"*
fthé fof ze\nafth/a miyatha kä\kor/é nima
when EMPH SG:PST:PFV\speak knowledge 2SG:IMP:PFV\become like_this
fof zrä\thor/ ane=r wo\rfiz/rmth
EMPH 3SG.F:IRR:PFV\appear DEM=PURP 2|3PL>1SG:RPST:DUR\tease
'He said: "Now you're feeling it! This is what will happen if you make fun of me."'

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(70) *näbuné manar thfgarwrmth brubru thuwänzrmth*
näbun=é manar thf\gar/wrmth brubru
INDF=ERG.NSG headdress 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\break drum
thu\wä/nzrmth
2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\crack
'Others almost broke their feathers (on their headdresses) and smashed their drums.'

(71) *wtrime kwakwirwrmth ane masisma fof mni*
wtri=me kwa\kwir/wrmth ane masis=ma fof mni
fear=INS 2|3PL:PST:DUR\run DEM matches=CHAR EMPH fire
'They ran away in fear because of these matches.'

(72) *wati, ykarkwrth ymsakwrth*
wati y\kark/wrth y\msak/wrth
then 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\take 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\sit
'Then they took (the matchbox) away from him and they sat him down.'

(73) *"be rar nima yam ŋafiyokwr ni kwa nŋarsirwrame nagayé fäth bramöwä berä ausi kamkam berä*
be ra=r nima yam ŋa\fiyok/wr ni kwa
2SG.ERG what.ABS=PURP like_this event 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\make 1NSG FUT
n=ŋa\rsir/wrme nagayé fäth bramöwä b=e\rä/
IPST=1PL:RPST:DUR\burn children DIM all MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
ausi kam~kam b=e\rä/
old_woman REDUP~bone MED=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'(They said) 'Why are you doing this? We all could have burnt, all the little children and the old women.'

(74) *mane kwa né foba trtha niyarmo*
mane kwa n foba trtha n=ya\r/mo
which FUT IMN DIST:ABL life IPST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'Who shall live from now on?"'

(75) *wati, ymsakwrth fof*
wati y\msak/wrth fof
then 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\sit EMPH
'They sat him down properly.'

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(76) *yara krär yarinakwrth bänemr fof nafane noku frazsir*
ya\r/a krä\r/ ya\rinak/wrth
3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\do 2|3PL>3SG.M.IO:NPST:IPFV\pour
bäne=r fof nafane noku fraz-si=r
PH.ABS=PURP EMPH 3SG.POSS anger extinguish-NMLZ=PURP
'They poured him some kava to calm his anger.'[6]

(77) *krärme srärirfth*
krär=me srä\rirf/th
kava=INS 2|3P>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\kill
'They bottled him with kava.'

(78) *wri kwosi sfthnm*
wri kwosi sf\thn/m
intoxication dead 3SG.M:PST:DUR\lie_down
'He was lying there drunk out of his mind.'

(79) *watik, nafane noku fam aneme säbthath fof*
wati nafane noku fam ane=me sä\bth/ath fof
then 3SG.POSS anger thought DEM=INS 2|3PL>3SG.M:PST:PFV\finish EMPH
'They put an end to his angry thoughts.'

(80) *wati, wath srethkäfth erära threwäf*
wati wath sre\thkäf/th e\rä/ra
then dance 2|3PL>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\start 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be
thre\wäf/
2|3SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\weaken
'Then they started the dance again up until the morning hours.'

(81) *ruga yfnzrth ykwathrth dagon ŋarithath ra bramöwä erära bi ra erära ŋarithath*
ruga y\fn/zrth y\kwa/thrth dagon
pig 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\hit 2|3PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\cut_meat food
ŋa\ri/thath ra bramöwä e\rä/ra bi ra
2|3PL:PST:IPFV\give what.ABS all 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be sago what.ABS
e\rä/ra ŋa\ri/thath
2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\give
'They killed the pig and slaughtered it. They distributed the meat, the sago and whatever else was there.'

[6]The root of the kava plant (*Piper methysticum*) is consummed for its sedating effects.

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(82) *wati, fi bana ŋabrigwath smärki ŋabrigwath*
wati fi bana ŋa\brig/wath smärki ŋa\brig/wath
then 3.ABS pitiful 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\return PLN 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\return
'Then the Smärki people went back.'

(83) *forzitho karnzo thägathifath fof*
forzitho kar=nzo thä\gathif/ath fof
PLN place=ONLY 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\leave EMPH
'They left Forzitho village for good.'

(84) *ane kidn mni ane nafadben komnzo thfrärm*
ane kidn mni ane nafadben komnzo thf\rä/rm
DEM mythical_fire fire DEM 3SG.LOC only 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'That kidn fire was just with that one guy.'

(85) *wati, namäwä kwot fthé masis ane fof thenthkäfath markai*
wati namä=wä kwot fthé
then good=EMPH properly when
'These matchboxes were only recently introduced by the whites.'

(86) *fthé australian markaiyé fthé thenäthkäfath fof masis ane fof*
masis ane fof then\thkäf/ath markai fthé
matches DEM EMPH 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\start outsider when
australian markai=é fthé then\thkäf/ath fof
PLN outsider=ERG.NSG when 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\start EMPH
'The white people from Autralia brought these matches with them.'

(87) *kabe miyatha kwot fof kwakonzrmth*
masis ane fof kabe miyatha kwot fof
matches DEM EMPH people knowledge properly EMPH
kwa\ko/nzrmth
2|3PL:RPST:DUR\speak
'People then found out that they call them matches.'

(88) *zane keke kidn rä zane keke zfth mni rä*
zane keke kidn \rä/ zane keke
DEM:PROX NEG mythical_fire 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be DEM:PROX NEG
zfth mni \rä/
tree_base fire 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'They have nothing do with the kidn fire.'

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(89) *zane katan mninzo rä bänema sukufa o mni bänema fof*
zane katan mni=nzo \rä/ bäne=ma sukufa o
DEM:PROX small fire=ONLY 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be PH.ABS=CHAR tobacco or
mni bäne=ma fof
fire PH.ABS=CHAR EMPH
'This small fire is used for smoking tobacco or making a fire.'

(90) *anema zane rä fof*
ane=ma zane \rä/ fof
DEM=CHAR DEM:PROX 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be EMPH
'It is for these things.'

(91) *fi zöbthé efothen mane thfrärm siria wtri thfrärm*
fi zöbthé efoth=en mane thf\rä/rm siria wtri
but first day=LOC which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be serious fear
thf\rä/rm
2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'But in the past, people were afraid.'

(92) *wtri kafar nima "bomb o kma bomb zfrärm?"*
wtri kafar nima bomb o kma bomb zf\rä/rm
fear big like_this bomb or POT bomb 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
'They were really scared "Is it a bomb or could it be a bomb?"'

(93) *nimame fof*
nima=me fof
like_this=INS EMPH
'That's how it was.'

(94) *keke kafar kwark miyatha thfrärm nima ane rokar. ane timen bana nima*
keke kafar kwark miyatha thf\rä/rm nima ane rokar
NEG big deceased knowledge 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be like_this DEM thing
ane time=en bana nima
DEM time=LOC pitiful like_this
'The old people did not really know about those things at the time.'

(95) *nzenme ŋafyé o nafanme ŋafyé mane erära keke miyatha nä skul keke eyaka bobo*

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nzenme ŋafe=é o nafanme ŋafe=é mane
1NSG.POSS father=ERG.NSG or 3NSG.POSS father=ERG.NSG which
e\rä/ra keke miyatha nä school keke e\yak/a
2|3PL:PST:IPFV\be NEG knowledge INDF school NEG 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\walk
bobo
MED:ALL
'Our fathers did not know and they did not go to school.'

(96) *mobo ra nä keke aunege zanthorath o*
mobo ra nä keke aunege
where.ALL what.ABS INDF NEG knowledge
zan\thor/ath o
2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\carry or
'There was no knowledge about this.'[7]

(97) *knowledge nä keke zanthorath*
knowledge nä keke zan\thor/ath
knowledge INDF NEG 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:PFV:VENT\carry
'Nothing was known abouth this.'

(98) *miyamr ane thfrärm fi fof zane mane wtri thfrärm*
miyamr ane thf\rä/rm fi fof zane mane wtri
ignorance DEM 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be but EMPH DEM:PROX which fear
thf\rä/rm
2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'They did not know about it, so they were afraid of it.'

(99) *nafanme nabawan efoth ane fof rera ane masi fthé nafa themarath fof*
nafanme nambawan efoth ane fof \rä/ra ane masis
3NSG.POSS first day DEM EMPH 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be DEM matches
fthé nafa the\mar/ath fof
when 3NSG.ERG 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:PFV\see EMPH
'It was their first time to see matches.'

(100) *anema nä katan zokwasi nimamenzo fof zfrä nzone katan masisma*

[7] *aunege* is a Motu loanword meaning 'knowledge'

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ane=ma nä katan zokwasi nima=me=nzo fof
DEM=CHAR INDF small speech like_this=INS=ONLY EMPH
zf\rä/ nzone katan masis=ma
3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\be 1SG.POSS small matches=CHAR
'That was the small story about these small matches.'

(101) *ane mnima zöbthé mane zukonzrmth kidn o zfth mni*
ane mni=ma zöbthé mane zu\ko/nzrmth kidn
DEM fire=CHAR first which 2|3PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR\speak mythical_fire
o zfth mni
or tree_base fire
'They used to call these kidn fire or zfth fire.'

(102) *masis ane zöbthé zafe kabeyé thfkonzrmth fof*
masis ane zöbthé zafe kabe=é thf\ko/nzrmth
matches DEM first old people=ERG.NSG 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:DUR\speak
fof
EMPH
'The old people used to call matches by those terms.'

(103) *eso kafar bramöwä yarizsima eso*
eso kafar bramöwä yariz-si=ma eso
thanks big all hear-NMLZ=CHAR thanks
'Thank you all for listening. Thank you!'

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# 14 *Fiyaf trikasi* - A hunting story

## 14.1 Introduction

*Fiyaf trikasi* is narrative lasting roughly 5min. It was recorded by Julia Miller and Christian Döhler on August 21st 2012, in both audio and video formats.[1] The story teller is Lucy (Néfiam) Abia, and the recording took place in her river garden while building a fence.

## 14.2 Summary & background

Lucy tells a story how she and her family spent a few days at their river camp. Her husband Abia goes off hunting and shots a big pig. They slaughter the pig and divide up the meat.

## 14.3 Parallel text

*zena mane hunting story kwa ŋatrikwé trikasi. fiyafma trikasi nima. ni masun nzwamnzrm. wati alice riley fi katakatan thfrnm. nzenme camp bä zfrärm bä bäne rä brä. ausi kam ane faf zn. biskar ŋarake fä zwarärm.*

I will tell a hunting story now, a story about hunting. We were living in *Masu*. Alice and Riley were small. Our camp was that place, at the old woman's place. She used to have cassava garden there.

*paituaf nzräkor "nzä fiyafr wiyak." afa sande zefara fiyafr. boba wazi kuf boba rä. fä emoth fäth thfamnzrm. ksi kar emoth fäth. wati afa mane zefara byé. ruga ane sathkäfa ŋathame. ŋathayé sathkäfath. sfaruthrmth. ane fathnzo zfrärm. wämne keke, dödönzo.*

Father said to us "I'll go hunting". It was on Sunday. Father set off to go hunting. He went across the river to *Kuf*. Some young girls were living there, bush girls. As father departed, he began hunting for pigs with his dogs. The dogs started barking at

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20120821-02. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189906

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*dödö maneme ŋarenwre fath. ane frnzo zfrärm. watik afaf ane ruga sathkäfa dunzi fof. sfruthrm. dunzime sfruthrm. watik, srethkäf. yruthr. srägathif. wati, foba krekaris. emothemoth ane ksi kar emoth thwanorm. okay, nafa nima afan swarärm. "bäiŋam ŋafethm kma rära" pilipanme ŋame, nafaemoth fefe. fi kma rära.*

the pigs. This was a clear place without trees, only dödö bushes. These dödö that we use as a broom. Only those bushes were there. Then father aimed with his bow and arrow, and he shot it. He shot it and left it there. he heard these girls. These bush girls were shouting. Okay, they were doing this but father thought to himself "This could be my aunt and my uncle." Phillip's mother, his sister really. "It could be her."

*wati, mane yaniyaka zyé. nzenm nzrätrif "ruga bä ythn." ni nafä nzfrärm, sitauane emoth nima. mane zokofo wämnzr dayr. dayr fthé emoth zfrä. watik fobo sräthor. afa nzrätrif "ruga z nzifnzé: yabun, yayabun, yabun, yabun! keke, kwa monme ynznzrm? nimäwä fi ra bä nzänor? ra emothemoth ane nzänor? ksi kar emothemoth?" watik, nzrämes ni yakyakme bnrä. yakme ane bäne ruga yfränzre. afa fi miyamr ykwasi. nzefnzo, nzefé ane thfkathrm ruga. wati, afaf kwräkor "yakme skwathé!" ykwathé. sräbthé. ŋawathknwre.*

Then he came back and he told us, "The pig is lying there." We were together with Sitau's sister Dayér, who is now living in *Tokwa*. Dayér wasn't married then. As he arrived, father told us "I just killed a pig, a huge one! But how can I carry it? also who was shouting there? Which girls were just shouting there? those bushgirls?" Then he took us there. We walked quickly. We burned the fur off the pig. Father didn't know how to cut it up. Only me, I was in charge of slaughtering pigs. Father told me: "Cut up the pig quickly!" I finished it and we packed it up.

*riley alice fi zbo thwamnzrm. ausi kam fof rä bobo mane wämnzr wämnzr mnzen. naf thfamonegrnm. wati kufraru, ane afaf ertmakwa mrrabma. kwa efsgwre "kuuuuu". fthé faso nima lucky fthé thrarä bafen. yabun faso nima ruga o yem. ra fthé srafnzth kafar. wati ane bafen ka wfsgwrth ane kufraru. kufraru keke! bäne rä?*

Riley and Alice were staying here, where the old woman is living. She stayed in the house. She was looking after them. Father made a flute from the small bamboo. In those days we blew these flutes "kuuuuu'' when we had hunting luck. When we got big animals like pigs or cassowaries, when we killed something big. That's

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*mrab bäne fof rä? turatura ertmakwr. wati kwa wfsgwrth kufraruthatha. turatura mrrabma kwa wrtmakwrth. ane zunfsgwrame e wati. railey katakatan sfrärm fi yarekarä. alice ŋakwire "nzenme afaf ruga weto kwarärm!"*

when we blew the kufraru flute. Oh, it's not the kufraru. It's the other one made from the small bamboo, the turatura flute. That's the one we blew. It is similar to the kufraru flute. They cut the turatura flute from the small bamboo. That's the one we were blowing. We went back home. Riley was still very small, he was in the baby basket. Alice was running around saying "Our father is making me happy."

*wati ynzänzake bobo brä. yrzathake. wati äkwathake nima sitauaneme afa kwark biyara. nafanm äkwane, nzenmwä. naniyaka zbo weekenr. wati we zäbrimake masu. masun ni fä nzwamnzrm. wati mon kwa. we fof zänbrimake mnz. wati story fof zäbth. katan ttrikasi erä.*

So we carried back the pig and we baked it in the oven. We cut the meat for them. Sitau's late father and the family were there. We cut some meat for them and also for ourselves. We sometimes came here for the weekend and then we returned to *Masu*, where we lived at the time. Anyhow, we went back to the house. Okay, that's the end of the story. These are small stories.

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## 14.4 Glossed text

(1) *zena mane hunting story kwa ŋatrikwé trikasi*
zena mane hunting story kwa ŋa\trik/wé trikasi
now which hunt story FUT 1SG:NPST:IPFV\tell story
'I will tell a hunting story now,'

(2) *fiyafma trikasi nima*
fiyaf=ma trikasi nima
hunt=CHAR story like_this
'a story about hunting.'

(3) *ni masun nzwamnzrm*
ni masu=en nzwa\m/nzrm
1NSG Masu=LOC 1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'We were living in Masu.'

(4) *wati alice riley fi katakatan thfrnm*
wati alice riley fi kata~katan thf\rn/m
then Alice Riley 3.ABS REDUP~small 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be
'Alice and Riley were small.'

(5) *nzenme camp bä zfrärm bä bäne rä brä*
nzenme camp bä zf\rä/rm bä bäne \rä/
1NSG.POSS camp MED 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be MED PH.ABS 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
b=\rä/
MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'Our camp was that place,'

(6) *ausi kam ane faf zn*
ausi kam ane faf zn
old_woman bone DEM yard place
'at the old woman's place.'

(7) *biskar ŋarake fä zwarärm*
biskar ŋarake fä zwa\rä/rm
cassava garden DIST 3SG.F.IO:PST:DUR\be
'She used to have cassava garden there.'

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(8) *paituaf nzräkor nzä fiyafr wiyak*
paitua=f nzrä\kor/ nzä fiyaf=r
old_man=ERG.SG 2|3SG>1PL:IRR:PFV\speak 1SG.ABS hunt=PURP
w\yak/
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk
'Father said to us "I'll go hunting".'

(9) *afa sande zefara fiyafr*
afa sande ze\far/a fiyaf=r
father Sunday SG:PST:PFV\set_off hunt=PURP
'It was on Sunday. Father set off to go hunting.'

(10) *boba wazi kuf boba rä*
boba wazi kuf boba \rä/
MED:ABL side PLN MED:ABL 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'He went across the river to Kuf.'

(11) *fä emoth fäth thfamnzrm*
fä emoth fäth thfa\m/nzrm
DIST girl DIM 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'Some young girls were living there,'

(12) *ksi kar emoth fäth*
ksi kar emoth fäth
grassland place girl DIM
'bush girls.'

(13) *wati afa mane zefara byé*
wati afa mane ze\far/a b=\yé/
then father which SG:PST:PFV\set_off MED=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'As father departed,'

(14) *ruga ane sathkäfa ŋathame*
ruga ane sa\thkäf/a ŋatha=me
pig DEM SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\start dog=INS
'he began hunting for pigs with his dogs.'

(15) *ŋathayé sathkäfath sfaruthrmth*
ŋatha=é sa\thkäf/ath sfa\ru/thrmth
dog=ERG.NSG 2|3PL>3SG.M.IO:PST:PFV\start 2|3PL>3SG.M.IO:PST:DUR\bark
'The dogs started barking (at the pigs).'

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(16) *ane fathnzo zfrärm wämne keke*
ane fath=nzo zf\rä/rm wämne keke
DEM clear_place=ONLY 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be tree NEG
'This was a clear place without trees,'

(17) *dödönzo*
dödö=nzo
melaleuca_species=ONLY
'only dödö bushes.'

(18) *dödö maneme ŋarenwre fath*
dödö mane=me ŋa\ren/wre fath
melaleuca_species which=INS 1PL:NPST:IPFV\sweep clear_place
'Thsh dödö which we use as a broom.'

(19) *ane frnzo zfrärm*
ane fr=nzo zf\rä/rm
DEM post=ONLY 3SG.F:PST:DUR\be
'Only those bushes were there.'

(20) *watik afaf ane ruga sathkäfa dunzi fof*
wati afa=f ane ruga sa\thkäf/a dunzi fof
then father=ERG.SG DEM pig SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\start arrow EMPH
'Then father aimed with his bow and arrow,'

(21) *sfruthrm*
sf\ru/thrm
SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\shoot
'and he shot it.'

(22) *dunzime sfruthrm*
dunzi=me sf\ru/thrm
arrow=INS SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\shoot
'He kept on shooting at it with arrows.'

(23) *watik, srethkäf yruthr srägathif*
wati sre\thkäf/ y\ru/thr
then 2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\start 2|3SG>3SG:NPST:IPFV\shoot
srä\gathif/
2|3SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\leave
'He shots it and left it there.'

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(24) *wati, foba krekaris emothemoth ane ksi kar emoth thwanorm*
wati foba kre\karis/ emoth~emoth ane ksi kar
then DIST:ABL 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\hear REDUP~girl DEM grassland place
emoth thwa\nor/m
girl 2|3PL:PST:DUR\shout
'Then he heard these girls. These bush girls were shouting.'

(25) *okay, nafa nima afan swarärm*
okay nafa nima afa=n swa\rä/rm
okay 3NSG.ERG like_this father=DAT.SG 3SG.M.IO:PST:DUR\be
'Okay, there doing this but father thought to himself'

(26) *"bäiŋam ŋafethm kma rära"*
bäiŋam ŋafethm kma \rä/ra
exchange_aunt paternal_aunt POT 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be
'"This could be my aunt and my uncle."'

(27) *pilipanme ŋame*
pilip=aneme ŋame
Phillip=POSS.NSG mother
'Phillip's mother,'

(28) *nafaemoth fefe*
nafa-emoth fefe
3.POSS-girl really
'his sister really.'

(29) *fi kma rära*
fi kma \rä/ra
3.ABS POT 3SG.F:PST:IPFV\be
'"It could be her."'

(30) *wati, mane yaniyaka zyé*
wati mane yan\yak/a z=\yé/
then which 3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\come PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'Then he came back'

(31) *nzenm nzrätrif*
nzenm nzrä\trif/
1NSG.DAT 2|3SG>1PL.IO:IRR:PFV\tell
'and he told us,'

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(32) *ruga bä ythn*
ruga bä y\thn/
pig MED 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\lie_down
'"The pig is lying there."'

(33) *ni nafä nzfrärm sitauane emoth nima*
ni nafä nzf\rä/rm sitau=ane emoth nima
1NSG 3PL.ASSOC 1PL:PST:DUR\be PN=POSS.SG sister like_this
'We were together with Sitau's sister'

(34) *mane zokofo wämnzr dayr*
mane zoko=fo wä\m/nzr dayr
which Tokwa=ALL 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\sit Dayr
'Dayér, who is now living in Tokwa.'

(35) *dayr fthé emoth zfrä*
dayr fthé emoth zf\rä/
Dayr when girl 3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\be
'Dayér wasn't married then.'

(36) *watik fobo sräthor*
wati fobo srä\thor/
then DIST:ALL 3SG.M:IRR:PFV\appear
'He arrived there.'

(37) *afa nzrätrif*
afa nzrä\trif/
father 2|3SG>1PL.IO:IRR:PFV\tell
'Father told us,'

(38) *ruga z nzifnzé yabun yayabun yabun yabun*
ruga z nz=y\fn/nzé yabun ya~yabun
pig IAM IPST=1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\hit big REDUP~big
'"I just killed a pig, a huge one!'

(39) *keke kwa monme ynznzrm*
keke kwa mon=me yn\zä/nzrm
NEG FUT how=INS SG>3SG.M:RPST:DUR:VENT\carry
'How will I carry it?'

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(40) *nimäwä fi ra bä nzänor*
nima=wä fi ra bä nz=ä\nor/
like_this=EMPH 3.ABS what.ABS MED IPST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\shout
'also what was shouting there?'

(41) *ra emoth emoth ane nzänor*
ra emoth~emoth ane nz=ä\nor/
what.ABS REDUP~girl DEM IPST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\shout
'Which girls were just shouting there?'

(42) *ksi kar emothemoth*
ksi kar emoth~emoth
grassland place REDUP~girl
'those bushgirls?"'

(43) *watik, nzrämes ni yakyakme bnrä*
wati nzrä\mes/ ni yak~yakme b=n\rä/
then 2|3SG>1PL:IRR:PFV\bring 1NSG REDUP~quickly MED=1PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'Then he took us there. We walked quickly.'

(44) *yakme ane bäne ruga yfränzre*
yakme ane ruga y\frä/nzre
quickly DEM pig 1PL>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\singe_off
'We burned the fur off the pig.'

(45) *afa fi miyamr ykwasi*
afa fi miyamr ykwa-si
father 3.ABS ignorance cut_meat-NMLZ
'Father didn't know how to cut it up.'

(46) *nzefnzo, nzefé ane thfkathrm ruga*
nzefé=nzo nzefé ane th\fka/thrm ruga
1SG.ERG.EMPH=ONLY 1SG.ERG.EMPH DEM SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\peel pig
'Only me, I was cutting the pigs.'

(47) *wati, afaf kwräkor yakme skwathé ykwathé*
wati afa=f kwrä\kor/ yakme
then father=ERG.SG 2|3SG>1SG:IRR:PFV\speak quickly
s\kwath/é y\kwath/é
2SG>3SG.M:IMP:IPFV\cut_meat 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\cut_meat
'Father told me: "Cut up the pig quickly!"'

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(48) *sräbthé ŋawathknwre*
srä\bth/é ŋa\wathkn/wre
1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\finish 1PL:NPST:IPFV\pack_up
'I finished it and we packed it up.'

(49) *riley alice fi zbo thwamnzrm*
riley alice fi zbo thwa\m/nzrm
Riley Alice 3.ABS PROX:ALL 2|3PL:PST:DUR\sit
'Riley and Alice were staying here,'

(50) *ausi kam fof rä bobo mane wämnzr*
ausi kam fof \rä/ bobo mane
old_woman bone EMPH 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be MED:ALL which
wä\m/nzr
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\sit
'where the old woman is living.'

(51) *wämnzr mnzen*
wä\m/nzr mnz=en
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\sit house=LOC
'She stayed in the house.'

(52) *naf thfamonegrnm*
naf thfa\moneg/rnm
3SG.ERG SG>2|3DU:PST:DUR\take_care
'She was looking after them.'

(53) *wati kufraru ane afaf ertmakwa mrrabma*
wati kufraru ane afa=f e\rtmak/wa
then bamboo_flute DEM father=ERG.SG SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\cut
mrrab=ma
small_bamboo=CHAR
'Father made a flute from the small bamboo.'

(54) *kwa efsgwre "ku" fthé faso nima lucky fthé thrarä bafen*
kwa e\fsg/wre ku fthé faso nima lucky fthé
FUT 1PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\blow *** when meat like_this lucky when
thra\rä/ baf=en
2|3PL:IRR:IPFV\be PH=LOC
'In those days we blew these (flutes) - 'kuuuuu' - when we had hunting luck.'

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(55) *yabun faso nima ruga o yem*
yabun faso nima ruga o yem
big meat like_this pig or cassowary
'When we got big animals like pigs or cassowaries,'

(56) *ra fthé srafnzth kafar*
ra fthé sra\fn/nzrth kafar
what.ABS when 2|3PL>3SG.M:IRR:IPFV\hit big
'when we killed something big.'

(57) *wati ane bafen ka wfsgwrth ane kufraru*
wati ane baf=en kwa w\fsg/wrth ane kufraru
then DEM PH=LOC FUT 2|3PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\blow DEM bamboo_flute
'That's when we blow the kufraru flute.'

(58) *kufraru keke*
kufraru keke
bamboo_flute NEG
'Oh, it's not the kufraru.'

(59) *bäne rä mrab bäne fof rä turatura ertmakwr wati kwa wfsgwrth*
bäne \rä/ mrrab bäne fof
PH.ABS 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be small_bamboo PH.ABS EMPH
\rä/ turatura e\rtmak/wr wati kwa
3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be bamboo_flute 2|3SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\cut then FUT
w\fsg/wrth
2|3PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\blow
'It's the other one made from the small bamboo, the turatura flute. That's the one we blew.'

(60) *kufraruthatha ...*
kufraru=thatha
bamboo_flute=SIMIL
'It is similar to the kufraru flute.'

(61) *turatura mrrabma kwa wrtmakwrth.*
turatura mrrab=ma kwa w\rtmak/wrth
bamboo_flute small_bamboo=CHAR FUT 2|3PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\cut
'They cut the turatura flute from the small bamboo.'

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(62) *ane zunfsgwrame*
ane zun\fsg/wrme
DEM 1PL>3SG.F:PST:DUR:VENT\blow
'That's the one we were blowing.'

(63) *eee wati*
e wati
until then
'up until (home).'

(64) *railey katakatan sfrärm fi yarekarä alice ŋakwire "nzenme afaf ruga weto kwarärm"*
riley kata~katan sf\rä/rm fi yare=karä alice
Riley REDUP~small 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be 3.ABS bag=PROP Alice
ŋa\kwir/e nzenme afa=f ruga weto kwa\rä/rm
1PL:NPST:IPFV\run 1NSG.POSS father=ERG.SG pig joy SG>1SG:PST:DUR\do
'Riley was still very small, he was in the baby basket. Alice was running around saying "Our father is making me happy."'

(65) *wati ynzänzake bobo brä yrzathake*
wati yn\zä/nzake bobo b=\rä/
then 1PL>3SG.M:PST:IPFV:VENT\carry MED:ALL MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
y\rza/thake
1PL>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\bake
'So we carried back the pig and we baked it in the oven.'

(66) *wati äkwathake nima*
wati ä\kwa/thake nima
then 1PL>2|3PL.IO:PST:IPFV\cut_meat like_this
'We cut the meat for them.'

(67) *sitauaneme afa kwark biyara nafanm äkwane nzenmwä*
sitau=aneme afa kwark b=ya\r/a nafanm
Sitau=POSS.NSG father deceased MED=3SG.M:PST:IPFV\be 3NSG.DAT
ä\kwa/ne nzenm=wä
1PL>2|3DU.IO:NPST:IPFV\cut_meat 1NSG.DAT=EMPH
'Sitau's late father and the family were there. We cut some meat for them and also for ourselves.'

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(68) *naniyaka zbo weekenr*
nan\yak/a zbo weekend=r
1PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come PROX:ALL weekend=PURP
'We sometimes came here for the weekend'

(69) *wati we zäbrimake masu. masun ni fä nzuwamnzrm*
wati we zä\brim/ake masu masu=en ni fä nzwa\m/nzrm
then also 1PL:PST:PFV\return Masu Masu=LOC 1NSG DIST 1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'and then we returned to Masu, where we lived at the time.'

(70) *wati mon kwa we fof zänbrimake mnz*
wati mon kwa we fof zän\brim/ake mnz
then how FUT also EMPH 1PL:PST:PFV:VENT\return house
'Anyhow, we went back to the house.'

(71) *wati story fof zäbth*
wati story fof zä\bth/
then story EMPH 2|3SG:RPST:PFV\finish
'Okay, that's the end of the story.'

(72) *katan ttrikasi erä*
katan t~trikasi e\rä/
small REDUP~story 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'These are small stories.'

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# 15 *Fiyaf trikasi* - A hunting story

## 15.1 Introduction

*Fiyaf trikasi* is narrative lasting roughly 9min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on September 3rd 2013, in both audio and video formats.[1] The story teller is Maembu Kwozi, and the recording took place in front of his house at Rouku village.

## 15.2 Summary & background

Maembu talks about a hunting trip that he taken the previous week. He went out hunting alone, just with his dogs. He passed several places on the other side of the Morehead River. He caught a wallaby, a goanna, and several fish.

## 15.3 Parallel text

*zrethkäfé. zyé bä kakatan matar komnzo kmam kanafré! zokwasi wzänzr daddyf. kmam kanafré!*

I will start it. You little ones here, stay quiet! Don't talk! Daddy's recording the story. Don't talk!

*zba zf zefara nama saturday. mane wiyaka burä. ŋathanzo thäsa. tosai ŋame bana zräkoré nima wiyak gastolr. wiyak kafar swäyé. krärité boba wazi. watik ŋathaf we ane we kwathofikwrm. watik, nzä we kränbrimé. ŋatha ane we srenfafa. sübrüzrm non. ybrüza fiyé. wati kräziré nima süfi frfo. wati foba we fof krafare. watik kma yisza yisza. keke. watik krefaré. wiyak e ftrsam.*

I left here the day before yesterday, on Saturday. As I got walking, I called the dogs. I told the baby's mother that I am going this way for Gastol fish. I walked to the big canoe place and went across. One of the dogs was romping around. I came back and grabbed it and dumped the dog in the water. Then I threw it up on the floating grass. Then I got going from

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20130903-03. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189913

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*fä kma srämonesé. keke. watik zefara. foba fof krefaré. wiyak e büdisn. büdisn fä threkarisé stevené. watik stevené ane bänemr gastolr kwafrzrmth fof. nafa foba woszrth. nzefé keke thärfitfa. nzä mothenzo.*

there. On the other side, I called him and called him, but nothing happened. Then I made my way to *Fétérsam*. I waited there for some while, but the dog didn't show up. I set off again. I walked until *Büdisén*. At *Büdisén*, I heard Steven and the others. They were catching fish with poison-root. They called out for me, but I didn't not answer them. I just kept walking.

*wiyak e mäbri fä kwräzik fzenzo. fzen wiyak e deya ŋathayé zrefafth. zrefafth fof. wati wfrthrth. yatr wrära. krefaré. foba wiyak e nä ttfö fäth fä wthn thden. mäbri fz nima wnkurwr. ŋanbrigwr. bömät fr nima boba wazi ŋabrigwro. ane thden ttfö fä wthn. watik dö fä samara. watik dö ane nzefé bäne srethkäfé rsoknsi fof. kwot kräthb bafen yfön fof. nzä kräthfé. nabi thräziné. wämne yfarwa fiyé. yaka yafiyokwr. aneme tharisi srethkäfé. ytharinza fyé. nima ane sremaré zyé. we kwot ytharinza fiyé. watik mrrab katan yrtmakwé fyé. watik aneme sfnagunzrm. ynagunza e dö bä kränmätr. watik, kränmätr. naifa zan dö sräkwré zyé. zane naifame zf zrä. watik kräthfé. fobo fof nabi mä ethn. wiyak dö sräziné. yatr yräré fyé. baiken ythorthé. nabinzo threrafinzé. buay krefaré.*

I went up until *Mämbri* and turned into the forest there. As I was walking in the forest and the dogs caught a wallaby. They held it and killed it. I made a carrying stick and then continued on. There is another small creek in the middle that divides *Mämbri* forest and comes back this way. *Bömät Fér* is located on the other side. There is a creek in between. I saw a goanna there and began to chase it. It went inside a hole. I walked there and put my bow on the side. I cut a stick for poking into the hole. I started digging like this for the goanna. I poked into it and I saw the goanna there. Then I cut a small bamboo and tried to stab it. I stabbed it and the goanna came out. It came out and I killed it with this bushknife here. Then I went to where the bow was lying and I started walked again. I put down the goanna and slinged it to the carrying stick. I put it in the bag. I put the bow on my the shoulder and continued walking.

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*wiyak e bömät fr. fzenzo kwofiyakm e rusa ŋathayé zräkothmth. rusa nima krämätro. ŋathanzo we kranbrimth. wiyak e krärsöfätho watik ttfön. baiknzo thrämiré. dökarä fof thrämiré ferä. gastolr fä kma kwarenzrm e stevenane yam we sramaré "oh z swaniyak zane." watik kränbrimé. sukufanzo ekenwé. buay krefaré. wiyak e nä töna kresöbätho. krärsöfäthé. kresöbätho mdüfi tönafo fof. watik nä ttfö katan fä wthn. sazäthifa zwänthma. watik fä fof thremaré gastor fof. totme kma nnz ŋanagunzé, keke. naifanzo zrefafé .naifame ane kwartmakwrm. edawä thrartmé. watik nima kräziré ane edawä gastor tönafo. watik we kwot ŋafnza e kwot thräkwré. gastor tüfrwä ethawä thräkwré. watik buyak we ttfö ane zräbrmé. nimame, keke, nomär rä. kränbrimé fobo fof mobo nabi thfthnm. kwim ŋad yfkathé fyé. yatrme erära ethorthé ferä. nabin thrämiré. krenfaré.*

I walked to *Bömät Fér*. As I was walking in the forest, the dogs were chasing a deer, but it escaped out of the forest and the dogs came back. I continued walking down. I hung up the bag with the goanna and all those things over there. I looked around for gastol fish. I saw Steven and their footprints and thought "Oh, they came here already." So I turned around. First, I rolled a smoke, then I departed. I walked up to the high ground, came down and went up again to the high ground at *Méndüfi*. There is another small creek there that's going to *Sazäthi*. I saw gastol fish there. I tried to spear it without success. I took my bushknife and I cut through the water with the knife. I caught two fish. I threw the two fish on the ground and killed them properly. Then I followed the creek upstream up until there was no more water in it. Then I returned to the place where the bow was lying. I cut some of the bushrope. I slinged those things and put the fish in the bag and hung it on the bow. I set off.

*waniyak e fobo fof bänefo ttföfo nä ttföfo. sazäthima kerwä wnrä. bäne wkonzrth, fidath fr ttfö. fidath zfth ttfö. watik fä fof sramaré we stevenane yam. "oh, zä naf thufrzro." watik wiyak nzä thdösnzo enwakunzé. ferä enfkathé. mni ŋathomonwé. tabeta erafigwé ferä. watik mrraben ertmakwé. gastol ane ewäthwé ferä. drid efkatha. gastol ewäthwé. thräbthé. tabetafo erafigwa. dö we yfränzé fyé. ykwathé.*

I came to that place, whatisname, to the other creek. It's at the end of *Sazäthi* creek. What's it called? *Findath Fér* or *Findath Zéféth* creek. I saw Steven's footprints there and thought "Oh, he must have caught fish here already." So I collected some tree bark. I peeled off the bark and piled up firewood. I put a grill over the fire. I cut the small bamboo and tied up the gastol fish. I took off the scales

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*tabetan yrafigwé. biskar äsinzé ferä. thräbthé. watik ane yrsi threthkäfé. thurwrm. komnzo thukwthenzrm. ane gastol fof dö fyé. watik enfthakwr. näbinzo gastol zräbthé. watik gastol-ane wrbé bänefa mrrabfa. zräziné. karesa yfkathé. fobo zräziné. watik dagon threthkäfé biskar. gastol ane fof thwanathrm. watik dö kerwä zrärfé. ane wänatha frä. efoth bä sfrärm "oh zizi fefe". yakme ane änathé ferä. thräbthé. krärsöfäthé we ttföfo. no ŋonathé frä. kränbrimé sukufanzo eknwé.*

and tied it up. Then I put it on the grill. I also burned off the skin of the goanna and cut it into pieces. I put it on the grill as well. I cooked some cassawas. Then I began scraping the cassawa tubers. While I was scraping them, I kept turning those gastol fish. The goanna was on the other side. I took them out of the fire. Only one gastol fish was done. I took the gastol fish out of the bamboo case. I put it down, peeled the bark and put it beside. I started eating the cassawa, and the gastol fish. I knocked off the tail of the goanna and ate it. The sun was about there and I thought "Oh, it's getting late." I ate up the fish quickly and finished all. I went down to the creek and drank some water there. I came back and rolled my tobacco.

*yatrme eräré. yatr krärgé. nabi threnrafinzé. buay. krenfaré. waniyak e mäbri fz. waniyak e ttfö kränrsöfäthé mäbri ttfö. nor bobo check kräré, keke. watik foba krenfare. waniyak e büdisen töna krensöbäthé. dagu zthk edawä thragarfé. baiken thrathbé. buay. krenfaré. waniyak e büdisn kwräthor. ŋafothakwé. nabi thräziné. no ŋonathé fwrä. buay. krenfaré nabi yatr ane. threnfafé. waniyak e büdisn. watik, büdisnen fä kma check kräré, keke. fi z nima ŋafarkwath kanathrfo. steven foba zefara. kakatan nimame zenfarath. watik nzä bunrä thrma. thrma kwanbragwrm waniyak e ftrsam. srikane mnz mänwä wwägr. watik fä fof zbär zwänfonza. we zbär ane kwa-*

I put the things on the carrying stick. I slinged them and put then on bow. Then I rushed off. I came back to *Mämbri* forest. I walked down to *Mämbri* creek and checked for water. But there wasn't any. I set off from there and came to *Büdisén*. I went up to the high ground. I broke off two banksia flowers and put them in the bag. I rushed off and came to *Büdisén*. I took off the bags and put down the bow. I drank water over there. I walked with the bow and carrying stick in my hand and came to *Büdisén*. I checked there for Steven and his family, but they weren't there. They had left already for *Kanathér*. Steven went from here and the children came this way.

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*niyakm e kafar swäyé. ŋatha fä kma we kwanorm. ane ŋatha mane ybrüzako. fä kma sfszrm keke. watik gardan krentharufé. ŋatha kratharufth. watik garda sränrifthé. ŋanrafinzé ŋe kränrité zba wazi. watik sukufanzo eknwé. buay krefaré.*

So I came too late. I followed them until I came to *Fétérsam*. Srik's house is here. The night caught up with me there. I arrived at the large canoe site in the dark. I called the dog that I thrown in the water earlier in the day. I called, but without success. So I got into the canoe with the other two dogs. Then I pushed out the canoe out and paddled across to the other side. I rolled a cigarette and set off.

*waniyak e zwrä. kwräthor mnz. ŋathama thräsé. nafaŋame zräsa fof. "ŋatha z santhor?" "zbo zyé. zafe fi mane santhor." nzefé nima "ane ŋatha bä nzwathofikwr. watik anema nzibrüzé. bobo watik ane wtrime fi ŋatha zanmath nima." watik nzä ŋafothakwé bana. krämsé.*

I came here. I arrived at the house. I asked them about the dog. I asked the mother "Did the dog show up here?" She replied "This one arrived earlier." I explained: "That dog was mucking around there and that's why I pushed him under water. He ran here in fear." Then I unloaded the things and took a rest.

*watik nimame trikasi zfrä brä. eso kafar.*

That was the story. Thank you very much.

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## 15.4 Glossed text

(1) *zrethkäfé*
zre\thkäf/é
1SG:IRR:PFV\start
'I will start it.'

(2) *zyé bä kakatan matar komnzo kmam kanafré*
z=\yé/ bä ka~katan matar komnzo kmam
PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be MED REDUP~small silence only APPR
ka\naf/ré
2SG:IMP:IPFV\talk
'You little ones here, stay quiet! Don't talk!'[2]

(3) *zokwasi wzänzr daddyf*
zokwasi w\zä/nzr daddy=f
speech 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\carry father=ERG.SG
'Daddy's recording the story.'

(4) *kmam kanafré*
kmam ka\naf/ré
APPR 2SG:IMP:IPFV\talk
'Don't talk!'

(5) *zba zf zefara nama saturday*
zba zf ze\far/a nama saturday
PROX:ABL ABSC SG:PST:PFV\set_off two_days_away saturday
'I left here the day before yesterday, on Saturday.'

(6) *mane wiyaka burä ŋathanzo thäsa*
mane w\yak/a b=wo\rä/ ŋatha=nzo
which 1SG:PST:IPFV\walk MED=1SG:NPST:IPFV\be dog=ONLY
thä\s/a
SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\call
'As I got walking, I called the dogs.'

(7) *tosai ŋame bana zräkoré nima wiyak gastolr*

[2]He talks to his children who are making noise.

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tosai ŋame bana zrä\kor/é nima
baby mother pitiful 1SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\speak like_this
w\yak/ gastol=r
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk fish_species=PURP
'I told the baby's mother that I am going this way for Gastol fish.'[3]

(8) *wiyak kafar swäy*
w\yak/ kafar swäy
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk big canoe_place
'I walked to the big canoe place'

(9) *krärité boba wazi*
krä\rit/é boba wazi
1SG:IRR:PFV\cross MED:ABL side
'and went across.'

(10) *watik ŋathaf we ane we kwathofikwrm*
watik ŋatha=f we ane we kwa\thofik/wrm
then dog=ERG.SG also DEM also SG:PST:DUR\disturb
'One of the dogs was romping around.'

(11) *watik, nzä we kränbrimé ŋatha ane we srenfafa sübrüzrm non ybrüza fiyé*
watik nzä we krän\brim/é ŋatha ane we
then 1SG.ABS also 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\return dog DEM also
sren\faf/a sü\brüz/rm no=en
SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV:VENT\hold SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\submerge water=LOC
y\brüz/a f=\yé/
SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\submerge DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'I came back and grabbed it, and dumped the dog in the water.'

(12) *wati kräziré nima süfi frfo*
wati krä\zir/é nima süfi fr=fo
then 1SG:IRR:PFV\throw like_this floating_grass post=ALL
'Then I threw it up on the floating grass.'

(13) *wati foba we fof krafare*
wati foba we fof kra\far/e
then DIST:ABL also EMPH 1DU:IRR:PFV\set_off
'Then got going from there.'

[3] *gastol* 'striped snakehead' (*Channa striata*) is an invasive species in the region.

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(14) *watik kma yisza yisza keke*
watik kma yi\sz/a yi\sz/a keke
then POT SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\call SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\call NEG
'On the other side, I called him and called him, but nothing happened.'

(15) *watik krefaré wiyak e ftrsam*
watik kre\far/é w\yak/ e ftrsam
then 1SG:IRR:PFV\set_off 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk until Ftrsam
'Then I set off and walked to Fétérsam.'

(16) *fä kma srämonesé keke*
fä kma srä\mones/é keke
DIST POT 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\wait NEG
'I waited there for some while, but but the dog didn't show up.'

(17) *watik zefara*
watik ze\far/a
then SG:PST:PFV\set_off
'I set off again.'

(18) *foba fof krefaré wiyak e büdisn*
foba fof kre\far/é w\yak/ e büdisn
DIST:ABL EMPH 1SG:IRR:PFV\set_off 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk until Büdisn
'I walked until Büdisén.'

(19) *büdisn fä threkarisé stevené*
büdisn fä thre\karis/é steven=é
Büdisn DIST 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hear Steven=ABS.NSG
'At Büdisén, I heard Steven and the others.'

(20) *watik stevené ane bänemr gastolr kwafrzrmth fof*
watik steven=é ane bäne=mr gastol=r
then Steven=ABS.NSG DEM PH=PURP fish_species=PURP
kwa\frz/rmth fof
2|3PL:PST:DUR\poison_root_fishing EMPH
'They were catching fish with poison-root.'

(21) *nafa foba woszrth*
nafa foba wo\sz/rth
3NSG.ERG DIST:ABL 2|3PL>1SG:NPST:IPFV\call
'They called out for me,'

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(22) *nzefé keke thärfitfa*
nzefé keke thä\rfitf/a
1SG.ERG.EMPH NEG SG>2|3PL:PST:PFV\answer
'but I didn't not answer them.'

(23) *nzä mothenzo*
nzä moth=en=nzo
1SG.ABS path=LOC=ONLY
'I just kept walking.'

(24) *wiyak e mäbri fä kwräzik fzenzo*
w\yak/ e mäbri fä kwrä\zik/
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk until Mäbri DIST 1SG:IRR:PFV\turn_off
fz=en=nzo
forest=LOC=ONLY
'I went up until Mämbri and turned into the forest there.'

(25) *fzen wiyak e deya ŋathayé zrefafth*
fz=en w\yak/ e deya ŋatha=é
forest=LOC 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk until forest_wallaby dog=ERG.NSG
zre\faf/th
2|3PL>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\hold
'As I was walking in the forest and the dogs caught a wallaby.'

(26) *zrefafth fof*
zre\faf/th fof
2|3PL>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\hold EMPH
'They held it and'

(27) *wati wfrthrth*
wati w\fr/thrth
then 2|3PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\bite
'then they killed it.'

(28) *yatr wrära krefaré*
yatr w\rä/ra kre\far/é
carrying_stick SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\do 1SG:IRR:PFV\set_off
'I made a carrying stick and I set off.'

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(29) *foba wiyak e*
foba w\yak/ e
DIST:ABL 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk until
'I walked further.'

(30) *nä ttfö fäth fä wthn thden*
nä ttfö fäth fä w\thn/ thd=en
INDF creek DIM DIST 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\lie_down middle=LOC
'There is another small creek in the middle'

(31) *mäbri fz nima wnkurwr ŋanbrigwr*
mäbri fz nima wn\kur/wr
Mäbri forest like_this 2|3SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\split
ŋan\brig/wr
2|3SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\return
'that divides Mämbri forest and comes back this way.'

(32) *bömät fr nima boba wazi ŋabrigwro*
bömät fr nima boba wazi ŋa\brig/wro
tree_species post like_this MED:ABL side SG:NPST:IPFV:AND\return
'Bömät Fér is located on the other side.'

(33) *ane thden ttfö fä wthn*
ane thd=en ttfö fä w\thn/
DEM middle=LOC creek DIST 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\lie_down
'There is a creek in between.'

(34) *watik dö fä samara*
watik dö fä sa\mar/a
then monitor_lizard DIST SG>3SG.M:PST:PFV\see
'I saw a goanna there.'

(35) *watik dö ane nzefé bäne srethkäfé rsoknsi fof*
watik dö ane nzefé bäne sre\thkäf/é
then monitor_lizard DEM 1SG.ERG.EMPH PH.ABS 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\start
rsokn-si fof
shock-NMLZ EMPH
'I began to chase the goanna.'

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(36) *kwot kräthb bafen yfön fof*
kwot krä\thb/ baf=en yfö=en fof
properly SG:IRR:PFV\enter PH=LOC hole=LOC EMPH
'It went inside a hole.'

(37) *nzä kräthfé nabi thräziné*
nzä krä\thf/é nabi thrä\zin/é
1SG.ABS 1SG:IRR:PFV\walk bow 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\put_down
'I walked there and put my bow on the side.'

(38) *wämne yfarwa fiyé yaka yafiyokwr*
wämne y\far/wa f=\yé/ yaka
tree SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\fell DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be digging_stick
ya\fiyok/wr
2|3SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\make
'I cut a stick for poking (into the hole).'

(39) *aneme tharisi srethkäfé*
ane=me thari-si sre\thkäf/é
DEM=INS dig-NMLZ 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\start
'I started digging for the goanna.'

(40) *ytharinza fyé*
y\thari/nza f=\yé/
SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\dig DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'I poked into it'

(41) *nima ane sremaré zyé*
nima ane sre\mar/é z=\yé/
like_this DEM 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\see PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'and I saw (the goanna) there.'

(42) *we kwot ytharinza fiyé*
we kwot y\thari/nza f=\yé/
also properly SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\dig DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'I poked some more.'

(43) *watik mrrab katan yrtmakwé fyé*

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watik mrrab katan y\rtmak/wé
then small_bamboo small 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\cut
f=\yé/
DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'Then I cut a small bamboo'

(44) *watik aneme sfnagunzrm*
watik ane=me sf\nagu/nzrm
then DEM=INS SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\poke
'and tried to stab it.'

(45) *ynagunza e dö bä kränmätr*
y\nagu/nza e dö bä
SG>3SG.M:PST:IPFV\poke until monitor_lizard MED
krän\mätr/
2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\exit
'I stabbed it and the goanna came out.'

(46) *watik, kränmätr naifa zan dö sräkwré zyé*
watik krän\mätr/ naifa zan dö
then 2|3SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\exit bushknife fight monitor_lizard
srä\kwr/é z=\yé/
1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\hit PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'It came out and I killed it with the bushknife,'

(47) *zane naifame zf zrä*
zane naifa=me zf z=\rä/
DEM:PROX bushknife=INS ABSC PROX=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'with this bushknife here.'

(48) *watik kräthfé fobo fof nabi mä ethn*
watik krä\thf/é fobo fof nabi mä
then 1SG:IRR:PFV\walk DIST:ALL EMPH bow where
e\thn/
2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\lie_down
'Then I went to where the bow was lying and'

(49) *wiyak dö sräziné yatr yräré fyé*

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w\yak/ dö srä\zin/é
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk monitor_lizard 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\put_down
yatr y\rä/ré f=\yé/
carrying_stick 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\do DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'I started walked again. I put down the goanna and slinged it to the carrying stick.'

(50) *baiken ythorthé*
baik=en y\thor/thé
bag=LOC 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\enter
'I put it in the bag.'

(51) *nabinzo threrafinzé buay krefaré*
nabi=nzo thre\rafinz/é buay
bow=ONLY 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\put_on_top running_away
kre\far/é
1SG:IRR:PFV\set_off
'I put the bow my the shoulder and set off.'

(52) *wiyak e bömät fr*
w\yak/ e bömät fr
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk until tree_species post
'I walked to Bömät Fér.'

(53) *fzenzo kwofiyakm e rusa ŋathayé zräkothmth*
fz=en=nzo kwof\yak/m e rusa ŋatha \yé/
forest=LOC=ONLY 1SG:PST:DUR\walk until deer dog 3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
zrä\kothm/th
2|3PL>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\chase
'As I was walking in the forest, the dogs were chasing a deer.'

(54) *rusa nima krämätro ŋathanzo we kranbrimth*
rusa nima krä\mätr/o ŋatha=nzo we
deer like_this SG:IRR:PFV:AND\exit dog=ONLY also
kran\brim/th
2|3DU:IRR:PFV:VENT\return
'But the deer escaped out of the forest and the dogs came back.'

(55) *wiyak e krärsöfätho watik ttfön*

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w\yak/ e krä\rsöfäth/o watik ttfö=en
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk until SG:IRR:PFV:AND\descend then creek=LOC
'I continued walking down'

(56) *baiknzo thrämiré*
watik ttfö=en baik=nzo thrä\mir/é
then creek=LOC bag=ONLY 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hang
'I hung up the bag'

(57) *dökarä fof thrämiré ferä*
dö=karä fof thrä\mir/é
monitor_lizard=PROP EMPH 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hang
f=e\rä/
DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'with the goanna and all those things over there.'

(58) *gastolr fä kma kwarenzrm e stevenane yam we sramaré oh z swaniyak zane*
gastol=r fä kma kwa\re/nzrm e steven=ane yam
fish_species=PURP DIST POT 1SG:PST:DUR\look until Steven=POSS.SG event
we sra\mar/é oh z swan\yak/ zane
also 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\see oh IAM 3SG.M:RPST:IPFV:VENT\come DEM:PROX
'I looked around for gastol fish. I saw Steven and their footprints (and said) "Oh, they came here already."'

(59) *watik kränbrimé sukufanzo ekenwé*
watik krän\brim/é sukufa=nzo e\kn/wé
then 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\return tobacco=ONLY 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\roll
'So I returned and rolled a smoke.'

(60) *buay krefaré*
buay kre\far/é
running_away 1SG:IRR:PFV\set_off
'Then I departed.'

(61) *wiyak e nä töna kresöbätho*
w\yak/ e nä töna kre\söbäth/o
1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk until INDF high_ground SG:IRR:PFV:AND\ascend
'I walked up to the high ground.'

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(62) *krärsöfäthé kresöbätho mdüfi tönafo fof*
krä\rsöfäth/é kre\söbäth/o mdüfi töna=fo
1SG:IRR:PFV\descend SG:IRR:PFV:AND\ascend Mdüfi high_ground=ALL
fof
EMPH
'I went down and went up again to the high ground at Méndüfi.'

(63) *watik nä ttfö katan fä wthn sazäthifa zwänthma*
watik nä ttfö katan fä w\thn/ sazäthi=fa
then INDF creek small DIST 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\lie_down Sazäthi=ABL
zwän\thn/a
3SG.F.IO:PST:IPFV:VENT\lie_down
'There is another small creek there that's going to Sazäthi.'

(64) *watik fä fof thremaré gastor fof*
watik fä fof thre\mar/é gastol fof
then DIST EMPH 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\see fish_species EMPH
'I saw gastol fish there.'

(65) *totme kma nnz ŋanagunzé keke*
tot=me kma n nz=ŋa\nagu/nzé keke
spear=INS POT IMN IPST=1SG:NPST:IPFV\poke NEG
'I tried to spear it without success.'

(66) *naifanzo zrefafé naifame ane kwartmakwrm*
naifa=nzo zre\faf/é naifa=me ane kwa\rtmak/wrm
bushknife=ONLY 1SG:IRR:PFV\hold bushknife=INS DEM SG:PST:DUR\cut
'I took my bushknife and I cut through the water with the knife.'

(67) *edawä thrartmé*
eda=wä thra\rt/mé
two=EMPH 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\cut
'I caught two fish.'

(68) *watik nima kräziré ane edawä gastor tönafo*
watik nima krä\zir/é ane eda=wä gastol
then like_this 1SG:IRR:PFV\throw DEM two=EMPH fish_species
töna=fo
high_ground=ALL
'I threw the two fish on the ground'

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(69) *watik we kwot ŋafnza e*
watik we kwot ŋa\fn/za e
then also properly SG:PST:IPFV\hit until
'and killed them properly.'

(70) *kwot thräkwré gastor tüfrwä ethawä thräkwré*
kwot thrä\kwr/é gastor tüfr=wä etha=wä
properly 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hit fish_species plenty=EMPH three=EMPH
thrä\kwr/é
1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hit
'I caught some more gastol fish.'

(71) *watik buyak we ttfö ane zräbrmé nimame*
watik b=w\yak/ we ttfö ane
then MED=1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk also creek DEM
zrä\bram/é nima=me
1SG>3SG.F:RPST:PFV\follow like_this=INS
'Then I followed the creek upstream'

(72) *keke nomär rä*
keke no=mär \rä/
NEG water=PRIV 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'up until there was no more water in it.'

(73) *kränbrimé*
krän\brim/é
1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\return
'Then I returned'

(74) *fobo fof*
fobo fof
DIST:ALL EMPH
'to the place'

(75) *mobo nabi thfthnm*
mobo nabi thf\thn/m
where.ALL bow 2|3PL:PST:DUR\lie_down
'where the bow was lying.'

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(76) *kwim ŋad yfkathé fyé*
kwim ŋad y\fkath/é f=\yé/
tree_species rope 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\peel DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'I cut some of the bushrope.'

(77) *yatrme erära ethorthé ferä*
yatr=me e\rä/ra e\thor/thé
carrying_stick=INS SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\do 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\carry
f=e\rä/
DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'I slinged those things and put the in the bag'

(78) *nabin thrämiré*
nabi=en thrä\mir/é
bow=LOC 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\hang
'and hung it on the bow.'

(79) *krenfaré*
kren\far/é
1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off
'I set off.'

(80) *waniyak e fobo fof bänefo ttföfo nä ttföfo*
wan\yak/ e fobo fof bäne=fo ttfö=fo nä
1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come until DIST:ALL EMPH PH=ALL creek=ALL INDF
ttfö=fo
creek=ALL
'I came to that place, whatisname, to the other creek.'

(81) *sazäthima kerwä wnrä*
sazäthi=ma ker=wä wn\rä/
Sazäthi=CHAR tail=EMPH 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be
'It's at the end of Sazäthi creek.'

(82) *bäne wkonzrth*
bäne w\ko/nzrth
PH.ABS 2|3PL>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\speak
'What's it called?'

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(83) *fidath fr ttfö fidath zfth ttfö*
fidath fr ttfö fidath zfth ttfö
tree_species post creek tree_species tree_base creek
'Findath Fér or Findath Zéféth creek.'

(84) *watik fä fof sramaré we stevenane yam*
watik fä fof sra\mar/é we steven=ane yam
then DIST EMPH 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV\see also Steven=POSS.SG footprint
'I saw Steven's footprints there (and thought)'

(85) *"oh zä naf thufrzro"*
oh zä naf thu\frz/ro
oh PROX 3SG.ERG SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV:AND\poison_root_fishing
'"Oh, he must have caught fish here already."'

(86) *watik wiyak nzä thdösnzo enwakunzé ferä enfkathé*
watik w\yak/ nzä thdös=nzo
then 1SG:NPST:IPFV\walk 1SG.ABS bark_type=ONLY
en\waku/nzé f=e\rä/
1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\pick_up DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
en\fkath/é
1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\peel
'So I walked on and collected some tree bark. I peeled them off'

(87) *mni ŋathomonwé*
mni ŋa\thomon/wé
firewood 1SG:NPST:IPFV\make_fire
'and piled up firewood.'

(88) *tabeta erafigwé ferä*
tabeta e\rafig/wé f=e\rä/
grill 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\put_on_top DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'I put a grill over the fire.'

(89) *watik mrraben ertmakwé*
watik mrrab=en e\rtmak/wé
then small_bamboo=LOC 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\cut
'I cut the small bamboo and'

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(90) *gastol ane ewäthwé ferä drid efkatha*
gastol ane e\wäth/wé
fish_species DEM 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\tie_around
f=e\rä/ drid e\fkath/a
DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be scales SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\peel
'tied up the gastol fish. I took off the scales and'

(91) *gastol ewäthwé thräbthé*
gastol e\wäth/wé thrä\bth/é
fish_species 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\tie_around 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\finish
'tied it up.'

(92) *tabetafo erafigwa*
tabeta=fo e\rafig/wa
grill=ALL SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\put_on_top
'Then I put it on the grill.'

(93) *dö we yfränzé fyé ykwathé*
dö we y\frä/nzé
monitor_lizard also 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\singe_off
f=\yé/ \ykwa/thé
DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\cut_meat
'I also burned off the skin of the goanna and cut it into pieces.'

(94) *tabetan yrafigwé*
tabeta=en y\rafig/wé
grill=LOC 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\put_on_top
'I put it on the grill as well.'

(95) *biskar äsinzé ferä thräbthé*
biskar ä\si/nzé f=e\rä/
cassava 1SG>2|3PL.IO:NPST:IPFV\cook DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
thrä\bth/é
1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\finish
'I cooked some cassawas.'

(96) *watik ane yrsi threthkäfé*
watik ane yr-si thre\thkäf/é
then DEM scrape-NMLZ 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\start
'Then I began scraping the cassawa tubers.'

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(97) *thurwrm komnzo thukwthenzrm ane gastol fof*
thu\r/wrm komnzo thu\kwthe/nzrm ane
SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\scrape only SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\change DEM
gastol fof
fish_species EMPH
'While I was scraping them, I kept turning those gastol fish.'

(98) *dö fyé*
dö f=\yé/
monitor_lizard DIST=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be
'The goanna was on the other side.'

(99) *watik enfthakwr näbinzo gastol zräbthé*
watik en\fthak/wé näbi=nzo gastol
then SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\take_out one=ONLY fish_species
zrä\bth/é
1SG:IRR:PFV\finish
'I took them out of the fire. Only one gastol fish was done.'

(100) *watik gastolane wrbé bänefa mrrabfa*
watik gastol ane w\rbä/é bäne=fa
then fish_species POSS.SG 1SG>3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\untie PH=ABL
mrrab=fa
small_bamboo=ABL
'I took the gastol fish out of the bamboo case.'

(101) *zräziné karesa yfkathé fobo zräziné*
zrä\zin/é karesa y\fkath/é
1SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\put_down paperbark 1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\peel
fobo zrä\zin/é
DIST:ALL 1SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\put_down
'I put it down, peeled the bark and put it beside.'

(102) *watik dagon threthkäfé biskar*
watik dagon thre\thkäf/é biskar
then food 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\start cassava
'I started eating the cassawa,'

(103) *gastol ane fof thwanathrm watik dö kerwä zrärfé ane wänatha frä*

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gastol ane fof thwa\na/thrm watik dö
fish_species DEM EMPH SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\eat then monitor_lizard
ker=wä zrä\rf/é ane wä\na/tha
tail=EMPH 1SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\knock DEM SG>3SG.F:PST:IPFV\eat
f=\rä/
DIST=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'and the gastol fish. I knocked off the tail of the goanna and ate it.'

(104) *efoth bä sfrärm oh zizi fefe*
efoth bä sf\rä/rm oh zizi fefe
sun MED 3SG.M:PST:DUR\be oh afternoon really
'The sun was about there (and I thought) "Oh, it's getting late."'

(105) *yakme ane änathé ferä thräbthé*
yakme ane ä\na/thé f=e\rä/
quickly DEM 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\eat DIST=2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
thrä\bth/é
1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\finish
'I ate up the fish quickly and finished all.'

(106) *krärsöfäthé we ttföfo*
krä\rsöfäth/é we ttfö=fo
1SG:IRR:PFV\descend also creek=ALL
'I went down to the creek and'

(107) *no ŋonathé frä*
no ŋo\na/thé f=\rä/
water 1SG:NPST:IPFV\drink DIST=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'drank some water there.'

(108) *kränbrimé sukufanzo eknwé*
krän\brim/é sukufa=nzo e\kn/wé
1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\return tobacco=ONLY 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\roll
'I came back and rolled my tobacco.'

(109) *yatrme eräré*
yatr=me e\rä/ré
carrying_stick=INS 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\do
'I put the things on the carrying stick.'

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(110) *yatr krärgé*
yatr krä\rg/é
carrying_stick 1SG:IRR:PFV\wear
'I slinged them and'

(111) *nabi threnrafinzé*
nabi thren\rafinz/é
bow 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV:VENT\put_on_top
'put then on bow.'

(112) *buay krenfaré*
buay kren\far/é
running_away 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off
'Then I rushed off.'

(113) *waniyak e mäbri fz*
wan\yak/ e mäbri fz
1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come until Mäbri forest
'I came back to Mämbri forest.'

(114) *waniyak e ttfö kränrsöfäthé mäbri ttfö*
wan\yak/ e ttfö kräṅ\rsöfäth/é mäbri
1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come until creek 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\descend Mäbri
ttfö
creek
'I walked down to Mämbri creek and'

(115) *nor bobo check kräré keke*
no=r bobo check krä\r/é keke
water=PURP MED:ALL checking 1SG:IRR:PFV\do NEG
'checked for water. But there wasn't any.'

(116) *watik foba krenfare waniyak e büdisen töna krensöbäthé*
watik foba kren\far/é wan\yak/ e
then DIST:ABL 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off 1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come until
büdisen töna kren\söbäth/é
Büdisn high_ground 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\ascend
'I set off from there and came to Büdisén. I went up to the high ground.'

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(117) *dagu zthk edawä thragarfé baiken thrathbé*
dagu zthk eda=wä thra\garf/é baik=en
tree_species penis two=EMPH 1SG>2|3DU:IRR:PFV\break bag=LOC
thra\thb/é
1SG>2|3DU:IRR:PFV\enter
'I broke off two banksia flowers and put them in the bag.'[4]

(118) *buay krenfaré waniyak e büdisn kwräthor*
buay kren\far/é wan\yak/ e
running_away 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off 1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come until
büdisn kwrä\thor/
Büdisn 1SG:IRR:PFV\appear
'I rushed off and came to Büdisén.'

(119) *ŋafothakwé nabi thräziné*
ŋa\fothak/wé nabi thrä\zin/é
1SG:NPST:IPFV\take_off bow 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\put_down
'I took off the bags and put down the bow.'

(120) *no ŋonathé fwrä*
no ŋo\na/thé f=wo\rä/
water 1SG:NPST:IPFV\drink DIST=1SG:NPST:IPFV\be
'I drank water over there.'

(121) *buay krenfaré nabi yatr ane threnfafé waniyak e büdisn*
buay kren\far/é nabi yatr ane
running_away 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off bow carrying_stick DEM
thren\faf/é wan\yak/ e büdisn
1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV:VENT\hold 1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come until Büdisn
'I walked with the bow and carrying stick in my hand and came to Büdisén.'

(122) *watik, büdisnen fä kma check kräré keke*
watik büdisn=en fä kma check krä\r/é keke
then Büdisn=LOC DIST POT checking 1SG:IRR:PFV\do NEG
'I checked there for (Steven and his family), but they weren't there.'

[4] *dagu* 'tropical banksia' (*Banksia dentata*); *dagu zthk* lit. 'banksia penis' is the dried up inflorescence, which is used to carry fire.

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(123) *fi z nima ŋafarkwath kanathrfo*
fi z nima ŋa\fark/wath kanathr=fo
3.ABS IAM like_this 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\set_off Kanathr=ALL
'They left already for Kanathér.'

(124) *steven foba zefara kakatan nimame zenfarath*
steven foba ze\far/a ka~katan nima=me
Steven DIST:ABL SG:PST:PFV\set_off REDUP~small like_this=INS
zen\far/ath
2|3PL:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off
'Steven went from here and the children came this way.'

(125) *watik nzä bunrä thrma*
watik nzä b=won\rä/ thrma
then 1SG.ABS MED=1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be later
'So I came later.'

(126) *thrma kwanbragwrm waniyak e ftrsam*
thrma kwan\brag/wrm wan\yak/ e ftrsam
later SG:PST:DUR:VENT\follow 1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come until Ftrsam
'I followed them until I came to Fétérsam.'

(127) *srikane mnz mänwä wwägr*
srik ane mnz mä=en=wä w\wä/gr
Srik POSS.SG house where=LOC=EMPH 3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be_up_high
'Srik's house is there.'

(128) *watik fä fof zbär züänfonza*
watik fä fof zbär zwän\fonz/a
then DIST EMPH night 1SG:PST:PFV:VENT\dawn_on_sb
'The night caught up with me there.'

(129) *we zbär ane kwaniyakm e kafar swäy*
we zbär ane kwan\yak/m e kafar swäy
also night DEM 1SG:PST:DUR:VENT\come until big canoe_place
'I arrived at the big canoe site in the dark.'

(130) *ŋatha fä kma we kwanorm ane ŋatha mane ybrüzako*

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ŋatha fä kma we kwa\nor/m ane ŋatha mane
dog DIST POT also 1SG:PST:DUR\shout DEM dog which
y\brüz/ako
SG>3SG.M:RPST:PFV:AND\submerge
'I called the dog that I thrown in the water earlier in the day.'

(131) *fä kma sfszrm keke*
fä kma sf\sz/rm keke
DIST POT SG>3SG.M:PST:DUR\call NEG
'I called, but without success'

(132) *watik gardan krentharufé ŋatha kratharufth*
watik garda=en kren\tharuf/é ŋatha
then canoe=LOC 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\enter_open_cont dog
kra\tharuf/th
2|3DU:IRR:PFV\enter_open_cont
'So I got into the canoe with the two dogs.'

(133) *watik garda sränrifthé*
watik garda sräṅ\rifth/é
then canoe 1SG>3SG.M:IRR:PFV:VENT\send
'Then I pushed out the canoe out'

(134) *ŋanrafinzé ŋe kränrité zba wazi*
ŋan\rafi/nzé kräṅ\rit/é zba wazi
1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\paddle 1SG:IRR:PFV:VENT\cross PROX:ABL side
'and paddled across to the other side.'

(135) *watik sukufanzo eknwé*
watik sukufa=nzo e\kn/wé
then tobacco=ONLY 1SG>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\roll
'I rolled a cigarette'

(136) *buay krefaré*
buay kre\far/é
running_away 1SG:IRR:PFV\set_off
'and set off.'

(137) *waniyak e zwrä kwräthor mnz*

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wan\yak/ e z=wo\rä/
1SG:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come until PROX=1SG:NPST:IPFV\be
kwrä\thor/ mnz
1SG:IRR:PFV\appear house
'I came here. I arrived at the house.'

(138) *ŋathama thräsé nafaŋame zräsa fof*
ŋatha=ma thrä\s/é nafa-ŋame zrä\s/é
dog=CHAR 1SG>2|3PL:IRR:PFV\call 3.POSS-mother 1SG>3SG.F:IRR:PFV\call
fof
EMPH
'I asked them about the dog. I asked the mother'

(139) *ŋatha z santhor zbo*
ŋatha z san\thor/ zbo
dog IAM 3SG.M:RPST:PFV:VENT\appear PROX:ALL
'"Did the dog show up here?"'

(140) *zyé zafe fi mane santhor*
z=\yé/ zafe fi mane san\thor/
PROX=3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\be old 3.ABS which 3SG.M:RPST:PFV:VENT\appear
'She replied "This one arrived earlier."'

(141) *nzefé nima "ane ŋatha bä nzwathofikwr watik anema nzibrüzé bobo watik ane wtrime fi ŋatha zanmath nima"*
nzefé nima ane ŋatha bä nzwa\thofik/wr
1SG.ERG.EMPH like_this DEM dog MED 2|3SG>1SG:RPST:IPFV\disturb
'I explained: "That dog was mucking around there'

(142) *watik anema nzibrüzé bobo*
watik ane=ma nz=y\brüz/é bobo
then DEM=CHAR IPST=1SG>3SG.M:NPST:IPFV\submerge MED:ALL
'and that's why I pushed him under water.'

(143) *watik ane wtrime fi ŋatha zanmath nima"*
watik ane wtri=me fi ŋatha zan\math/ nima
then DEM fear=INS 3.ABS dog 2|3SG:RPST:PFV:VENT\run like_this
'He ran here in fear."'

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(144) *watik nzä ŋafothakwé bana*
watik nzä ŋa\fothak/wé bana
then 1SG.ABS 1SG:NPST:IPFV\take_off pitiful
'Then I unloaded the things'

(145) *krämsé*
krä\ms/é
1SG:IRR:PFV\sit
'and took a rest.'

(146) *watik nimame trikasi zfrä brä*
watik nima=me trikasi zf\rä/ b=\rä/
then like_this=INS story 3SG.F:RPST:IPFV\be MED=3SG.F:NPST:IPFV\be
'That was the story.'

(147) *eso kafar*
eso kafar
thanks big
'Thank you very much.'

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# 16 *Ausi* - The old woman

## 16.1 Introduction

*Ausi* is a narrative lasting roughly 14min. It was recorded by Christian Döhler on September 19th 2015, in video format.[1] The story is an excerpt from a longer recording session. The story teller is Lucy Néfiyam Abia, and the recording took place in her house in Rouku. Lucy was telling this story over dinner while we were sitting in the house. Her daughter Nakre and nephew Sékri were also present.

## 16.2 Summary & background

The story was prompted by a comment about Lucy's mother. Her mother was know as *ausi kamkam*, which is a nickname that means something like 'bony old woman'. Her mother had passed away during my absence a few months earlier. She must have been well over 90 years old, as she was the sole survivor of the last headhunting raid in the area.

Lucy talks about her own youth growing up in small hamlet close to Yokwa village, and later at Kanathér. Lucy's father died when she was still very young. It was her mother and another woman who took care of her and her elder sister. She describes her mother as a fierce woman who went hunting by herself killing pigs and cassowaries.

In the mid-70s, Lucy married Abia Bai and they moved to Kiunga for a few years. Abia was working there for the mining company. Later they returned to the Morehead district and lived at Kanathér, Masu and Rouku, and Lucy looked after the old woman.

The story is both a praise of her mother and an account of her own life.

[1]The original recording session for this text is labelled tci20150919-05. It is archived at: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189920

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## 16.3 Parallel text

*kwa zrethkäfé. nzä mane worera bä ŋarkwiyanza nzone kar bä rä wämnefr tfotfo. ŋars fä rä nzäwi rä. okay ane bafen ane thartharen kar katan rä. ŋazi fä ekogr. wimäs fä ekogr. nzuŋafe kwark fthé trtha sfrärm fä fof nzwamnzrm. nä kayé ŋafe fthé kwosi yara. nzone ŋameyé edanzo. ni edanzo. nä ŋafema ane nzunane rä. bä kiungan mane wämnzr. okay, nzä nezä katakatanwä kwofrärm.*

I will start now. As for me, I was born there. My village is there, close to *Wämnefér*. There is a lagoon by the river there. Okay, there is a small village on the side. There are coconuts and mango trees there. When my late father was still alive, we used to live there. One day, my father passed away and only my mothers were left, and the two of us. My big sister is from another father. She lives up in *Kiunga*. Okay, I am just a little younger.

*nä kayé nzone ŋame ausi zane zf zrä zefarake zrafo zagrmäre nima. nima zagr mission station brä. fobo fof niyaka bnrä. watik nzuŋame ane mane zfrärm fi fiyafr fthé zfyakm zane ausi zf. naf thufnzrm. naf yem thufnzrm. naf rusa thufnzrm. tauri thufnzrm. okay, fiyafr zefarake. watik ŋathayé ruga srethkäfth. funny story we rä foba fof. watik niyak niyak niyak ŋathayé ane ruga srethkäfth. amaf nzrakor "kasöbäthe" ama kwarkf. watik nzä nanyéf kwofsogm. nzä sogsi miyamr. wosogwa nima. nima zagr zf nima warfo. kwerafinz zürben. zürb fä ekogr thartharen. nzone kar ane rä zürb thartharen rä ane karesa fr. watik nanyf wosog. bänemr fof wtrima. kwerafinz frsima. kwrerafinz fi ŋasog krerafinz. ama ausi wiyak.*

One day my mother, this old woman right here, she went with me to the swamp not far away. Maybe as far as the Mission station from there. So we walked there. As for my mother, this old woman here, she went hunting. She killed animals. She hunted cassowaries. She hunted deer. She hunted wallabies. Okay, so the two of us went hunting. We were making our way, when the dogs started chasing a pig. There is a funny part in this story. Then we walked and walked and the dogs started chasing the pig. The late mother said to us: "You climb up!" My big sister lifted me up on the tree. I couldn't climb then. So she put me up, maybe up to this height. She put me up on the Zürémb tree. There stood some Zürémb trees on the side. At my place there were some Zürémb trees on the side of that paperbark grove. Then my big sister put me on top because she was afraid. She put me up

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because she was afraid that the pig might bite me. So she put me up, and she climbed up herself. But the old woman went for it.

*ama nzuŋame ane mane zfrärm srak bänethatha zfrärm. zane ausi fäth srak tmäthé. naf keke rugaane si zfamarm yemane o rusaane. fthmäsü zfyakm birame thufnzrm ane.*

My mother behaved more like a man. This little old woman had the strength of a man. She didn't care about the dangers of a cassowary, a wallaby or a pig. When she went for those, she killed them with an axe.

*ruga ane ŋathayé srethkäfth. wiyak wiyak. ŋathayé bä sunrärmth nafazawe. ausif nima kwa komnzo sfafenakwrm nima frsima. eh bira fof zäfasira ebar fefen. ruga tkwinzo krär.*

So these dogs started chasing the pig. The old woman followed them. The dogs chased it towards her. The old woman stepped aside so that the pig wouldn't bite her. She whacked it right on the head. The pig fell over and curled up.

*ni fi mane nrna nzä wthf warfo bä kwräbth. watik, nzä wth boba warfo fof kwanorm wämne warfo. ama wäniyak eda ŋamayé "mern?" "wai" naf foba nanyf zrärn. nafane yf rä nancy. "fi wth z nzwänor warfo znwäkrn komnzo" "kanrsöfäthe ruga bithn!" watik amaf bana warsörwr. nane ŋarsör krefare e bobo ruga znfo.*

We were both sitting there in the tree. I really had to go for a shit. So I was shitting from the tree top. Mother came, both mothers in fact! They asked "Where are you two?" "Hey, over here!" big sister replied. Her name is Nancy by the way. "She's just shat herself. We're up here in the tree." "You come down! The pig is lying dead over there." Then mum lifted me poor chap down. My sister came down and we went to the place where the pig was lying..

*amaf nzräkor nzrakor fof "mni kathomone! kwa yfränzre fafä kräbrime bobo mnzfo." watik monwe kwa nyak nyak nyak fobo fof ruga znfo. mni ŋagarnth amayé nanyr. wthomonth. ruga*

Mother said to us "Pile up some firewood! We will burn off the fur and then go back to the house." Then we walked around collecting firewood and then returned to pig. Mum and

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*fräsi srethkäfe. amaf ykwathr. watik krenfare we karfo. ni ane nomai fä fefe nzwamnzrm. bä fefe nzwamnzrm kwot e nane kafar zäkora. nzä nima zäkora ester brä. bunzäthe bäiane nge nima wwark. zäkora*

big sister chopped firewood. They piled up the fire and we started to burn the pig's hair off. Mum slaughtered it and we made our way back to the village. We had been living there for a long time. We were there until my sister grew older. I was as old as Ester there, as old as your namesake Bäi's daughter there. That's how old I became.

*ane ŋamyé edawä mane thfrnm fiyaf thfyanm. nä kayé fthé finzo zfyakm zane fiyafr. tauri rusa o ruga thunfnzrm. nzwanyakm nezä ni naf fof nzfamonegrnm. nä ŋame mane rera sotama rera. zane mane rera fethka kar nima mane rä. garaitama boba bräro. kakafar zakorake. nzä zänkora nima lisa brä. watik bä fefe nzfrärmo ane. watik nä kayé zäbrimake zbo karfo. kar kwark bobo räro yokwa.*

Sometimes my two mothers went hunting together. Sometimes she went hunting by herself. She hunted for wallabies, deer or pigs. The other mother then took care of us two children. The other mother was from *Sota*. But this mother here was from *Fethkakar*, from the *Garaita* side over there. We grew older and I was about as old as Lisa. We lived there until, we moved back here to this village. There is an abandoned village over there close to *Yokwa*.

*we nä kayé zefara. wiyak wiyak fz thd. yem fä srethkäf ŋathame. yem bä zanmatha. zane zwänagufa. zä fortu zfarärm kwayanthé bana. ane fof zanagufa. mane wäniyak gräme kwanrfekwrm. zä wfnza ŋathame bä fefe yem zangathifa. gräme ane zwaniyakm eh fobo fof. watik nä aman zratrif "yem bä ythn. z sunfnzé. zwänaguf mrrab bänefo. n zarnzmsa mrrab bafen." fobo bana zanagufa zane. ni ane nimame amafnzo nzumgthkrnm. amayénzo maf nä keke yakasi.*

One day she set off again. She went right in the middle of the forest and started hunting a cassowary with her dogs. The cassowary charged at her and pierced this leg. She still had a white scar, where it wounded her. When she came back, she was limping. She had killed the cassowary with the help of the dogs, but she had to leave it there. She was walking back slowly. She said to the other mother "The cassowary is lying there. I killed it already! It has pierced my leg and I almost stepped on these sharp bam-

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boos." The poor mother was wounded on the leg by the cassowary. This is how mother has provided for us, only the two mothers, no one else was helping us.

*kwot e bäne 1968. boba zenfarake. amaf nzwanrokonm. fi nane z zathaba bänwä skoron. watik nzä ane katan fäth fof nima wwark z zänkora lisa brä. ama ausif wanrokonza. nä ŋame mane rera bä boba wazi zäritako wämnefr. nä mgthkasi nanyé fä zwamonegwrm. ane nane we z kwosi yara. nzuŋafaf mane sarzafa. wati zenfarake. zäzr mnz bä rä. safs ane mothen rä nima ŋars zawe. mission school fä n nznäthbath fi keke kwot.*

Time went by until 1968. We left that place. Mum accompanied us. She enrolled my sister in school. I was still a young girl back then. I was about the same age as Lisa. The old woman accompanied me. As for the other mother, she moved to *Wämnefér*. She had an adopted son, who took care of her there. That brother has passed away already. My father had adopted him. So we departed and moved to *Zäzér Ménz*. That's on the road to *Safés*, on the side towards the river. They tried to enroll us in the Mission school, but that didn't work. So we didn't go to school.

*school ke wäfiyokwake. watik foba nznenrokafthath 68 fof. nnrera zrä. zä nzäkorth "keke zbo skul moreheadfo." wati nanyak kanathr zäritake boba. bäne mä yamnzr ben mä sfamnzrm. fä bäne mnz thfarärm dagon mnz. znsä kabe mane thfrärm nafanme dagon mnz. fobo niyaka. fobo ŋaritakwake. fä nrugra. watik schoolfo narokonzath. nzä mane kwofrärm nä kayé skulr kwofiyakm nä kayé keke. nä kayé ane ausif tokume kwofzänzrm. bobo kwäthayfm morehead station skulfo. nzone fam ke kwot thfrärm. bänethatha kwofrärm nima kunigakuniga. mane ekonzrth ra erä. bänema*

In 1968, we moved away from there. We came here. They told us "There is no school here anymore. It has moved to *Morehead*." So we came to *Kanathér* and crossed river there, where that one lives, where Ben was living. There used to be these food houses. It was accommodation for the workers there. We went across the river and we slept there. Then they enrolled us in school. I went to school on some days, but on other days I didn't. Sometimes my mother carried me there on her shoulders. She would always drop me off at *Morehead* station, at the school. I wasn't very interested in school. I was

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*fzen bä. bä nzfamnzrm ksi karen. ni keke kwot mnzen nzwamnzrm. nzone amayé bä thfamrnm mnz ksi karen. foba ane zunmätrath nima skulr. fi nanenzo z zäthba. watik naf namäme zfrärm. nzä mane kwofrärm nima fefe kwafiyokwrm ausif fof. nä kayé tokume kuzänzrm e bwrä skul. bä fefe kwamonegwrm we kwänbrimm. e watik zänbrimake kanathr. prepen fof kuzänzrm we one. two nimämä komnzo kwafiyokwrm.*

like a "wild" girl, or whatever they call those who live in the forest. We used to live in the bush. We did not live in a proper house. My mothers lived in the bush. They took me out of school. Only my big sister went and she did well in school. But it was different with me. Some days, she really had to carry me to the school. Then she waited there for me and brought me back. We returned to *Kanathér*. She was carrying me there during prep school, and in grade one, and she did the same in second grade.

*kanathren mnz erwath. fä nzwamnzrm. nzä keke maf support nima yawiyawime. nima fefe nzone mane zfrärm. zuzir zfyakm. marketr zfyakm. wati gwonyame kwosi aneme kwazänzrm. fi keke busy kwafiyokwrm nima "oh keke kwa nzä nima wäfiyokwé" fi naf nzä mon zfkonzrm. ane yam naf zwafiyokwrm. keke zokwasi nzone kwarzrm. ra zwäkorm. kwa ane nzwäfiyokwrm naf nzonema.*

They built a house in *Kanathér*, where we lived. No one supported me with money for the school fee. My mother would go fishing, she sold the fish at the market. She then used this money to buy second-hand clothes. She didn't mind doing all these things. "Oh, no problem. I will do that for her." is what she was saying. She was doing this. She always listened to me, to what I told her. She did all those things for me.

*nane mane rera skul zabtha. watik mosbi mizif zamesa nima mosbi bä zwamnzrm. watik nzänzo ane kwamonegwrm ama ausi. kwot kwot kwot kwot 1973. nze grade 6 zabtha. watik select zwäfiyothath highschoolr. kma n si zäzira maf nä keke yakasi nzun. nze ama zakora "maski kwa namrn. nima fefe namrn nzefé kwa namonegwé."*

Then my big sister finished school. A pastor from *Moresby* took her, and she stayed with him in Port *Moresby*. Then mum took care only of me up until 1973. I finished grade 6 in 1973. They selected me for high school. I looked for financial support, but nobody helped me. I told mother "Nevermind, we'll stay here. We are going to live here and I will look after you."

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*kwot eh afa boba yanra. fi bä kwabznwrm kiungan. watik party we ane funny story rä. wati bä rä party nafa wäfiyokwath bä garaitan. afa ane guitarkarä sfkogr. watik nzefé ane size swafiyokwrm "nzone kabe ane fof yé." watik kanathren ane ni nzwamnzrm. watik afa ane boba binrä. nä kayé nanyaka watik zäbrima watik. fobo bana bäne nafiyokwath fof fof nritakwath. bäiŋafe zba ynrera. oriomon bä kwabznwrm fi. oroman kwarkf zwäkora "watik naf kwa wfathwr fäms ŋarer." watik ŋanafrath bobo mane bäne ykogr wari. wari z ykonzrm? keke bä kanathren mane yé zba mäbü mä ykogr.*

Time went by until father came. He used to work in *Kiunga*. There was a party, that's another funny story. They were having a party in *Garaita*. Father was standing there with a guitar. I picked him thinking "This one will be my husband." Then we were living in *Kanathér*. Father visited us there. Other days, we went for a visit. Then he was about to return (to *Kiunga*). That was the time, when we got engaged. They exchanged us. The exchange man came from here. He was working in *Oriomo*. The late old father said to me: "Okay, he will marry her as an exchange." So they arranged everything and talked where this watchamacallit stands, that Wari tree. Do they call it Wari? No, it's the one that stands in *Kanathér* on this side, where the Mämbü tree grows.

*skiski fä äfiyokwath. garaitafa äniyaka. fäms ŋarane mrn äniyaka garaitafa. zba oroman kwarké äniyaka fäms bobo. watik fä fof maret ŋafiyokwake.*

They built a sitting platform and some people came from *Garaita*. The exchange woman's family came to *Garaita*. Their late old father and the exchange man came to this place. Then we got married there.

*wati 75 afaf zwämesa kiunga. katan ŋareŋare ane zwänmesa katan drisdriskaf. bä fthé samara nima sakorath "ra rä? nafangth rä o mon?" naf thukonzrm "keke! nzone ŋare rä." watik bä nanmza. nä ysokwr afaf bä nä ŋare wfnza. afa zane gathagatha ebar sfrärm. razé short temper! nafadben keke mistake! ane ŋare wfnza. rumginae fobo satharufath diburar. ni nima*

Then in 1975, father took me to *Kiunga*. I looked like a small girl in a dress when he brought me there. When they saw us, they wondered "Who's that? It that his small sister or what?" He told them "No, she is my wife!" Then we lived there. A year later, father had hit some woman there. Father was a bad guy then, really a short-tempered guy.

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*fefe zänbrimake. nzä zentharufa booten. kowi fof warä ra. watik nzä nima fefe zänbrima.*

You shouldn't make any mistakes with him. He had hit that woman and they took him to *Rumginae* prison. When he returned, we got on the boat to go back down the Fly River. I had some chickens and all those things which I left behind. We returned for good then.

*zä kwamnzrm karen. fobo fefe zänbrima kanathr ausidben fä fof kwofrärm. watik zena zwamnzr. nzone fam mane né bänemr erära nima schoolr. maf keke yakasinzo ane skul fee. watik anema fefe nima zägathifa. watik karen bana kwa wamnzr. okay nzone zawe ane fof rä nima kaben ra frasi yarithé. nimame warfo kabef nzä zwäfrmsa. zena nima wamnzr. ane kwanmnzr kanathr masu roku.*

I have been staying here in the village. After our return, I stayed at *Kanathér* with old mother. I've been living here until today. I was thinking of continuing school, but nobody helped with the school fee. That's really when I forgot about it and stayed in the village. My main occupation is sharing food with people in need. God has blessed me in this way. That's how I live today. I have lived at *Kanathér*, then *Masu* and now *Rouku*.

*watik z zäkoré. ausi kam we fänwä zfnrä zunfsrwrm. zbo e watik zrä bana watik. nama fof bufrukaren kwot e zane z zäbtha. nima fefe komnzo zfthnm bana.*

I have become an old woman now. But I was also taking my old mother around. She became weaker until one day she died. She passed away only recently, while you were away. In her last weeks, the poor old woman was lying down most of the time.

*watik nzone story katan rä. eso!*

That's my little story. Thank you.

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## 16.4 Glossed text

(1) *kwa zrethkäfé*
kwa zre\thkäf/é
FUT 1SG:IRR:PFV\start
'I will start now.'

(2) *nzä mane worera bä ŋarkwiyanza nzone kar bä rä*
nzä mane wo\rä/ra bä ŋa\rkwiya/nza nzone
1SG.ABS which 1SG:PST:IPFV\be MED SG:PST:IPFV\give_birth 1SG.POSS
kar bä \rä/
village MED 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'As for me, I was born there. My village is there,'

(3) *wämnefr tfotfo*
wämnefr tfotfo
PLN almost
'close to Wämnefr.'

(4) *ŋars fä rä nzäwi rä*
ŋars fä \rä/ nzäwi \rä/
river DIST 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be lagoon 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'There is a lagoon by the river there.'

(5) *okay ane bafen ane thartharen kar katan rä*
okay ane baf=en ane tharthar=en kar katan \rä/
okay DEM PH=LOC DEM beside=LOC village small 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'Okay, there is a small village on the side.'

(6) *ŋazi fä ekogr wimäs fä ekogr*
ŋazi fä e\ko/gr wimäs fä
coconut DIST 2|3PL:NPST:STAT\be_standing mango DIST
e\ko/gr
2|3PL:NPST:STAT\be_standing
'There are coconuts and mango trees there.'

(7) *nzuŋafe kwark fthé trtha sfrärm fä fof nzwamnzrm*

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nzu-ŋafe kwark fthé trtha sf\rä/rm fä fof
1SG.POSS-father deceased when life 3SGM:PST:DUR\be DIST EMPH
nzwa\m/nzrm
1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'When my late father was still alive, we used to live there.'

(8) *nä kayé ŋafe fthé kwosi yara*
nä kayé ŋafe fthé kwosi ya\r/a
INDF one_day_away father when dead 3SGM:PST:IPFV\be
'One day, my father passed away'

(9) *nzone ŋameyé edanzo*
nzone ŋame=é eda=nzo
1SG.POSS mother=ERG.NSG TWO=ONLY
'and only my mothers (were left)'

(10) *ni edanzo*
ni eda=nzo
1NSG TWO=ONLY
'and the two of us.'

(11) *nä ŋafema ane nzunane rä*
nä ŋafe=ma ane nzu-nane \rä/
INDF father=CHAR DEM 1SG.POSS-elder_sibling 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'My big sister is from another father.'

(12) *bä kiungan mane wämnzr*
bä kiunga=en mane wä\m/nzr
MED PLN=LOC which 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\sit
'She lives up in Kiunga.'

(13) *okay, nzä nezä katakatanwä kwofrärm*
okay nzä nezä kata~katan=wä kwof\rä/rm
okay 1SG.ABS in_return REDUP~small=EMPH 1SG:PST:DUR\be
'Okay, I am a just little younger.'

(14) *nä kayé nzone ŋame ausi zane zf zrä*
nä kayé nzone ŋame ausi zane zf
INDF one_day_away 1SG.POSS mother old_woman DEM:PROX ABSC
z=\rä/
PROX=3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'One day my mother, this old woman right here,'

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(15) *zefarake zrafo zagrmäre nima*
ze\far/ake zra=fo zagr=märe nima
1PL:PST:PFV\set_off swamp=ALL far=PRIV like_this
'she went with me to the swamp not far away.'

(16) *nima zagr mission station brä*
nima zagr mission station b=\rä/
like_this far mission station MED=3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'Maybe as far as the mission station from there.'

(17) *fobo fof niyaka bnrä*
fobo fof n\yak/a b=n\rä/
DIST:ALL EMPH 1PL:PST:IPFV\walk MED=2SG:NPST:IPFV\be
'So we walked there.'

(18) *watik*
watik
then
'well'

(19) *nzuŋame ane mane zfrärm*
nzu-ŋame ane mane zf\rä/rm
1SG.POSS-mother DEM which 3SGF:PST:DUR\be
'As for my mother,'

(20) *fi fiyafr fthé zfyakm zane ausi zf*
fi fiyaf=r fthé zf\yak/m zane ausi zf
3.ABS hunt=PURP when 3SGF:PST:DUR\walk DEM:PROX old_woman ABSC
'this old woman here, she went hunting.'

(21) *naf thufnzrm*
naf thu\fn/zrm
3SG.ERG SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit
'She killed (animals).'

(22) *naf yem thufnzrm*
naf yem thu\fn/zrm
3SG.ERG cassowary SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit
'She killed cassowaries.'

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(23) *naf rusa thufnzrm tauri thufnzrm*
naf rusa thu\fn/zrm tauri thu\fn/zrm
3SG.ERG deer SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit wallaby SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit
'She killed deer. She killed wallabies.'

(24) *okay, fiyafr zefarake*
okay fiyaf=r ze\far/ake
okay hunt=PURP 1PL:PST:PFV\set_off
'Okay, so the two of us went hunting.'

(25) *watik ŋathayé ruga srethkäfth*
watik ŋatha=é ruga sre\thkäf/th
then dog=ERG.NSG pig 2|3PL>3SGM:IRR:PFV\start
'The dogs started (chasing) a pig.'

(26) *funny story we rä foba fof*
funny story we \rä/ foba fof
funny story also 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be DIST:ABL EMPH
'it is also a funny bit in this story.'

(27) *watik niyak niyak niyak*
watik n\yak/ n\yak/ n\yak/
then 1PL:NPST:IPFV\walk 1PL:NPST:IPFV\walk 1PL:NPST:IPFV\walk
'Then we walked and walked'

(28) *ŋathayé ane ruga srethkäfth*
ŋatha=é ane ruga sre\thkäf/th
dog=ERG.NSG DEM pig 2|3PL>3SGM:IRR:PFV\start
'and the dogs started (chasing) the pig.'

(29) *amaf nzrakor kasöbäthe ama kwarkf*
ama=f nzra\kor/ ka\söbäth/e ama
mother=ERG.SG 2|3SG>1DU:IRR:PFV\speak 2DU:IMP:PFV\ascend mother
kwark=f
deceased=ERG.SG
'The late mother said to us: "You climb up!"'

(30) *watik nzä nanyéf kwofsogm*
watik nzä nane=f kwof\sog/wrm
then 1SG.ABS elder_sibling=ERG.SG SG>1SG:PST:DUR\ascend
'My big sister lifted up (on the tree).'

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(31) *nzä sogsi miyamr*
nzä sog-si miyamr
1SG.ABS ascend-NMLZ ignorance
'I couldn't climb.'

(32) *wosogwa nima*
wo\sog/wa nima
SG>1SG:PST:IPFV\ascend like_this
'So she put me up,'

(33) *nima zagr zf nima warfo*
nima zagr zf nima warfo
like_this far ABSC like_this above
'maybe up to this height.'

(34) *kwerafinz zürben*
kwe\rafinz/ zürb=en
2|3SG>1SG:RPST:PFV\put_on_top tree_species=LOC
'She put me up on the zürb tree.'

(35) *zürb fä ekogr thartharen*
zürb fä e\ko/gr tharthar=en
tree_species DIST 2|3PL:NPST:STAT\be_standing beside=LOC
'There stood some zürb trees standing on the side.'

(36) *nzone kar ane rä zürb thartharen rä ane karesa fr*
nzone kar ane \rä/ zürb tharthar=en
1SG.POSS place DEM 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be tree_species beside=LOC
\rä/ ane karesa fr
3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be DEM paperbark post
'At my place there were some zürb tree on the side of that paperbark grove.'

(37) *watik nanyf wosog*
watik nane=f wo\sog/wr
then elder_sibling=ERG.SG 2|3SG>1SG:NPST:IPFV\ascend
'Then my big sister put me on top'

(38) *bänemr fof wtrima*

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bäne=mr fof wtri=ma
PH=PURP EMPH fear=CHAR
'because she was afraid'

(39) *kwerafinz frsima*
kwe\rafinz/ fr-si=ma
2|3SG>1SG:RPST:PFV\put_on_top bite-NMLZ=CHAR
'She put me up because (she was afraid that the pig) might bite me.'

(40) *kwrerafinz fi ŋasog krerafinz*
kwre\rafinz/ fi ŋa\sog/wr
2|3SG>1SG:IRR:PFV\put_on_top 3.ABS 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\ascend
kre\rafinz/
2|3SG:IRR:PFV\put_on_top
'So she put me up, and she climbed up herself.'

(41) *ama ausi wiyak*
ama ausi w\yak/
mother old_woman 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\walk
'But the old woman went for it.'

(42) *ama nzuŋame ane mane zfrärm srak bänethatha zfrärm*
ama nzu-ŋame ane mane zf\rä/rm srak bäne=thatha
mother 1SG.POSS-mother DEM which 3SGF:PST:DUR\be boy PH=SIMIL
zf\rä/rm
3SGF:PST:DUR\be
'My mother behaved more like a man.'

(43) *zane ausi fäth srak tmäthé*
zane ausi fäth srak tmä-thé
DEM:PROX old_woman DIM boy strength-ADLZR
'This little old woman had the strength of a man.'

(44) *naf keke rugaane si zfamarm yemane o rusaane*
naf keke ruga=ane si zfa\mar/m yem=ane
3SG.ERG NEG pig=POSS.SG eyes SG>3SGF:ITER:DUR\see cassowary=POSS.SG
o rusa=ane
or deer=POSS.SG
'She was looking in the eyes of the pigs, cassowaries or wallabies.'

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(45) *fthmäsü zfyakm birame thufnzrm ane*
fthmäsü zf\yak/m bira=me thu\fn/zrm ane
meanwhile 3SGF:PST:DUR\walk axe=INS SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\hit DEM
'When she went for those, she killed them with an axe.'

(46) *ruga ane ŋathayé srethkäfth wiyak wiyak*
ruga ane ŋatha=é sre\thkäf/th w\yak/
pig DEM dog=ERG.NSG 2|3PL>3SGM:IRR:PFV\start 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\walk
w\yak/
3SGF:NPST:IPFV\walk
'So these dogs started chasing the pig. The old woman followed them.'

(47) *ŋathayé bä sunrärmth nafazawe*
ŋatha=é bä sun\rä/rmth nafa-zawe
dog=ERG.NSG MED 2|3PL>3SGM:PST:DUR:VENT\do 3.POSS-right
'The dogs chased it towards her.'

(48) *ausif nima kwa komnzo sfafenakwrm nima frsima*
ausi=f nima kwa komnzo
old_woman=ERG.SG like_this FUT only
sfa\fenak/wrm ane nima fr-si=ma
SG>3SGM.IO:PST:DUR\give_way DEM like_this bite-NMLZ=CHAR
'The old woman stepped aside so that the pig wouldn't bite her.'

(49) *eh bira fof zäfasira ebar fefen ruga tkwinzo krär*
eh bira fof zä\fasir/a ebar fefe=en ruga
hey axe EMPH SG:PST:PFV\make_noise head really=LOC pig
tkwi=nzo krä\r/
curving=ONLY 2|3SG:IRR:PFV\do
'She whacked it right on the head. The pig fell over and curled up.'

(50) *ni fi mane nrna nzä wthf warfo bä kwräbth*
ni fi mane n\rn/a nzä wth=f warfo bä
1NSG but which 1DU:NPST:IPFV\be 1SG.ABS faeces=ERG.SG above MED
kwrä\bth/
2|3SG>1SG:IRR:PFV\finish
'We were both sitting there in the tree. I really had to go for a shit.'

(51) *watik, nzä wth boba warfo fof kwanorm wämne warfo*

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watik nzä wth boba warfo fof kwa\nor/m wämne
then 1SG.ABS faeces MED:ABL above EMPH 1SG:PST:DUR\shout tree
warfo
above
'So I was shitting from the tree top.'

(52) *ama wäniyak eda ŋamayé*
ama wän\yak/ eda ŋama=é
mother 3SGF:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come two mother=ERG.NSG
'Mother came, both mothers in fact!'

(53) *mern*
m=e\rn/
IGNO=2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\be
'(They asked) "Where are you two?"'

(54) *"wai" naf foba nanyf zrärn*
wai naf foba nane=f zrä\rn/
hey 3SG.ERG DIST:ABL elder_sibling=ERG.SG 3SGF:IRR:PFV\shout
'"Hey, over here!" big sister replied.'

(55) *nafane yf rä nancy*
nafane yf rä nancy
3SG.POSS name 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be PN
'Her name is Nancy by the way.'

(56) *"fi wth z nzwänor warfo znwäkrn komnzo"*
fi wth z nz=wä\nor/ warfo
3.ABS faeces IAM IPST=3SGF:NPST:IPFV\shout above
z=n\wä/krn komnzo
PROX=1DU:NPST:IPFV\be_up_high only
'"She's just shat herself. We're up here in the tree."'

(57) *"kanrsöfäthe ruga bithn"*
kan\rsöfäth/e ruga b=y\thn/
1DU:IRR:PFV:VENT\descend pig MED=3SGM:NPST:IPFV\lie_down
'"You come down! The pig is lying dead over there."'

(58) *watik amaf bana warsörwr*

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watik ama=f bana wa\rsör/wr
then mother=ERG.SG pitiful 2|3SG>1SG.IO:NPST:IPFV\descend
'Then mum lifted me poor chap down.'

(59) *nane ŋarsör krefare*
nane ŋa\rsör/ kre\far/e
elder_sibling 2|3SG:NPST:IPFV\descend 1PL:IRR:PFV\set_off
'My sister came down and we walked over'

(60) *e bobo ruga znfo*
e bobo fof ruga zn=fo
until MED:ALL EMPH pig place=ALL
'to the place where the pig lay.'

(61) *amaf nzräkor nzrakor fof*
ama=f nzra\kor/ fof
mother=ERG.SG 2|3SG>1DU:IRR:PFV\speak EMPH
'Mother said to us'

(62) *mni kathomone*
mni ka\thomon/e
fire 2DU:IMP:IPFV\make_fire
'"Pile up some firewood!'

(63) *kwa yfränzre fafä kräbrime bobo mnzfo*
kwa y\frä/nzre fafä krä\brim/e bobo
FUT 1PL>3SGM:NPST:IPFV\singe_off after_that 1PL:IRR:PFV\return MED:ALL
mnz=fo
house=ALL
'We will burn off the fur and then go back to the house."'

(64) *watik monwe kwa nyak nyak nyak fobo fof ruga znfo*
watik monwe kwa n\yak/ n\yak/
then how FUT 1PL:NPST:IPFV\walk 1PL:NPST:IPFV\walk
n\yak/ fobo fof ruga zn=fo
1PL:NPST:IPFV\walk DIST:ALL EMPH pig place=ALL
'Then we walked around (collecting firewood) and then returned to pig.'

(65) *mni ŋagarnth amayé nanyr*

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mni ŋa\gar/nth ama=é nane=r
firewood 2|3DU:NPST:IPFV\break mother=ERG.NSG elder_sibling=IC.DU
'Mum and big sister chopped firewood.'

(66) *wthomonth ruga fräsi srethkäfe*
w\thomon/th ruga frä-si
2|3DU>3SGF:NPST:IPFV\make_fire pig singe_off-NMLZ
sre\thkäf/e
1PL>3SGM:IRR:PFV\start
'They piled up the fire and we started to burn the pig's hair off.'

(67) *amaf ykwathr*
ama=f y\kwath/r
mother=ERG.SG 2|3SG>3SGM:NPST:IPFV\cut_meat
'Mum slaughtered it'

(68) *watik krenfare we karfo*
watik kren\far/e we kar=fo
then 1PL:IRR:PFV:VENT\set_off also village=ALL
'and we set off back to the village.'

(69) *ni ane nomai fä fefe nzwamnzrm*
ni ane nomai fä fefe nzwa\m/nzrm
1NSG DEM HAB DIST really 1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'We lived there for a long time.'

(70) *bä fefe nzwamnzrm kwot e nane kafar zäkora*
bä fefe nzwa\m/nzrm kwot e nane kafar
MED really 1PL:PST:DUR\sit properly until elder_sibling big
zä\kor/a
SG:PST:PFV\become
'We were there until my sister grew older.'

(71) *nzä nima zäkora ester brä*
nzä nima zä\kor/a ester b=\rä/
1SG.ABS like_this SG:PST:PFV\become PN MED=3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'I was as old as Ester there,'

(72) *bunzäthe bäiane nge nima wwark*

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bu-nzäthe bäi=ane nge nima w~wark
2SG.POSS-namesake PN=POSS.SG child like_this REDUP~size
'as old as your namesake Bäi's daughter there.'

(73) *zäkora*
zä\kor/a
SG:PST:PFV\become
'(That's how old) I became.'

(74) *ane ŋamyé edawä mane thfrnm fiyaf thfyanm*
ane ŋame eda=wä mane thf\rn/m fiyaf
DEM mother two=EMPH which 2|3DU:PST:DUR\be hunt
thf\yan/m
2|3DU:PST:DUR\walk
'My two mothers went hunting together.'

(75) *nä kayé fthé finzo zfyakm zane fiyafr*
nä kayé fthé fi=nzo zf\yak/m zane
INDF one_day_away when 3.ABS=ONLY 3SGF:PST:DUR\walk DEM:PROX
fiyaf=r
hunt=PURP
'Sometimes she went hunting by herself.'

(76) *tauri rusa o ruga thunfnzrm*
tauri rusa o ruga thun\fn/zrm
wallaby deer or pig SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR:VENT\hit
'She killed wallabies, deer or pigs.'

(77) *nzwanyakm nezä ni naf fof nzfamonegrnm*
nzwan\yak/m nezä ni naf fof
1PL:PST:DUR:VENT\come in_return 1NSG 3SG.ERG EMPH
nzfa\moneg/rnm
SG>1DU:PST:DUR\wait
'The other mother then took care of us two children.'

(78) *nä ŋame mane rera sotama rera*
nä ŋame mane \rä/ra sota=ma \rä/ra
INDF mother which 3SGF:PST:IPFV\be PLN=CHAR 3SGF:PST:IPFV\be
'The other mother was from Sota.'

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(79) *zane mane rera fethka kar nima mane rä garaitama boba bräro*
zane mane \rä/ra fethka_kar nima mane
DEM:PROX which 3SGF:PST:IPFV\be PLN like_this which
\rä/ garaita=ma boba b=\rä/ro
3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be PLN=CHAR MED:ABL MED=3SGF:NPST:IPFV:AND\be
'But this mother here was from Fethkakar, from the Garaita side over there.'

(80) *kakafar zakorake nzä zänkora nima lisa brä*
ka~kafar za\kor/ake nzä zän\kor/a
REDUP~big 1DU:PST:IPFV\become 1SG.ABS SG:PST:PFV:VENT\become
nima lisa b=\rä/
like_this PN MED=3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'We grew older and I was about as old as Lisa.'

(81) *watik bä fefe nzfrärmo ane watik nä kayé*
watik bä fefe nzf\rä/rmo ane watik nä kayé
then MED really 1PL:PST:DUR:AND\be DEM then INDF one_day_away
'We lived there until,'

(82) *zäbrimake zbo karfo*
zä\brim/ake zbo kar=fo
1PL:PST:PFV\return PROX:ALL village=ALL
'we moved back here to this village.'

(83) *kar kwark bobo räro yokwa*
kar kwark bobo \rä/ro yokwa
village deceased MED:ALL 3SGF:NPST:IPFV:AND\be PLN
'There is an abandoned village over there close to Yokwa.'

(84) *we nä kayé zefara*
we nä kayé ze\far/a
also INDF one_day_away SG:PST:PFV\set_off
'One day she set off again.'

(85) *wiyak wiyak fz thd*
w\yak/ w\yak/ fz thd
3SGF:NPST:IPFV\walk 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\walk forest middle
'She went right in the middle of the forest'

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(86) *yem fä srethkäf ŋathame*
yem fä sre\thkäf/ ŋatha=me
cassowary DIST 2|3SG>3SGM:IRR:PFV\start dog=INS
'and started hunting a cassowary with her dogs.'

(87) *yem bä zanmatha zane zwänagufa*
yem bä za\math/a zane zwä\naguf/a
cassowary MED SG:PST:PFV:VENT\run DEM:PROX SG>3SGF:PST:PFV\poke
'The cassowary charged at her and pierced this (leg).'

(88) *zä fortu zfarärm kwayanthé bana*
zä fortu zfa\rä/rm kwayan-thé bana
PROX scar 3SGF.IO:PST:DUR\be light-ADLZR pitiful
'She still had a white scar,'

(89) *ane fof zanagufa*
ane fof za\naguf/a
DEM EMPH SG>3SGF:PST:PFV\poke
'where it wounded her.'

(90) *mane wäniyak gräme kwanrfekwrm*
mane wän\yak/ grä=me kwan\rfek/wrm
which 3SGF:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come slowness=INS SG:PST:DUR:VENT\limp
'When she came back, she was limping.'

(91) *zä wfnza ŋathame bä fefe yem zangathifa*
zä w\fn/za ŋatha=me bä fefe yem
PROX SG>3SGF:PST:IPFV\hit dog=INS MED really cassowary
zan\gathif/a
SG>3SGF:PST:PFV:VENT\leave
'She had killed the cassowary with the help of the dogs, but she had to leave it there.'

(92) *gräme ane zwaniyakm eh fobo fof*
grä=me ane zwan\yak/m e fobo fof
slowness=INS DEM 3SGF:PST:DUR:VENT\come until DIST:ALL EMPH
'She was walking back slowly.'

(93) *watik nä aman zratrif "yem bä ythn*

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watik nä ama=n zra\trif/ yem bä
then INDF mother=DAT.SG 2|3SG>3SGF.IO:IRR:PFV\tell cassowary MED
y\thn/
3SGM:NPST:IPFV\lie_down
'She said to the other mother "The cassowary is lying there.'

(94) *z sunfnzé zwänaguf mrrab bänefo n zarnzmsa mrrab bafen"*
z sun\fn/zé zwä\naguf/ mrrab
IAM 1SG>3SGM:PST:IPFV:VENT\hit 2|3SG>1SG:RPST:PFV\poke small_bamboo
bäne=fo n za\rnzms/a mrrab baf=en
PH=ALL IMN SG>3SGF:PST:PFV\step_on_sth small_bamboo PH=LOC
'I killed it already! It has pierced (my leg) and I almost stepped on these (sharp) bamboos.'

(95) *fobo bana zanagufa zane*
fobo bana za\naguf/a zane
DIST:ALL pitiful SG>3SGF:PST:PFV\poke DEM:PROX
'The poor mother was wounded on the leg by the cassowary.'

(96) *ni ane nimame amafnzo nzumgthkrnm*
ni ane nima=me ama=f=nzo nzu\mgthk/rnm
1NSG DEM like_this=INS mother=ERG.SG=ONLY SG>1DU:PST:DUR\feed
'This is how mother has provided for us,'

(97) *amayénzo maf nä keke yakasi*
ama=é=nzo maf nä keke yaka-si
mother=ERG.NSG=ONLY who.ERG.SG INDF NEG help-NMLZ
'only the two mothers, no other help at all.'

(98) *kwot e bäne 68*
kwot e bäne 68
properly until PH.ABS 1968
'until 1968.'

(99) *boba zenfarake*
boba zen\far/ake
MED:ABL 1PL:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off
'We left that place.'

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(100) *amaf nzwanrokonm*
ama=f nzwan\roko/nm
mother=ERG.SG SG>1DU:ITER:DUR:VENT\escort
'Mum accompanied us.'

(101) *fi nane z zathaba bänwä skoron*
fi nane z za\thb/a bänwä skoro=en
3.ABS elder_sibling IAM SG>3SGF:PST:PFV\enter MED:EMPH school=LOC
'She enrolled my sister in school.'

(102) *watik nzä ane katan fäth fof nima wwark z zänkora lisa brä*
wati nzä ane katan fäth fof nima w~wark z
then 1SG.ABS DEM small DIM EMPH like_this REDUP~size IAM
zän\kor/a lisa b=\rä/
SG:PST:PFV:VENT\become PN MED=3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'I was still a young girl back then. I was about the same age as Lisa.'

(103) *ama ausif wanrokonza*
ama ausi=f wan\roko/nza
mother old_woman=ERG.SG SG>1SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\escort
'The old woman accompanied me.'

(104) *nä ŋame mane rera bä boba wazi zäritako wämnefr*
nä ŋame mane \rä/ra bä boba wazi
INDF mother which 3SGF:PST:IPFV\be MED MED:ABL side
zä\rit/ako wämnefr
SG:PST:PFV:AND\cross PLN
'As for the other mother, she moved to Wämnefér.'

(105) *nä mgthkasi nanyé fä zwamonegwrm*
nä mgthk-si nane fä zwa\moneg/wrm
INDF feed-NMLZ elder_sibling DIST SG>3SGF:PST:DUR\wait
'She had an adopted son, who took care of her there.'

(106) *ane nane we z kwosi yara*
ane nane we z kwosi ya\r/a
DEM elder_sibling also IAM dead 3SGM:PST:IPFV\be
'That brother has passed away already.'

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(107) *nzuŋafaf mane sarzafa*
nzu ŋafe=f mane sa\rzaf/a
1SG.POSS father=ERG.SG which SG>3SGM:PST:PFV\tie
'My father had adopted him.'

(108) *wati zenfarake zäzr mnz bä rä*
wati zen\far/ake zäzr_mnz bä \rä/
then 1PL:PST:PFV:VENT\set_off PLN MED 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'So we departed and moved to Zäzér Ménz.'

(109) *safs ane mothen rä nima ŋars zawe*
safs ane moth=en \rä/ nima ŋars zawe
PLN DEM path=LOC 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be like_this river side
'That's on the road to Safés, on the side towards the river.'

(110) *mission school fä n nznäthbath fi keke kwot*
mission school fä n nznä\thb/ath fi keke kwot
mission school DIST IMN 2|3PL>1PL:PST:PFV\enter 3.ABS NEG properly
'They tried to enroll us in the Mission school, but that didn't work.'

(111) *school ke wäfiyokwake watik foba nznenrokafthath 68 fof*
school keke wä\fiyok/wake wati foba
school NEG 1PL>3SGF:PST:IPFV\make then DIST:ABL
nznen\rokofth/ath 68 fof
2|3PL>1PL:PST:PFV:VENT\escort 1968 EMPH
'So we didn't go to school. In 1968, they took us away from there.'

(112) *nnrera zrä*
nn\rä/ra z=\rä/
1PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\be PROX=3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'We came here.'

(113) *zä nzäkorth "keke zbo skul moreheadfo*
zä nzä\kor/th keke zbo skul morehead=fo
PROX 2|3PL>1PL:RPST:PFV\speak NEG PROX:ALL school PLN=ALL
'They told us "There is no school here anymore. It has moved to Morehead."'

(114) *wati nanyak kanathr zäritake boba*

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wati nan\yak/ kanathr zä\rit/ake boba
then 1PL:NPST:IPFV:VENT\come PLN 1PL:RPST:PFV\cross MED:ABL
'So we came to Kanathér and crossed river there,'

(115) *bäne mä yamnzr ben mä sfamnzrm*
bäne mä ya\m/nzr ben mä sfa\m/nzrm
PH.ABS where 3SGM:NPST:IPFV\sit PN where 3SGM:PST:DUR\sit
'where that one lives, where Ben was living.'

(116) *fä bäne mnz thfarärm dagon mnz*
fä bäne mnz thfa\rä/rm dagon mnz
DIST PH.ABS house 2|3PL.IO:PST:DUR\be food house
'There used to be these cafeteria buildings.'

(117) *znsä kabe mane thfrärm nafanme dagon mnz*
znsä kabe mane thf\rä/rm nafanme dagon mnz
work man which 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be 3NSG.POSS food house
'For those workers, their cafeteria and accommodation buildings.'

(118) *fobo niyaka fobo ŋaritakwake fä nrugra*
fobo n\yak/a fobo ŋa\ritak/wake fä
DIST:ALL 1PL:PST:IPFV\walk DIST:ALL 1PL:PST:IPFV\cross DIST
n\ru/gra
1PL:PST:IPFV\sleep
'We walk there, we went across the river and we slept there.'

(119) *watik schoolfo narokonzath*
wati school=fo na\roko/nzath
then school=ALL 2|3PL>1PL:PST:IPFV\escort
'Then they enrolled us in school.'

(120) *nzä mane kwofrärm nä kayé skulr kwofiyakm nä kayé keke*
nzä mane kwof\rä/rm nä kayé skul=r
1SG.ABS which 1SG:PST:DUR\be INDF one_day_away school=PURP
kwof\yak/m nä kayé keke
1SG:PST:DUR\walk INDF one_day_away NEG
'I went to school on some days, but on other days I didn't.'

(121) *nä kayé ane ausif tokume kwofzänzrm*

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nä kayé ane ausi=f toku=me
INDF one_day_away DEM old_woman=ERG.SG carry_piggyback=INS
kwof\zä/nzrm
SG>1SG:PST:DUR\carry
'Sometimes my mother carried me there on her shoulders.'

(122) *bobo kwäthayfm morehead station skulfo*
bobo kwä\thayf/m morehead station skul=fo
MED:ALL SG>1SG:ITER:DUR\present PLN station school=ALL
'She would always drop me off at Morehead station, at the school.'

(123) *nzone fam ke kwot thfrärm*
nzone fam keke kwot thf\rä/rm
1SG.POSS thought NEG properly 2|3PL:PST:DUR\be
'I wasn't very interested in school.'

(124) *bänethatha kwofrärm nima kunigakuniga mane ekonzrth ra erä*
bäne=thatha kwof\rä/rm nima kuniga~kuniga mane
PH=SIMIL 1SG:PST:DUR\be like_this REDUP~wild which
e\ko/nzrth ra e\rä/
2|3PL>2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\speak what.ABS 2|3PL:NPST:IPFV\be
'I was like a "wild" girl, or whatever they call'

(125) *bänema fzen bä*
bäne=ma fz=en bä
PH=CHAR forest=LOC MED
'those who live in the forest.'

(126) *bä nzfamnzrm ksi karen*
bä nzfa\m/nzrm ksi kar=en
MED 1PL:PST:DUR\sit grassland place=LOC
'We used to live in the bush.'

(127) *ni keke kwot mnzen nzwamnzrm*
ni keke kwot mnz=en nzwa\m/nzrm
1NSG NEG properly house=LOC 1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'We did not live in a proper house.'

(128) *nzone amayé bä thfamrnm mnz ksi karen*

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nzone ama=é bä thfa\m/rnm ksi kar=en
1SG.POSS mother=ABS.NSG MED 2|3DU:PST:DUR\sit grassland place=LOC
'My mothers lived in the bush.'

(129) *foba ane zunmätrath nima skulr*
foba ane zun\mätr/ath nima skul=r
DIST:ABL DEM 2|3DU>1SG:PST:PFV:VENT\exit like_this school=PURP
'They took me out of school.'

(130) *fi nanenzo z zäthba*
fi nane=nzo z zä\thb/a
3.ABS elder_sibling=ONLY IAM SG:PST:PFV\enter
'Only my big sister went'

(131) *watik naf namäme zfrärm*
watik naf namä=me zf\rä/rm
then 3SG.ERG good=INS 3SGF:PST:DUR\be
'and she did well in school.'

(132) *nzä mane kwofrärm*
nzä mane kwof\rä/rm
1SG.ABS which 1SG:PST:DUR\be
'But it was different with me.'

(133) *nima fefe kwafiyokwrm ausif fof nä kayé tokume kuzänzrm e bwrä skul*
nima fefe kwa\fiyok/wrm ausi=f fof nä
like_this really SG:PST:DUR\make old_woman=ERG.SG EMPH INDF
kayé toku=me ku\zä/nzrm e
one_day_away carry_piggyback=INS SG>1SG:PST:DUR\carry until
b=wo\rä/ skul
MED=1SG:NPST:IPFV\be school
'Some days, she really had to carry to the school.'

(134) *bä fefe kwamonegwrm we kwänbrimm*
bä fefe kwa\moneg/wrm we kwän\brim/m
MED really SG>1SG:PST:DUR\wait also SG>1SG:ITER:DUR:VENT\return
'Then she waited there for me and brought me back.'

(135) *e watik zänbrimake kanathr*

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e wati zän\brim/ake kanathr
until then 1PL:PST:PFV:VENT\return PLN
'We returned to Kanathér.'

(136) *prepen fof kuzänzrm*
prep=en fof ku\zä/nzrm
prep_school=LOC EMPH SG>1SG:PST:DUR\carry
'She was carrying me there during prep school,'

(137) *we one*
we one
also one
'and in grade one,'

(138) *two nimämä komnzo kwafiyokwrm*
two nima=ma komnzo kwa\fiyok/wrm
two like_this=CHAR only SG:PST:DUR\make
'and she did the same in second grade.'

(139) *kanathren mnz erwath fä nzwamnzrm*
kanathr=en mnz e\r/wath fä nzwa\m/nzrm
PLN=LOC house 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\build DIST 1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'They built a house in Kanathér, where we lived.'

(140) *nzä keke maf support nima yawiyawime*
nzä keke maf support nima yawi~yawi=me
1SG.ABS NEG who.ERG.SG support like_this REDUP~round_object=INS
'No one supported me with money (for the school fee).'

(141) *nima fefe nzone mane zfrärm zuzir zfyakm*
nima fefe nzone mane zf\rä/rm zuzi=r
like_this really 1SG.POSS which 3SGF:PST:DUR\be fishing=PURP
zf\yak/m
3SGF:PST:DUR\walk
'My mother would go fishing,'

(142) *marketr zfyakm*
market=r zf\yak/m
market=PURP 3SGF:PST:DUR\walk
'she sold the fish at the market.'

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(143) *wati gwonyame kwosi aneme kwazänzrm*
wati gwonyame kwosi ane=me kwa\zä/nzrm
then clothing dead DEM=INS SG>1SG.IO:PST:DUR\carry
'She then used this money to buy second-hand clothes.'

(144) *fi keke busy kwafiyokwrm nima a*
fi keke busy kwa\fiyok/wrm nima a
3.ABS NEG busy SG:PST:DUR\make like_this and
'She didn't mind doing all these things.'

(145) *"oh keke kwa nzä nima wäfiyokwé" fi naf nzä mon zfkonzrm*
oh keke kwa nzä nima wä\fiyok/wé naf
oh NEG FUT 1SG.ABS like_this 1SG>3SGF:NPST:IPFV\make 3SG.ERG
nzä mon zf\ko/nzrm
1SG.ABS how SG>3SGF:PST:DUR\speak
'"Oh, no (problem). I will do that for her" is what she was saying.'

(146) *ane yam naf zwafiyokwrm*
ane yam naf zwa\fiyok/wrm
DEM event 3SG.ERG SG>3SGF:PST:DUR\make
'She was doing this.'

(147) *keke zokwasi nzone kwarzrm ra zwäkorm*
keke zokwasi nzone kwa\rz/rm ra
NEG speech 1SG.POSS SG>1SG.IO:PST:DUR\throw what.ABS
zwä\kor/m
SG>3SGF:ITER:DUR\speak
'She always listened to me, to what I told her.'

(148) *kwa ane nzwäfiyokwrm naf nzonema*
kwa ane nzwä\fiyok/wrm naf nzone=ma
FUT DEM SG>1SG:PST:DUR\make 3SG.ERG 1SG.POSS=CHAR
'She did all those things for me.'

(149) *nane mane rera skul zabtha*
nane mane \rä/ra skul za\bth/a
elder_sibling which 3SGF:PST:IPFV\be school SG>3SGF::PST:PFV\finish
'Then my big sister finished school.'

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(150) *watik mosbi mizif zamesa nima*
wati mosbi mizi=f za\mes/a nima
then PLN pastor=ERG.SG SG>3SGF:PST:PFV\bring like_this
'A pastor from Moresby brought her,'

(151) *mosbi bä zwamnzrm*
mosbi bä zwa\m/nzrm
PLN MED 3SGF:PST:DUR\sit
'and she stayed with him in Port Moresby.'

(152) *watik nzänzo ane kwamonegwrm ama ausi*
wati nzä=nzo ane kwa\moneg/wrm ama ausi
then 1SG.ABS=ONLY DEM SG>1SG:PST:DUR\wait mother old_woman
'Then mum took care only of me'

(153) *kwot kwot kwot kwot 73*
kwot kwot kwot kwot 73
properly properly properly properly 1973
'up until 1973.'

(154) *73 nze grade 6 zabtha*
73 nze grade 6 za\bth/a
1973 1SG.ERG grade 6 SG>3SGF:PST:PFV\finish
'I finished grade 6 in 1973.'

(155) *watik select zwäfiyothath highschoolr*
wati select zwä\fiyoth/ath highschool=r
then select 2|3PL>1SG:PST:PFV\make highschool=PURP
'They selected me for high school.'

(156) *kma n si zäzira maf nä keke yakasi nzun*
kma n si zä\zir/a maf nä keke yaka-si
POT IMN eyes SG:PST:PFV\throw who.ERG.SG INDF NEG help-NMLZ
nzun
1SG.DAT
'I looked around, but no (financial) support for me.'

(157) *nze ama zakora "maski kwa namrn*

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nze ama za\kor/a maski kwa
1SG.ERG mother SG>3SGF:PST:PFV\speak nevermind FUT
na\m/rn
1DU:NPST:IPFV\sit
'I told mother "Nevermind, we'll stay here.'

(158) *nima fefe namrn nzefé kwa namonegwé"*
nima fefe na\m/rn nzefé kwa
like_this really 1DU:NPST:IPFV\sit 1SG.ERG.EMPH FUT
na\moneg/wé
1SG>2SG:NPST:IPFV\wait
'We are going to live here and I will look after you."'

(159) *kwot eh ... afa boba yanra*
kwot e afa boba yan\r/a
properly until father MED:ABL 3SGM:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'Time went by until father came.'

(160) *fi bä kwabznwrm kiungan*
fi bä kwa\bzn/wrm kiunga=en
3.ABS MED SG:PST:DUR\work PLN=LOC
'He used to work in Kiunga.'

(161) *watik party we ane funny story rä*
wati party we ane funny story ane \rä/
then party also DEM funny story DEM 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'There was a party, that's another funny story.'

(162) *wati bä rä party naf# nafa wäfiyokwath bä garaitan*
wati bä \rä/ party nafa wä\fiyok/wath
then MED 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be party 3NSG.ERG 2|3PL>3SGF:PST:IPFV\make
garaita=en
PLN=LOC
'They were having a party in Garaita.'

(163) *afa ane guitarkarä sfkogr*
afa ane guitar=karä sf\ko/gr
father DEM guitar=PROP 3SG:PST:STAT\be_standing
'Father was standing there with a guitar.'

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(164) *watik nzefé ane size swafiyokwrm "nzone kabe ane fof yé"*
wati nzefé ane size swa\fiyok/wrm nzone kabe ane
then 1SG.ERG.EMPH DEM size SG>3SGM:PST:DUR\make 1SG.POSS man DEM
fof \yé/
EMPH 3SGM:NPST:IPFV\be
'I picked him (thinking) "This one will be my husband."'[2]

(165) *watik kanathren ane ni nzwamnzrm*
wati kanathr=en ane ni nzwa\m/nzrm
then PLN=LOC DEM 1NSG 1PL:PST:DUR\sit
'Then we were living in Kanathér.'

(166) *watik afa ane boba binrä*
wati afa ane boba b yn\rä/
then father DEM MED:ABL MED 3SGM:NPST:IPFV:VENT\be
'Father visited us there.'

(167) *nä kayé nanyaka*
nä kayé nan\yak/a
INDF one_day_away 1PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come
'Other days, we went for a visit.'

(168) *watik zäbrima watik*
wati zä\brim/a wati
then SG:PST:PFV\return then
'Then he returned (to Kiunga).'

(169) *fobo bana bäne nafiyokwath fof fof nritakwath*
fobo bana bäne na\fiyok/wath fof fof
DIST:ALL pitiful PH.ABS 2|3PL>1PL:PST:IPFV\make EMPH EMPH
n\ritak/wath
2|3PL>1PL:PST:IPFV\cross
'That was the time, when we got engaged. They exchanged us.'

(170) *bäiŋafe zba ynrera*
bäiŋaf zba yn\rä/ra
exchange_uncle PROX:ABL 3SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
'The exchange man came here.'

[2] Abia and his brother Kaumb both played in a band.

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(171) *oriomon bä kwabznwrm fi*
oriomo=en bä kwa\bzn/wrm fi
PLN=LOC MED SG:PST:DUR\work 3.ABS
'He was working in Oriomo.'

(172) *oroman kwarkf zwäkora "watik naf kwa wfathwr fäms ŋarer"*
oroman kwark=f zwä\kor/a wati naf kwa
old_man deceased=ERG.SG SG>1SG:PST:PFV\speak enough 3SG.ERG FUT
w\fath/wr fäms ŋare=r
2|3SG>3SGF:NPST:IPFV\hold exchange woman=PURP
'The late old father said to me: "Okay, he will marry her as an exchange."'

(173) *watik ŋanafrath bobo mane bäne ykogr wari*
wati ŋa\naf/rath bobo mane bäne
then 2|3PL:PST:IPFV\talk MED:ALL which PH.ABS
y\ko/gr wari
3SGM:NPST:STAT\be_standing tree_species
'Then they arranged everything and talked where that one stands, that wari tree.'[3]

(174) *wari z ykonzrm*
wari z y\ko/nzrm
tree_species IAM SG>3SGM:NPST:IPFV\speak
'Do they call it wari?'[4]

(175) *keke bä kanathren mane yé zba mäbü mä ykogr*
keke bä kanathr=en mane \yé/ zba mäbü
NEG MED PLN=LOC which 3SGM:NPST:IPFV\be PROX:ABL tree_species
mä y\ko/gr
where 3SGM:NPST:STAT\be_standing
'No, it's the one that stands in Kanathér on this side, where the Mämbü tree grows.'

(176) *skiski fä äfiyokwath*
skiski fä ä\fiyok/wath
platform DIST 2|3PL>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\make
'They built a sitting platform'

[3] *wari* "Indian coral tree" (*Erythrina variagata*)
[4] She asks the others.

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(177) *garaitafa äniyaka*
garaita=fa än\yak/a
PLN=ABL 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come
'and some people came from Garaita.'

(178) *fäms ŋarane mrn änyaka garaitafa*
fäms ŋare=ane mrn än\yak/a garaita=fa
exchange woman=POSS.SG family 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come PLN=ABL
'The exchange woman's family came to Garaita.'

(179) *zba oroman kwarké änyaka fäms bobo*
zba oroman kwark=é än\yak/a
PROX:ABL old_man deceased=ABS.NSG 2|3PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\come
fäms bobo
exchange MED:ALL
'Their late old father and the exchange man came to this place.'

(180) *watik fä fof maret ŋafiyokwake*
wati fä fof maret ŋa\fiyok/wake
then DIST EMPH marriage 1PL:PST:IPFV\make
'Then we got married there.'

(181) *wati 75 afaf zwämesa kiunga*
wati 75 afa=f zwä\mes/a kiunga
then 1975 father=ERG.SG SG>1SG:PST:PFV\bring PLN
'The in 1975, father took me to Kiunga.'

(182) *katan ŋareŋare ane zwänmesa katan drisdriskaf*
katan ŋare~ŋare ane zwän\mes/a katan
small REDUP~woman DEM SG>1SG:PST:PFV:VENT\bring small
dris~dris=kaf
REDUP~dress=PROP
'I looked like a small girl in a dress when he brought me there.'

(183) *bä fthé samara nima sakorath "ra rä? nafangth rä o mon?"*
bä fthé sa\mar/a nima sa\kor/ath
MED when SG>3SGM:PST:PFV\see like_this 2|3PL>3SGM:PST:PFV\speak
ra \rä/ nafa-ngth \rä/
what.ABS 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be 3.POSS-younger_sibling 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be

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o mon
or how
'When they saw us, they wondered "Who's that? It that his small sister or what?"'

(184) *naf thukonzrm "keke! nzone ŋare rä"*
naf thu\ko/nzrm keke nzone ŋare \rä/
3SG.ERG SG>2|3PL:PST:DUR\speak NEG 1SG.POSS wife 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'He told them "No, she is my wife!"'

(185) *watik bä nanmza*
wati bä nan\m/nza
then MED 1PL:PST:IPFV:VENT\sit
'Then we lived there.'

(186) *nä ysokwr afaf bä nä ŋare wfnza*
nä ysakwr afa=f bä nä ŋare w\fn/za
INDF year father=ERG.SG MED INDF woman SG>3SGF:PST:IPFV\hit
'A year later, father had hit some woman there.'

(187) *afa zane gathagatha ebar sfrärm*
afa zane gatha~gatha ebar sf\rä/rm
father DEM:PROX REDUP~bad head 3SGM:PST:DUR\be
'Father was a bad guy then.'

(188) *razé short temper*
razé short temper
oh_yes short tempered
'Really a short-tempered guy.'

(189) *nafadben keke mistake*
nafadben keke mistake
3SG.LOC NEG mistake
'no mistakes with him.'

(190) *ane ŋare wfnza rumginae fobo satharufath diburar*
ane ŋare w\fn/za rumginae fobo
DEM woman SG>3SGF:PST:IPFV\hit PLN DIST:ALL
sa\tharuf/ath dibura=r
2|3PL>3SGM:PST:PFV\enter prison=PURP
'He had hit that woman and they took him to Rumginae prison.'

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(191) *ni nima fefe zänbrimake nzä zentharufa booten*
ni nima fefe zän\brim/ake nzä
1NSG like_this really 1PL:PST:PFV:VENT\return 1SG.ABS
zen\tharuf/a boat=en
SG:PST:PFV:VENT\enter_open_cont boat=LOC
'We he returned, we got on the boat (to go back down the Fly River).'

(192) *kowi fof warä ra*
kowi fof wa\rä/ ra
chicken EMPH 1SG.IO:NPST:IPFV\be what.ABS
'I had some chickens and all those things.'

(193) *watik nzä nima fefe zänbrima*
wati nzä nima fefe zän\brim/a
then 1SG.ABS like_this really SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return
'I returned for good then.'

(194) *zä kwamnzrm karen*
zä kwa\m/nzrm kar=en
PROX 1SG:PST:DUR\sit village=LOC
'I have been staying here in the village.'

(195) *fobo fefe zänbrima kanathr ausidben fä fof kwofrärm*
fobo fefe zän\brim/a kanathr
DIST:ALL really SG:PST:PFV:VENT\return PLN
ausi=dben fä fof kwof\rä/rm
old_woman=LOC.ANIM.SG DIST EMPH 1SG:PST:DUR\be
'When I returned from there, I stayed at Kanathér with old mother.'

(196) *watik zena zwamnzr*
wati zena z=wa\m/nzr
then now PROX=1SG:NPST:IPFV\sit
'I've been living here until today.'

(197) *nzone fam mane né bänemr erära nima schoolr*
nzone fam mane n bäne=r e\rä/ra nima
1SG.POSS thought which IMN PH=PURP SG>2|3PL:PST:IPFV\do like_this
school=r
school=PURP
'I was thinking of continuing school,'

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(198) *maf keke yakasinzo ane skul fee*
maf keke yaka-si=nzo ane skul fee
who.ERG.SG NEG help-NMLZ=ONLY DEM school fee
'but there was no help with the school fee.'

(199) *watik anema fefe nima zägathifa watik karen bana kwa wamnzr*
wati ane=ma fefe nima zä\gathif/a wati kar=en
then DEM=CHAR really like_this SG:PST:IPFV\leave then village=LOC
bana kwa wa\m/nzr
pitiful FUT 1SG:NPST:IPFV\sit
'Therefore I left it and (poor me) stayed in the village.'

(200) *okay nzone zawe ane fof rä nima*
okay nzone zawe ane fof \rä/ nima
okay 1SG.POSS preference DEM EMPH 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be like_this
'My occupation is like this'

(201) *kaben ra frasi yarithé*
kabe=n ra frasi ya\ri/thé
people=DAT.SG what.ABS hunger 1SG>3SGM.IO:NPST:IPFV\give
'I give to someone if he is hungry.'

(202) *nimame warfo kabef nzä zwäfrmsa*
nima=me warfo kabe=f nzä zwä\frms/a
like_this=INS above man=ERG.SG 1SG.ABS SG>1SG:PST:PFV\prepare
'God has blesses me in this way.'

(203) *zena nima wamnzr*
zena nima wa\m/nzr
today like_this 1SG:NPST:IPFV\sit
'That's how I live today.'

(204) *ane kwanmnzr kanathr masu roku*
ane kwan\m/nzr kanathr masu roku
DEM 1SG:PST:IPFV:VENT\sit PLN PLN PLN
'I have lived at Kanathér, then Masu and now Rouku.'

(205) *watik z zäkoré*
wati ausi z zä\kor/é
then old_woman IAM 1SG:RPST:PFV\become
'I have become an old woman now.'

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(206) *ausi kam we fänwä zfnrä zunfsrwrm*
ausi kam we fänwä zfn\rä/
old_woman bone also DIST:EMPH 3SGF:PST:IPFV:VENT\be
zun\rfrsr/wrm
SG:SBJ>3SGF:PST:DUR:VENT\take_along
'But I was also taking the old woman (my mother) around.'

(207) *zbo e watik zrä bana watik*
zbo e wati z=\rä/ bana wati
PROX:ALL until enough PROX=3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be pitiful enough
'She became weaker until one day (she died).'

(208) *nama fof bufrukaren kwot e zane z zäbtha*
nama fof bu-frukar=en kwot e zane
two_days_away EMPH 2SG.POSS-absence=LOC properly until DEM:PROX
z zä\bth/a
IAM 2|3SG:PST:PFV\finish
'She passed away only recently, while you were away.'

(209) *nima fefe komnzo zfthnm bana*
nima fefe komnzo zf\thn/m bana
like_this really only 3SGF:PST:DUR\lie_down pitiful
'The poor (old woman) was lying down most of the time.'

(210) *watik nzone story katan rä*
wati nzone story katan \rä/
then 1SG.POSS story small 3SGF:NPST:IPFV\be
'That's my little story.'

(211) *eso*
eso
thanks
'Thank you.'

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# Speaking the map

This is the first collection of texts in Komnzo.